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8000: The life of the believer

- 8010: Faith
- 8100: The life of faith
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- 8700: Threats to the life of faith

8010: Faith

- 8020: faith
- 8030: trust

8020: faith

A constant outlook of trust towards God, whereby human beings abandon all reliance on their own efforts and put their full confidence in him, his word and his promises.

8021: faith, nature of

Confidence in and commitment to God and Jesus Christ. These attitudes remain sure even though the objects of faith are unseen. True faith is seen in obedient action, love and continuing good works.

The object of faith

God as the object of faith

HEB 11:6 See also PSA 25:1–25:2, PSA 26:1; PRO 29:25; 1PE 1:21

Jesus Christ as the object of faith

JHN 14:1 See also JHN 3:16, JHN 3:18, JHN 3:36, JHN 6:68–6:69

False objects of faith

Human resources: PSA 20:7; ; HOS 10:13; PSA 118:9 other people; ; PRO 28:26 self; ; ISA 42:17 idols

Faith is personal trust in God

2SA 22:31 See also PSA 18:2–18:6, PSA 27:13–27:14; 1PE 2:23

True faith cannot be second-hand

2TI 1:5 See also JHN 4:42

Faith and assurance

Assurance accompanies faith

HEB 11:1 See also ROM 4:19–4:21; 1TI 3:13; HEB 10:22

Faith may be mixed with doubt

MAT 14:31 Simon Peter; ; MRK 9:24 the father of the boy with an evil spirit; ; JHN 20:24–20:28 Thomas

Faith and sight

2CO 5:7

Faith as trust in what is unseen

JHN 20:29 See also 2CO 4:18; HEB 11:1–11:3, HEB 11:7, HEB 11:27

Faith looks towards an unseen future

HEB 11:13–11:14 See also HEB 11:8–11:10 Abraham; HEB 11:20–11:22 Isaac, Jacob and Joseph; HEB 11:24–11:26 Moses

Faith and obedience

True faith is demonstrated in obedience

ROM 1:5; HEB 4:2 See also ROM 16:26; 2CO 9:13; 1PE 1:2

Examples of obedient faith

Noah builds the ark: GEN 6:22; ; HEB 11:7; GEN 12:4; ; HEB 11:8; GEN 22:1–22:10; ; HEB 11:17; EXO 14:15–14:16 Moses parts the sea.; NUM 13:30, NUM 14:8–14:9; JOS 3:5–3:13 Joshua at the river Jordan; ; JOS 6:2–6:5; ; HEB 11:30; JHN 21:4–21:6 Jesus Christ's disciples, fishing; ; ACT 26:19 Paul

Faith and works

True faith is demonstrated in good deeds

JAS 2:14–2:26 See also PHP 2:17; 1TH 1:3; TIT 1:1; 2PE 1:5

True faith issues in love

GAL 5:6 See also EPH 1:15, EPH 6:23; 1TH 3:6, 1TH 5:8; 1TI 1:5, 1TI 1:14, 1TI 4:12

True faith is constantly productive

LUK 8:15 parallels MAT 13:23, MRK 4:20 See also JHN 15:1–15:5

8022: faith, as basis of salvation

Both in the OT and in the NT faith is the only basis of salvation. Faith is the means by which God's grace in Christ, and with him the blessings of salvation, is received. Paul's doctrine of justification by faith emphasises the centrality of faith in the Christian life.

Salvation by faith in the OT

HAB 2:4

The faith of Abraham and other individuals

GEN 15:6 See also ROM 4:9–4:16 Abraham, the father of those righteous by faith; HEB 11:4 Abel; HEB 11:5 Enoch; HEB 11:7 Noah

Salvation by faith in the NT

ROM 1:16–1:17 See also 1CO 1:21; PHP 3:8–3:9

Salvation through faith alone

EPH 2:8–2:9 See also ROM 3:27–3:28, ROM 4:1–4:8; PSA 32:1–32:2; ROM 9:30–9:32; GAL 3:10–3:14; DEU 27:26

Salvation is by faith in Jesus Christ

JHN 3:14–3:16 Being “lifted up” is a reference to Jesus Christ’s death on the cross; **ROM 10:9–10:10** The necessity of outward confession, as evidence of personal faith in Jesus Christ. See also JHN 8:24; ACT 8:37, ACT 13:38–13:39; ROM 3:21–3:26, ROM 4:24; 2CO 4:13–4:14; GAL 3:22

Salvation is for all who believe

ROM 10:4 Jesus Christ is the “end of the law”, in the sense that he brings it to its goal and fulfilment, and accomplishes its intentions. See also ACT 15:7–15:9; ROM 3:29–3:30

Salvation is for those who persevere in their faith

COL 1:21–1:23 See also HEB 3:14, HEB 6:11–6:12

Saving faith shows itself in action

JAS 2:14

Blessings of salvation received through faith**Justification and peace with God**

See also ROM 5:1–5:2; GAL 2:15–2:16, GAL 5:5

Forgiveness

LUK 7:48–7:50; ; ACT 10:43

Adoption into God’s family

JHN 1:12; ; GAL 3:26

The gift of the Holy Spirit

JHN 7:38–7:39; ; GAL 3:2; ; EPH 1:13

Jesus Christ in the heart

EPH 3:17

Protection through God’s power

1PE 1:5

Access to God

EPH 3:12; ; HEB 10:22

Sanctification

ACT 26:17–26:18

New life

GAL 2:20

Eternal life

JHN 3:16, JHN 3:36, JHN 5:24, JHN 6:40, JHN 6:47

Victory over death

JHN 11:25–11:27

8023: faith, necessity of

A fundamental duty for all people and the necessary response to God’s self-revelation. The only channel through which God’s blessings may be received, and the only means by which life may be made meaningful, in relationship with God.

The call to faith**In the OT**

PSA 37:3–37:5 See also PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 26:4, ISA 50:10

In the NT

JHN 6:28–6:29 See also MRK 1:15; ACT 16:30–16:31, ACT 19:4, ACT 20:21; ROM 1:5; 1JN 3:23

God’s self-revelation leaves no excuse for unbelief

JHN 14:8–14:11; ROM 10:17–10:18 See also PSA 19:4; JHN 1:10–1:12; ROM 1:18–1:21, ROM 3:1–3:4; PSA 51:4; ROM 16:25–16:27

The need for faith in God**The LORD is the only true God**

HAB 2:18–2:20 See also PSA 115:2–115:11

God alone can be trusted absolutely

PSA 9:10 See also PSA 91:1–91:4; ISA 12:2; NAM 1:7

Faith in God is the basis for peace

ISA 26:3 See also PSA 42:11; JHN 14:1; ROM 15:13; 2PE 1:1–1:2

Faith is necessary to receive God’s blessing

HEB 11:6 See also PSA 40:4; JER 17:7–17:8; JHN 5:24

Faith is necessary to avoid God’s judgment

JHN 3:36 See also JHN 3:18; 2TH 2:12; 1PE 2:6–2:8; ISA 28:16; PSA 118:22; ISA 8:14

Actions not springing from faith are sinful

ROM 14:23 See also ROM 14:5–14:8, ROM 14:14

Unbelief challenged

HEB 3:12–3:18; ; PSA 95:7–95:8 comparison with the Israelites in the wilderness; ; ISA 7:9 Ahaz, king of Judah; ; JER 17:5–17:6 the people of Judah; ; MRK 16:14 Jesus Christ’s disciples after the resurrection

8024: faith, and blessings of God

Confidence in the ability and willingness of God to act in supernatural power to advance his kingdom, and a commitment, expressed in prayer and action, to being the means by which he does so.

God’s power is released through faith

MAT 17:20 See also MRK 9:23; LUK 17:6

Praying in faith

MAT 21:21–21:22 parallel MRK 11:22–11:24 See also JAS 1:5–1:7, JAS 5:14–5:15

Praying in Jesus Christ’s name

JHN 14:12–14:14

In the OT, faith in God's power

HEB 11:32–11:34 See also HEB 11:11–11:12 Abraham's faith when promised an heir in his old age; JOS 14:6–14:14 Caleb receives Hebron; 1SA 14:6 Jonathan's confidence in God's power to defeat the Philistines; 1SA 17:32–17:47 David's confidence in God's power to overcome Goliath; 2CH 20:20 Jehoshaphat's faith in God's power to give success against Moab and Ammon; 2CH 32:7–32:8 Hezekiah's faith in God when threatened by the Assyrians under Sennacherib; DAN 6:23 Daniel's faith when in the lions' den

In the NT, healing in response to faith

MAT 9:22 parallels MRK 5:34, LUK 8:48 The woman had exercised faith by touching the edge of Jesus Christ's cloak. See also MAT 9:29–9:30 Two blind men are healed; MRK 10:52 parallel LUK 18:42 Bartimaeus receives his sight; LUK 17:19 One of the ten men with leprosy who thanked Jesus Christ; ACT 3:16 the crippled man at the temple gate; ACT 14:8–14:10 the crippled man in Lystra

Powerful ministries marked by faith

ACT 11:24 See also ACT 6:5–6:10 Stephen; 1CO 12:9 Exceptional faith to meet specific needs is a special spiritual gift.

Faith and spiritual warfare

EPH 6:16 See also 1TH 5:8; 1JN 5:4–5:5

The importance of love accompanying faith 1CO 13:2

8025: faith, origins of

Faith is a gift from God himself and is not to be seen as the result of human striving or achievement. Faith is inspired by the word and works of God.

Faith is a gift from God

JHN 6:63–6:65; EPH 2:8–2:9 See also MAT 16:15–16:17; MRK 9:24; LUK 17:5; ACT 3:16, ACT 14:27, ACT 18:27; ROM 12:3; 1CO 4:7, 1CO 12:9; PHP 1:29; JAS 2:5

Faith comes through God's word

Faith following a direct word from God

HEB 11:29–11:30; ; EXO 14:15 Moses receives God's instructions at the Red Sea; ; JOS 6:2–6:5 Joshua receives God's instructions concerning Jericho; ; ACT 27:23–27:25

Faith through the Scriptures

JHN 2:22, JHN 20:30–20:31; ; 2TI 3:15

Faith comes through hearing God's word preached

ROM 10:14–10:17 See also ISA 52:7, ISA 53:1; JHN 1:7, JHN 4:41–4:42, JHN 17:20; ACT 11:19–11:21; 1CO 2:4–2:5

Faith comes through a personal encounter with Jesus Christ

JHN 9:35–9:38, JHN 20:26–20:28

Faith comes through witnessing miracles

JHN 14:11 See also JHN 2:11 the miracle at the wedding feast; JHN 4:53 Jesus Christ heals an official's son. JHN 11:45, JHN 12:11 ACT 9:42 the raising of Tabitha

Faith based on knowledge of God

Knowledge of God's faithfulness leads to faith

PSA 46:1–46:3; ; LAM 3:19–3:24; ; NAM 1:7; ; ACT 2:25–2:26

Knowledge of God's achievements leads to faith

DEU 3:21–3:22; ; 1SA 17:34–17:37; ; JER 14:22

8026: faith, growth in

Christians are called to have a growing faith, built up by prayer and the encouragement of others, and also through testing.

Examples of growing faith

2TH 1:3 See also ACT 16:5; 2CO 10:15; REV 2:19

Weak faith

Weak faith rebuked

MAT 6:28–6:30 parallel LUK 12:27–12:28 See also MAT 8:26 parallels MRK 4:40, LUK 8:25; MAT 14:31, MAT 16:8, MAT 17:20

Other examples of weak faith

JHN 12:42–12:43, JHN 19:38; ; ROM 14:1–14:2; ; 1CO 8:1–8:13

Strong faith

Strong faith commended and encouraged

HEB 10:22 See also MAT 8:10 parallel LUK 7:9; MAT 9:20–9:22 parallels MRK 5:25–5:34, LUK 8:43–8:48; MAT 15:28 parallel MRK 7:29

The faith of OT leaders

1KI 18:3 Obadiah; ; 2KI 18:5 parallel 2CH 31:20 Hezekiah

The faith of Christian leaders

1TI 4:12; HEB 13:7 See also ACT 6:5 Stephen; ACT 11:24 Barnabas; 2TI 3:10 Paul 1TI 6:11; 2TI 2:22

Other examples of strong faith

HAB 3:17–3:18 See also JOB 13:15, JOB 19:25–19:27; MAT 14:35–14:36 parallel MRK 6:56; 2CO 8:7; COL 2:5–2:7

The growth of faith

Praying for more faith

LUK 17:5 See also MRK 9:24

The encouragement of others

2CH 32:7–32:8; 1TH 3:10 See also NUM 14:6–14:9; LUK 22:32; ACT 14:22; ROM 1:11–1:12; 1TH 3:2–3:3; JUD 1:20

Faith strengthened through testing

ROM 4:18–4:21 See also GEN 15:5; JAS 1:2–1:4; 1PE 1:6–1:7

8027: faith, testing of

The means through which the genuineness of faith is proved and Christian character developed. God promises to help his people during times of testing.

God allows faith to be tested**Testing proves the genuineness of faith**

1PE 1:6–1:7 See also MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13

Testing develops Christian character

JAS 1:2–1:4 See also ROM 5:3–5:4

Testing purifies God's people

ISA 48:10 See also PSA 66:10–66:12; JER 9:7; ZEC 13:9; MAL 3:2–3:3; 1PE 4:17

Examples of God testing faith

Abraham is told to sacrifice Isaac: GEN 22:1–22:2; ; HEB 11:17–11:19; DEU 8:2–8:5 God tested Israel in the desert; ; JDG 7:1–7:8 God reduces Gideon's army; ; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30 Jesus Christ appears to discourage the Canaanite woman; ; JHN 11:1–11:6 Jesus Christ delays going to Bethany when Lazarus is ill.

Means by which faith is tested**God allows Satan to test faith**

JOB 2:7 See also LUK 22:31; 1TH 3:4–3:5; REV 2:10

Difficult circumstances test faith

1KI 17:17–17:18; ; 2KI 4:1, 2KI 4:27–4:28; ; ACT 14:22; ; 2CO 11:25–11:27

Persecution tests faith

DAN 6:10–6:12; ; ACT 8:1–8:4; ; HEB 11:35–11:38

Discouraging people test faith

2KI 18:19–18:25 parallels 2CH 32:10–32:15, ISA 36:4–36:10; ; MRK 5:35–5:36 parallel LUK 8:49–8:50; ; MRK 5:40 parallels MAT 9:24, LUK 8:53

God's promise of help during testing

ISA 43:2; LUK 22:32 See also PSA 91:14–91:15; 1CO 10:13; 2CO 12:7–12:9; 1PE 5:10; 2PE 2:9

God's help through the encouragement of others

1TH 3:2–3:3 See also 2CO 7:5–7:7

The response to trials**Rejoicing at sharing Jesus Christ's suffering**

1PE 4:12–4:13

Praying for God's help

HEB 4:14–4:16; ; 1PE 4:19

Persevering

JAS 1:12 See also 2TH 1:4; HEB 12:1–12:3; JAS 5:11; REV 2:3, REV 2:19

Examples of faith victorious through testing

GEN 22:9–22:12 Abraham; ; 2KI 6:15–6:17 Elisha's servant; ; JOB 1:22 Job; ; DAN 3:16–3:27 Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; ACT 5:27–5:29 the apostles; ; ACT 7:59–7:60 Stephen; ; 2CO 4:7–4:9 Paul

8028: faith, as a body of beliefs

That body of essential truth to which Christians hold. It is revealed by God and is to be passed on by faithful teachers. Believers are urged to remain true to the faith and to contend for it.

Faith as the truth that Christians believe

GAL 1:23; 1TI 2:7 See also ACT 6:7; EPH 4:5; 1TI 1:2; TIT 3:15

Terms equivalent to ``the faith''

The truth: JHN 14:6; ; 1TI 3:15; ; 3JN 1:3; ACT 2:42 the apostles' teaching; GAL 1:6–1:9; ; PHP 1:7; 2TI 1:13–1:14 the good deposit

Aspects of ``the faith'' summarised

ACT 2:22–2:24, ACT 2:32–2:33; ; 1CO 15:1–15:4; ; PHP 2:5–2:11; ; COL 1:15–1:20; ; 1TI 1:15, 1TI 3:16; ; 2TI 2:11–2:13; ; HEB 6:1–6:2

The source and transmission of the faith**The faith has been given by God**

GAL 1:11–1:12 See also JHN 1:17, JHN 8:40; 1CO 11:23; 2TI 3:16; 2PE 1:21

The faith is passed on by apostles and teachers

TIT 1:9 See also JHN 15:20; ACT 4:20; 2TI 2:2; 2PE 1:16

Christians must remain true to the faith

ACT 14:21–14:22; 1CO 16:13 See also HEB 4:14–4:16

Being strengthened in the faith

PHP 1:25; COL 2:6–2:7 See also EPH 4:11–4:13; JUD 1:20

The danger of turning from the faith

MAT 24:10; HEB 6:6 See also ACT 13:8; 2CO 13:5–13:6; 1TI 5:8, 1TI 6:10, 1TI 6:20–6:21; HEB 2:1, HEB 3:12, HEB 10:35, HEB 12:25

Christians must contend for the faith

PHP 1:27; JUD 1:3

Refuting false teachers

See also 1TI 4:1–4:6; 2TI 3:6–3:8; TIT 1:10–1:13; 2JN 1:7

Witnessing to the truth

1PE 3:15

Contending for the faith is a responsibility of leaders

Apostles: PHP 1:7, PHP 1:15–1:16; ; 2TI 4:7; 1TI 3:2 overseers, who must be able to teach; ; 1TI 3:9 deacons; ; 1TI 6:12 Timothy, responsible for the church at Ephesus

8030: trust

Reliance on and confidence in a person. Scripture affirms the total trustworthiness of God, especially in relation to his promises to his people. Christian faith is, essentially, trust in the person and character of God. While Scripture insists that believers should be able to trust one another, it also provides examples of false or misplaced trust.

8031: trust, importance of

Scripture emphasises the importance of putting one's trust in God. This trust, which is nurtured by an understanding of God's revealed truth, finds expression in a life lived according to his purpose. There are examples in Scripture of proper trust being placed in other people.

Grounds for trust in God

Trust in God's power and strength

EXO 14:31; 2TI 1:12 See also 2SA 22:1–22:3 parallel PSA 18:2–18:3; PSA 9:9–9:10, PSA 115:9–115:11, PSA 144:1–144:2

Trust in God's unfailing love

PSA 13:5 See also EXO 15:13; PSA 17:7, PSA 21:7, PSA 33:18, PSA 52:8, PSA 147:11

Trust in God's salvation

ISA 12:2 See also 1SA 17:37; PSA 22:4–22:5, PSA 40:2–40:3; ISA 25:9

Trust nurtured by God's revealed truth

PRO 22:19–22:21 See also PSA 18:30, PSA 119:42; PRO 30:5; JHN 12:36, JHN 14:1–14:3

Expressions of trust in God

Praise and worship

PSA 4:5, PSA 28:7, PSA 64:10; ; DAN 3:28

Perseverance in faith

ISA 7:4–7:7; ; JER 51:46–51:47; ; 2TH 1:4; ; HEB 10:35–10:36, HEB 12:2–12:3; ; JAS 1:12, JAS 5:11

Holding on to God's promise

1KI 8:56–8:57; ; PSA 130:5; ; ACT 26:7; ; ROM 4:20–4:21; ; COL 1:5

Jesus Christ's trust in the Father

LUK 23:46 See also PSA 31:5, PSA 22:8; MAT 27:43; HEB 2:13; ISA 8:17

King Hezekiah's trust in God

2KI 18:5–18:7 parallel 2CH 31:20–31:21 See also 2KI 18:30 parallel ISA 36:15; 2KI 19:14–19:19 parallel ISA 37:14–37:20; 2CH 32:20

Further examples of trust in God

RUT 2:12 Ruth; ; 1CH 5:20 the tribes of Reuben, Gad and Manasseh; ; DAN 3:17 Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; DAN 6:23 Daniel; ; ZEP 3:12 the meek and humble; ; ACT 14:23 members of the NT churches

The results of trusting in God

Peace

ISA 26:3–26:4 See also ROM 15:13

Security

PSA 37:3 See also PSA 32:10, PSA 125:1; PRO 29:25; ISA 28:16, ISA 57:13

Protection from danger

PSA 25:1–25:3, PSA 31:14–31:15, PSA 32:7, PSA 33:18–33:22, PSA 91:1–91:4

Freedom from fear

PSA 27:1 See also PSA 23:4, PSA 34:4, PSA 56:3–56:4, PSA 56:10–56:11, PSA 112:7

Prosperity

PRO 28:25 In the OT material prosperity is often seen as a sign of the spiritual wealth that belongs to those who trust God; ; PRO 16:20; ; JER 17:7–17:8

Strength

ISA 30:15, ISA 40:29–40:31

Physical life

PSA 25:20; ; JER 39:18, JER 49:11

Trust in people

God's servants entrusted with responsibility

1CO 4:1–4:2 See also LUK 16:1–16:2; 1TH 2:4; 2TI 1:14

Trust at home and work

PRO 31:10–31:11 A good wife gives her husband confidence; ; TIT 2:10 Employees should be trustworthy.

Examples of trusting others

GEN 39:4 See also GEN 41:39–41:40; EXO 19:9 Moses to be trusted by Israel; 1CH 9:22 the gatekeepers appointed by David and Samuel; NEH 2:6 Nehemiah

is trusted by Artaxerxes to return to Jerusalem; DAN 5:29–6:2 Daniel given responsibility; PHP 2:25 Paul's confidence in Epaphroditus; 2TI 2:2 Timothy to find others to be entrusted to teach the gospel

Continued trust in those who fail

JON 3:1–3:2 God re-appoints Jonah despite earlier disobedience. See also JHN 21:15 Jesus Christ reinstates Peter after his denial; ACT 15:37–15:39 Barnabas gives John Mark a second chance.

8032: trust, lack of

Forsaking God and relying on other objects of dependence. This is futile and it provokes God's anger. Failure to trust others may be the result of a betrayal of trust in the past.

Failure to trust God

The nature of failure to trust God

JER 2:13 See also DEU 31:16; ISA 8:6, ISA 65:11

Examples of failure to trust God

DEU 1:32–1:33 See also DEU 9:23; PSA 78:21–78:22; NUM 20:12 Moses and Aaron; 1KI 11:4 Solomon; 2CH 16:7 Asa; REV 3:17 the church at Laodicea

The consequences of failure to trust God

HEB 10:38–10:39 See also HAB 2:4; LEV 26:14–26:20; JER 13:24–13:25, JER 46:25; HOS 10:13–10:14

Objects of misplaced trust

Trust in false gods

PSA 40:4 See also DEU 31:20; PSA 4:2; ISA 42:17, ISA 47:9–47:10

Trust in alliances, real or metaphorical

ISA 31:1 See also ISA 28:15, ISA 30:1–30:2; JER 2:18

Trust in human strength and resources

JER 17:5 See also PSA 44:6–44:7, PSA 146:3; PRO 3:5, PRO 28:26; ISA 2:22, ISA 22:8–22:11, ISA 30:15–30:16; EZK 16:15

Trust in the outward form of religion

MIC 6:6–6:8 See also JER 7:14 trust in the temple; JER 28:15 trust in false prophecy; JHN 8:33 trust in descent from Abraham; ROM 2:17 trust in possession of the law

Trust in one's own righteousness

ROM 3:19–3:20 See also EZK 33:13; LUK 18:9

Trust in wealth

1TI 6:17 See also JOB 31:24–31:25; PSA 49:5–49:6, PSA 52:7, PSA 62:10; PRO 11:28; JER 48:7, JER 49:4; LUK 12:18–12:20

The futility of misplaced trust

JOB 15:31 See also JOB 8:13–8:15

Futility of trust in false gods

DEU 32:37–32:38; ; 1KI 18:26–18:29; ; PSA 115:5–115:8; ; ISA 37:19; ; HAB 2:18

Futility of trust in human resources

ISA 64:6 human righteousness; ; MAT 6:19–6:20 wealth and possessions; ; COL 2:8 human philosophy; ; JAS 4:13–4:14 human planning

Futility of trust in others

PRO 25:19; ; ISA 31:3

Failure to trust others

JDG 11:20; JER 12:6 See also NUM 21:23; JER 9:4; MIC 7:5–7:6; MAT 10:36; MRK 13:12; ACT 15:37–15:38; 2TI 4:14–4:15

8100: The life of faith

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8102: abiding in Christ

The NT stresses the need for believers to remain in Christ. The reality of this close personal relationship with Jesus Christ is expressed in obedience to his word and is essential to effective discipleship.

Jesus Christ tells his disciples to abide in him

JHN 15:4–15:9 See also MAT 24:10–24:13; LUK 9:62; JHN 6:67

NT writers exhort believers to abide in Christ

COL 2:6 See also GAL 4:9, GAL 5:5–5:6; COL 3:1–3:3; HEB 12:1–12:3

Abiding in Christ depends upon holding on to his teaching

1JN 2:24 See also JHN 8:31; 2TH 2:15; 2TI 3:14; 2JN 1:9; 3JN 1:3-1:4

It depends on obedience to him

JHN 15:10 See also MAT 7:24-7:25; JHN 14:23; JAS 1:25; 1JN 3:24

It requires living like Jesus Christ

1JN 2:6

Aids to abiding in Christ

Eating his flesh and drinking his blood

JHN 6:56 Jn 6:35-40 gives the primary explanation of this verse as being a metaphor of the believer coming in faith to Jesus Christ, “the bread of life”. But the verse also reflects the language of the Lord’s Supper.

The Spirit’s anointing

1JN 2:27 See also JHN 14:17; JHN 14:23; ROM 8:9; 1JN 3:24

Jesus Christ abides in believers

JHN 15:4 It is clear that the believer’s “abiding in Christ” and Jesus Christ’s “abiding in him” are closely connected, although the verse does not make their exact relationship clear. Because of Jesus Christ’s indwelling by his Spirit, believers are able to continue to live as his disciples; as they do so, the reality of his indwelling presence is deepened. See also JHN 17:23; COL 1:27; 1JN 3:24; REV 3:20

By his Spirit

JHN 14:17; ; ROM 8:9-8:10; ; 1CO 3:16; ; 1JN 2:27

By faith

EPH 3:17-3:19; ; GAL 2:20

Results of abiding in Christ

Fruitfulness

JHN 15:4-15:5 The picture of “bearing fruit” may cover many aspects of Christian life but it includes that of developing Christian character, effective Christian service and mission. These result, not from human effort, but from abiding in Christ. See also GAL 5:22-5:23

Answered prayer

JHN 15:7; JHN 15:16

Freedom from persistent sin

1JN 3:6-3:9 John is not saying that Christians are absolutely sinless. He says elsewhere that to claim sinless perfection is to deceive oneself (1Jn 1:8). But when people are born again there is the real possibility of living lives in which sin is not the norm. As

believers abide in Christ more deeply, the grip of sin upon their lives is lessened.

Relationship with God the Father

See also JHN 14:23; 2JN 1:9

Confidence in the face of the last day

1JN 2:28

Warnings to those who fail to abide in Christ

MAT 24:12-24:13; ; JHN 15:2; JHN 15:6; ; 1CO 15:2; ; HEB 6:4-6:6

8104: assurance

Certainty of a present relationship with God through Jesus Christ and a secure future hope which is based upon divine revelation, centred on the person, promises and action of God and confirmed by the Holy Spirit.

8105: assurance, basis of

The assurance of believers is based upon the certain knowledge of God revealed in creation and his mighty acts in history, upon the certainty of his promises, the vindication and resurrection of Christ and the inward testimony and outward demonstration of the power of the Holy Spirit.

Assurance is based upon the certain knowledge of God

Assurance comes from knowing God through creation

ROM 1:19-1:20 See also PSA 19:1-19:4; ACT 14:17

Assurance comes from knowing God through his mighty acts

EXO 6:7; EZK 37:13-37:14 See also EXO 16:12; EXO 29:46; JOS 3:10-3:13; 1KI 20:13; ISA 49:23; ISA 60:16; EZK 20:42; EZK 28:26

Assurance is based upon the certainty of God’s word

JHN 17:8; ; 1JN 5:9-5:10

Assurance because of God’s oath

HEB 6:17 See also GEN 50:24; DEU 4:31; DEU 7:7-7:9; ACT 2:30; HEB 7:21

Assurance because of God’s promise

JOS 1:9; ROM 4:20-4:21 See also JOS 23:10; JOS 23:14; 2SA 7:25-7:26 parallel 1CH 17:23-17:24; 1KI 8:56; PSA 145:13; ISA 33:6; HEB 13:5; JAS 1:12; JAS 2:5

Assurance is based upon God's vindication of his Son

Assurance because of the resurrection of Jesus Christ

ACT 2:32, ACT 17:31 See also ACT 1:3, ACT 1:22, ACT 10:39–10:41, ACT 13:30–13:31; ROM 1:4; 1CO 15:3–15:7; 1PE 1:3

Assurance because of the miracles of Jesus Christ
MAT 11:2–11:6 parallel LUK 7:18–7:23; ; JHN 4:48, JHN 10:38, JHN 14:11, JHN 20:30–20:31

Assurance comes through the work of the Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit assures believers by enabling outward demonstrations of God's power

HEB 2:4 See also MRK 16:17–16:18; 2CO 3:2–3:3; 1TH 1:5

The Holy Spirit assures believers by giving inward conviction

ROM 8:16; 1JN 4:13 See also JHN 15:26, JHN 16:8–16:11; ACT 5:32; GAL 4:6

The Holy Spirit assures believers by sealing God's promise

EPH 1:13–1:14 See also ACT 15:8; ROM 5:5; 2CO 1:22, 2CO 5:5; EPH 4:30; 1JN 3:24

Assurance based upon the testimony of God's people

Assurance because of the testimony of eye-witnesses

2PE 1:16–1:19 See also EXO 10:2; LUK 1:2–1:4; JHN 1:32–1:34, JHN 15:27, JHN 19:35; ACT 1:22, ACT 4:20; 1PE 5:1

Assurance because of the testimony of the apostles
ACT 22:14–22:15; ; 1CO 1:6, 1CO 2:1; ; 1TH 2:13; ; 1TI 2:5–2:7; ; REV 1:2

Assurance is based upon godly living

1JN 2:3–2:5 See also 1JN 2:23 right belief about Jesus Christ; 1JN 2:29 righteousness 1JN 3:9, 1JN 5:18 1JN 3:14–3:20 love for fellow believers; 1JN 5:1 love for God the Father and God the Son

8106: assurance, nature of

The God-given security which believers have in the blessings of divine grace. Believers are assured of the unfailing love of God and of their relationship with him as Father, the salvation and eternal life which he offers and the sure hope of one day sharing his glory.

Assurance of a relationship with God

Assurance of God's unfailing love

PSA 13:5 See also EXO 15:13; PSA 51:1, PSA 130:7–130:8; ISA 54:10; JHN 13:1; 1JN 4:9

Assurance of acceptance by God

ACT 15:8; ; ROM 5:1, ROM 14:3, ROM 15:7

Assurance of adoption as God's children

1JN 3:1–3:3 See also JHN 1:12–1:13; ROM 8:14–8:17; GAL 4:6; JAS 1:18; 1JN 4:7, 1JN 5:1

Assurance of God's presence

DEU 31:8 See also GEN 28:15; JOS 3:7; ISA 41:10; JER 1:8; MAT 28:20; JHN 14:18; ACT 18:10

Assurance of access to God

EPH 3:12 See also ROM 5:2; EPH 2:8; HEB 4:16, HEB 10:19–10:22

Assurance of salvation

ISA 12:2 See also PSA 69:13

Assurance of redemption

JOB 19:25; ; PSA 111:9; ; ROM 3:24; ; EPH 1:14; ; HEB 9:12

Assurance of justification

ROM 3:26, ROM 5:16, ROM 8:33–8:34; ; 1CO 6:11

Assurance of forgiveness

1JN 1:9 See also 2CH 7:14; PSA 32:5, PSA 103:12; ISA 43:25; JER 31:34, JER 36:3; MIC 7:18–7:19; LUK 24:47; ACT 2:38, ACT 3:19; COL 2:13–2:14

Assurance of election

ISA 43:1; EPH 1:4 See also ISA 44:1–44:2; ROM 8:28–8:30, ROM 11:29; 1CO 1:9; 2TI 1:9; 1PE 2:9–2:10

Assurance of preservation

2TI 1:12; JUD 1:24 See also JHN 6:39; ROM 8:38–8:39; 2CO 4:14; PHP 1:6; HEB 7:25; 2PE 1:10

Assurance of eternal life

JHN 3:15–3:16; 1JN 5:11–5:13 See also MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:30, LUK 18:30; JHN 5:24, JHN 6:40, JHN 11:25–11:26, JHN 17:2; 1JN 1:2, 1JN 5:20

Assurance of a future hope

Assurance of confidence at Jesus Christ's return

MAT 24:30–24:31 parallels MRK 13:26–13:27, LUK 21:27–21:28; ; 1TH 4:13–4:17

Assurance on the day of judgment

1CO 1:8; ; 1TH 3:13; ; 1JN 4:17

Assurance in the hope of resurrection

JHN 6:40; ; 1CO 15:42–15:44; ; PHP 3:21

Assurance in the hope of glory

ROM 8:18 See also ROM 5:2; COL 3:4; 1TH 2:12; 1PE 5:10; REV 5:10

Assurance in the hope of an eternal inheritance

ROM 8:17 See also MAT 25:34; GAL 4:7; HEB 9:15; 1PE 1:3–1:5

Assurance in the hope of an eternal reward

MAT 5:12 parallel LUK 6:23; ; 2TI 4:7–4:8; ; JAS 1:12

8107: assurance, and life of faith

The completeness of conviction and confidence expressed in the life of the believer, worked by the Holy Spirit. It derives from a reliance upon God and his promises alone, and results in boldness and steadfastness in service and in the face of difficulties.

Assurance and faith

DEU 9:3; HEB 10:22 See also DEU 1:21; JOS 1:9; 2CH 20:17; JHN 17:8; HEB 11:1; HEB 12:5

Assurance and hope

HEB 6:11 See also PRO 23:18; HEB 6:19

Assurance expressed by believers**Assurance in adversity**

HEB 13:6 See also PSA 118:6–118:7; PSA 3:6; PSA 27:3–27:5; PSA 46:1–46:3; PSA 71:5–71:6; PSA 73:26; ROM 8:38–8:39; 2CO 4:16

Assurance of God's promises

JOS 23:14 See also 1KI 8:56; ROM 4:20–4:21; 2CO 1:20

Assurance in ministry

ROM 1:16; 1TI 3:13 See also 2CO 3:4; 2CO 4:1; 2CO 5:14; 1TH 1:5; 2PE 1:12

Assurance in prayer

1JN 5:14 See also 1JN 3:21–3:22

Assurance of God's will

ROM 14:5 See also ROM 14:14; ROM 14:23; 1CO 8:9–8:11

Assurance may be strengthened**Examples of believers asking for assurance**

GEN 15:8 Abraham; ; EXO 33:16 Moses; ; JDG 6:17 Gideon; ; LUK 1:18 Zechariah

Assurance through understanding

COL 2:2

Assurance through waiting on God

PSA 46:10 See also PSA 27:14; PSA 33:20; ISA 30:15; ISA 32:17–32:18 The revelation of God's righteousness among his people results in true peace.

Assurance strengthened by others

2CH 32:6–32:8 by example; ; 2TI 3:14 through teaching; ; COL 4:12 through prayer; ; 1TH 3:2–3:3 through encouragement amidst trials

False teaching weakens assurance

2TH 2:2; ; 2TI 2:18

The delusion of false assurance**The danger of self-assurance**

LUK 18:9–18:14; ; 2CO 10:12; ; PHP 3:3–3:4

Such assurance proved false by conduct

1JN 1:6 See also 1JN 2:9–2:11; 1JN 3:6; 1JN 4:20; 2JN 1:9; 3JN 1:11

8108: assurance, and Holy Spirit

See [3203: Holy Spirit, and assurance](#)

8110: athletics

Sports engaged in by athletes. Scripture uses the image of running in a race to represent the Christian life. Believers should show similar perseverance as they press on to their heavenly reward.

The Christian life is like running a race

ACT 20:24 See also GAL 2:2; GAL 5:7; PHP 2:16; 1TI 1:18–1:19

Christians, like athletes, are to be single-minded

2TI 2:4–2:5 See also 1CO 9:24–9:27

Christians, like athletes, are to persevere

HEB 12:1 See also PHP 3:12–3:14; 1TI 6:12; REV 3:11

The reward at the end of the race of life

2TI 4:7–4:8 See also 1CO 9:25; JAS 1:12; 1PE 5:4; REV 2:10 The “crown” referred to is the garland or wreath awarded to the winner in athletics contests.

The race is not necessarily won by the swiftest

ECC 9:11

8112: certainty

A sure knowledge or conviction that what is believed is true and trustworthy. Christian certainty does not arise from the credulity of the believer, but is based on the faithfulness and trustworthiness of God.

Affirmations and statements of certainty

JOB 19:25 See also JOS 23:14; PSA 27:3; DAN 3:17; MRK 5:28 parallel MAT 9:21; LUK 1:3–1:4; ROM 8:38–8:39; PHP 3:8; 1JN 5:18–5:20

Certainty in God

Because of his character

HEB 6:18 See also NUM 23:19–23:20; DEU 7:9–7:10, DEU 32:3–32:4; 2SA 7:28; PSA 18:30–18:31; ISA 26:4

Because his promises are confirmed

HEB 6:16–6:19 See also ROM 15:8

His intervention encourages certainty

JDG 6:36–6:40 See also EXO 16:6–16:8, EXO 33:12–33:23; JOS 3:9–3:13; 1KI 18:36–18:39

Jesus Christ's certainty about his identity and mission

JHN 13:3 See also MRK 8:31 parallels MAT 16:21, LUK 9:22; JHN 10:14–10:18, JHN 14:6–14:11

Certainty and the believer

Certainty about who Jesus Christ is

2TI 1:12 See also MAT 16:16 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20; JHN 11:27, JHN 20:28–20:29, JHN 21:24

Certainty of salvation

2CO 1:21–1:22 See also ROM 4:16, ROM 8:31–8:39; PHP 1:6; HEB 6:18–6:19; 1JN 4:13

Certainty gained through obedience

1JN 2:3–2:6 See also MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:46–6:49

Certainty in prayer

1JN 5:14–5:15 See also MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; MAT 18:19–18:20, MAT 21:21–21:22 parallel MRK 11:22–11:24; JHN 14:13–14:14

An area of permissible uncertainty

MRK 13:32–13:37 See also ACT 1:6–1:7; 1TH 5:1–5:2

8114: discipleship

The process of becoming a committed follower of Jesus Christ, with all the spiritual discipline and benefits which this brings.

8115: discipleship, nature of

The state of following Jesus Christ, and serving and obeying him. The NT stresses the privileges, joys and cost of this calling.

Discipleship involves learning

Learning from God

JHN 6:45 See also ISA 54:13; LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7; EPH 5:1–5:2; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Learning from Jesus Christ

MAT 11:29 See also JHN 13:15; EPH 4:20–4:21; PHP 2:5; 1PE 2:21; 1JN 2:6

Learning from the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:26 See also LUK 12:12; JHN 16:13; 1CO 2:13; EPH 1:17, EPH 3:16–3:19; 1PE 1:12

Learning from other people

PHP 4:9 See also DEU 4:10, DEU 5:1, DEU 31:12; 1CO 4:6, 1CO 4:16, 1CO 11:1; PHP 3:17; 2TH 3:7, 2TH 3:9; 1TI 2:11, 1TI 5:4; 2TI 3:14

Learning to do what is good

TIT 3:14 See also PSA 34:14, PSA 37:27; ISA 1:17, ISA 26:9; 3JN 1:11

Jesus Christ calls people to be his disciples

MAT 4:19 parallel MRK 1:17 See also MAT 4:21 parallel MRK 1:20 Jesus Christ calls James and John; MAT 8:21–8:22 parallel LUK 9:59–9:60; MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:27 Jesus Christ calls Matthew; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; JHN 1:43 Jesus Christ calls Philip; JHN 21:19

The consequences of discipleship

Following Jesus Christ

MAT 10:38 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; LUK 14:27; JHN 10:27, JHN 12:26; REV 14:4

Serving Jesus Christ

COL 3:24 See also MAT 20:25–20:28 parallel MRK 10:42–10:45; ROM 12:11; 1TH 1:9

Obeying Jesus Christ

JHN 8:31 See also JHN 14:21, JHN 14:23–14:24, JHN 15:10, JHN 15:14; 1JN 2:3, 1JN 3:22, 1JN 3:24, 1JN 5:3

Responding immediately to Jesus Christ's commands

MAT 8:21–8:22 See also MAT 4:20 parallel MRK 1:18; MAT 4:22 parallels MRK 1:20, LUK 5:11

Living for Jesus Christ and not for oneself

2CO 5:15 See also ROM 14:7–14:8; 1PE 4:2

Loving others

JHN 13:12–13:17 See also JHN 15:9–15:14; 1JN 4:7–4:21

Total commitment is required of Jesus Christ's disciples

MAT 10:37–10:39 See also MAT 16:24–16:25 parallels MRK 8:34–8:35, LUK 9:23–9:24; MRK 6:8; LUK 14:26–14:27, LUK 17:33; JHN 12:25

The purpose of discipleship is to become Christ-like

EPH 4:22–4:24 See also MAT 5:48; LUK 6:40; ROM 8:29 God's purpose in election; ROM 12:1–12:2, ROM 13:14; 2CO 3:18, 2CO 7:1; EPH 1:4; COL 1:28, COL 3:12; 2TI 3:17 the purpose of Scripture; 1PE 1:14–1:15 a call to holiness; 2PE 1:5–1:7; 1JN 3:2–3:3

Examples of secret discipleship

JHN 3:1–3:2 See also JHN 7:50, JHN 12:42, JHN 19:38–19:39

8116: discipleship, cost of

The denial of self-interests and desires, and a total commitment to do the will of God, even to the point of death.

The cost of discipleship involves a denial of self-interests and desires**The cost involves self-denial**

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 See also MAT 10:38; LUK 14:27

Self-denial means not living for oneself

ROM 14:7 See also 2CO 5:15; GAL 2:20; 1PE 4:2

The cost of discipleship is to be carefully considered

LUK 14:28–14:32

The cost of discipleship means total commitment to the will of God**Total surrender is required**

LUK 14:33 See also PHP 3:7–3:8

The security of the world is to be resisted

MAT 8:19–8:20 parallel LUK 9:57–9:58

Jesus Christ must have first priority

LUK 9:59–9:60 parallel MAT 8:21–8:22 See also MAT 19:16–19:21 parallels MRK 10:17–10:21, LUK 18:18–18:22; COL 1:18

Jesus Christ must come before family ties

LUK 9:61–9:62 See also MAT 10:37; LUK 14:26

The cost of discipleship is constant

LUK 9:23

The cost of discipleship includes persecution

JHN 15:20 See also ACT 14:22; 2TI 3:12

The cost of discipleship includes willingness to suffer and die for Jesus Christ's sake

MAT 10:38–10:39 See also MAT 16:24–16:25 parallels MRK 8:34–8:35, LUK 9:23–9:24; JHN 12:25

8117: discipleship, benefits of

Joy, peace and happiness result from following Jesus Christ, together with the hope of being like him and with him in heaven. This is anticipated in the OT, which stresses the importance of obedience to the LORD.

Blessings result from obedient discipleship

LUK 11:28 See also PRO 8:32; MAT 7:24–7:25 parallel LUK 6:47–6:48; JHN 13:17, JHN 14:21; JAS 1:25

Joy results from discipleship

JHN 15:10–15:11 See also PSA 119:14; ACT 13:52, ACT 16:34 the Philippian jailer; ROM 14:17, ROM 15:13; GAL 5:22 the fruit of the Spirit; PHP 1:25; 1TH 1:6; HEB 10:34; 1PE 1:6, 1PE 1:8; JUD 1:24

Peace results from discipleship

JHN 14:27 See also NUM 6:26; PSA 4:8, PSA 29:11, PSA 37:11; ISA 26:3; MAT 11:28–11:29 Jesus Christ promises rest for the weary; LUK 2:14 the angels' greeting to the shepherds at the birth of Jesus Christ LUK 24:36; JHN 20:19 JHN 16:33, JHN 20:21, JHN 20:26; ROM 2:10, ROM 5:1; PHP 4:7; COL 3:15

True happiness results from discipleship**Happiness flows from doing God's will**

PSA 1:1, PSA 119:1–119:2 See also PSA 94:12, PSA 112:1, PSA 128:1; PRO 29:18

Disciples are truly happy

MAT 5:3–5:12 parallel LUK 6:20–6:23 See also REV 1:3, REV 22:14

Disciples are abundantly recompensed in this life

MRK 10:29–10:30 parallels MAT 19:29, LUK 18:29–18:30 See also PRO 15:16, PRO 16:8; MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; JHN 8:12, JHN 10:27, JHN 12:26; ROM 8:31–8:39; 1TI 6:6

Disciples are blessed by being united with Jesus Christ in the family of God

MAT 12:46–12:50 parallels MRK 3:31–3:35, LUK 8:19–8:21 See also GAL 6:10; EPH 2:19, EPH 3:15

Disciples will be blessed with eternal life

MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:30, LUK 18:30 See also MAT 25:46; ROM 2:7; GAL 6:8; 1JN 1:2, 1JN 5:11, 1JN 5:13, 1JN 5:20

Disciples have the hope of being like Jesus Christ and being with him in heaven

1JN 3:2 See also JHN 12:26, JHN 14:3; ROM 8:29; 1CO 15:49; 2PE 1:4

8120: following Jesus Christ

The NT provides examples of individuals who followed Jesus Christ and of the implications of this decision for their lives.

Examples of those who followed Jesus Christ

Crowds of people

MAT 4:25 See also MAT 8:1, MAT 12:15 parallel MRK 3:7; MAT 14:13 parallels LUK 9:11, JHN 6:2; MAT 19:2; MRK 2:15, MRK 5:24; LUK 7:9, LUK 7:11

Those who were healed

MAT 20:34 See also MRK 10:52 parallel LUK 18:43

Those who were needy

MAT 9:27

The disciples

MAT 8:23 See also MRK 14:51, MRK 15:41; JHN 18:15

Examples of those who obeyed Jesus Christ's call to follow him

Peter and Andrew

MAT 4:18–4:20 parallel MRK 1:16–1:18 See also LUK 5:11

James and John

MRK 1:19–1:20

Matthew

MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:27–5:28

Philip

JHN 1:43–1:45

Examples of those who hesitated when called to follow Jesus Christ

See also MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22–18:23; LUK 9:59–9:60

Wrong motives in following Jesus Christ

1CO 1:11–1:13

The cost of following Jesus Christ

Carrying one's cross

MAT 16:24–16:26 parallels MRK 8:34–8:37, LUK 9:23–9:25 See also MAT 10:37–10:39; LUK 14:25–14:33; JHN 12:23–12:25

Leaving security behind

MAT 8:19–8:20 parallel LUK 9:57–9:58 See also LUK 9:61–9:62

Those who failed to persevere in following Jesus Christ

JHN 6:66

Those who persevered under suffering in following Jesus Christ

See also JHN 13:12–13:17, JHN 21:19; ACT 22:4, ACT 24:14; ROM 15:5; 1CO 11:1; 1TH 1:6; 1PE 2:20–2:23; REV 14:4, REV 17:14

The blessings of following Jesus Christ

MAT 19:27–19:30 parallels MRK 10:28–10:31, LUK 18:28–18:30 The reward is not on the basis of merit but the free gift promised to those who follow Jesus Christ. See also JHN 8:12, JHN 12:26

The limits on following Jesus Christ

JHN 13:36

8122: friendship, with God

A relationship of love and faithfulness into which God calls all people through faith.

Examples of friendship with God

Abraham

JAS 2:23 See also 2CH 20:7; ISA 41:8

Moses

EXO 33:11 See also NUM 12:8; DEU 34:10

Job

JOB 29:4–29:5 See also JOB 16:20–16:21

Examples of friendship with Jesus Christ

Mary, Martha and Lazarus

JHN 11:5 See also JHN 11:3, JHN 11:11, JHN 11:35–11:36, JHN 12:1–12:2

The beloved disciple

JHN 13:23 “the disciple whom Jesus loved” is generally thought to be John. See also JHN 19:26, JHN 20:2, JHN 21:7, JHN 21:20

The disciples

JHN 15:14–15:15

The ministry of Jesus Christ is an expression of friendship to sinners

In his life on earth

MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34 See also LUK 7:39, LUK 19:7

In his death on the cross

JHN 15:13; ROM 5:7–5:8 See also LUK 12:4; JHN 3:16; 1PE 3:18

God's delight in friendship with those who he loves

ISA 5:7; HOS 11:1–11:4 See also 1JN 1:3

The reliability of God as a friend

ISA 54:10 See also DEU 7:9; JOS 1:5; PRO 18:24; JHN 13:1; HEB 13:5

God's invitation for people to know his friendship
PSA 145:18; JAS 4:8; REV 3:20 Sharing a meal is a strong expression of friendship in Scripture. See also ZEC 1:3; MAL 3:7; ACT 17:27; JAS 4:4

8124: guidance

God has purposes and plans for his people, as individuals and communities. Believers and churches should seek his direction and counsel in discerning these purposes and plans in their lives.

8125: guidance, God's promises of

Scripture bears witness to God's promises of guidance for his people.

All God's intentions will be realised

God has purposes

ISA 14:27 See also JOB 36:5; ISA 55:10–55:11; JER 23:20; ROM 8:28; EPH 3:10–3:11; 2TI 1:9; HEB 6:17

God has plans

LAM 2:17 See also PSA 33:11, PSA 40:5; PRO 16:9; ISA 14:24, ISA 25:1, ISA 37:26

God desires his purposes and plans to be fulfilled

LUK 22:42 parallels MAT 26:39, MRK 14:36 **ACT 21:14** See also 1CH 13:2; PSA 57:2, PSA 138:8; ACT 18:21; ROM 1:10, ROM 15:32; JAS 4:13–4:15

Examples of God working out his purposes

ACT 2:23 ISA 46:10–46:11, ISA 48:14; JER 29:10–29:11 restoration of Israel after the exile; ; ACT 13:36 David; ; ROM 9:11–9:12 Esau and Jacob; ; ROM 9:17 Pharaoh

God promises to guide Israel and Judah

EXO 15:13 See also EXO 32:34; PSA 23:2–23:3, PSA 48:14; ISA 30:21, ISA 49:10, ISA 58:11; JER 31:8–31:9; EZK 34:11–34:16; LUK 1:76–1:79

Other promises of God's guidance

GEN 12:1, GEN 26:2–26:3; ; ISA 16:3; ; PSA 32:8, PSA 67:4; ; ISA 42:16; ; REV 7:17

8126: guidance, need for God's

God's guidance is needed because people are naturally ignorant and rebellious and there are many who lead others astray.

The need to know and do the will of God

JER 10:23 See also EZR 7:18; 1TH 4:3; HEB 13:20–13:21; 1PE 2:15; 1JN 2:17; MAT 6:10, MAT 7:21, MAT 12:50 parallels MRK 3:35, LUK 8:21; JHN 7:17

The concern of Jesus Christ to do the will of God

JHN 6:38 See also JHN 4:34

By themselves people are ignorant of the right way in life

PRO 14:12 See also ECC 6:12, ECC 8:7; ISA 53:6, ISA 59:10 blindness the result of disobedience; MAT 9:36; 1PE 2:25

Warnings against false guidance

False prophets and teachers

JER 23:25–23:27; LUK 11:52 parallel MAT 23:13 See also ISA 9:16; JER 23:13, JER 27:9–27:10; MIC 3:5; 2PE 2:1–2:3; JUD 1:17–1:19

False shepherds and guides

JER 50:6; MAT 24:24 See also ISA 3:12; JER 10:21, JER 23:1–23:2; EZK 34:4–34:6; MAT 15:14; ACT 20:30

Idols and mediums

ZEC 10:2 See also LEV 19:31; ISA 41:22–41:24; AMO 2:4; HAB 2:19

Other agencies

1KI 11:3; ; 2KI 21:9; ; 2CH 21:11; ; PRO 16:29; ; 1CO 15:33; ; REV 12:9, REV 18:23

Despite knowing God's will, sinners still rebel against him

JER 18:11–18:12 See also ISA 30:9–30:11; JER 6:16, JER 42:5–42:6, JER 42:19–42:21; 2TI 4:3

The adverse consequences of false guidance and disobedience

1CH 10:13–10:14 See also JOB 5:12; PSA 33:10–33:11, PSA 146:3–146:4; ISA 19:3, ISA 30:1; JER 19:7; HOS 11:5–11:7; HEB 3:7–3:11; PSA 95:7–95:11

8127: guidance, of Holy Spirit

See [3263: Holy Spirit, guidance of](#)

8128: guidance, receiving God's

God's guidance is promised to those who genuinely desire it and seek it.

God's readiness to guide his people

PSA 25:4–25:5; JAS 1:5 See also EXO 33:12–33:16; JOB 6:24; PSA 5:8, PSA 27:11, PSA 31:3, PSA 61:1–61:2, PSA 86:11, PSA 143:8

Guidance is given through the truth and counsel of God

PSA 43:3 See also PSA 16:7–16:8, PSA 73:23–73:24, PSA 119:35, PSA 119:105, PSA 119:133; JHN 10:3–10:4, JHN 10:27

Guidance is given to the humble and penitent

PRO 3:5-3:6 See also 2CH 6:26-6:27; PSA 25:9, PSA 139:23-139:24; ISA 57:15, ISA 57:18-57:19; JER 50:4-50:5; EZK 20:1-20:3, EZK 20:30-20:31

Guidance is given to those willing to obey God's will

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35-14:36, LUK 22:42 See also NUM 14:8-14:9; PSA 32:8-32:9; ISA 48:17-48:18; ROM 12:1-12:2

The role of the Holy Spirit in guidance

LUK 12:11-12:12 See also PSA 143:10; JHN 16:13; ACT 10:19-10:20, ACT 13:2, ACT 16:6-16:7; GAL 5:18; 1JN 2:26-2:27

Receiving guidance from Scripture

PSA 119:105, PSA 119:133 See also PSA 19:8; ISA 8:19-8:20; ACT 17:11; 2PE 1:19

Means of being guided by God**The pillar of cloud and the pillar of fire**

EXO 13:21-13:22 See also EXO 14:19-14:20; NEH 9:19

The Urim and the Thummin

EXO 28:29-28:30; ; NUM 27:21

The casting of lots

1SA 14:36-14:42; ; PRO 16:33; ; JON 1:7; ; ACT 1:26

Dreams and visions

MAT 2:19-2:20; ACT 9:10-9:11 See also GEN 40:5-40:8; JOL 2:28; ACT 10:3-10:6, ACT 11:5-11:9

Angels

ACT 8:26 See also ACT 5:19

8129: guidance, examples of God's

Scripture provides numerous examples of individuals who have realised their need of God's guidance and who have been given direction by him.

Examples of God taking the initiative to lead his people**God's guidance of Israel and her leaders at the exodus**

EXO 13:17-13:18; ; DEU 8:2, DEU 8:15, DEU 32:12; ; JOS 24:2-24:3; ; PSA 77:19-77:20, PSA 106:9; ; ACT 7:36, ACT 13:17

God's guidance likened to that of a shepherd

PSA 23:1-23:3 See also PSA 78:52-78:54; ISA 40:11, ISA 63:11-63:14; JER 23:3; EZK 34:12-34:13; HOS 11:3-11:4; JHN 10:3

God's guidance of Paul during his missionary journeys

ACT 16:6-16:10

Examples of God responding to requests for guidance**Abraham's servant**

GEN 24:12-24:27

Balaam

NUM 23:3-23:8

Gideon

JDG 6:36-6:40

Israel

JDG 20:23-20:28; ; PSA 107:4-107:7, PSA 107:23-107:30

Saul and Samuel

1SA 9:6-9:10, 1SA 9:15-9:20, 1SA 10:20-10:24

David

1SA 23:1-23:5, 1SA 30:7-30:8; ; 2SA 2:1, 2SA 5:18-5:19, 2SA 5:22-5:25

Ahab and Micaiah

1KI 22:12-22:23

Josiah and Huldah the prophetess

2KI 22:13-22:20

Jehoshaphat and Jahaziel the son of Zechariah

2CH 20:15-20:17

Zedekiah and Jeremiah

JER 21:1-21:7

Examples of God's guidance being refused or disobeyed**Saul**

1SA 28:4-28:7

The people of Jerusalem

JER 2:13-2:17, JER 43:1-43:4

8130: guidance, from godly people

Scripture gives examples of God guiding his people through the example and witness of godly leaders and men and women of faith.

The guidance of godly leaders**Moses**

EXO 32:34, EXO 33:12-33:17; ; DEU 10:11, DEU 31:2

Joshua

NUM 27:15-27:18; ; DEU 1:38, DEU 3:28; ; JOS 1:6

Gideon

JDG 7:17

David

2SA 5:1–5:2 parallel 1CH 11:1–11:2; ; PSA 78:70–78:72

Solomon

1KI 3:5–3:13 parallel 2CH 1:7–1:12

Israel's priests

DEU 17:9–17:10; ; MAL 2:6–2:7

Israel's shepherds

JER 3:15, JER 23:3–23:4

Pastors and teachers in the church

EPH 4:11–4:13; ; 2TI 2:24–2:26

Godly parents

GEN 18:19; ; PRO 4:11–4:13, PRO 6:20–6:23, PRO 13:1, PRO 22:6; ; EPH 6:4

Other godly people

JOB 31:18; ; PRO 16:23; ; DAN 5:12–5:17

8131: guidance, results of

Wise counsel, advice and direction from God or his servants, if carefully followed, will enrich and benefit those to whom it is given.

Guidance resulting in military victory

2SA 5:17–5:20 parallel 1CH 14:8–14:11 See also JOS 6:1–6:21, JOS 8:1–8:22; JDG 6:33–7:25; 2SA 5:22–5:25 parallel 1CH 14:13–14:16

Guidance resulting in safety

MAT 2:1–2:23

Guidance resulting in personal benefit

2SA 2:1–2:4 See also GEN 24:10–24:27, GEN 41:1–41:49; 2KI 5:1–5:14

Guidance resulting in the appointment of leaders

ACT 13:1–13:3 See also 1KI 19:15–19:21; LUK 6:12–6:16; ACT 1:15–1:26

Guidance inspiring confidence

ACT 23:11 See also GEN 46:1–46:7; ACT 18:9–18:11

Guidance resulting in spiritual growth

PRO 9:9 See also EXO 16:1–16:30; 1KI 19:3–19:18; ACT 9:1–9:19

Guidance eliciting praise and worship

DAN 2:19–2:23 See also EXO 14:15–15:21; 2SA 7:1–7:29; PSA 73:23–73:28

Guidance leading to obedience

GEN 12:1–12:5 See also GEN 6:9–6:22; JDG 6:11–6:27

Guidance disregarded

MAT 19:16–19:22 parallels MRK 10:17–10:22, LUK 18:18–18:23 See also GEN 3:1–3:6; 1KI 22:1–22:38

8134: knowing God

A faith-relationship and love-relationship with God involving mind, heart and will, and bringing experience of his presence and power. To know God is to worship him and be transformed by him. Human knowledge of God, which begins with knowledge about him, comes through God's self-revelation.

8135: knowing God, nature of

To know God is not merely to know things about him, such as his character, but also to experience his presence and power. To know God is to be transformed by him. Human knowledge of God is as a result of God's revelation of himself.

The origin of knowing God**Knowing God depends on revelation**

ROM 11:33–11:36 See also ISA 40:13; DEU 29:29; NUM 12:6, NUM 23:3; JOB 12:22; ISA 40:5, ISA 65:1; EZK 20:5; DAN 2:20–2:23, DAN 2:28 AMO 4:13; MAT 11:25–11:27 parallel LUK 10:21–10:22 Jesus Christ praises the Father for the revelation the disciples receive; ROM 16:25–16:26; GAL 1:12; EPH 3:4–3:5

God gives knowledge of his reality through creation

ROM 1:20 See also PSA 8:1, PSA 19:1–19:4, PSA 97:6; ACT 14:17, ACT 17:24–17:27

God gives knowledge of his mercy and his will through Scripture, both law and gospel

ROM 1:17 See also DEU 31:13; ACT 10:36; 1CO 1:20–1:21; HEB 8:10–8:11; JER 31:33–31:34

God gives knowledge of himself through Jesus Christ

MAT 11:27 parallel LUK 10:22 See also JHN 3:2, JHN 8:19, JHN 10:32, JHN 14:7, JHN 16:30, JHN 17:3; COL 2:2; 2TI 1:9–1:10; 1PE 1:20–1:21

God gives knowledge of himself and his ways through the Spirit

EPH 1:17 See also ISA 11:2; JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:12–16:15; ACT 4:31; 1CO 2:9–2:11, 1CO 12:8; EPH 3:16–3:19; 1PE 1:12

God gives knowledge of his greatness and grace through experience of him, submission to him and in answer to prayer

PSA 56:9–56:11 See also EXO 9:29; PSA 17:6–17:7, PSA 66:19–66:20; ISA 41:19–41:20, ISA 45:3–45:6, ISA 50:4, ISA 60:16; JER 22:16, JER 24:7; EZK 6:7

The nature of knowing God

Knowing his character

JON 4:2 See also DEU 7:9; PSA 9:10, PSA 36:10, PSA 135:5; 1TH 4:3–4:5; 1JN 4:8, 1JN 4:16

Knowing his words and works

AMO 3:7 See also GEN 41:25 Pharaoh; EXO 6:6–6:7, EXO 7:5, EXO 7:17, EXO 18:11; DEU 29:29ISA 3:7, ISA 3:21ISA 17:46; 2SA 7:21 parallel 1CH 17:19; 2SA 7:27 parallel 1CH 17:25 2KI 8:10 Elisha; 2KI 19:19 Hezekiah; PSA 147:19; EZK 20:9; LUK 2:26 Simeon; JHN 17:8; ACT 2:22, ACT 22:14

To know Jesus Christ is to know God

JHN 14:6; COL 1:15 See also MAT 16:16–16:17; JHN 8:19, JHN 15:15, JHN 16:15, JHN 17:26; COL 2:2–2:3; 1JN 5:20

To know God is to experience his salvation

JHN 17:3 See also PSA 17:6–17:7; ISA 25:9, ISA 43:12, ISA 52:10, ISA 56:1; 1JN 5:13, 1JN 5:20

8136: knowing God, effects of

Knowing God has a transforming effect on a person spiritually and morally and makes that person bold in actions for God. Not knowing God in the present will result in dissatisfaction and degeneration into wickedness and in the future will bring eternal alienation from him.

The effects of knowing God

Spiritual transformation: from death to life

COL 1:9 See also JHN 17:3; GAL 4:8–4:9; EPH 1:17, EPH 3:19; COL 2:2

Moral transformation: from evil to good

PRO 2:1–2:6; 2CO 10:5; 1TH 4:3–4:5 See also ROM 16:26; EPH 4:17–4:24; PHP 1:9–1:11; COL 1:10; 1JN 3:10, 1JN 4:8

Boldness of action for God

JER 32:38–32:39; DAN 11:32 See also PSA 138:3; PRO 28:1; ACT 6:8–6:10; 2CO 3:12; 1PE 1:13

Biblical images of knowing God

Like parent and child

2SA 7:14 parallel 1CH 17:13**1JN 3:1** HEB 12:6; ; PRO 3:12; ; DEU 8:5; PSA 2:7, PSA 27:10, PSA 68:5, PSA 89:26, PSA 103:13; ; ISA 49:15, ISA 66:12–66:13; ; HOS 11:1; ; MAT 5:45, MAT 5:48, MAT 6:6–6:9, MAT 6:18, MAT 6:32; ; LUK 15:11–15:32 the parable of the lost son; ; JHN 14:21; ; 1CO 1:3

Like husband and wife

ISA 62:5; JER 3:14 See also ISA 54:5; JER 2:2, JER 3:20, JER 31:32; HOS 2:16; EPH 5:25; REV 19:7, REV 21:2

Like king and subject

PSA 97:1 See also 1SA 8:7; PSA 5:2, PSA 10:16, PSA 29:10, PSA 44:4, PSA 84:3, PSA 95:3, PSA 99:1, PSA 145:1;

MAT 6:33 parallel LUK 12:31 Jesus Christ's teaching on seeking first his kingdom; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15

Like shepherd and sheep

GEN 48:15; PSA 23:1–23:2; ISA 40:11 See also PSA 28:9, PSA 80:1; EZK 34:16; MIC 7:14; JHN 10:11; REV 7:17

The peril of not knowing God

Lack of satisfaction and degeneration in the present

ROM 1:21–1:32; TIT 1:15–1:16 See also EXO 5:2; JER 4:22; ROM 10:2–10:3; 1TH 4:3–4:5

Eternal punishment in the future

MAT 7:22–7:23; ROM 1:18–1:19 See also ROM 2:5; 2TH 1:8

8138: monotheism

The central doctrine that there is one true God, who alone is the object of worship. There is none like the LORD; other gods and idols are nothing. Scripture also indicates that there is a network of relationships within the Godhead which is stated in terms of the doctrine of the Trinity.

The doctrine of monotheism

There is only one God

DEU 6:4; EPH 4:6; 1TI 2:5 See also DEU 4:35, DEU 32:39; NEH 9:6; PSA 83:18, PSA 86:10; ISA 43:10, ISA 44:6, ISA 45:18; MRK 12:29, MRK 12:32; ROM 3:30; 1CO 8:6; JAS 2:19

There is none like the LORD

1KI 8:23 See also EXO 8:10; 2SA 7:22 parallel 1CH 17:20; PSA 89:6; ISA 40:18, ISA 40:25

He alone is to be worshipped

EXO 20:3–20:5 parallel DEU 5:7–5:9**JER 25:6** See also EXO 20:23, EXO 34:14; DEU 6:14, DEU 13:6–13:8; 2KI 17:38–17:39; PSA 81:9; JER 1:16, JER 19:4, JER 35:15

He alone is to be served

MRK 12:30 parallel MAT 22:37 See also DEU 6:4–6:5, DEU 6:13, DEU 13:4; 1SA 7:3; MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8; 1TH 1:9–1:10

Other gods are nothing

ISA 37:19; 1CO 8:4, 1CO 10:19–10:20 Idols are nothing in themselves, but those worshipping them open themselves to demonic influence. See also DEU 32:17; PSA 106:36–106:37; ISA 40:18–40:20, ISA 44:9–44:11; ACT 14:15; GAL 4:8

Monotheism and plurality in the Godhead

In the OT

GEN 1:26 See also GEN 1:2 The Spirit of God is seen as God's agent; GEN 3:22, GEN 11:7; EXO 3:2–3:6 The angel of the LORD is identified with, yet distinct from, God;

JDG 13:20–13:22; NEH 9:20; PSA 139:7; ISA 6:8, ISA 63:10–63:14

The Trinity in the NT

MAT 28:19; 2CO 13:14 See also MAT 3:16–3:17; JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26; ACT 2:32–2:33; EPH 2:18; 1PE 1:2

8140: prize

Something of value given to those competing in a race, which the Christian life is likened to. Though believers must accept discipline and training, a prize is reserved for everyone who is committed to Jesus Christ.

A prize is reserved for all believers

2TI 4:7–4:8 The crown is the wreath given to the winner of a race. See also JAS 1:12; 1PE 5:4

Requirements for winning the prize

Total dedication to God

ACT 20:24 See also PHP 3:7–3:8

Perseverance

PHP 3:14 See also PHP 2:16; HEB 12:1; REV 2:10, REV 3:11

Keeping God's rules

2TI 2:5

Self-discipline

1CO 9:25–9:27

Hindrances to winning the prize

Falling into sin

HEB 12:1

Following false teaching

GAL 5:7 See also GAL 2:2; COL 2:18

8142: religion

A set of beliefs, a form of worship, ritual, prayer and a code of moral behaviour. True faith in God, moral standards and good works are important in relation to a biblical understanding of true religion, which is contrasted with the false religion of paganism.

Belief

HEB 11:6 See also GEN 15:6; ISA 4:3–4:8; 1KI 20:23; JON 3:5; JAS 2:19 Belief by itself is insufficient for salvation.

Worship

JON 1:16 See also 2KI 19:37 parallel ISA 37:38; JER 44:17–44:19; ACT 17:22–17:23

Ritual

MRK 7:3–7:4 See also EXO 32:2–32:6; 1KI 18:22–18:29; HEB 10:11

Prayer

ISA 44:17 See also 1KI 18:26; ISA 45:20; LUK 2:37; ACT 10:4

Code of behaviour

NEH 9:13–9:14 See also 2KI 23:3 parallel 2CH 34:31; MAT 19:16–19:20 parallels MRK 10:17–10:20, LUK 18:18–18:21; MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42 Religious people do not always see the inconsistencies in their behaviour; LUK 1:6; JHN 18:28; JAS 1:26

True religious practice

JAS 1:27

Moral standards

1CO 7:19 See also MAT 15:16–15:20 parallel MRK 7:18–7:23; MRK 12:33; LUK 11:39–11:41; ROM 10:2–10:4, ROM 14:17

Good works

1TI 5:4 See also MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; EPH 2:10; JAS 2:14–2:17

8144: renewal

The regeneration or revitalisation that God brings to his people and creation, as part of the process of redemption.

8145: renewal, of people of God

The transformation by God of the lives of his people, whether corporately or individually, leading to the recovery of lost vitality and purity.

Individual renewal

ISA 40:30–40:31; EPH 4:22–4:24 See also PSA 23:3, PSA 51:10–51:12, PSA 103:1–103:5; JHN 7:37–7:39; ROM 12:2; 2CO 4:16; COL 3:9–3:10; 2TI 1:6; TIT 3:5

Corporate renewal

The renewal of Israel

EZK 37:1–37:14 See also JER 31:31–31:34; LAM 5:21; EZK 11:17–11:20, EZK 36:24–36:28; JOL 2:28–2:32

Examples of national renewal

2CH 34:29–34:33 See also JOS 24:1, JOS 24:14–24:27; EZR 10:1–10:4; NEH 10:28–10:29

The new Jerusalem

ISA 65:17–65:19 See also REV 3:12, REV 21:2–21:4, REV 21:10

The church

MAT 9:16–9:19 parallels MRK 2:21–2:22, LUK 5:36–5:39 Jesus Christ here prophesies the great act of renewal by God whereby the church rather than Israel becomes the people of God. See also ACT 2:1–2:4, ACT 2:42–2:47

8146: renewal, of natural order

God's transformation of the natural order is part of his plan of redeeming the whole universe as well as humanity.

Cosmic renewal

REV 21:1; ROM 8:19–8:21 See also ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; MAT 19:28; 2PE 3:10–3:13; REV 21:5

The renewal of nature

ISA 11:6–11:9 See also PSA 104:30; ISA 35:1–35:2, ISA 35:5–35:7, ISA 43:18–43:21, ISA 65:25; EZK 34:25–34:27

8148: revival

The sovereign activity of God whereby he renews his people individually and corporately in vigour, affecting both sincerity of belief and quality of behaviour.

8149: revival, nature of

Scripture indicates that a number of characteristics precede revival, including repentance, humility and obedience.

Characteristics which precede revival

God's people long for renewal of their lives

PSA 80:18 See also PSA 74:22, PSA 80:1–80:17, PSA 80:19, PSA 85:6

God's people must repent

2CH 7:14 See also 1KI 8:46–8:50 parallel 2CH 6:26–6:27; ISA 64:1–64:7; HOS 5:15; ACT 3:19

God's people experience a new awareness of sin

2KI 22:11 See also PSA 32:3–32:5

God's people need to be humble

ISA 57:15 See also PSA 149:4; ISA 66:2; MIC 6:6–6:8

God's people are revived through God's initiative

ISA 59:16 See also JER 24:7, JER 33:6–33:9; TIT 3:5

Characteristic results of revival

People experience inward change

HEB 8:10–8:12 See also JER 31:33–31:34; EZK 11:19; ACT 2:42–2:47

People live obedient lives

EZK 11:20 See also EPH 4:1–4:3; 1TH 1:7–1:8

People are zealous for God's work

EZR 5:1–5:2 See also HAG 1:12–1:15

People are generous in giving

EXO 36:5 See also 1CH 29:6–29:9; 2CH 31:3–31:8; ACT 11:28–11:30

People delight in worshipping God

EZR 3:11 See also ISA 12:1–12:6

People are joyful

ACT 13:49–13:52 See also ISA 35:1–35:10; ACT 8:5–8:8

8150: revival, personal

The bringing back of individuals to life or vigour both at the point of personal regeneration through the work of the Holy Spirit and at other times in believers' lives.

Aspects of individual revival**Physical revival**

ISA 38:16 See also JDG 15:18–15:19; 1SA 14:27, 1SA 30:11–30:12; 1KI 19:7–19:8; JOB 33:25; PSA 41:3, PSA 116:8–116:9

Revival of hope

GEN 45:27 See also RUT 4:14–4:15

Revival of sanity

DAN 4:26, DAN 4:34, DAN 4:36

Spiritual revival

PSA 23:3 See also 1KI 19:9–19:15; JHN 21:15–21:19

The Holy Spirit brings regeneration by giving spiritual life to those dead in sin

EPH 2:1–2:5; ; TIT 3:5–3:6

Preparation for personal spiritual revival**The Holy Spirit convicts**

JHN 16:8–16:11; ; ACT 2:37; ; 1TH 1:5

Individuals appeal to God

JER 17:14 See also PSA 51:7–51:12, PSA 119:34–119:37

Individuals long for God

PSA 42:1–42:2 See also PSA 63:1

Personal repentance is required

PSA 51:1–51:4 See also 2CH 32:26, 2CH 33:11–33:13; JOB 22:23; JER 15:19

The believer must take responsibility for personal revival

2TI 1:6

God is active in bringing about personal revival

ISA 57:15 See also PSA 43:3–43:4; ISA 40:31; HAG 1:14

God's law may initiate personal revival

PSA 19:7 See also PSA 119:130, PSA 119:162

The fruit of personal revival

God receives praise

PSA 40:3 See also 2SA 22:50 parallel PSA 18:49; PSA 51:15, PSA 59:16, PSA 61:8

God is obeyed

2CH 33:15–33:16 See also ACT 2:14 Peter had denied Jesus Christ seven weeks before.

8151: revival, corporate

The experience of God's people both in the OT and NT when prayer is answered and their growth and effectiveness are renewed.

The recurring pattern of apostasy and revival in the OT

JDG 2:10–2:19

God is petitioned to revive his people

PSA 80:14–80:15 See also PSA 85:4–85:7; JER 31:18; LAM 5:21; HAB 3:2

Repentance is necessary for revival

God's people are urged to repent

2CH 30:6 Hezekiah's appeal to all Israel. See also ISA 55:1–55:3; JER 3:22; LAM 3:40; HOS 12:6, HOS 14:1–14:2; ZEC 1:3; MAL 3:7; REV 2:5, REV 2:16, REV 3:2–3:3

Wholehearted repentance is required

JOL 2:12–2:13 See also DEU 4:29, DEU 30:2–30:3; JER 24:7, JER 29:13–29:14; ACT 19:18–19:19 Repentance should be evidenced by deeds.

Repentance prepares for revival

ISA 59:20 See also JDG 10:9–10:16; EZR 10:1, EZR 10:10–10:12; NEH 1:9; EZK 18:30–18:32

Revival is God's work

HOS 6:2 See also PSA 80:3, PSA 80:7, PSA 80:17–80:19; ISA 32:14–32:17

God promises revival

God promises to revive his people

EZK 11:19 See also JER 31:33–31:34; EZK 36:26; ZEC 10:6

The nations are included in the promise of revival

ISA 2:3 parallel MIC 4:2 See also ISA 19:22–19:25, ISA 45:22, ISA 56:6–56:8; ZEC 8:20–8:22

The revival of Israel

Under Hezekiah

2KI 18:4–18:6; ; 2CH 29:3–29:5, 2CH 30:1, 2CH 31:4, 2CH 31:9–31:10, 2CH 31:20–31:21

Under Josiah

2KI 23:1–23:4 parallel 2CH 34:29–34:33; ; 2CH 35:1–35:3

Revival in the NT

Crowds turn to the Lord

MRK 1:5; ; JHN 3:26, JHN 4:39; ; ACT 2:41, ACT 2:47, ACT 4:4, ACT 11:21

The Holy Spirit is active in the revival of believers

ACT 4:31 See also ACT 13:9; 2CO 4:16; EPH 5:18

The response of believers in revival

ROM 12:1–12:2 See also EPH 4:23–4:24; PHP 3:13–3:14; COL 3:9–3:14

8154: righteousness

Scripture identifies a close link between righteousness and faith. Part of “being in a right relationship with God” is believing and trusting in him. The NT does not see faith simply in terms of moral righteousness, but also in terms of a living trusting relationship with God. Scripture affirms the righteousness of God and Jesus Christ in all their activity.

8155: righteousness, of God

See [1125: God, righteousness of](#)

8156: righteousness, of Jesus Christ

See [2072: Jesus Christ, righteousness of](#)

8157: righteousness, as faith

Full faith and trust make a person pleasing in the sight of God.

Human righteousness compared with God's righteousness

Human beings cannot by themselves achieve righteousness in the sight of God

ECC 7:20; ISA 64:6; MAT 5:20 See also PRO 21:2; DAN 9:18; MAT 23:28; LUK 16:15, LUK 18:9; ROM 3:10, ROM 3:20; PHP 3:6–3:7

True righteousness is the result of the action of God

ROM 8:3–8:4; EPH 4:24; 1JN 2:29 See also ROM 6:13, ROM 6:16–6:20, ROM 8:10, ROM 14:17; GAL 5:5; EPH 5:9; PHP 1:11; HEB 12:11; JAS 3:18; 1PE 2:24; 1JN 3:10

Faith pleases God

GEN 15:6; HEB 11:6 See also 1SA 26:23; PSA 32:10, PSA 40:4, PSA 84:12, PSA 106:30–106:31; JER 17:7; HAB 2:4; HEB 10:38, HEB 11:4, HEB 11:7

Righteousness and faith in Jesus Christ

It is God-given and not the result of human effort

ROM 1:17; PHP 3:8–3:9 Paul is contrasting this righteousness with his own previous efforts. See also ACT 13:39; ROM 3:21, ROM 3:27–3:28 It is apparent that faith is not regarded as another kind of “work” which earns salvation; ROM 4:1–4:8, ROM 5:17, ROM 9:30–9:31; GAL 3:11–3:12

Faith is centred on Jesus Christ and what he has accomplished

ROM 5:1–5:2 “justified” means “declared righteous” in a legal sense. See also ROM 3:21–3:26, ROM 4:18–4:25, ROM 10:6–10:10; GAL 3:6–3:9

Saving faith is not mere belief, but acting on the basis of that belief

JAS 2:21–2:24

8158: righteousness, of believers

A sincere desire to please God by keeping his law is both commanded and approved by him. However, human fallibility means that true righteousness must be the product of the Holy Spirit’s work in the believer.

Righteousness includes keeping the laws of God

DEU 6:25; JOB 27:6; 1JN 3:7 See also GEN 6:9 Noah; GEN 18:19 Abraham; DEU 6:17–6:18; 1KI 3:6 David; 1KI 15:11; 2CH 31:20 Hezekiah; PSA 7:8, PSA 15:1–15:5, PSA 17:1, PSA 32:11, PSA 45:7; ISA 26:7–26:9, ISA 48:18, ISA 51:1; HOS 14:9; LUK 2:25 Simeon; ACT 4:19; 2CO 6:14; 2TI 3:15–3:16

God requires righteousness of his people

AMO 5:24; MAT 6:33 See also ISA 1:16–1:17, ISA 56:1; JER 22:3; HOS 10:12; ZEP 2:3; MAT 5:6; EPH 6:14; 1TI 6:11; 2TI 2:22

God loves those who are righteous

PSA 146:8; PRO 15:9; JAS 1:20 See also PSA 1:5–1:6, PSA 14:5, PSA 33:5, PSA 37:6, PSA 37:28–37:30, PSA 106:3; PRO 10:16

The righteous receive blessing from God

PRO 12:28; MAT 13:43 See also PSA 5:12, PSA 34:15 the LORD watches over them; PSA 37:16–37:17, PSA 55:22, PSA 92:12, PSA 112:4; PRO 10:2–10:3, PRO 10:6–10:7, PRO 10:16, PRO 10:29–10:32 they are secure; PRO 11:4–11:6; ISA 3:10, ISA 33:15–33:16; DAN 12:3; JAS 5:16 their prayers are effective

The righteous may suffer for their faith

MAT 5:10 See also PSA 94:21; ISA 57:1; AMO 2:6, AMO 5:12; 1PE 3:14

8160: seeking God

God’s desire is that all people should seek after him and find him. Those who seek God with all their heart are rewarded, but those who fail to seek him do so to their eternal loss.

God’s heart is for people to seek him

God wants people to seek him

ACT 17:27 See also 1CH 16:11, 1CH 22:19; PSA 14:2; ACT 15:16–15:17; AMO 9:11–9:12; HEB 11:6

God calls people to seek him

ISA 55:6–55:7 See also HOS 10:12; AMO 5:4–5:6

God promises that people will seek him

JER 50:4 See also HOS 3:4–3:5, HOS 5:13–5:15; ZEP 2:3; ZEC 8:20–8:23

God promises to be found by those who seek him

PRO 8:17 See also DEU 4:29–4:31; 1CH 28:9; 2CH 15:1–15:2; ISA 45:19; JER 29:11–29:14; MAT 7:7–7:8 parallel LUK 11:9–11:10

God’s opportunity for seeking him is now and is restricted to this life

2CO 6:2 See also LUK 16:19–16:31

Seeking God is an issue of the heart

Seeking God begins in the heart

PSA 27:8 See also 2CH 11:16

Wholeheartedness in seeking God is required

JER 29:13 See also DEU 4:27–4:29; 1CH 22:17–22:19; 2CH 15:12–15:15; PSA 63:1

Seeking God and his kingdom is the priority of life

MAT 6:33 parallel LUK 12:31 See also PSA 27:4; MAT 13:44–13:46

Examples of people seeking God

2KI 22:11–22:20 Josiah; ; 2CH 14:2–14:7 Asa; 2CH 17:3–17:6, 2CH 20:1–20:4; EZR 8:21–8:23 Ezra; ; PSA 27:4–27:8; ; DAN 9:2–9:3; ; ACT 13:1–13:3

The consequences of seeking God

It leads to life

AMO 5:4–5:6 See also PSA 69:32; ROM 2:7–2:8

It leads to forgiveness

2CH 7:14 See also 2CH 30:18–30:20; ISA 55:6–55:7; JER 26:17–26:19

It leads to blessing

PSA 119:2 See also PSA 24:3–24:6; ISA 65:9–65:10

It leads to provision

PSA 34:8–34:10 See also MAT 6:31–6:33 parallel LUK 12:29–12:31

It leads to protection

PSA 27:4–27:5 See also EZR 8:21–8:23

It leads to understanding and wisdom

PRO 28:5 See also DAN 2:17–2:23

It leads to renewed strength

ISA 40:30–40:31 See also LUK 22:42–22:43

It leads to rejoicing

1CH 16:10 See also PSA 40:16, PSA 70:4, PSA 105:3

Hindrances to seeking God**Unrighteousness**

HOS 10:12–10:13 See also ISA 59:1–59:2

Pride

PSA 10:4 See also 2CH 26:16–26:18

Trusting in human resources

ISA 31:1 See also 2CH 16:12; HOS 5:13–5:15

Idolatry

ZEP 1:4–1:6 See also ROM 1:21–1:23

Superficial religion

AMO 5:5–5:6 See also ISA 58:1–58:9

Seeking God through occult practices is forbidden

1CH 10:13–10:14 See also LEV 19:31, LEV 20:6; DEU 18:10–18:12; 1SA 28:4–28:20; ACT 16:16–16:18

Consequences of not seeking God**Loss of life**

2CH 15:13 See also DEU 13:6–13:10

Loss of salvation

PSA 119:155

8162: spiritual vitality

The quality of possessing a living faith, which is commended by Scripture.

Spiritual vitality commended

2TH 1:3 See also JOB 17:9; PSA 84:7, PSA 92:12; PRO 4:18; 1TI 4:15; 2PE 1:5–1:7

The means of developing spiritual vitality**Abiding in Christ**

JHN 15:4

Seeking to imitate Jesus Christ

EPH 4:15 See also JHN 13:15; ROM 12:1–12:2, ROM 13:14; 1CO 11:1; GAL 3:27; PHP 3:10; 1TH 1:6; 1PE 2:21; 1JN 2:6, 1JN 2:28

Resisting temptation

1JN 2:14 See also MAT 26:41; 1CO 7:5, 1CO 10:13; 1TH 3:5; HEB 2:18; JAS 1:2–1:3, JAS 1:12; REV 3:10

Developing discipline

1TI 6:12 See also HEB 12:7–12:11; REV 3:18–3:19

Exhorting others

1KI 2:2; ; 2CH 15:7; ; ISA 35:4; ; HAG 2:4; ; 1CO 16:13; ; EPH 6:10; ; 2TI 2:1

Being filled with the Holy Spirit

EPH 5:18 See also GAL 5:16–5:18; 1TH 1:5

Obstacles to spiritual vitality**Lack of sound teaching**

2TI 4:1–4:3

A failure to progress beyond basic teachings

HEB 5:12; ; 1PE 2:2

Examples of individuals with spiritual vitality

1SA 2:26 Samuel; ; LUK 1:80 John the Baptist; LUK 2:40, LUK 2:52; ACT 9:22 Paul

The consequences of spiritual vitality**Spiritual growth**

GAL 5:22–5:23; 2PE 3:18 See also ROM 12:1–12:2; 2CO 3:18; EPH 4:11–4:15; PHP 3:12; COL 1:10; 1TH 4:3–4:7

Loving others

1JN 3:23 See also GAL 5:6; EPH 1:15, EPH 6:23; COL 1:4–1:5; 1TI 1:5

Rejoicing in the Lord

PHP 4:4–4:7 See also PSA 5:11, PSA 13:5, PSA 33:21; ISA 35:10; ACT 16:34; 1PE 4:12–4:13

Spiritual perseverance

HEB 6:12 See also 1TH 5:8; 1TI 3:9; 2TI 1:13; REV 13:10

8164: spirituality

The quality of life generated and nourished by the Spirit of God, in which believers experience the power and presence of God in their lives. True spirituality comes from living under the control of the Holy Spirit and is evidenced by the fruit of the Spirit, spiritual maturity and growth in holiness.

The foundations of spirituality**The need for spiritual renewal**

1CO 2:14; ; ROM 7:14; ; JUD 1:19

Believers have been renewed spiritually**JHN 3:5–3:8** See also ROM 8:11; TIT 3:5; 1PE 1:3, 1PE 1:23**Faith****HEB 11:6** See also JHN 6:53–6:58, JHN 14:1, JHN 20:31; ACT 16:31; ROM 10:9–10:10**A longing for God****PSA 27:8** See also PSA 119:2, PSA 143:5–143:6; PHP 3:10–3:14**The nature of spirituality****Living under the Spirit's control****ROM 8:5–8:9** See also ROM 8:12–8:13; GAL 5:16–5:17; EPH 5:18**Reflecting Jesus Christ's character****2CO 3:18** See also ROM 8:29; 1JN 3:2–3:3**Intimacy with God through the Spirit****ROM 8:14–8:16** See also GAL 4:6**Evidence of spirituality****Bearing spiritual fruit****GAL 5:22–5:23** See also MAT 7:17; JHN 15:5–15:8; ROM 14:17; EPH 5:8–5:9**Love for one another****1JN 4:7** See also JHN 13:34–13:35; 1CO 13:1–13:4; COL 3:12**Spiritual maturity****1CO 3:1–3:3** See also 1CO 14:20; HEB 5:13–5:14**Showing concern for weaker believers****GAL 6:1** See also ROM 14:1–14:3, ROM 14:19–14:21; 1CO 8:9–8:13**Understanding spiritual truths****1CO 2:9–2:13** See also JHN 14:17, JHN 16:13–16:15; 1CO 2:15–2:16**Holiness****TIT 2:12** See also ROM 12:1–12:2; 1CO 6:19–6:20; GAL 5:24; COL 3:1–3:2**Obedience**

JHN 15:10; ; 1JN 2:2–2:6, 1JN 5:2–5:3

Aids to spirituality**Co-operation with the Spirit****GAL 5:25** See also ACT 7:51; EPH 4:30; 1TH 5:19**Meditation on God's word**

JOS 1:8; ; JHN 17:7; ; 2TI 3:15–3:17

Spending time with God

LUK 6:12; ; MRK 1:35; ; ACT 4:13

Encouragement of others**HEB 10:24** See also COL 3:16; 1TH 2:11–2:12**Tests and trials****JAS 1:2–1:4** See also ROM 5:3–5:4; 1PE 1:6–1:7**Examples of spirituality**

GEN 5:24 Enoch; ; GEN 6:9 Noah; NUM 12:3, NUM 12:6–12:8; 1SA 13:14; ; ACT 13:22; ACT 6:5, ACT 6:8; ACT 11:24 Barnabas

8166: theology

The study of God, as he has revealed himself in Jesus Christ and in Scripture.

Theology is based on God's self-revelation**2TI 3:15–3:17** See also PSA 1:1–1:3; ROM 1:1–1:3, ROM 15:4; 1CO 15:1–15:4; 2PE 1:19**The benefits of theology****A concern for right teaching in the church****TIT 2:1** See also HEB 6:1–6:3**A deepened understanding of God****PSA 119:169** See also PSA 119:24; ROM 15:4; 2TI 3:14–3:16**Spiritual illumination****PSA 119:130** See also PSA 119:105; 2PE 1:19; 1JN 2:8**Access to the truth****PSA 33:4** See also PSA 119:43, PSA 119:160; COL 1:3–1:6; REV 21:5**An inspiration to meditation and praise****PSA 119:15–119:16** See also JOS 1:8; PSA 48:9, PSA 56:4, PSA 56:10, PSA 119:27, PSA 119:97–119:98, PSA 119:148, PSA 143:5**A life of obedience and holiness**

PSA 119:9–119:11; ; MAT 7:24–7:27; ; LUK 11:28; ; JHN 14:15, JHN 17:6; ; 2TI 3:16–3:17; ; JAS 1:22

8168: way, the

A term used metaphorically to refer both to the Christian faith (especially in Acts) and to Jesus Christ himself (especially in John's Gospel). Faith in Jesus Christ is the only way of salvation for sinful human beings. The term is often used with other expressions in Scripture to describe aspects of the life of the believer.

The Way refers to the Christian faith**ACT 9:2** See also ACT 19:9, ACT 19:23, ACT 22:4, ACT 24:14, ACT 24:22**The way refers to Jesus Christ himself****JHN 14:6** See also JHN 10:9, JHN 14:4–14:6; 1TI 2:5; HEB 10:19–10:20

Faith in Jesus Christ is the only way of salvation for sinful human beings

ACT 4:12 See also MRK 16:16; JHN 1:12–1:13, JHN 3:15–3:16; ACT 16:31; ROM 10:9; EPH 2:8; 1PE 1:5

Way used with other terms to describe the life of faith

The way of righteousness

MAT 21:32 See also MAT 3:1–3:12; 2PE 2:21

The way of God

MAT 22:16 parallels MRK 12:14, LUK 20:21 See also PSA 18:30; ISA 55:9; ACT 18:25–18:26; HEB 3:10; PSA 95:10

The way of the Lord

ACT 18:24–18:25 See also GEN 18:19; PSA 27:11, PSA 143:8; PRO 10:29

The way of salvation

ACT 16:17 See also MAT 7:14

The way of peace

LUK 1:79 See also ISA 26:3, ISA 26:12, ISA 57:20–57:21; ROM 3:17; ISA 59:8

The way of holiness

ISA 35:8 See also HEB 9:8

8200: The character of the believer

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- 8292: love
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- 8306: mercifulness
- 8307: moderation
- 8308: modesty
- 8309: morality
- 8313: nurture
- 8314: orthodoxy
- 8318: patience
- 8319: perception, spiritual
- 8320: perfection
- 8324: purity
- 8328: quietness
- 8329: readiness
- 8330: receptiveness
- 8331: reliability
- 8332: reputation
- 8333: reverence
- 8339: self-control
- 8340: self-respect
- 8341: separation
- 8342: servanthood
- 8347: spiritual growth
- 8351: teachableness
- 8352: thankfulness
- 8353: tolerance
- 8354: trustworthiness
- 8355: understanding
- 8356: unselfishness
- 8357: weakness
- 8361: wisdom
- 8369: worthiness
- 8370: zeal

8201: blamelessness

A quality of life apparent in an individual against whom no just charge can be made. This is exemplified supremely in the blameless life and death of Jesus Christ. Though believers remain imperfect in this life, they are counted blameless in God's sight on account of the atoning death of Jesus Christ.

Jesus Christ's human life was blameless

1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; JHN 8:46; 2CO 5:21; HEB 7:26; 1PE 1:19; 1JN 3:5

Jesus Christ's blameless life and death were the perfect fulfilment of the OT sacrifices

The lamb or goat sacrificed at Passover had to be unblemished

EXO 12:5

All other animals used as sacrifices had to be without defect

See also LEV 1:3, LEV 6:6; NUM 6:14, NUM 28:19; DEU 15:21; EZK 45:23; MAL 1:8, MAL 1:13–1:14

Jesus Christ's death was as the perfect lamb of God
HEB 9:14 See also JHN 1:29; 1CO 5:7; 1PE 1:19; REV 5:6, REV 6:1

In the OT, the righteous were often described as blameless

GEN 6:9; JOB 1:1 See also ISA 12:3; 2SA 22:21–22:25; PSA 15:1–15:5, PSA 37:37; PRO 11:20, PRO 28:18; SNG 4:7; LUK 1:6

God counts believers as blameless in his sight on account of Jesus Christ's death for them

ACT 13:39 See also ROM 3:28, ROM 5:1; 1CO 6:11; GAL 3:6; EPH 1:4; PHP 3:9

Believers should be blameless in their Christian lives

1TI 5:7 See also 2CO 6:3; PHP 1:10, PHP 2:14–2:15; 1PE 1:15, 1PE 2:12; 2PE 3:14; JAS 1:27

Paul, Silas and Timothy could claim to have been blameless

1TH 2:10

Officers of the church are to be blameless

1TI 3:2, 1TI 6:14; ; TIT 1:6–1:7

The administration of financial help is to be blameless

2CO 8:20

Believers will be presented blameless before God at the last day

1CO 1:8; JUD 1:24 See also EPH 5:27; COL 1:22; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 5:23

8202: boldness

Courage and confidence in approaching God and also other people.

Boldness in approaching God

HEB 10:19–10:22 See also GEN 18:27, GEN 18:31 Abraham prays for Sodom

Boldness in proclaiming the gospel to others

ACT 4:29 Persecuted Christians pray. See also ACT 4:13, ACT 4:31, ACT 9:28, ACT 13:46, ACT 14:3, ACT 18:26, ACT 19:8, ACT 28:31

Boldness in dealing with others

Inner confidence

PSA 138:3 See also 1SA 17:34–17:50; PRO 28:1; 2CO 3:12 Paul concerning his ministry

Confident authority

PHM 1:8–1:9 See also ROM 15:15; 2CO 10:1–10:2

Courage

MRK 15:43 See also EXO 14:8; NUM 33:3

Persistence

LUK 11:8 The friend at midnight.

Misplaced boldness

2PE 2:10 The heretics' arrogance. See also 1CO 8:10

8203: character

The moral and mental features that define a person, whether good or evil. The term also means moral strength, which Scripture regards as something to be highly valued.

The character of God

God is the Father of believers

EPH 1:2 See also GAL 1:1; COL 1:12; 1TH 1:3, 1TH 3:13

God is good

PSA 34:8 See also EXO 33:19; LAM 3:25; MAT 19:17 parallel MRK 10:18; 2PE 1:3

God is holy

1SA 2:2 See also LEV 11:44–11:45; ISA 6:3, ISA 43:15; EZK 39:7; 1PE 1:15; REV 4:8

God is faithful

PSA 36:5 See also DEU 7:9; 1KI 8:56; PSA 89:2, PSA 146:6; LAM 3:23; 1TH 5:23–5:24

God is just and righteous

ROM 3:25–3:26 See also 2CH 12:6; PSA 33:5; ISA 30:18; ZEP 3:5; ACT 17:31; REV 16:5–16:6

God is loving

PSA 145:17 See also JHN 3:16; ROM 5:8; EPH 2:4; TIT 3:4–3:5; HEB 12:6; 1JN 4:7–4:10

God is merciful and compassionate

PSA 86:15; LUK 1:50 See also NEH 9:31; ISA 63:7; LAM 3:22; JON 4:2; LUK 18:10–18:14; 2CO 1:3; JAS 5:11

The character of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ possesses the exact likeness of God

HEB 1:3 See also 2CO 4:4; COL 1:15

Jesus Christ is faithful

HEB 3:6 See also 2TH 3:3; HEB 2:17; REV 1:5, REV 3:14

Jesus Christ is holy

MRK 1:24 parallel LUK 4:34 See also LUK 1:35; JHN 6:69; HEB 4:15; REV 3:7

Jesus Christ is loving

2CO 5:14 See also JHN 15:9; ROM 8:35–8:39; 1JN 3:16

The character of the Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit is holy

ROM 1:4 See also ROM 15:16; 1CO 6:19; TIT 3:5

The Holy Spirit is powerful

LUK 4:14 See also MIC 3:8; ACT 1:8; ROM 15:13, ROM 15:19; 2TI 1:7

The Holy Spirit is eternal

HEB 9:14

The Holy Spirit is the Spirit of truth, the Counsellor

JHN 14:16–14:17 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:7

Character as a moral strength

ROM 5:3–5:4 See also RUT 3:11; PRO 12:4, PRO 31:10; ACT 17:11; 1CO 15:33

The character of believers

Believers should be compassionate

COL 3:12 See also PSA 112:4; 1PE 3:8

Believers should be humble

1PE 5:5 See also ISA 29:19; PHP 2:3; COL 3:12; 1PE 3:8

Believers should be joyful

PHP 4:4 See also ROM 12:12, ROM 15:13; 1TH 5:16

Believers should be loving

1JN 4:7 See also GAL 5:22; COL 3:14; 1TH 4:9

Believers should be content

PHP 4:11 See also 1TI 6:6–6:8; HEB 13:5

Believers should be holy

DEU 7:6; 1PE 1:15–1:16 See also ROM 12:1–12:2; COL 3:12; HEB 12:14

Believers are to be poor in spirit

MAT 5:3

Believers are to be meek

MAT 5:5

Believers are to be merciful

MAT 5:7 See also LUK 6:36; ROM 12:8; JAS 3:17

Believers are to be pure in heart

MAT 5:8 See also 2CO 11:2–11:3; PHP 1:10; 1TI 5:22; 2TI 2:22

8204: chastity

The state of sexual abstinence. Although Scripture commends marriage, it insists that celibacy should be honoured.

Condemnation of sexual immorality

NUM 25:1; ; MAT 15:19; ; ACT 15:20; ; 1CO 10:8; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20, REV 9:21

The command to avoid sexual immorality

ROM 13:13 See also ACT 15:19–15:20; 1CO 6:18, 1CO 10:8; EPH 5:3; 1TH 4:3

Believers should not associate with those who are sexually immoral

1CO 5:9–5:11

Sexual purity is commended

1CO 6:18–6:20 See also PSA 51:10, PSA 119:9; 2TI 2:22; 1PE 2:11; REV 14:1–14:4

Chastity and marriage

Marriage commended for those incapable of remaining chaste

1CO 7:9

The sanctity of marriage

See also MRK 10:2–10:12

The condemnation of adultery

LEV 18:20 See also LEV 20:10; EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18; MAT 5:27–5:28; ROM 2:22

8205: childlikeness

An attitude of simple trust and faith, to be distinguished from childishness. It is commended by Scripture as an appropriate attitude for the believer to take towards God.

God treats his people like children

PSA 103:13 See also NUM 11:12; ISA 49:15, ISA 66:13; JER 31:20; HOS 11:1–11:4; ROM 8:14–8:17; GAL 4:1–4:7

God's people should respond to God as children to a parent

In trust

PSA 131:2

In obedience

1PE 1:14

In humility

LUK 9:46–9:48 parallels MAT 18:2–18:5, MRK 9:33–9:37
See also 1KI 3:7 Solomon

In innocence

MRK 10:13–10:15 parallels MAT 19:13–19:14, LUK 18:15–18:17 See also LUK 10:21

In imitating a model

EPH 5:1–5:2 See also 1JN 3:10

Childlikeness is reflected in pastoral care

1TH 2:7 See also 1JN 2:28

Childlikeness is to be distinguished from immature childishness

1CO 3:1–3:3 See also HEB 5:12–6:1

8206: Christlikeness

The process by which believers are conformed to the likeness of Jesus Christ, especially in relation to obedience to and trust in God. Through the Holy Spirit, God refashions believers in the image of his Son, who is set before them as a model of the form of the redeemed life.

Believers are to become Christlike

1CO 11:1; PHP 2:5 Paul is arguing that believers must allow God to make them Christlike, which is the natural goal of their process of growing in faith. Christlikeness is not achieved by people merely trying to imitate Jesus Christ, but by God making believers more like his Son in sanctification, through the Spirit. See also JHN 13:15; ROM 8:29; EPH 4:11–4:13; PHP 3:8–3:11, PHP 3:20–3:21; 1JN 2:6

The Holy Spirit makes believers Christlike

2CO 3:18 See also ROM 8:5–8:9; GAL 5:22–5:23; 1TH 1:6

Christlikeness is the aim of discipleship

MAT 10:25 See also LUK 6:40; 1JN 2:6

Christlikeness is based on total commitment to Jesus Christ

LUK 9:57–9:62 See also MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:27; MAT 19:21 parallel LUK 18:22; JHN 1:43, JHN 10:27, JHN 12:26, JHN 15:10; 2JN 1:9

The demonstration of Christlikeness**In costly sacrifice**

MRK 8:34–8:35 parallels MAT 16:24, LUK 9:23–9:24 **1PE 2:21–2:23** See also MAT 10:38; LUK 14:26–14:27; JHN 12:26, JHN 21:19; PHP 3:10; 1PE 4:1

In humility and service

MAT 20:26–20:28 parallel MRK 10:43–10:45 See also MAT 11:29; MRK 9:35; LUK 22:24–22:26; JHN 13:14–13:15; PHP 2:4–2:5

In love for other believers

JHN 15:12; 1JN 3:16 See also JHN 13:34, JHN 15:17; EPH 5:2, EPH 5:25

In a readiness to forgive others

COL 3:13 See also MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4

In sharing Jesus Christ's mission to the world

MAT 4:19 parallel MRK 1:17 See also JHN 20:21

By following godly examples that imitate Jesus Christ

1CO 11:1 See also EPH 5:1; 1TH 1:5–1:6, 1TH 2:14; HEB 6:12, HEB 13:7–13:8; 3JN 1:11

Christlikeness is part of God's re-creation

GEN 1:26–1:27; 2CO 4:4; EPH 4:24; COL 3:10

The process of becoming Christlike**It is the purpose for which believers are saved**

ROM 8:28–8:29 See also EPH 2:10; 2PE 1:4

It continues in the experience of believers

2CO 3:18

It will be complete when believers finally share Jesus Christ's glory

1JN 3:2–3:3 See also PSA 17:15; JHN 17:24; 1CO 15:49–15:53; GAL 4:19; PHP 3:20–3:21; COL 3:4; 1JN 4:17

8207: commitment

A state of personal dedication to something or someone, which results in actively promoting and working for their good and well-being.

8208: commitment, to God

Commitment to God arises from faith in his promises, is expressed in worship and adoration and leads to obedience to his commands.

Commitment to God commanded

DEU 27:10; JOS 24:14; ROM 12:1–12:2 See also DEU 6:13, DEU 10:12–10:13, DEU 13:4; JOS 22:5 Joshua reiterates Moses' commands; JDG 6:10; 1SA 7:3, 1SA 12:24; 1CH 28:9 David's instructions to Solomon; 2CH 19:9; JER 38:20; 1TH 4:1; 2TI 2:22

Obedience to God's commands as a sign of commitment

DEU 7:9; JOS 24:24; ROM 6:17 See also EXO 19:8; DEU 11:22; 1KI 8:61; NEH 10:29; PSA 40:6–40:8 The reference

may be to the ear-piercing that was a sign of slaves' voluntary commitment to their masters; JER 7:23, JER 11:3, JER 38:20, JER 42:6; HAG 1:12; ZEC 6:15 JHN 14:15, JHN 15:10 ACT 5:29; ROM 2:13

Love for God and worship of him are hallmarks of commitment

DEU 30:6; JHN 21:15 See also DEU 6:5, DEU 10:12, DEU 11:1, DEU 11:13, DEU 11:22; JOS 23:11; NEH 1:5; ISA 56:6–56:7; JER 20:12; DAN 9:4; MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; MAT 22:37 parallel MRK 12:30

Benefits of commitment to God

DEU 30:20; 2CH 16:9; PRO 16:3; REV 2:10 See also EXO 19:5–19:6, EXO 20:6; DEU 28:1; 1SA 12:14; 1KI 2:2–2:4; PSA 97:10; PRO 2:7–2:8; ISA 1:19; JER 26:13

Examples of commitment to God

Abraham: GEN 22:17–22:18; ; HEB 11:8; NUM 12:7 Moses; ; JOS 22:2 the tribes who settled in Transjordan; ; 1KI 15:5 David; ; 1KI 15:14 parallel 2CH 15:17 Asa; 2KI 20:3; ; 2CH 31:20; 2KI 23:25 Josiah; ; NEH 13:14 Nehemiah; ; JHN 13:37 Simon Peter's good intentions

God's commitment of gifts and tasks to his people

God's commitment of gifts

1CO 9:17

God's commitment of the faith to believers

JUD 1:3

8209: commitment, to Jesus Christ

Commitment to Jesus Christ is grounded in the knowledge of his saving power and divinity, and expresses itself in adoration and obedience to Jesus Christ.

Jesus Christ commanded people to make the commitment to follow him

MAT 4:19 parallel MRK 1:17 **MAT 9:9** parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:27 See also MAT 19:21–19:22; JHN 1:43, JHN 21:19, JHN 21:22; ROM 15:5; 1CO 1:12 There may have been a "Christ-party" at Corinth, or in contrast with the sectarianism, Paul may be asserting his own commitment to Jesus Christ.

Jesus Christ frequently spelt out the cost of commitment to him

MAT 10:37–10:38 parallel LUK 14:26–14:27 **MAT 16:24** parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 **JHN 12:25–12:26** See also MAT 8:22, MAT 10:39 parallels MRK 8:35, LUK 17:33; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 14:28–14:33; 1PE 2:21

Jesus Christ's demand for commitment was sometimes met with a refusal

LUK 9:59 See also LUK 9:61

Sometimes people followed Jesus Christ without being truly committed to him

JHN 6:2 This would have been true for many in the crowds. See also JHN 6:66

Some committed themselves wholeheartedly to his invitation

MAT 4:20 parallel MRK 1:18; ; MAT 4:22 parallel MRK 1:20; ; MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:28; ; JHN 1:40

Secret commitment to Jesus Christ

JHN 12:42 See also JHN 3:1–3:2

True commitment to Jesus Christ is seen in love and obedience to him

JHN 14:21; PHP 2:12 In response to who Jesus Christ is and what he has done. See also JHN 8:31, JHN 14:15, JHN 14:23–14:24; 1CO 11:1, 1CO 16:22; EPH 6:5–6:6, EPH 6:24; 1JN 2:3, 1JN 3:22–3:24; REV 14:4

8210: commitment, to God's people

Commitment to God means a commitment to his people. Believers are meant to be nourished and supported by the church, and to work towards its edification.

Commitment to the church

ACT 2:42; EPH 4:3–4:4; COL 3:15 ROM 12:4–12:10; ; 1CO 12:12–12:27

Commitment to other Christians is an expression of love made known in Christ

JHN 13:34–13:35; COL 3:13–3:14; 1PE 1:22 See also JHN 15:12, JHN 15:17; ROM 12:10, ROM 12:16, ROM 13:8; GAL 5:13; EPH 4:32–5:2; 1TH 3:12, 1TH 4:9; 2TH 1:3; HEB 13:1; 1PE 2:17; 1JN 3:11, 1JN 3:23, 1JN 4:7, 1JN 4:21, 1JN 5:2

Such commitment is expressed in mutual responsibility and concern

GAL 6:2; HEB 10:24–10:25; 1PE 3:8 See also ROM 14:13, ROM 15:7, ROM 15:14; 1CO 1:10 Paul's concern for unity among believers; EPH 5:21; COL 3:13 the responsibility of believers to forgive one another; COL 3:16; 1TI 5:11; HEB 3:13; JAS 4:11; 1PE 4:9, 1PE 5:5

For its leaders, commitment to the church may prove a joy and a burden

ACT 20:28 Paul speaking to the elders of the church at Ephesus; **2CO 11:28** See also COL 1:24; 1TH 2:8, 1TH 5:12–5:13; 1TI 3:1; HEB 13:17; 1PE 5:1–5:3

8211: commitment, to the world

Though the world is fallen, God still loves the world and is committed to it. Commitment by believers to worldly pursuits and evil is to be avoided as they are called upon to be “in the world” but “not of the world”.

Commitment to this world to be avoided because it is a fallen and sinful place

GAL 1:4; 1JN 5:19 See also 2CO 4:4; EPH 2:2, EPH 6:12; 2PE 1:4; 1JN 2:16–2:17, 1JN 3:1, 1JN 3:13

Though the world is fallen, God still loves it

JHN 3:16 See also 2CO 5:18–5:20

Preoccupation with the things of this world is incompatible with holy living

JAS 4:4; 1JN 2:15 See also JHN 17:14–17:16; ACT 2:40; ROM 12:2; 1CO 7:31; 2CO 6:14–6:17; ISA 52:11; PHP 2:15; COL 3:2; TIT 2:12; JAS 1:27; 1PE 1:14, 1PE 2:11, 1PE 4:3

Commitment to the world is seen especially in materialism

1TI 6:17 See also MAT 6:19, MAT 19:23 parallel LUK 18:24; LUK 12:16–12:21

The outcome of worldly commitment

Spiritual loss

LUK 9:25 parallels MAT 16:26, MRK 8:36 See also MAT 13:22; 2TI 4:10

God's judgment

1CO 11:32 See also JHN 12:31, JHN 16:11; EPH 5:6

Carelessness with regard to Jesus Christ's return

LUK 21:34 See also MAT 24:38–24:39; LUK 12:40, LUK 12:46; 1TH 5:1–5:9

8213: confidence

A state of self-assurance regarding one's status or ability, often grounded in human achievements. Scripture insists that Christian confidence is to be grounded in what God has done for believers, rather than in what they themselves have achieved.

8214: confidence, basis of

The confidence of believers, is grounded in God's character, actions and trustworthy promises, rather than human achievements.

Confidence originates with God

In his unchanging and faithful nature

NUM 23:19; TIT 1:1–1:2 See also 1SA 15:29; PSA 33:11, PSA 102:27; PRO 3:26; ISA 49:23; MAL 3:6; 2TI 1:12; JAS 1:17

In his covenant

JER 32:40; HEB 9:15 See also GEN 9:16 with all living creatures; GEN 17:7 with Abraham; 2SA 7:13 with the house of David; 2SA 23:5; PSA 89:34; ISA 54:10, ISA 55:3; EZK 16:60; ACT 3:25

In election

DEU 7:6; ROM 8:28 See also ISA 41:9–41:10; JER 31:3; ROM 8:33; 1CO 1:9; 1TH 5:24; 2TI 2:19

In his past deliverances

PSA 22:4–22:5; ROM 8:31–8:32 See also DEU 7:18, DEU 20:1; JOS 1:5; 1SA 17:37; 1KI 8:57; PSA 44:1–44:5, PSA 78:2–78:4; 2CO 1:10

In his word

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also PSA 89:34, PSA 119:74, PSA 130:5; ROM 15:4; 1PE 1:25; 2PE 1:19

In his promises

JOS 23:14; HEB 10:23 See also 1KI 8:20; PSA 119:140; 2PE 1:4

Confidence is centred on Jesus Christ

ROM 8:38–8:39 See also ACT 17:31; ROM 8:1; 2CO 1:20; COL 1:27; 1TI 3:13; HEB 7:22, HEB 7:25, HEB 9:15; 1PE 2:6; ISA 28:16

Confidence is mediated by the Holy Spirit

ROM 8:16 See also 2CO 1:21–1:22, 2CO 5:5; EPH 1:13–1:14

8215: confidence, results of

God-given assurance produces spiritual maturity and stability, so that believers may withstand the adverse conditions of life.

Confidence in God's protection removes fear of disaster

PSA 46:1–46:2 See also EXO 14:13–14:14; PSA 56:3–56:4; ACT 27:22–27:25

Confidence in God's purposes produces hope

PSA 130:7; 2CO 1:10 See also PSA 25:3–25:6, PSA 62:5–62:8, PSA 71:5–71:7; PRO 23:17–23:18; ROM 5:3–5:5; 1TI 6:17–6:18; HEB 6:17–6:19

Confidence in God's presence makes his people bold

ISA 41:8–41:10 See also JOS 1:5–1:9; PSA 3:3–3:6, PSA 20:7, PSA 23:4, PSA 27:1–27:4, PSA 138:3; ISA 12:2, ISA 44:8; JER 1:8; ACT 4:13, ACT 9:27, ACT 18:9–18:11; EPH 6:10–6:11

Confidence in God enables believers to endure difficulties

HAB 3:17–3:19; 2TI 3:10–3:11 See also JOB 19:26; PSA 42:9–42:10; EPH 6:13; HEB 10:32–10:35, HEB 11:35–11:39, HEB 12:1–12:2; 1PE 3:14, 1PE 4:12–4:19; REV 3:10

Confidence in God leads to awareness of security

PSA 23:1; EPH 6:10 See also DEU 33:12; PSA 7:9, PSA 28:7, PSA 40:2, PSA 46:1–46:3, PSA 112:6–112:8, PSA 121:1–121:2; PRO 14:26; ISA 32:17; 2CO 1:21; EPH 6:13; 1TI 3:13; 2TI 1:12

8217: conformity

Correspondence in character or behaviour; believers are not to conform to the ways of this world but are to be conformed to the image of Christ.

Believers are not to conform to the ways of this world

ROM 12:2; 1PE 1:14 See also EXO 23:2; LEV 20:23; DEU 18:9 Israel was not to imitate the practices of surrounding nations; 2KI 17:15; EZK 11:12; DAN 1:8 Daniel refused to conform to the ways of Babylon; DAN 3:12; EPH 4:17; COL 3:7–3:8; 1TH 5:6; 1TI 1:9–1:11; 1PE 4:3; 3JN 1:11

Christians will be conformed to the image of Christ

ROM 8:29 See also JHN 13:15, JHN 13:34; ROM 13:14; 1CO 11:1; EPH 5:1–5:2; PHP 2:5

The means of being conformed to Jesus Christ

In being completely united with him

ROM 6:3–6:10; 2CO 4:10 See also ROM 8:10–8:11, ROM 8:17–8:18; PHP 3:10–3:11; 1PE 4:13

In his death

PHP 3:10 See also GAL 6:14; COL 1:24, COL 3:3; 1PE 2:21, 1PE 4:1

In his resurrection

EPH 2:4–2:6 See also 1CO 15:20–15:22; COL 3:1

8218: consecration

The setting apart of people, things, times or places as sacred, for God to use.

Consecration is the requirement of a holy God

LEV 20:7–20:8 See also LEV 11:44, LEV 22:32

The consecration of people

The importance of personal consecration

ROM 6:13

Inward consecration to God is symbolised by outward cleansing

ROM 12:1; ; 2CO 5:14–5:15; ; 1PE 2:24; ; EXO 19:10, EXO 19:14; ; 1SA 16:5; ; 2CH 30:17, 2CH 35:6; ; PSA 50:5; ; ROM 12:1

The consecration of all firstborn males

EXO 13:2; LUK 2:22–2:23 See also EXO 13:12–13:13; NUM 3:11–3:13, NUM 8:17–8:18 The Levites served in place of the firstborn males in Israel.

The consecration of priests

EXO 29:1 See also EXO 19:22; 1KI 13:33; 2CH 30:3, 2CH 30:24

The consecration of the Aaronic priesthood

EXO 30:30 See also EXO 28:41; LEV 8:30; 1CH 23:13

The consecration of the Levitical priesthood

1CH 15:12; ; 2CH 23:6, 2CH 29:5, 2CH 35:3

Special consecration is marked by a vow

NUM 6:8, NUM 6:11 the Nazirite vow

The consecration of things

Altars

EXO 29:36–29:37 See also EXO 30:29 EXO 40:9–40:11; LEV 8:11–8:12

Offerings

EXO 28:38, EXO 29:27; ; LEV 22:2; ; 2CH 30:17

Garments

EXO 28:3, EXO 29:21, EXO 40:13; ; NUM 15:39–15:40

Bread

1SA 21:4, 1SA 21:6; ; MAT 12:4 parallels MRK 2:25–2:26, LUK 6:3–6:4

Meat

HAG 2:12 The state of consecration could be transmitted; ; JER 11:15 True consecration should involve a right spirit.

Certain places are consecrated

EXO 19:23 Mount Sinai; ; EXO 29:43–29:44 the Tent of Meeting; LEV 8:10; ; NUM 7:1; 1KI 8:64 parallel 2CH 7:7; ; 1KI 9:3 parallel 2CH 7:16; ; 2CH 29:17–29:19

Certain times are specially consecrated

LEV 25:10 the Year of Jubilee; GEN 2:3; ; EXO 20:8, EXO 20:11; ; DEU 5:12

The consecration of daily life

1TI 4:4–4:5 The reference may be to grace before eating. See also ZEC 14:20–14:21

Consecration as preparation for work and worship

NUM 11:18; ; JOS 3:5, JOS 7:13

Consecration to other gods incurs God's displeasure

ISA 66:17 See also JDG 17:3; 2CH 13:9, 2CH 26:18, 2CH 30:17, 2CH 36:14; HOS 9:10

8219: courage

The quality of being able to act bravely under difficulties or in the face of opposition; being prepared to do dangerous or risky things in obedience to God, in the belief that he will strengthen, guard and protect his people.

8220: courage, in facing enemies

In the OT, courage is shown principally in the leading of God's people against their enemies.

God commands his people to be courageous

JOS 1:6–1:9 The LORD to Joshua as he was about to lead the Israelites into Canaan. See also JOS 1:18, JOS 8:1, JOS 10:8; JDG 7:9–7:11; 2CH 20:15, 2CH 20:17

Recommended by leaders

DEU 1:21 See also DEU 31:1–31:8; JOS 10:25, JOS 23:6; 2SA 10:12; 2CH 32:7

Seen in the behaviour of people of God

1SA 17:32; ACT 4:13 See also JOS 1:10–1:11, JOS 14:12; 1SA 14:6–14:7, 1SA 17:45–17:47; ACT 13:44–13:47 Paul and Barnabas; ACT 19:8–19:10 Paul at Ephesus

8221: courage, as strength from God

God gives strength to his people. He enables them to be courageous through his gift of faith. God proves himself faithful to his promises and enables his people to trust him in everyday life.

Courage through faithful obedience

1CH 22:11–22:13 See also 1CH 28:20; GEN 12:1–12:4; HEB 11:8; GEN 22:1–22:5; HEB 11:17–11:19; 2CH 15:8, 2CH 19:8–19:11; EZR 7:27–7:28, EZR 10:1–10:4; MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35–14:36, LUK 22:41–22:42

Courage in the face of wrongdoing

2SA 12:7–12:9 The prophet accuses the king of adultery and murder. See also 2CH 26:16–26:18 Azariah and Uzziah; MRK 6:18 John the Baptist and Herod; HEB 11:7, HEB 11:24–11:27

Courage under pressure

PSA 46:1–46:3 See also PSA 10:17, PSA 27:3; ISA 12:2 Isaiah's encouragement of the exiles of Israel; ACT 27:22; 1CO 16:13; 2CO 6:4–6:10; HEB 3:6, HEB 11:32–11:39; MAT 14:27 parallels MRK 6:50, JHN 6:20

Courageous witness

ACT 4:18–4:20 See also MAT 10:19–10:26 parallels MRK 13:9–13:11, LUK 21:12–21:15; ACT 23:11; PHP 1:14, PHP 1:20

Courage in prayer

HEB 4:14–4:16 See also GEN 18:27–18:28; 1CH 17:25 parallel 2SA 7:27

8223: dedication

The single-minded devoting of a person, object or action to the honour of God.

Personal dedication to God must be wholehearted

JOS 22:5 See also DEU 10:20; JOS 24:14–24:15; 1CH 28:9; NEH 10:28–10:29; PSA 119:106; MAT 22:37 parallels MRK 12:30, LUK 10:27; DEU 6:5

OT dedication to the worship and service of God

Dedication of individuals

NUM 6:1–6:8 See also JDG 13:5, JDG 13:7, JDG 16:17; 1SA 1:11; PRO 20:25

Dedication of property

LEV 27:1–27:8 See also LEV 27:9–27:27

Dedication of animals

LEV 1:1–1:4

Dedication of the priesthood

NUM 18:6 See also EXO 28:41; LEV 21:10–21:12; DEU 10:8; 1CH 15:2, 1CH 23:13

Dedication of the tabernacle and its furnishings

NUM 7:1 See also NUM 7:10, NUM 7:84, NUM 7:88

Dedication of the temple and its contents

1KI 7:51 parallel 2CH 5:1; ; 1KI 8:63–8:64, 1KI 15:15; ; 2CH 2:4, 2CH 7:9; ; EZR 6:16–6:18; ; LUK 21:5

Dedication of particular items of value

1KI 7:51 parallel 2CH 5:1 See also 1KI 15:15; 1CH 29:1–29:5; 2CH 3:6

Dedication of the booty of war

2SA 8:11–8:12 parallel 1CH 18:11 See also NUM 31:28; JOS 6:19, JOS 7:1, JOS 7:10–7:13; 1CH 26:27

NT dedication to God and his service

Dedication is more usually applied to people than things

ROM 12:1 See also MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; MAT 19:29; ACT 4:36–4:37; ROM 6:13, ROM 6:16, ROM 6:19; 1CO 16:1–16:2; 1TI 5:11; 1PE 1:15–1:16; LEV 11:44

Particular work and time may be given over to the service of God

ACT 6:1–6:4 See also ACT 1:14, ACT 13:2; ROM 1:1

Service for others is to be dedicated to God and done in his name

COL 3:17 See also 1CO 10:31; EPH 5:21, EPH 6:5–6:7

8224: dependence

Reliance upon God or upon others. Dependence on God for help with spiritual and physical needs arises out of an awareness of human helplessness, though dependence may be wrongly directed. People may look to others for encouragement and support, but over-dependence is not commended.

Dependence arising from a sense of helplessness

Physical helplessness

PSA 18:6 See also PSA 107:4–107:6, PSA 116:6; MRK 4:38 parallels MAT 8:25, LUK 8:24; MRK 5:25–5:26 parallels MAT 9:20, LUK 8:43

Spiritual helplessness

ISA 64:6; ; MRK 9:17–9:18 parallels MAT 17:14–17:16, LUK 9:38–9:40; ; ROM 5:6, ROM 7:18

Dependence on God encouraged

God is to be trusted

HEB 4:16 See also EXO 14:31; DEU 8:3; PSA 4:5, PSA 9:10, PSA 20:7, PSA 37:3; PRO 3:5–3:6; NAM 1:7; JHN 15:4–15:5

God is a refuge

PSA 46:1 See also DEU 33:27; PSA 62:8, PSA 71:1

God can help those who depend on him

HEB 13:6 See also PSA 118:6–118:7, PSA 22:4–22:5, PSA 33:18–33:20, PSA 94:17–94:18

God will help those who depend on him

LUK 11:13 parallel MAT 7:11 See also PSA 121:2–121:4, PSA 145:18–145:19; JAS 1:5

Examples of failure to depend on God

NUM 20:12; ; DEU 1:32, DEU 9:23; ; 2KI 17:14; ; PSA 49:6, PSA 49:13; ; ISA 42:17

Dependence on God for physical help

2CH 20:12 Jehoshaphat and the people of Judah. See also 2KI 19:14 parallel ISA 37:14 Hezekiah; 2CH 13:18 the

men of Judah 2CH 14:11, 2CH 16:8 PSA 22:9–22:10 David; MAT 9:27–9:28 two blind men; JHN 2:3–2:5 Mary; 2CO 1:8–1:10 Paul

Dependence on God for spiritual needs

MRK 10:14–10:15 parallels MAT 19:14, LUK 18:16–18:17 Childlike dependence is necessary for those who would enter God's kingdom; **JHN 3:27** See also RUT 2:12; LUK 23:40–23:42, LUK 24:47–24:49; 2CO 3:4–3:5

Dependence on God expressed in prayer

PSA 5:2 See also PSA 22:24, PSA 88:13, PSA 102:1, PSA 119:147, PSA 130:1–130:2

Examples of those crying out in dependence on God

EXO 2:23 the Israelites in Egypt; ; JOB 30:28 Job in his suffering; ; ISA 30:19 the people of Jerusalem; ; LAM 3:55 Jeremiah; ; JON 2:2 Jonah from within the fish; ; LUK 18:13 the tax collector in the temple; ; ACT 12:5 the church praying for Peter; ; 2CO 1:11 the Corinthians praying for Paul

Misplaced dependence

Dependence on surrounding nations

JER 2:18 See also 2KI 18:20–18:21 parallel ISA 36:5–36:6; ISA 31:1

Dependence on false gods and religions

PSA 40:4 See also DEU 31:20; ISA 42:17; COL 2:8

Dependence on human strength and resources

JER 17:5; ROM 9:16 See also PSA 33:16–33:17, PSA 118:8–118:9, PSA 127:1–127:2; EPH 2:8–2:9

Dependence on sinful behaviour

ISA 30:12, ISA 59:4

The futility of misplaced dependence

PRO 25:19; JER 2:13 See also ISA 8:6–8:8, ISA 31:3; HOS 10:13–10:14; ACT 12:20; 1TH 4:11–4:12

A proper dependence on others is commended

Human help can strengthen

GAL 6:2 See also ECC 4:9–4:12

Examples of a right dependence on others

LEV 21:3 a priest's support for an unmarried sister; DEU 15:11; ; MAT 25:35–25:36; 1SA 29:6 Achish found David to be a reliable soldier; ; ISA 8:2 Uriah and Zechariah were reliable witnesses; ; 2TI 2:2 Reliable teachers are a blessing to the church.

8225: devotion

Wholehearted commitment to God, to another person or to a task. God's people are encouraged to show such commitment.

God's people are to be wholehearted in their devotion to him

DEU 6:5; ROM 12:1 See also DEU 30:1–30:3; JDG 5:2; PSA 119:2; JER 29:13

Examples of devotion to God

PSA 42:1; PHP 3:7–3:8 NUM 14:6–14:9, NUM 32:11–32:12; ; JOS 14:7–14:12; 2KI 23:1–23:3 parallel 2CH 34:29–34:32 Josiah and his subjects; ; 2CH 15:12–15:15 the people of Judah; PSA 27:1–27:4, PSA 40:7–40:8, PSA 84:2, PSA 119:57, PSA 119:135–119:136; 1CO 2:2, 1CO 9:26–9:27; ; 2CO 1:8–1:10; ; PHP 3:13–3:14; ; COL 1:24, COL 1:28–1:29

Examples of devotion to other people

MAT 26:35 parallel MRK 14:31 **JHN 6:68** See also RUT 1:15–1:17 Ruth to Naomi **ISA 19:4–19:5**, **ISA 20:12–20:13**, **ISA 20:41–20:42** **EPH 5:22–5:23**, **EPH 5:28–5:29**; **COL 3:18–3:19** **2CO 8:1–8:5** the Macedonian churches to Christians in poverty

Examples of devotion to a specific task

The leaders and people of Israel to building the temple

1CH 28:2–28:3, **1CH 28:6**, **1CH 28:9–28:10**, **1CH 29:1–29:6**, **1CH 29:17–29:19**

Nehemiah and the people of Judah to rebuilding the walls of Jerusalem

NEH 2:4–2:6, **NEH 2:17–2:18**, **NEH 4:13–4:18**, **NEH 4:21–4:23**, **NEH 6:15**

Jesus Christ devoted to his mission

LUK 9:51 See also **MAT 16:23** parallel **MRK 8:33**; **LUK 4:1–4:12** parallel **MAT 4:1–4:10**; **LUK 4:16–4:21**, **LUK 22:42** parallels **MAT 26:39**, **MRK 14:35–14:36**; **JHN 9:4**, **JHN 19:30**

The disciples devoted themselves to the ministry of the church

ACT 2:42, **ACT 5:42**, **ACT 6:1–6:4**, **ACT 8:4**

8226: discernment

The sound judgment which makes possible the distinguishing of good from evil, and the recognition of God's right ways for his people. It is necessary for the understanding of spiritual realities and, on a practical level, for right government and the avoidance of life's pitfalls.

8227: discernment, nature of

Discernment is given by God, through his Holy Spirit. It is received through God's word and through the insight of a renewed mind. Discerning believers seek to grow in their understanding and knowledge of God's truth.

Discernment as sound judgment

Judging the right course

PRO 15:21; PHP 1:9–1:10 See also **PRO 3:21–3:23**, **PRO 8:8–8:9**, **PRO 10:21**, **PRO 11:12**, **PRO 18:1**, **PRO 24:30**; **HOS 14:9**

Distinguishing good from evil

2SA 14:17 See also **GEN 3:22**; **JOB 6:30**, **JOB 34:3–34:4**; **ISA 7:15**

Distinguishing holy from common

LEV 10:10, **LEV 11:47**; ; **EZK 22:26**, **EZK 44:23**

Seeing through outward appearances

PRO 28:11 See also **ISA 16:7**; **ISA 11:3**

Understanding the significance of events

DEU 32:29–32:30 See also **1CH 12:32**; **EST 1:13**; **MAT 24:32–24:33** parallel **MRK 13:28–13:29**; **LUK 12:54–12:56**

Exercising judgment to rule

1KI 3:9 See also **PRO 8:14–8:16**, **PRO 28:2**, **PRO 28:16**; **JER 23:5**

Discernment as insight into spiritual realities

Distinguishing between spirits

1CO 12:10 See also **1KI 22:19–22:23** parallel **2CH 18:18–18:22**; **1TI 4:1**; **1JN 4:1–4:3**

Discerning true and false prophecy

DEU 13:1–13:3, **DEU 18:21–18:22**; ; **1CO 14:29**

Characteristics of discerning people

The discerning grow in wisdom

PRO 1:5 See also **PRO 9:9**, **PRO 10:14**, **PRO 14:6**, **PRO 15:14**, **PRO 17:24**, **PRO 18:15**

The discerning accept rebuke

PRO 17:10, **PRO 19:25**

The discerning keep God's law

1CH 22:12; ; **PSA 119:34**; ; **PRO 28:7**

The source of discernment

Discernment is given by God

DAN 2:21 See also **PRO 9:10**; **DAN 2:27–2:28**; **1CO 2:12–2:15**

Discernment through God's word

HEB 5:14 See also PSA 19:7, PSA 119:98–119:100, PSA 119:130; ROM 2:18

Discernment through a renewed mind

ROM 12:2 See also JER 31:33; 1CO 2:16

Asking for discernment

PSA 119:66 See also PSA 119:27, PSA 119:125; JAS 1:5

8228: discernment, examples of

Perfect discernment is displayed by God and Jesus Christ. Evil spirits also have discernment, about the person and work of Christ. Discernment has been evident in the rulers and spiritual leaders of God's people, but Israel, like children and the foolish who lack judgment, failed to discern God's purpose and truth.

God's discernment

PSA 139:1–139:4 See also JOB 31:4, JOB 34:21; HEB 4:13; 1JN 3:20; PSA 19:12 God alone knows our hidden faults.

Jesus Christ's discernment

JHN 2:25 See also MAT 9:4 parallels MRK 2:8, LUK 5:22 Jesus Christ discerns the thoughts of the teachers of the law; MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33 Jesus Christ discerns the source of Peter's words; MAT 22:18 parallels MRK 12:15, LUK 20:23 Jesus Christ discerns the true motive of his questioners; JHN 1:47 Jesus Christ sees into the heart of Nathaniel; JHN 8:16 Jesus Christ has perfect discernment of right and wrong.

Evil spirits' discernment

MRK 1:23–1:24 parallel LUK 4:33–4:34 See also MRK 1:34 parallel LUK 4:41; ACT 16:17

Discernment in those who govern

Joseph: GEN 41:39; ; ACT 7:10; 1KI 3:12; ; 2CH 2:12; JOB 12:20 elders

Examples of spiritual discernment

2KI 4:9 See also JHN 4:19, JHN 4:42 **1KI 22:19–22:23** parallel 2CH 18:18–18:22 Micaiah discerns that a lying spirit is responsible for false prophecy. See also JER 23:16–23:22 Jeremiah knows that the false prophets' message is not from God; ACT 5:3 Peter is aware of the deception of Ananias and Sapphira; ACT 8:23 Peter discerns the true condition of Simon's heart; ACT 16:18 Paul discerns the spiritual source of a girl's fortune-telling ability.

Futher examples of discernment

2SA 14:18–14:20 David sees through Joab's ruse; ; 1KI 3:24–3:28 Solomon discerns a child's true mother; ; NEH 6:12–6:13 Nehemiah sees through the plot against him.

Lack of discernment**Young children lack discernment**

DEU 1:39 See also ISA 7:15–7:16; JON 4:11

Israel's lack of discernment

DEU 32:28; LUK 12:54–12:56 See also ISA 1:3, ISA 5:13, ISA 44:18–44:19; EZK 12:2; ACT 28:27; ISA 6:9–6:10

Those who lack judgment

PRO 6:32, PRO 10:21 See also PRO 7:7, PRO 9:4, PRO 12:11, PRO 18:1, PRO 24:30

Other examples of lack of discernment

PSA 82:5 the "gods" in the heavenly assembly; ; MIC 4:12 the nations who fail to discern God's plan

8230: discipline

Loving and corrective training that leads to maturity and responsibility on the part of those who experience it.

8231: discipline, divine

God disciplines his people through his word, through their experiences and through punishment, so that they may live in ways pleasing to him.

The nature of God's discipline**It is a sign of God's love**

HEB 12:6 See also PRO 3:12; PSA 119:75; REV 3:19

It is a sign of belonging to God's family

HEB 12:6 See also PRO 3:12; DEU 8:5; 2SA 7:14; HEB 12:7

It trains God's people

HEB 12:11

The means of God's discipline**The use of Scripture**

2TI 3:16 See also DEU 4:36, DEU 29:29; ISA 8:11

The knowledge of God's grace

TIT 2:11–2:12

Instructive experiences

See also DEU 8:1–8:5, DEU 11:2–11:7; PSA 90:12; ISA 48:17

Painful experiences

HEB 12:7 See also 2CO 12:7–12:10; HEB 12:5, HEB 12:11; 1PE 1:6–1:7

Punishment

HEB 12:6 See also PRO 3:12; LEV 26:18, LEV 26:21, LEV 26:23–26:24, LEV 26:27–26:28; 2SA 7:14; PSA 73:14; JER 32:19; HOS 5:2, HOS 7:15–7:16; 1CO 11:32

God disciplines all and only his children

HEB 12:8 See also HEB 12:6

The goals of God's discipline

Respectful submission to God
HEB 12:9

The good of God's people

HEB 12:10 See also JOB 5:17–5:18; PSA 94:12, PSA 119:67, PSA 119:71, PSA 119:75

Spiritual growth

HEB 12:11 See also PRO 1:2–1:3

Preparation for heaven

2CO 4:17–4:18 See also ROM 8:18; JAS 1:12

Believers should not despise God's discipline

JOB 5:17 See also HEB 12:5; PRO 3:11

Divine discipline in the church

By reproof

2CO 7:8, 2CO 13:2; ; 2TH 3:15

For the benefit of sinners

MAT 18:15; ; 1CO 5:1–5:7; ; 2TH 3:14

As a warning to others

1TI 5:20

To be exercised with kindness

2CO 2:6; ; GAL 6:1

The role of witnesses

MAT 18:16; ; 1TI 5:19

8232: discipline, in the family

Parents' loving, corrective training of their children, by verbal instruction and punishments, so that they grow up in the way God wants.

Parents are to discipline their children

HEB 12:7 See also DEU 8:5; HEB 12:9–12:11

Parents discipline out of love for their children

PRO 13:24 See also PRO 3:12

The means of parental discipline

Training

PRO 22:6 See also GEN 18:19; DEU 6:7; PRO 29:17; EPH 6:4; COL 3:21

Correction

PRO 22:15 See also PRO 19:18, PRO 23:13–23:14, PRO 29:15

Verbal instruction

EPH 6:4 See also DEU 4:9, DEU 6:7, DEU 6:20–6:25, DEU 11:19, DEU 31:13; PSA 78:5; PRO 1:8, PRO 6:20; 2TI 3:15

Punishment

PRO 23:13–23:14 See also PRO 22:15, PRO 29:15

The purpose of parental discipline is to impart wisdom

PRO 29:15 See also PRO 19:18, PRO 22:15, PRO 29:17; HEB 12:9, HEB 12:11

Examples of parents who neglected discipline

Eli

1SA 3:13

David

1KI 1:5–1:6

8234: doctrine

The body of teachings of the Christian faith concerning its central beliefs. Doctrine is grounded in Scripture and aims to maintain the integrity of Christianity by distinguishing it from non-Christian beliefs. Doctrine is of central importance in Christian preaching and teaching in that it equips the people of God for effective and faithful service in his world.

8235: doctrine, nature of

The teachings of Scripture, especially as expressed as a formulation and summary of revealed truth.

Doctrine communicated

In the OT

EZR 7:10 See also DEU 33:10; PSA 78:1–78:4, PSA 119:33–119:36; PRO 4:1–4:2; MAL 2:6

In the ministry of Jesus Christ

MAT 4:23 See also MAT 9:35; MRK 6:6, MRK 6:34; LUK 6:6, LUK 13:10, LUK 13:22, LUK 19:47, LUK 20:1, LUK 21:37; JHN 6:59; MAT 7:28–7:29, MAT 13:54, MAT 22:23–22:33; MRK 1:21–1:22 parallel LUK 4:31–4:32

In the ministry of the apostles

ACT 2:42 See also ACT 4:2, ACT 5:42, ACT 18:11; **2TI 1:13** See also 1CO 15:3–15:5; PHP 2:5–2:11; 1TI 3:16; TIT 2:1–2:10; HEB 5:11–6:2

In the church

EPH 4:11 See also ACT 13:1; ROM 12:7; 1CO 12:28, 1CO 14:26; 1TI 5:17; JAS 3:1

True doctrine is from God

JHN 7:16; 2TI 3:16–3:17 See also JHN 8:28, JHN 12:49–12:50, JHN 14:10, JHN 14:24; 2PE 1:20–1:21

8236: doctrine, purpose of

Sound doctrine is intended to shape and mould the people of God for life and service in the world.

The purpose of doctrine for the individual

It leads to repentance

2TI 2:25

It leads to salvation

1TI 4:16 See also JHN 20:31; 1CO 1:21–1:24; 2TI 3:14–3:15

It is necessary for Christian maturity and effective service

2TI 3:16–3:17 See also PSA 19:7–19:8; ACT 2:42–2:43; EPH 4:11–4:14; HEB 5:13–5:14

It makes possible a defence of the faith

1PE 3:15–3:16 See also COL 2:2–2:4; JUD 1:3

It leads to enrichment and blessing

DEU 32:1–32:4 See also PSA 19:7–19:11, PSA 119:97–119:104; ISA 55:10–55:13; EZK 3:1–3:3

It leads to perfection

COL 1:28

Doctrine as the basis of faithful ministry in the church

TIT 1:9 See also 1TI 4:6, 1TI 4:13–4:16; 2TI 1:13–1:14, 2TI 2:2; TIT 2:1

8237: doctrine, false

Teaching that distorts or contradicts the revealed truth of God, causing division and distress in the church by leading people away from the truth.

False doctrine deviates from the truth

It contradicts the gospel of Jesus Christ

JUD 1:3–1:4 See also 1CO 3:10–3:13; 2CO 11:3–11:4; GAL 1:6–1:7; 1TI 6:3–6:4; 2JN 1:7

It may be of human origin

COL 2:8 See also COL 2:20–2:23; MAT 15:8–15:9 parallel MRK 7:6–7:7; ISA 29:13

It may be of demonic origin

1TI 4:1–4:5 See also 1JN 4:2–4:3

The dangers of false doctrine

It leads to instability and confusion

EPH 4:14 See also ACT 15:24; GAL 1:7; 1TI 1:18–1:20; 2TI 2:16–2:18; TIT 1:10–1:11; HEB 13:9; 2PE 3:17

It causes division

ROM 16:17–16:18 See also 1TI 1:3–1:4

It leads to severe punishment

GAL 1:8–1:9 See also 2CO 11:13–11:15; 2PE 2:1, 2PE 2:17; REV 2:14–2:16

False doctrine is to be dealt with by the church

TIT 1:10–1:11 See also 1TI 1:3; TIT 1:13–1:14

False doctrine will be common in later times

1TI 4:1 See also MRK 13:5–13:6 parallel LUK 21:8; 2TH 2:3; 2TI 4:3–4:4

8239: earnestness

An attitude characterised by seriousness and commitment. Scripture commends earnestness in believers' attitudes towards God and in the concerns of the gospel.

The significance of earnestness

In repentance

JOL 2:12 See also 1SA 7:2–7:3; REV 3:19

In seeking God

JER 29:13 See also PSA 119:2; HEB 11:6

In salvation

LUK 13:24 See also MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:47–6:49; HEB 2:3, HEB 6:11; JAS 1:22, JAS 2:14

In love for God

DEU 6:5 See also MAT 22:37 parallels MRK 12:30, LUK 10:27

In prayer

2CH 7:14 See also ISA 62:6–62:7; MAT 6:5–6:6

In trusting God

PRO 3:5 See also ISA 26:3–26:4

In spiritual progress

PHP 2:12–2:13 See also 1CO 9:24; HEB 12:1; 2PE 1:5–1:11

In serving God

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 See also DEU 18:6–18:7; LUK 9:57–9:62; 1CO 12:31, 1CO 14:1; 2TI 2:15

Examples of earnestness

In seeking God

PSA 63:1 See also 2CH 15:15; HOS 5:15

In prayer

ACT 12:5 See also 1TH 3:10; JAS 5:17–5:18

In evangelism

1CO 9:19–9:22 See also 1TH 2:2–2:9

In Christian living

PHP 3:13–3:14 See also 1CO 9:25–9:27; 2CO 8:7–8:8

Regarding personal needs

MAT 9:18 parallels MRK 5:22–5:23, LUK 8:41–8:42; ; LUK 7:4

Jesus Christ's own earnestness

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35, LUK 22:42 See also JHN 2:17, JHN 4:34

Earnest concern for the people of God**For Israel**

LUK 19:41; ROM 9:1–9:3 See also NEH 1:2–1:4; ISA 22:4, ISA 62:1; JER 4:19–4:21, JER 8:21, JER 9:1, JER 13:17; LAM 3:48; MIC 1:8–1:9; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34; ROM 10:1

For the church

2CO 11:28–11:29 See also ACT 20:31; ROM 1:11; 2CO 2:4, 2CO 11:2–11:3; GAL 4:19–4:20; COL 1:24, COL 1:28–1:29, COL 2:1; 1TH 2:17

Earnestness may be misdirected

ROM 11:7 See also ACT 26:7

8240: ethics

Principles, both theoretical and practical, for righteous living in the sight of God. Scripture provides detailed guidance concerning the conduct of believers, as well as examples of individuals whose lives illustrate positive and negative aspects of behaviour.

8241: ethics, basis of

The ultimate foundation of ethics is the character and will of God, which is made known supremely through Jesus Christ and in Scripture.

The foundation of ethics is the revealed righteousness of God

ROM 1:18–1:20 See also PSA 97:6; ROM 2:14–2:15

The basis of ethics revealed in Scripture**All Scripture**

2TI 3:16–3:17

The word of God

LUK 11:28; JAS 1:22 See also PSA 103:20, PSA 119:17; JHN 17:6; REV 3:8

The commandments of God

DEU 11:26–11:28; ; JDG 2:17; ; 2CH 34:29–34:31

The will of God

MRK 3:35 See also PSA 143:10; COL 4:12

The commandments of Jesus Christ

JHN 15:10 See also JHN 13:34, JHN 14:15, JHN 15:12–15:17; 1CO 14:37

The example of Jesus Christ

JHN 13:15 See also ROM 15:2–15:3, ROM 15:7; 2CO 8:9; EPH 5:1–5:2, EPH 5:25; PHP 2:5; COL 3:13; 1PE 2:21

The ethical teaching of Jesus Christ

In the Sermon on the Mount: MAT 5:22, MAT 5:28, MAT 5:32, MAT 5:34, MAT 5:39, MAT 5:44, MAT 7:29; JHN 1:9, JHN 3:18–3:19, JHN 5:19, JHN 12:48–12:49, JHN 13:34, JHN 14:6, JHN 15:22, JHN 17:6

Areas of life in which ethical conduct is expected of believers**In sexual behaviour**

ROM 1:26–1:27 See also LEV 18:22–18:23; 1CO 5:1

In government

ROM 13:1 See also MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; JHN 19:11; ROM 13:2–13:5; 1PE 2:13–2:14

In rewarding individuals

1CO 9:7

In punishing individuals

GAL 6:7

8242: ethics, personal

Scripture teaches that individuals have a responsibility before God for their conduct.

Ethical principles in relationships generally

MAT 7:12, MAT 22:39 parallel MRK 12:31 See also EXO 20:13–20:17 parallel DEU 5:17–5:21; LEV 19:18; LUK 6:31; ROM 12:9–12:10; GAL 6:10; 1TI 5:10; 1PE 3:8

The importance of thoughts and motives

MAT 6:1–6:4 See also EXO 21:13–21:14; MAT 5:22, MAT 5:28; PHP 4:8; JAS 1:15

Personal ethics in relation to God**Idolatry prohibited**

EXO 20:4 parallel DEU 5:8 See also LEV 26:1; JOS 24:14; ACT 14:15; 1JN 5:21; REV 22:9

God's name to be honoured

EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11 See also LEV 19:12; DEU 28:58; MAT 5:34, MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2; JAS 5:12

Sabbath observance

EXO 20:8 parallel DEU 5:12 See also EXO 31:15, EXO 34:21; LEV 26:2; NEH 10:31; ISA 56:2

Obedience to God's commands

ACT 5:29 See also DEU 26:16; MAT 7:21

Personal ethics and human relationships**Wives and husbands**

EPH 5:22, EPH 5:25 See also GEN 2:24; DEU 24:5; MAT 19:6 parallel MRK 10:9; 1CO 7:10–7:11; COL 3:18–3:19; 1PE 3:1, 1PE 3:7

Children and parents

EPH 6:1–6:4 See also EXO 20:12, EXO 21:15; LEV 20:9; DEU 6:7; PRO 19:18, PRO 22:6, PRO 23:22; COL 3:20–3:21; 1TI 3:4, 1TI 5:4

The extended family

1TI 5:8 See also LEV 25:10, LEV 25:25, LEV 25:49; NUM 36:8; DEU 25:5; ISA 20:29

Slaves and masters

COL 3:22, COL 4:1 See also EXO 21:2; EPH 6:5, EPH 6:9; 1TI 6:1; TIT 2:9; 1PE 2:18

Employers and employees

LEV 19:13 See also DEU 24:14–24:15; JOB 31:13–31:14; JER 22:13; MAL 3:5; JAS 5:4

8243: ethics, social

Scripture sees ethics as embracing the life of society as a whole, and not simply individual relationships.

The benefits of social ethics

PRO 14:34 See also 2SA 23:3–23:4; PSA 2:10–2:12; PRO 11:11, PRO 16:12, PRO 25:5, PRO 28:2, PRO 29:4; ISA 54:14

Believers are to behave ethically in society

Praying for rulers

1TI 2:1–2:2 See also EZR 6:10; PSA 20:9, PSA 72:1

Submitting to the authorities

ROM 13:1; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:14 See also EXO 22:28; DEU 17:12; ISA 24:6; 1KI 21:10; PRO 24:21; ECC 8:2; ACT 23:5; ROM 13:5; 1PE 2:17

Paying taxes

MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25 See also LEV 27:30; DEU 14:28; NEH 10:32; MAT 17:27; ROM 13:6–13:7

Specific areas of social concern

Promoting justice

DEU 16:19–16:20; MIC 6:8 See also EXO 23:8; LEV 19:15; DEU 27:19; PRO 21:3; ISA 1:17, ISA 10:1, ISA 56:1; 1TI 5:21

Helping the poor

DEU 15:7–15:9 See also LEV 25:35, LEV 25:39; DEU 24:12; PRO 19:17; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 11:41, LUK 12:33; ROM 12:13; GAL 2:10; JAS 2:3–2:4

Feeding the hungry

DEU 26:12 See also EXO 23:11; LEV 19:9–19:10, LEV 23:22; ISA 58:10; MAT 15:32 parallel MRK 8:2–8:3; LUK 3:11; ROM 12:20; PRO 25:21

Protecting the vulnerable

PSA 82:3–82:4; JAS 1:27 See also EXO 22:22, EXO 23:9; LEV 25:25; DEU 24:17; PSA 41:1; PRO 23:10; ISA 58:7; JER 22:3, JER 22:16; ACT 20:35

Peacemaking

MAT 5:9 See also PRO 12:20; ROM 12:18, ROM 14:19; HEB 12:14; JAS 3:17

Showing concern for the environment

GEN 2:15 See also GEN 1:26–1:28; LEV 25:2–25:5; NEH 10:31; PSA 115:16

8244: ethics, and grace

Ethical conduct on the part of believers rests upon both the grace of God and human obedience.

People are unable to fulfil the law of God without divine grace

MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21–7:22 **ROM 7:14–7:15** See also GEN 6:5; 1KI 8:46; PSA 51:5, PSA 64:6; ISA 53:6; ROM 1:21, ROM 3:23; GAL 3:22; 1JN 1:8

Ethical conduct also depends on human obedience

DEU 26:16; PHP 2:12 See also DEU 4:40, DEU 6:17; JOS 1:8, JOS 22:5; 1KI 2:3, 1KI 11:38; 2KI 17:13; JER 7:23; MAT 5:48, MAT 7:21, MAT 19:17; ROM 6:19; 2CO 7:1; 1TI 6:11; 2PE 1:5–1:7, 2PE 3:14; 1JN 3:3

God assists believers' ethical endeavours

He enlightens their minds

PSA 119:130 See also DEU 4:1; PSA 119:144; PRO 6:23; MIC 6:8; ROM 7:7; 1CO 2:12–2:14

He gives them his Spirit

GAL 5:16 See also EZK 36:27; JHN 14:15–14:17; ROM 8:3–8:5, ROM 8:9, ROM 8:13; GAL 5:22–5:23; 2TH 2:13; 1PE 1:2

He gives them spiritual resources

2PE 1:3 See also 1KI 8:58; PSA 19:13; JHN 15:5; 1CO 10:13; EPH 6:11, EPH 6:13; PHP 2:13; 2TI 1:7; HEB 2:18; JAS 4:6

God will bring believers to ethical perfection

He will deliver them from the power of sin

ROM 7:24–7:25 See also 1CO 1:8; EPH 4:24; COL 3:10; PHP 1:6; 1TH 3:13; JUD 1:24

He will make them like Jesus Christ

1JN 3:2 See also ROM 8:29; 2CO 3:18

He is preparing them for a righteous existence

2PE 3:13 See also MAT 13:41–13:43; REV 21:8, REV 21:27, REV 22:15

8245: ethics, incentives towards

God's ethical demands are reinforced by a variety of sanctions and incentives.

Sanctions promoting ethical behaviour

The authorities

ROM 13:3–13:4 See also DEU 16:18, DEU 17:11–17:12, DEU 25:1; PSA 82:3–82:4; 1TI 2:1–2:4; 1PE 2:13–2:14

God treats people as they treat others

MAT 6:14–6:15 See also 2SA 12:9–12:10; MAT 5:7, MAT 7:2, MAT 18:35; JAS 2:13

Unethical behaviour renders worship unacceptable

ISA 58:4 See also ISA 1:13–1:15; EZK 33:31; ZEC 7:5, ZEC 7:9–7:10; MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42; TIT 1:16

The withdrawal of God's fellowship

ISA 59:2 See also PSA 51:11, PSA 66:18; HOS 5:6; MIC 3:4; EPH 4:30

God's judgment

GAL 6:8 See also DEU 28:15; ISA 1:23–1:24; 1CO 6:9; 2CO 5:10; COL 3:5–3:6; HEB 12:14

Incentives to correct ethical behaviour

A new life in Christ

EPH 5:8 See also ROM 6:2, ROM 6:13; 2CO 5:15; COL 3:9–3:10

God's goodness and love

EPH 5:1–5:2 See also EXO 20:2; ROM 12:1; 2CO 8:8–8:9; TIT 2:14; 1JN 3:16

Pleasing God

HEB 13:16 See also 2CO 5:9; COL 3:20; 1TH 2:3–2:4, 1TH 4:1; 1JN 3:22

True worship is made possible

PSA 24:3–24:4 See also PRO 21:3; HOS 6:6; ISA 58:6–58:7; MRK 12:33; JAS 1:27

God's fellowship

JHN 14:23 See also DEU 10:12–10:13; PSA 15:1–15:5; REV 21:7

God's blessing

DEU 16:20 See also DEU 28:2; PSA 1:3, PSA 84:11; ISA 56:1–56:2, ISA 58:9–58:14; MAT 6:18

Future reward

LUK 14:13–14:14 See also MAT 10:42 parallel MRK 9:41; MAT 25:34–25:36; LUK 6:35; ROM 2:10; COL 3:24; REV 22:12

8248: faithfulness

Commitment to a relationship with God or fellow human beings; seen in that loyalty, devotion and service which is a reflection of God's own faithfulness. Scripture points to the faithfulness of Jesus Christ as an example for believers.

8249: faithfulness, of God

See [1035: God, faithfulness of](#)

8250: faithfulness, of Jesus Christ

See [2021: Jesus Christ, faithfulness of](#)

8251: faithfulness, to God

The proper response to God by his covenant people; seen in a steadfast commitment which reflects God's own faithfulness to the covenant. Encouraged in all believers, it is especially important in leaders.

Faithfulness is the proper response to God by his covenant people

God's covenant with his people requires faithfulness

1KI 2:3–2:4 See also EXO 19:5; DEU 5:32–5:33, DEU 10:12–10:13, DEU 29:9; ISA 1:26

Faithfulness to God seen as marital fidelity

HOS 2:20 See also ISA 54:5; JER 2:2; EZK 16:8; EPH 1:1, EPH 5:22–5:25

Faithfulness to God reflects God's faithfulness

DEU 7:9 See also 1SA 2:35; 1CO 10:12–10:13; HEB 4:14–4:16, HEB 10:23; 1PE 4:19

Faithfulness is seen as steadfast commitment to God

In unwavering devotion

MIC 4:5 See also JOS 24:14–24:15; LUK 9:62; REV 2:10

In obedience

DEU 11:13; ; EZK 18:9

In service

1SA 12:24; ; 2CH 19:9, 2CH 34:10–34:12 parallel 2KI 22:4–22:7; ; EZK 44:15, EZK 48:11; ; 1TI 1:12

In giving

2CH 31:12 Faithfulness to God is expressed in giving to him for the benefit of others; ; 2CO 8:1–8:5

In prayer

ROM 12:12; ; 1TH 5:17

In patient endurance

2TI 2:11–2:13; ; HEB 10:36; ; REV 13:10, REV 14:12

In fulfilling vows

NUM 30:2; ; DEU 23:21–23:23; ; PSA 22:25, PSA 61:8; ; ECC 5:4; ; JON 2:9

Faithfulness is especially important in leaders

1CO 4:1–4:2; 3JN 1:3 See also EXO 18:21; 1TI 4:13–4:16, 1TI 6:20; 2TI 1:13–1:14, 2TI 2:2, 2TI 2:15, 2TI 4:1–4:2

Encouragements to faithfulness

The call to faithfulness

1CO 15:58 See also PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 26:4; JHN 14:1; 1CO 16:13; GAL 5:1; EPH 6:13

God watches over the faithful

PSA 97:10 See also PSA 31:23, PSA 37:28, PSA 86:2; PRO 2:8

God rewards faithfulness

ISA 26:23; MAT 25:21 parallel LUK 19:17 See also PSA 101:6; PRO 28:20; MAT 24:45–24:47 parallel LUK 12:42–12:44; 2TI 4:6–4:8; REV 17:14, REV 20:4

Lack of faithfulness

HOS 4:1 See also PSA 12:1, PSA 78:8, PSA 78:37; HOS 1:2, HOS 5:7, HOS 9:1

8252: faithfulness, in human relationships

Loyalty and commitment within human relationships is important in the life of God's people. It is seen particularly in fidelity within marriage, fulfilling family obligations, honouring vows, dutiful service and trust-worthy speech and conduct.

Faithfulness within society

It is important in the life of God's people

HOS 12:6 The word translated “love” is the Hebrew word “hesed”, which here expresses the loyalty and faithfulness that should characterise the life of God's people. See also MIC 6:8; MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42

It is a reflection of God's faithfulness to his people

PSA 89:14 See also DEU 32:4; ISA 11:4–11:5

Faithfulness in marriage

HEB 13:4 See also MAL 2:11, MAL 2:14–2:15; MAT 5:27–5:28; EXO 20:14; EPH 5:33; 1TI 5:9

Faithfulness in family relationships

1TI 5:4, 1TI 5:8 See also GEN 24:47–24:51 fulfilling family obligations in marriage arrangements; GEN 47:28–47:31 fulfilling family obligations regarding burial RUT 1:16–1:18, RUT 2:11–2:12 ISA 2:19 Hannah visits Samuel regularly. PRO 31:15, PRO 31:21, PRO 31:27–31:28 JHN 19:25–19:27 Jesus Christ provides for his mother.

Faithfulness to vows and covenants

NUM 30:2 GEN 29:18, GEN 29:30; GEN 50:25; ; EXO 13:19; JOS 2:14, JOS 6:25; JOS 9:15–9:20 Joshua and the Gibeonites; 1SA 18:3, 1SA 20:8, 1SA 20:42, 1SA 23:16; 1KI 20:34 Ben-Hadad and Ahab

Faithfulness in speech

In carrying messages

PRO 13:17 See also PRO 25:13

In telling the truth

PRO 12:17, PRO 14:5

In bringing God's word

JER 23:28 See also 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:2; 2TI 2:15

Faithfulness in conduct

In serving others

3JN 1:5 See also ROM 16:1–16:2; GAL 6:10; 1PE 4:10

In intercession

ROM 1:9–1:10; ; EPH 6:18; ; COL 4:2–4:4

In giving

2CO 8:7–8:11 See also 2CH 31:5–31:10; PHP 4:15–4:18

In handling money

2KI 12:13–12:15 See also 2KI 22:7; 2CH 31:12–31:15; MAT 25:21; LUK 16:10, LUK 19:17

The rarity of true faithfulness

PRO 20:6 See also PSA 12:1–12:2; ISA 57:1; JER 17:9

8253: faithfulness, examples of

Those who show loyalty, reliability and devotion in their relationships with God and others.

Abraham

NEH 9:7–9:8 See also GAL 3:9; HEB 11:8–11:12

Moses

HEB 3:5 See also NUM 12:7; HEB 11:24–11:28

Caleb

NUM 14:24 See also DEU 1:36; JOS 14:8–14:9

Elijah

1KI 19:10 See also 1KI 19:14

David

1SA 29:6 David, fleeing from Saul, shelters with Achish, king of Gath. See also 2SA 9:6–9:7, 2SA 22:22–22:24

Hezekiah

2KI 20:3 parallel ISA 38:3 See also 2CH 31:20, 2CH 32:1

Daniel

DAN 6:4 See also DAN 6:10

Paul

1TI 1:12 See also 1CO 7:25; 2TI 4:7

Timothy**1CO 4:17** See also 2TI 1:5**Silas****1PE 5:12** See also ACT 16:25**Christian martyrs****REV 2:13** See also REV 2:10, REV 12:11**Further examples**

Enoch: GEN 5:22–5:24; ; HEB 11:5; GEN 6:9; ; HEB 11:7; JOS 24:14–24:15 Joshua; ; 1KI 19:18 7,000 in Israel; 2KI 22:2 parallel 2CH 34:2; ; 2CH 35:26; NEH 13:13–13:14 Nehemiah; JOB 23:11–23:12, JOB 27:6; ISA 8:2; ; 2TI 2:2; DAN 3:16–3:18 Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; ACT 4:18–4:20 Peter and John; EPH 6:21–6:22; ; COL 4:7; COL 1:7, COL 4:12; COL 4:9; ; PHM 1:10–1:11

8255: fruit, spiritual

The spiritual life and growth of believers is likened to a fruit-bearing tree. As the fruit is evidence of the health and vigour of the tree, so the believer's life, attitudes and behaviour should reflect the presence of the Holy Spirit.

Believers should exhibit evidence of their conversion

JAS 3:13 See also MAT 3:8 parallel LUK 3:8–3:9; MAT 7:15–7:20, MAT 12:33; JHN 15:16; ROM 7:4–7:5; TIT 3:14; JAS 2:14–2:26

The nature of spiritual fruit

GAL 5:22–5:23 See also ROM 8:5–8:6; PHP 1:9–1:11; JAS 3:17

The sources of spiritual fruit**Acceptance of the gospel****LUK 8:15** parallels MAT 13:23, MRK 4:20**The old way of life put to death**

JHN 12:24 See also ROM 6:6, ROM 6:11–6:14, ROM 8:13–8:14; GAL 5:24; EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:5–3:10

Actively living a new life in Jesus Christ

GAL 6:7–6:9 See also ROM 6:11–6:14; GAL 5:25; EPH 5:8–5:9; COL 1:10, COL 3:12–3:15; 2TI 2:22; 2PE 1:5–1:8; TIT 3:14; 1JN 3:18

Remaining close to Jesus Christ**JHN 15:4–15:5****Submission to God's discipline****HEB 12:10–12:11** See also JHN 15:1–15:2**8256: fruitfulness**

Fruitfulness is seen as a sign of blessing and closeness to God, just as barrenness may be seen as a sign of God's disfavour. Scripture stresses that faith is given in order that it may bear fruit.

8257: fruitfulness, natural

In the OT fruitfulness is often used as a way of referring to God's material and physical blessings.

God's blessing on creation generally**GEN 1:11–1:12, GEN 1:22** See also GEN 8:17**Fruitfulness in the promised land**

LEV 25:18–25:19 God's blessing was seen in terms of material prosperity. See also LEV 26:3–26:4; DEU 32:13, DEU 33:13–33:16; EZK 34:27; AMO 9:14; ZEC 8:12

Fruitfulness in family relationships**Such fruitfulness promised**

GEN 13:16 See also GEN 15:5, GEN 17:6, GEN 17:20, GEN 22:17; LEV 26:9; DEU 7:13, DEU 28:4, DEU 28:11, DEU 30:9; PSA 128:3; JER 23:3; EZK 36:11

Such fruitfulness commanded

GEN 1:28 See also GEN 9:1, GEN 9:7, GEN 35:11, GEN 48:3–48:4

Examples of such fruitfulness

PSA 105:24 See also GEN 41:52, GEN 47:27, GEN 49:22; EXO 1:7; PSA 107:37–107:38

8258: fruitfulness, spiritual

Fruitfulness is used by Scripture as a symbol of spiritual maturity and well-being.

Spiritual fruitfulness described

GAL 5:22–5:23 The results of the Holy Spirit's activity in the life of a Christian believer. See also PSA 92:12; PRO 11:30; ISA 32:17; JER 11:16; EZK 19:10; EPH 5:9; COL 1:10; JAS 3:17

Spiritual fruitfulness expected in God's people

JHN 15:16 See also ISA 5:1–5:2; MAT 7:16–7:20 parallel LUK 6:43–6:44 Such fruitfulness, seen in a person's behaviour, is evidence of their true character; ROM 7:4

The conditions for spiritual fruitfulness

Spiritual fruitfulness through an intimate relationship with Jesus Christ

JHN 15:4–15:5

Spiritual fruitfulness through a commitment to God's word

PSA 1:1–1:3 See also MAT 13:23; JHN 15:2–15:3

Spiritual fruitfulness through a death to self-interest

JHN 12:24 Although Jesus Christ is speaking here primarily of his own death, the principle remains true for Christian living.

8260: generosity

The free and liberal bestowal of wealth, possessions or food upon others. The generosity of God is shown in his free bestowal of grace upon undeserving sinners.

8261: generosity, God's

The generosity of God is evident in the way in which he deals with his creation, and supremely with sinners. God bestows his gracious gifts upon sinners in salvation, in sanctification and through the coming of the Holy Spirit.

God's generous heart

EPH 1:7–1:9 See also EXO 34:6–34:7; PSA 33:18–33:22; MAT 7:11; LUK 15:22–15:24; ROM 11:35–11:36

God's generosity evident in creation

PSA 65:9–65:13 See also PSA 33:5, PSA 68:9

God's generosity evident in providence

ACT 14:17 See also GEN 24:35; NUM 14:8; DEU 28:11, DEU 33:23; PSA 66:12, PSA 78:15, PSA 132:15, PSA 145:7, PSA 147:6; JER 31:12–31:14, JER 33:6–33:9; MAL 3:10; 1TI 6:17

God's generosity experienced in salvation

EPH 1:3 See also JHN 1:16; ROM 5:5, ROM 10:12; EPH 2:7, EPH 3:8; COL 2:10; 1JN 3:1

His love and mercifulness towards sinners

PSA 116:5, PSA 130:7; ; ISA 55:7; ; HOS 14:4; ; EPH 2:7; ; 1JN 3:1

Redemption through the death of Jesus Christ

ROM 3:24; ; EPH 1:7; ; 1TI 1:14–1:16; ; TIT 2:13–2:14; ; 1PE 1:18–1:19

His gift of eternal life

JHN 3:16, JHN 10:28; ; ROM 3:23–3:24, ROM 5:17, ROM 6:23; ; 1TI 1:14–1:16

God's generosity experienced in sanctification

2PE 1:2–1:3 See also PSA 23:5, PSA 36:7–36:8; EZK 47:1–47:12; PHP 2:12–2:13, PHP 4:19; JUD 1:2

The gift of the Holy Spirit

JOL 2:28–2:29 See also ACT 2:17–2:18; EZK 39:29; JHN 3:34; ACT 10:45; ROM 5:5; TIT 3:6

Wisdom

JAS 1:5 See also COL 2:2

Comfort, strength and encouragement

2CO 1:5 See also EPH 3:16; 2TH 2:16–2:17

God's generosity in heaven

Inheritance

1CO 2:9 See also EPH 1:18

Reward

PRO 28:20 See also HEB 10:35; REV 21:1–21:4

8262: generosity, human

Believers should be generous in their dealings with others, following the example of God himself.

Motivations for generosity

God's example

2CO 8:7–8:9 See also 1JN 3:16–3:18

God's dealings with believers

EPH 4:32–5:2 See also MAT 10:7–10:8, MAT 18:21–18:35

Demonstrations of generosity

In material giving

ACT 4:32–4:37 See also LEV 25:35; DEU 15:7–15:8; MAT 5:42, MAT 19:21; 2CO 8:3, 2CO 9:5

In support of God's work

PHP 4:16 See also EXO 36:5; NUM 7:13–7:17; 1CH 28:14–28:18, 1CH 29:9; 2CH 31:9–31:10; MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; GAL 6:6; 1TI 5:17–5:18

In worship

MAT 26:6–26:7 See also EXO 35:22; 1KI 3:4, 1KI 8:63; 2CH 1:6, 2CH 5:6; EZR 6:9; ROM 12:1–12:2; PHP 2:17

In acts of mercy

LUK 10:33–10:35 See also 2KI 6:22; 2CH 28:15

In giving presents

1KI 10:13 See also GEN 24:53, GEN 32:17–32:21, GEN 45:21–45:23; 2KI 5:5, 2KI 8:9

Meanness and covetousness the opposites of generosity

ECC 5:13 See also 2SA 12:2–12:4; ISA 43:23–43:24; MIC 2:2; MAL 3:8–3:9; MAT 25:45; LUK 12:15

Generosity rewarded

MAL 3:10 See also PSA 37:25–37:26, PSA 112:5, PSA 112:9; PRO 11:24–11:25, PRO 22:9; ISA 58:10; LUK 6:38; 2CO 9:6–9:9; GAL 6:9–6:10

8264: gentleness

An expression of compassion, seen in God's dealings with the frail and weak, and expected of believers in their dealings with others.

The gentleness of God

In dealing with the wayward

ISA 40:1–40:2; LUK 1:76–1:79 See also ISA 30:18–30:19, ISA 54:8, ISA 63:15 God's gentleness is not always evident; HOS 2:13–2:15; ROM 2:4 God's gentle dealings are not always appreciated.

In caring for the weak

ISA 40:11 See also 1KI 19:12

The gentleness of Jesus Christ

MAT 11:29 See also ZEC 9:9; MAT 21:4–21:5, MAT 12:18–12:21; ISA 42:1–42:3; 2CO 10:1; PHP 2:1; HEB 5:2

Examples of Jesus Christ's gentleness

MRK 1:40–1:42, MRK 5:25–5:34, MRK 10:13–10:16; ; JHN 8:3–8:11

Gentleness as strength esteemed by God

PRO 15:1; JAS 3:17 See also PRO 25:15; MAT 5:5; 1PE 3:1–3:4

Gentleness as a mark of Christian character

COL 3:12 See also GAL 5:22–5:23; EPH 4:1–4:2; 1TI 6:11

Believers are to reflect God's gentleness in their dealings with people

In correcting the wayward

GAL 6:1 See also 2TI 2:24–2:25

In reasoning with unbelievers

1PE 3:15–3:16

In nurturing new believers

See also 1TH 2:7

In showing consideration to all

TIT 3:1–3:2 See also EPH 4:32; PHP 4:5

8265: godliness

Reverence for or devotion to God, producing a practical awareness of God in every aspect of life.

Examples of godliness in the OT

GEN 5:24 Enoch; ; GEN 6:9 Noah; ; 1KI 18:3–18:4 Obadiah; ; 2CH 31:20–31:21 Hezekiah; ; JOB 1:1 Job

Examples of godliness in the NT

LUK 2:25 Simeon; ; LUK 2:37 Anna; ; JHN 1:47 Nathanael; JHN 8:29; ; HEB 5:7; ACT 2:5, ACT 8:2; ACT 10:2, ACT 10:7; ACT 11:24 Barnabas; ; ACT 22:12 Ananias

God has a special concern for the godly

PSA 4:3 “the godly” (sometimes translated “the saints”) is often used in the OT to refer to God's people. See also PSA 32:6; JHN 9:31

Godly living

Godliness should be seen in the lives of believers

2PE 3:11 See also 1TI 2:2, 1TI 6:11; TIT 2:12

Jesus Christ is the beginning and end of godliness

1TI 3:16 The model and the power for godly living derives from the incarnate Christ. See also HEB 5:7; 2PE 1:3

The basis for godly living is true teaching about Jesus Christ

1TI 6:3–6:4 See also TIT 1:1

Godly living demands self-discipline

1CO 9:24–9:27; ; 2CO 10:5; ; 1TI 4:7–4:8

Sorrow for sin is a sign of godliness

2CO 7:10–7:11

The benefits of godliness

Its value in both this world and the next

1TI 4:8

Its present blessings

DEU 4:40; 1TI 6:6 See also ISA 3:10; TIT 3:8

The promise of future blessing

TIT 2:11–2:13 See also 2PE 3:11–3:12

Godliness does not guarantee escape from suffering

PSA 12:1 See also MIC 7:2; 2TI 3:12; 2PE 2:9

Apparent godliness may not be genuine

1TI 6:5; ; 2TI 3:4–3:5

8266: holiness

The quality of God that sets him utterly apart from his world, especially in terms of his purity and sanctity. The holiness of God is also manifested in the persons and work of Jesus Christ and the Holy Spirit. Believers are called upon to become like God in his holiness.

8267: holiness, of God

See [1065: God, holiness of](#)

8268: holiness, of Jesus Christ

See [2030: Jesus Christ, holiness of](#)

8269: holiness, as separation from the worldly

God's people are called to holiness, which involves being distinct from other people. In the OT, this is seen in the command to separate from other nations and from everything that can compromise commitment to

the LORD. In the NT believers are called to distance themselves from the ways and values of the world, which can be dishonouring to God and destructive to obedience to him.

Israel is to be set apart from other nations

LEV 20:23–20:26 See also EXO 33:15–33:16; LEV 15:31, LEV 18:29–18:30; DEU 7:1–7:6, DEU 23:9–23:14; EZR 9:1–9:2, EZR 9:10–9:12; ISA 52:11

Common things are designated clean or unclean by ritual law

Clean and unclean animals

LEV 11:46–11:47 See also LEV 11:1–11:23 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20; MRK 7:14–7:19; ACT 10:14

Infectious skin diseases

LEV 13:2–13:3, LEV 14:2

Mildew

LEV 13:47–13:49, LEV 14:33–14:36

Bodily discharges

LEV 12:2, LEV 15:2

Corpses

LEV 5:2–5:3, LEV 11:31–11:40, LEV 21:1, LEV 21:11

What is holy must be kept separate

The Israelites must distinguish between the holy and the common

LEV 10:10–10:11; ; EZK 44:23

Contact with the profane desecrates the holy

ACT 21:28 See also JER 51:51

Unclean people and things must be removed

NUM 5:1–5:3; EZR 10:10–10:11 See also LEV 7:22–7:27, LEV 13:45–13:46, LEV 19:5–19:8; NUM 19:13, NUM 19:20; DEU 23:10–23:14; 2CH 26:21

Unclean people are not to approach what is sacred

LEV 7:20–7:21, LEV 22:3–22:6

The holy must be treated with respect

Unintentional defilement of the holy carries a penalty

LEV 5:14–5:16

Warnings against contempt for the holy

LEV 22:1–22:2 See also EXO 19:10–19:13, EXO 28:42–28:43, EXO 30:18–30:21, EXO 31:14–31:15; NUM 4:15, NUM 4:17–4:20; HEB 10:28–10:29

Examples of contempt for the holy

LEV 10:1–10:2; ; NUM 16:1–16:7, NUM 16:18–16:35; ; 1SA 6:19–6:20; ; 2SA 6:6–6:7; ; EZK 22:26, EZK 22:31; ; ACT 5:1–5:10

Christians are called to be separate from the ways of the world

JHN 15:19; JAS 4:4; 1PE 2:9–2:11 See also JHN 17:14–17:16; 2CO 6:14–7:1; 2TI 2:19; JAS 1:27

8270: holiness, as set apart for God

Believers are holy, in that they are called to be set apart from the world as God's own people. Likewise certain days and articles are holy because they are set apart for God alone.

Believers are called to be a holy people, set apart for God

The nation of Israel

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; LEV 20:26; DEU 26:18–26:19

The priests

1CH 23:13 See also LEV 21:5–21:8

The Nazirites

NUM 6:1–6:8

The apostles and prophets

LUK 1:70; ; ACT 3:21; ; EPH 3:5; ; 2PE 3:2

Christians

EPH 1:4; 1PE 1:15–1:16 See also 1CO 1:2; COL 3:12; 2TI 1:9; 1PE 2:9

Consecration sets apart for holiness

God's people are consecrated

LEV 20:7–20:8 See also EXO 19:10–19:11, EXO 19:14–19:15; LEV 11:44–11:45; JOS 3:5, JOS 7:13; 1SA 16:5

Priests are consecrated for divine service

EXO 30:30 See also EXO 40:12–40:15; 1SA 7:1; 1CH 15:14; 2CH 23:6, 2CH 29:5, 2CH 35:3

Articles are consecrated for divine use

EXO 40:9–40:11 See also EXO 29:36–29:37, EXO 30:25–30:29

Days and occasions set apart for God

The Sabbath

LEV 23:1–23:3 See also GEN 2:3; EXO 16:23–16:25, EXO 20:11

The Passover

LEV 23:4–23:8; ; NUM 28:16, NUM 28:25

The Feast of Weeks

LEV 23:15–23:16, LEV 23:21; ; NUM 28:26

The Feast of Trumpets

LEV 23:23–23:25; ; NUM 29:1; ; NEH 8:2, NEH 8:9–8:11

The Day of Atonement

LEV 23:26–23:28, LEV 23:32; ; NUM 29:7

The Feast of Tabernacles

LEV 23:33–23:36; ; NUM 29:12

The sabbath year

LEV 25:1–25:5

The Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:8–25:12

Places identified with the presence of God are made holy**Holy ground**

EXO 3:5; ; JOS 5:15

Holy mountains

EXO 19:18–19:23; ; 2PE 1:18

The tabernacle

EXO 29:42–29:44, EXO 40:9

The temple**1KI 9:3** parallel 2CH 7:16 See also 1KI 8:10–8:13; EZK 42:14, EZK 42:20; MAT 24:15; ACT 6:13, ACT 21:28**Jerusalem and the holy land**

JOL 3:17; ; ZEC 2:12; ; MAT 4:5, MAT 27:53

Things associated with worship are holy**Bread**

EXO 29:32–29:33; ; 1SA 21:3–21:6; ; MAT 12:3–12:4 parallels MRK 2:25–2:26, LUK 6:3–6:4

Perfume

EXO 30:34–30:38

Ritual offerings**LEV 6:24–6:29** See also LEV 6:17, LEV 7:1, LEV 7:6, LEV 10:12–10:13, LEV 10:16–10:18**Offerings dedicated with a vow**

LEV 27:9, LEV 27:14, LEV 27:20–27:23, LEV 27:28

Tithes

LEV 27:30–27:33

The firstborn

EXO 13:2, EXO 13:11–13:12; ; LUK 2:22–2:23

8271: holiness, purpose of

God in his holiness desires a holy people amongst whom he can dwell, and who can effectively worship, witness to and serve him as they prepare for a future with God and to be like God.

The goal of holiness is to be like God**LEV 19:2; MAT 5:48** See also ROM 8:29; HEB 12:10; 1PE 1:15–1:16; 1JN 3:2–3:3**God dwells with holy people****God dwelt with the people of Israel****DEU 23:14** See also EXO 29:42–29:46; NUM 5:1–5:3; 1KI 9:3; EZK 37:26–37:28; ZEC 2:10–2:12**God dwells with Christians****EPH 2:19–2:22** See also 1CO 3:16–3:17**Holiness is required for acceptable worship****HEB 10:19–10:22** See also LEV 22:17–22:22; 2CH 29:15–29:31; ISA 56:6–56:7; MAT 15:7–15:9 parallel MRK 7:6; ISA 29:13; ROM 12:1**Holiness is needed for effective witness****1PE 2:9–2:12** See also EZK 20:41, EZK 36:20, EZK 39:7; 1PE 3:1–3:2**Holiness is needed for godly service****HEB 9:13–9:14** See also EXO 28:41; LEV 21:6–21:8; 2CH 35:3; ZEP 3:9; LUK 1:74–1:75; 2TI 2:20–2:21; TIT 2:14**Holiness leads to a future hope****Holy people will see God****HEB 12:14** See also MAT 5:8; 1TH 3:13; 2TH 1:10**Holy people will receive eternal life****ROM 6:22** See also 2PE 3:11**Holy people will inherit the kingdom****COL 1:12** See also DAN 7:18, DAN 7:22, DAN 7:27; EPH 1:18; REV 20:6**Holy people will judge the world**

1CO 6:2

Believers' ultimate destiny is to share God's holiness for ever**EPH 5:25–5:27; REV 21:2–21:3****8272: holiness, believers' growth in**

Believers are enabled to grow in holiness on account of the sacrificial death of Jesus Christ, foreshadowed by the OT sacrificial system, and through the sanctifying work of the Holy Spirit.

Holiness begins with God's initiative**God chooses who and what is to be holy****2CH 7:16** parallel 1KI 9:3 See also EXO 20:11; NUM 16:7; 2CH 29:11; ZEC 2:12

God chooses and calls his people to holiness

DEU 7:6; EPH 1:4 See also DEU 14:2; ROM 1:7; COL 3:12; 1PE 1:2, 1PE 1:15

Holiness is conferred by the holy God**Holiness is conferred by the presence of God**

EXO 29:42–29:43 See also EXO 3:4–3:5, EXO 19:23; 2CH 7:1–7:2

Holiness is conferred through covenant relationship with God

EXO 19:5–19:6 See also DEU 28:9; EZK 37:26–37:28; 1PE 2:9

Holiness is conferred by the sovereign action of God

1TH 5:23 See also LEV 20:8; ISA 4:3–4:4; EZK 36:25; ZEP 1:7; ACT 15:9; HEB 2:11

Holiness through the OT rituals**Cleansing from what is unclean**

NUM 8:6–8:7 See also EXO 19:14; NUM 19:9; NEH 12:30

Purification and atonement through sacrifice

NUM 8:12–8:14 The OT sacrificial system and holiness laws foreshadow the perfect sacrifice of Jesus Christ that enables believers to grow in holiness through faith. See also EXO 29:35–29:37; LEV 8:14–8:15, LEV 16:5–16:10, LEV 16:15–16:22, LEV 16:29–16:30

Consecration by anointing

LEV 8:10–8:12 See also EXO 29:21, EXO 40:9

Holiness through Jesus Christ**Through the sacrifice of Jesus Christ**

HEB 10:10 See also EPH 5:25–5:27; COL 1:22; HEB 1:3, HEB 9:13–9:14, HEB 9:23–9:28, HEB 10:14, HEB 10:19–10:22, HEB 13:12; 1JN 1:7, 1JN 2:2, 1JN 4:10

Through relationship with Jesus Christ

1CO 1:2 See also 1CO 1:30

Holiness through the sanctifying work of the Holy Spirit

2TH 2:13 See also JHN 3:5–3:8; ROM 15:16; 1CO 6:11; 1TH 4:7–4:8; TIT 3:5; 1PE 1:2

The human response to holiness**Repentance**

1JN 1:9 See also EZR 9:1–9:7, EZR 10:1–10:4; PSA 51:1–51:10; ACT 2:38; ROM 6:11–6:13; JAS 4:8

Faith

GAL 5:5 See also ROM 1:17–1:18; 2TH 2:13

Obedience

1PE 1:22 See also PSA 119:9; JHN 17:17; ROM 6:16–6:19

8273: holiness, ethical aspects of

Behaviour that reflects the holy character of God himself is to be expressed in both social and personal dimensions of life.

Holiness in practice is a reflection of God's own character

1PE 1:15–1:16 See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7; EPH 4:24; 1JN 3:3

Holiness demands a different way of life**Shunning practices that defile**

LEV 18:1–18:3; EPH 5:11–5:12; 1TI 5:22 See also LEV 18:21–18:24, LEV 18:29–18:30, LEV 20:1–20:3, LEV 20:6–20:7, LEV 20:23–20:26, LEV 21:7; 2CO 6:17–7:1; GAL 5:19–5:21, GAL 5:24; EPH 5:3–5:7; COL 3:5–3:10

Obedience to God's law

LEV 20:7–20:8 See also LEV 18:4–18:5, LEV 19:37; DEU 6:25, DEU 28:9; PSA 119:9; ROM 7:12; 1PE 1:22

Holiness is expressed in social behaviour**Care for the disadvantaged**

LEV 19:9–19:10 See also LEV 19:14, LEV 19:33–19:34; 1TI 5:3–5:4, 1TI 5:8; JAS 1:27

A concern for truth and justice

LEV 19:15–19:16 See also LEV 19:11–19:13, LEV 19:35–19:37

Loving one's neighbour

LEV 19:18 See also LEV 19:16–19:17 Most of the OT law can be seen as an expression of holiness.

Holiness is expressed in family and sexual relations

1TH 4:3–4:7 See also LEV 18:5–18:20, LEV 18:22–18:23, LEV 19:3, LEV 20:9; EPH 5:3; 1CO 6:13–6:15, 1CO 6:18–6:19

Holiness is seen in personal character

COL 3:12 See also EPH 4:23–4:24, EPH 4:32–5:2; 2TI 2:22

8275: honesty

Behaviour, in action and words, that aims to convey truth. This quality is an essential aspect of God's own nature and purposes, and is required of those whom he calls to be his people.

Honesty is integral to the gospel**The honesty of God**

2SA 7:28 See also PSA 19:7, PSA 33:4, PSA 111:7, PSA 119:142, PSA 119:151; ISA 45:19; JER 10:10; JHN 7:28; ROM 3:4; 1TH 1:9; 1JN 5:20; REV 3:7, REV 15:2–15:3, REV 19:9

The honesty demanded of believers

PSA 15:1–15:2; 2CO 4:2 See also EXO 18:21LEV 19:35–19:36; DEU 25:13–25:16 1KI 9:4–9:5; PRO 11:1; EZK 45:10; ZEC 8:16–8:17; JHN 4:23–4:24; ROM 1:18; 1CO 5:8EPH 4:15, EPH 4:25 PHP 4:81TI 3:8; TIT 1:7 TIT 2:7–2:8

The honesty of Jesus Christ

1PE 2:22 See also MAT 22:16 parallel MRK 12:14 Jesus Christ's opponents flattering Jesus Christ, but nevertheless speaking the truth.

Other examples of honest behaviour commended by Scripture

Jacob: GEN 30:33, GEN 43:12; 1SA 12:3–12:5 Samuel; ; 1KI 17:24 Elijah; ; 1CH 29:17 David; ; JOB 27:4 Job; ; DAN 6:4 Daniel; ACT 24:16; ; 2CO 1:12, 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:2

The cost of honesty

JER 26:15 See also PRO 17:26, PRO 29:10, PRO 29:27; ISA 59:14–59:15; AMO 5:10; JHN 8:45–8:46, JHN 18:23; GAL 4:16

8276: humility

An attitude of lowliness and obedience, grounded in the recognition of one's status before God as his creatures.

God commands humility

MIC 6:8; JAS 4:10; 1PE 3:8 See also EXO 10:3; PRO 16:19; ISA 57:15, ISA 58:5; ZEP 2:3; LUK 14:9–14:11; ROM 12:3 sober assessment of oneself; 1CO 1:28; EPH 4:2; COL 3:12; TIT 3:2; JAS 3:13; 1PE 5:5

God exalts the humble

LUK 1:52 See also 2SA 7:8; 1KI 14:7

Believers should humble themselves before God

2CH 7:14; 1PE 5:6 See also 2SA 22:281KI 21:29; 2KI 22:19; 2CH 12:6–12:7, 2CH 12:12, 2CH 30:11, 2CH 33:12, 2CH 33:19, 2CH 34:27PSA 18:27, PSA 25:9, PSA 138:6, PSA 147:6, PSA 149:4; PRO 3:34, PRO 18:12; JAS 4:6; ISA 29:19, ISA 38:15, ISA 57:15; PRO 15:33, PRO 22:4 PSA 35:13; JER 44:10 lack of humility linked with disobedience

God humbles his people to renew and restore them

PSA 44:9 See also LEV 26:41; DEU 8:2, DEU 8:16; 1KI 11:39; 2CH 28:19; PSA 107:39; ISA 9:1; 2CO 12:21

God humbles the proud

LUK 18:14 See also 1SA 2:7; ISA 2:11, ISA 2:17, ISA 5:15, ISA 13:11, ISA 23:9, ISA 25:11, ISA 26:5; DAN 4:37

Examples of humble people

Outstanding individuals

GEN 32:10 Jacob; ; GEN 41:16 Joseph; ; NUM 12:3 Moses; ; 1SA 9:21 Saul; 1SA 18:18; ; 2SA 7:18; 1KI 3:7 Solomon; ; DAN 2:30 Daniel; ; MAT 3:14 John the Baptist; ; LUK 1:43 Elizabeth; ; LUK 1:48 Mary, the mother of Jesus Christ; 1TI 1:15; ; ACT 20:19

Other examples

2SA 16:4; ; PRO 6:3, PRO 11:2, PRO 16:19, PRO 29:23; ; DAN 5:22; ; MAT 8:8, MAT 15:27, MAT 18:4

The example of Jesus Christ

PHP 2:5–2:8 ISA 53:3–53:5, ISA 53:7–53:8; ; ZEC 9:9 parallels MAT 21:5, JHN 12:15; MAT 11:29, MAT 20:28; ; LUK 22:26–22:27; ; JHN 13:4; ; 2CO 8:9

8277: innocence

The state of being devoid of guilt, experience of sin or evil motives or thoughts. Scripture commends this state to believers.

8278: innocence, teaching on

A highly valued quality to be eagerly sought. The OT stresses that the innocent deserve justice rather than evil. In the NT believers are encouraged to attain innocence.

Exhortations to be innocent

MAT 10:16 See also PSA 32:2; ROM 16:19; PHP 2:14–2:15; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 5:23; 2PE 3:14

Ascribing innocence to people

Innocence is ultimately established by God

1CO 4:4 See also COL 1:21–1:22

The need to acquit the innocent

1KI 8:32 See also EXO 23:7; NUM 5:29–5:31; DEU 25:1; PRO 17:15, PRO 18:5

The danger of acquitting the guilty

PRO 17:15 See also PRO 24:23–24:24

The rewards of innocence

PSA 15:1–15:5 See also REV 14:1–14:5

The characteristics of innocence

PRO 21:8 See also PHP 2:14–2:15, PHP 4:8

The shedding of innocent blood

Its prohibition

DEU 19:8–19:10 See also JER 22:3

The guilt associated with it

JER 26:15 See also DEU 19:11–19:13; 2KI 21:16; PSA 106:38; PRO 6:16–6:17; ISA 59:7; JER 7:2–7:8

The need to purge the guilt

1KI 2:31–2:33 See also DEU 21:1–21:9

The right to be avenged

2SA 4:9–4:11 See also NUM 35:16–35:28

Examples of those shedding innocent blood

MAT 27:3–27:4 See also 2KI 24:1–24:4; JON 1:14

8279: innocence, examples of

Innocence is displayed most purely in Jesus Christ but is also ascribed to others.

Examples of innocence**Innocence before the fall**

GEN 2:25

The innocence of Jesus Christ

1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; MAT 27:19; LUK 23:41; JHN 8:46; 2CO 5:21; HEB 4:15; 1JN 3:4–3:5

Innocence in others

JOB 9:21; JHN 1:47 See also GEN 6:9 Noah; JDG 21:20–21:22 the assembly of Israel; 2SA 11:6–11:13 Uriah; JOB 9:15 Job; DAN 6:22 Daniel; 2CO 7:10–7:11 the Corinthians

The varied experiences of innocence**Loss of innocence**

GEN 3:1–3:13

The innocent wronged

ISA 5:22–5:23 See also 1SA 19:4–19:5; 2SA 13:1–13:14; ISA 29:20–29:21; MAT 2:16; MAT 12:1–12:7; JAS 5:6

Admissions of lack of innocence

2KI 10:9 See also GEN 44:1–44:16

Claims to innocence

JOB 34:5–34:6 See also GEN 20:1–20:5; 2SA 3:26–3:28; ISA 50:8–50:9; ACT 20:25–20:27

False claims to innocence

JER 2:34–2:35 See also MAT 27:24

Washing hands to signify innocence

MAT 27:24 See also PSA 26:6; PSA 73:13

A distorted view of innocence

PRO 16:2 See also JOB 4:7; JOB 9:23; JOB 9:28

8281: insight

The spiritual quality that enables a person to appreciate God's mind and will in matters of behaviour, truth and providence, especially where right percep-

tion is not obvious. Insight is akin to wisdom and understanding. It is given by God and is to be sought by believers.

Insight is given by God

2TI 2:7 See also PRO 2:6

Insight through angelic instruction

JOB 33:23; ; DAN 9:20–9:22

Insight through Jesus Christ's teaching

LUK 24:45–24:47 See also LUK 24:27; MAT 16:12

Insight through the Holy Spirit

1CO 2:9–2:13 See also ISA 64:4; EPH 3:4–3:5

Human insight cannot comprehend spiritual truth

1CO 2:14 See also JOB 9:11; 1CO 1:20–1:21

Insight into spiritual truth**Insight into the truth about Jesus Christ**

COL 2:2–2:3 See also JHN 16:12–16:15

Insight into the believer's hope and power

EPH 1:18–1:19

Insight into the make-up of the church

ACT 10:34–10:35; ; EPH 3:2–3:6

Insight into the number of the beast

REV 13:18

Insight into the providence of God**Joseph's insight**

GEN 50:20 See also GEN 45:4–45:8

David's insight

2SA 5:12 parallel 1CH 14:2

Job's insight

JOB 42:1–42:6 Job does not learn why he has suffered, but reaffirms his trust in God's superior wisdom and power. See also JOB 15:9 Human insight into Job's suffering did not bring enlightenment; JOB 26:3; JOB 34:35

Insight into correct behaviour

PHP 1:9–1:11 See also PRO 28:7; COL 1:9–1:10; PSA 19:12 discerning one's own faults; PSA 119:34 understanding God's law; PRO 5:1–5:4 avoiding evil

Insight into the truth about people

2KI 4:8–4:9 The Shunammite woman recognises Elisha as a man of God; ; NEH 6:1–6:2 Nehemiah discerns the motives of his enemies; ; MAT 9:3–9:4 parallels MRK 2:6–2:8; LUK 5:21–5:22 Jesus Christ is aware of the evil thoughts of the Pharisees and the teachers of the

law; ; JHN 4:19 The woman of Samaria understands some of the truth about Jesus Christ.

Insight is to be sought

PRO 2:3–2:5 See also PRO 3:21, PRO 18:15

Asking God for insight

JAS 1:5 See also 1KI 3:9–3:12 parallel 2CH 1:10–1:12

Insight through meditation on God's word

PSA 119:98–119:100 See also PSA 119:104; DAN 9:2; MAT 22:29 parallel MRK 12:24

Examples of people of insight

1KI 4:29–4:34 Solomon; ; 1CH 27:32 Jonathan, David's uncle; ; DAN 5:11 Daniel

Examples of lack of insight

MAT 16:9–16:11 parallel MRK 8:17–8:21 Jesus Christ's disciples; ; MAT 16:22 parallel MRK 8:32 Simon Peter; ; LUK 24:25 Cleopas and his companion; ; JHN 3:10 Nicodemus; ; JHN 20:2 Mary Magdalene

8282: intolerance

Unwillingness to allow or permit something beyond certain levels. God's intolerance should be the model for God's people, but they should avoid becoming wrongly intolerant.

God is intolerant of evil

God is pure and cannot tolerate evil

HAB 1:13 See also NUM 25:3; JOS 7:1; 2SA 6:7 parallel 1CH 13:10; 2KI 17:11; PSA 5:6; ROM 1:18; REV 21:27

God demonstrates his intolerance as the last resort

JER 44:22 See also EXO 4:10–4:14, EXO 34:6–34:7; NUM 14:18; NEH 9:30; ACT 17:30; ROM 2:3–2:5

Human intolerance should reflect God's attitudes

Human intolerance of God's enemies

JDG 5:31 See also 1SA 17:26; PSA 69:9; MAT 26:51 parallels MRK 14:47, LUK 22:50; JHN 18:10; EPH 5:6–5:7

Human intolerance of ungodliness

EXO 32:19–32:20 See also DEU 6:13–6:15; PSA 119:115; 1TI 4:7; 2TI 2:16, 2TI 3:5; TIT 2:12

Human intolerance of error

TIT 3:10 See also ACT 17:11, ACT 20:30–20:31; GAL 5:11–5:12; EPH 5:6–5:7; COL 2:8; HEB 13:9

Human intolerance of evil and sinfulness

REV 2:20 See also JOB 28:28; PSA 34:14, PSA 101:4–101:5; MAT 5:30; ROM 6:12, ROM 12:9; EPH 4:25; 2TH 3:6; REV 2:2

Human intolerance can be misguided

It can be a form of hypocrisy

LUK 6:41–6:42 See also MAT 23:29–23:30; LUK 13:14–13:15; JHN 12:5–12:6

It can amount to exclusiveness

MAT 23:13 See also ACT 15:1

It can be a form of oppression

Intolerance of minority, afflicted or underprivileged groups often leads to oppression: EXO 1:11–1:14, EXO 23:9; ; PRO 14:31, PRO 28:3; ; ECC 5:8; ; MAT 20:31 parallels MRK 10:48, LUK 18:39

It can be harshly condemnatory

JHN 8:5 See also NUM 21:4–21:5; EST 3:8; MAT 23:34–23:35; JHN 7:45–7:51, JHN 16:2

It can be a form of bigotry

JHN 15:19 See also NUM 11:27–11:29; JDG 12:5–12:6; MAT 21:15–21:16, MAT 23:16, MAT 23:18

Intolerance is usually a matter of decision

Intolerance leading to a good decision

LUK 18:4–18:5 See also LUK 11:7–11:8

Intolerance leading to a bad decision

MAT 19:13–19:14 parallels MRK 10:13–10:14, LUK 18:15–18:16 The disciples' intolerance is counteracted by Jesus Christ's tolerance.

8283: joy

A quality or attitude of delight and happiness, which is ultimately grounded in the work of God as Father, Son and Holy Spirit. Among the many situations in which joy is experienced, Scripture recognises as supreme being accepted in the presence of God.

8284: joy, of God

See [1070: God, joy of](#)

8285: joy, of Jesus Christ

See [2039: Jesus Christ, joy of](#)

8286: joy, of Holy Spirit

See [3020: Holy Spirit, joy of](#)

8287: joy, and human experience

Joy is experienced naturally in many circumstances of life and in human relationships. It is especially important in the life of God's people, who experience joy in response to all that God has done for them.

Poetic images of joy in creation

PSA 96:11–96:13 parallel 1CH 16:31–16:33 See also JOB 39:13; PSA 65:12–65:13, PSA 89:12, PSA 97:1, PSA 100:1; ISA 35:1–35:2, ISA 49:13

Joy arising from specific circumstances

Joy because of the birth of children

LUK 1:13–1:15 See also GEN 30:12–30:13; LUK 1:58

Joy because of victory and deliverance

EXO 18:9; ; ISA 18:6; ; JER 41:13; ; ZEC 10:7

Joy because of the behaviour of others

PRO 15:30 See also PRO 23:24–23:25; MAT 14:6–14:7; HEB 13:17

Joy because of God's blessings in everyday life

ECC 5:19–5:20

Joy arising from relationships

PHP 4:1 See also PRO 5:18; SNG 1:4, SNG 3:11; ROM 12:15, ROM 15:26–15:27; 1CO 12:26; PHP 1:4–1:6; PHM 1:7

God's people find their joy in him

PSA 4:7, PSA 16:11; HAB 3:17–3:18; PHP 3:1 See also 1CH 16:10; PSA 43:4; PHP 1:23–1:26 knowing Jesus Christ; PHP 4:4

God himself gives joy to his people

NEH 12:43; ; JOB 8:21; ; ECC 2:26; ; ISA 9:3; ; ACT 13:52, ACT 14:15–14:17

Reasons for God's people to know joy

ISA 2:1 God's deliverance; ; 2CH 6:41 God's goodness; ; JOB 22:22–22:26 repentance; ; PSA 19:8 the rightness of God's precepts; ; PSA 94:19 God's consolation; ; PSA 122:1 being in God's presence; ; ISA 25:9 God's salvation; ; ISA 58:13–58:14 honouring the Sabbath; ; JER 15:16 God's words; ; JER 31:12 God's generosity; ; LUK 1:46–1:49 recognition by God; ; ROM 15:13 trusting God

8288: joy, of Israel

Joy is characteristic of Israel's corporate worship, especially the great festivals.

Joy expressed in and through Israel's life of worship

PSA 100:1–100:4 See also NUM 10:10; DEU 27:6–27:7; PSA 98:4–98:6, PSA 132:6–132:9, PSA 149:2–149:5; ISA 30:29; ZEC 8:19 LEV 23:39–23:41; DEU 16:13–16:15 2CH 30:21–30:23, 2CH 30:26–30:27

Joy expressed by the individual as a result of faith

PSA 16:8–16:9, PSA 28:7 See also JOB 6:10, JOB 33:26; PSA 5:11, PSA 21:1, PSA 71:23, PSA 92:4, PSA 104:34, PSA 119:14, PSA 119:174; PRO 10:28; ISA 61:10

Joy experienced by the nation as the people of God

PSA 20:5; ISA 51:11; JER 31:12–31:13 See also DEU 26:11; PSA 53:6, PSA 105:43, PSA 145:7

Joy predicted in prophetic assurances of restoration and blessing

ISA 51:3 See also ISA 52:8–52:9, ISA 55:12, ISA 60:4–60:5, ISA 66:10–66:11; JER 30:18–30:19, JER 31:4, JER 31:7; JOL 2:21–2:23; ZEP 3:14; ZEC 9:9

Joy at times of national celebration

The anointing of kings

1KI 1:39–1:40 See also 1CH 29:21–29:22; 2CH 23:12–23:13

The consecration of the temple

1KI 8:64–8:66 parallel 2CH 7:1–7:10 See also 1CH 29:9, 1CH 29:17

Consecration of the temple in the reign of King Hezekiah

2CH 29:36

Deliverance of the Jews through Queen Esther

EST 8:15–8:17 See also EST 9:20–9:22

The rebuilding of the temple and Jerusalem

EZR 6:16 See also EZR 3:10–3:13, EZR 6:22; NEH 3:16–3:17, NEH 12:27

Other nations encouraged to share Israel's joy

PSA 47:1; ISA 24:14–24:16 See also DEU 32:43; PSA 66:1–66:2, PSA 67:4; ISA 42:10–42:11; JER 51:48

8289: joy, of the church

The church is to rejoice in the salvation brought about by Jesus Christ's faithful life and death, and by the power of his resurrection. Even in adversity, believers know the joy of Jesus Christ.

Joy at the coming of Jesus Christ

LUK 2:8–2:11 See also JHN 3:27–3:29, JHN 8:56

Joy as the hallmark of the kingdom of God

GAL 5:22 See also MAT 13:44; LUK 10:17–10:21, LUK 15:4–15:10 parallel MAT 18:12–18:14; JHN 4:34–4:36, JHN 16:20–16:24, JHN 17:13; ROM 12:12, ROM 14:17–14:18; 1TH 5:16–5:18

Jesus Christ promises joy to his disciples

JHN 15:9–15:11 See also MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23; JHN 16:20–16:24, JHN 17:13

Joy among believers

ACT 2:46–2:47 See also ACT 15:1–15:3; ROM 15:31–15:32; 2CO 2:3; PHP 2:17–2:18

Joy experienced in relationship with Jesus Christ

1PE 1:8–1:9 See also JHN 15:7–15:11; HEB 12:22–12:24; REV 19:7

Joy experienced through conversion

ACT 16:33–16:34 See also ACT 8:38–8:39; ROM 5:11

Joy experienced even in adversity

ACT 5:41; 1PE 4:12–4:13 See also MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23; 2CO 7:4, 2CO 8:1–8:2, 2CO 12:7–12:10, 2CO 13:9; PHP 2:17–2:18; COL 1:24; 1TH 1:6; HEB 10:34; JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 1:3–1:6

Joy experienced by the apostles**Joy because of the believers' faith and obedience**

ROM 16:19; 3JN 1:3–1:4 See also 2CO 7:4; PHP 1:23–1:26, PHP 4:1; COL 2:5; 1TH 2:19–2:20, 1TH 3:9

Joy because of the believers' love and concern

2CO 7:7 See also 2CO 7:12–7:13; PHP 2:1–2:2 the Philipians' love for one another; PHM 1:7

Joy because of the believers' partnership in the gospel

PHP 1:4–1:6

8291: kindness

The quality of compassion and generosity, characteristic of God's dealings towards the weak and poor, and demanded of believers. The kindness is also shown in the words and deeds of Jesus Christ.

The kindness of God**To all**

ACT 14:17 Paul to the pagans at Lystra. See also JER 9:24; LUK 6:35

To his people

ISA 63:7 See also EZR 9:9; ISA 54:8; HOS 11:4

To the king

2SA 22:51 See also 1KI 3:6

To individuals

GEN 19:19 Lot; ; GEN 24:27 Abraham; ; GEN 32:10 Jacob; ; GEN 39:21 Joseph; ; RUT 1:8 Ruth; ; RUT 2:20 Naomi; ; JOB 10:12 Job; ; 2SA 9:1–9:13 Mephibosheth through David

The kindness of Jesus Christ

MAT 9:36 See also MAT 14:14, MAT 20:34; MRK 8:2–8:3; LUK 7:13; ACT 20:35; HEB 4:15

Its demonstration in the gospel

TIT 3:4–3:5 See also ROM 11:22 God's grace extending to the Gentiles while the Jews are judged for their unbelief; EPH 2:7

Failure to acknowledge God's kindness is a sin

PSA 106:7 See also 2CH 32:24–32:25; ROM 2:4

Kindness encouraged in people**In the OT**

PRO 14:21; DAN 4:27 See also PRO 11:16–11:17, PRO 12:25, PRO 14:31, PRO 19:17, PRO 28:8

In the NT

EPH 4:32 See also 1CO 4:13, 1CO 13:4; 2CO 6:6; GAL 5:22–5:23 seen as the result of the Holy Spirit's work in the believer; COL 3:12; 1TH 5:15; 2TI 2:24 a necessary characteristic of a church leader; TIT 2:5; 2PE 1:7

Examples of human kindness**By unbelievers**

1SA 15:6 the Kenites to Israel; ; 2KI 25:28 the king of Babylon to Jehoiachin; ; ACT 27:3 the centurion Julius to Paul; ; ACT 28:2 the Maltese islanders to Paul and his companions

By God's people

GEN 21:23 Abraham to Abimelech; ; GEN 47:29 Joseph to Jacob; ; GEN 50:21 Joseph to his brothers when he might have been expected to settle old scores; ; JOS 2:12–2:14 the spies to Rahab; RUT 2:13, RUT 3:10; 1SA 20:8, 1SA 20:14; 2SA 2:5 The men of Gilead have their kindness rewarded; ; 1KI 2:7 Solomon to Barzillai; ; ACT 4:9 Peter to a beggar

When kindness fails**The failure to show kindness**

PSA 109:16 See also JDG 8:35 the Israelites to Gideon's family; 2CH 10:7–10:8 Rehoboam to the Israelites; JOB 24:21 evil men to needy women

Failure to respond to kindness

2SA 10:2–10:4

Failure to remember kindness

2CH 24:22

8292: love

A caring commitment, in which affection and delight are shown to others, which is grounded in the nature of God himself. In his words and actions, and

supremely in the death of Jesus Christ on the cross, God demonstrates the nature of love and defines the direction in which human love in all its forms should develop.

8293: love, of God

See [1085: God, love of](#)

8294: love, and Jesus Christ

See [2048: Jesus Christ, love of](#)

8295: love, and Holy Spirit

See [3209: Holy Spirit, and love](#)

8296: love, nature of

Scripture offers an understanding of the source, character and value of love, based on the nature and actions of God.

God is the source of love

His very character is love

1JN 4:7–4:8 See also 1TH 3:12; 2TI 1:7; 1JN 4:16, 1JN 4:19

The love of God is revealed in the cross of Jesus Christ

1JN 3:16, 1JN 4:10 See also JHN 15:13; EPH 5:2, EPH 5:25

Love is part of the Holy Spirit's fruit

GAL 5:22 See also ROM 5:5, ROM 15:30; COL 1:8

The loving-kindness of God referred to in the OT

JER 31:3 See also EXO 15:13, EXO 34:6; 2CH 6:42; PSA 6:4, PSA 32:10, PSA 51:1, PSA 107:43; ISA 54:10, ISA 63:7; LAM 3:22; HOS 2:19

The love of God in the NT

To describe God's love for humanity

JHN 3:16 See also JHN 5:42, JHN 15:10; ROM 8:39; 2CO 13:14; EPH 2:4; HEB 12:6; 1JN 3:1

To describe love for God

LUK 10:27; ; JHN 14:21, JHN 21:15; ; ROM 8:28; ; 1TH 1:3; ; JAS 1:12; ; 1PE 1:8; ; 1JN 5:3

To describe brotherly love

JHN 13:35; ; ROM 13:8; ; 1CO 16:24; ; 2CO 8:8; ; GAL 5:13; ; EPH 4:2; ; PHP 1:9; ; COL 2:2; ; PHM 1:5

To describe love expressed by eating together

2PE 2:13; ; JUD 1:12

To describe love in a negative sense

LUK 11:43; ; JHN 3:19, JHN 12:43; ; 2TI 4:10; ; 2PE 2:15; ; 1JN 2:15

Characteristics of love

1CO 13:4–13:8 See also ROM 12:9; 1TI 1:5; 1PE 1:22; 1JN 4:18

Love is shown by deeds

1JN 3:17–3:18 See also JHN 14:15, JHN 14:23; ROM 5:8, ROM 14:15; GAL 2:20; 1JN 4:9, 1JN 5:2–5:3; 2JN 1:6; 3JN 1:5–1:6

The pre-eminence of love

1CO 13:13 See also MAT 22:37–22:39 parallel MRK 12:29–12:31; ROM 13:9–13:10; 1CO 12:31–13:3; GAL 5:6; EPH 3:17–3:19; COL 3:14; 2PE 1:7; 1JN 2:10

8297: love, for God

Scripture teaches believers to love God and shows how such love should be expressed in worship and practical service.

Believers' response to God's love

1JN 4:19 See also DEU 7:7–7:8; PSA 116:1; JHN 15:16; EPH 2:4–2:5; 1JN 4:10

Love for God is commanded

MAT 22:37–22:38 parallel MRK 12:29–12:30 See also DEU 6:5, DEU 10:12, DEU 11:1; JOS 22:5, JOS 23:11; PSA 31:23

Loving God involves loving Jesus Christ

JHN 8:42 See also JHN 5:42, JHN 15:23

Expressing love for God

Delight in worship and in God's house

PSA 27:4 See also PSA 26:8, PSA 43:4, PSA 65:4, PSA 84:2, PSA 122:1, PSA 122:6; ACT 2:46–2:47

Love for God's word

PSA 119:97 See also PSA 1:2, PSA 19:7–19:8, PSA 19:10, PSA 119:16, PSA 119:35, PSA 119:72, PSA 119:163; JER 15:16; EZK 3:3

Self-sacrifice

LUK 14:33 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; ROM 12:1; PHP 3:8

Giving

1CH 29:3 See also EXO 25:2, EXO 35:5; 1CH 29:6, 1CH 29:9; 2CO 8:4–8:5, 2CO 8:8, 2CO 9:7

Obedying God

1JN 5:3 See also PSA 40:8; JHN 14:15, JHN 14:23, JHN 15:14; 2JN 1:6

Loving others

1JN 4:21 See also JHN 13:35, JHN 15:12; 1JN 4:11

The blessings of loving God

JHN 14:15–14:16 See also JHN 14:23, JHN 16:27; 1PE 1:8

Examples of love for God and Jesus Christ

PSA 18:1 See also PSA 73:25; MAT 26:7 parallel MRK 14:3; JHN 12:3; LUK 2:37, LUK 7:47, LUK 24:53; JHN 11:16, JHN 21:16; ACT 21:13; HEB 6:10

8298: love, for one another

Scripture instructs God's people to love one another and illustrates what this means in practice.

Reasons for loving one another

God commands it

GAL 5:14 See also LEV 19:18; LEV 19:34; DEU 10:19; MAT 22:39 parallel MRK 12:31 the second greatest commandment; JHN 15:12 Jesus Christ commands his disciples to love one another; ROM 13:10; 1TH 4:9; HEB 13:1; JAS 2:8; 1PE 1:22, 1PE 2:17; 1JN 3:23, 1JN 4:21; 2JN 1:5

God has taken the initiative in showing love

1JN 4:11 See also MAL 2:10; 1CO 8:11–8:13; 1JN 3:16

God's people are known by their love

JHN 13:35 See also 1JN 2:10, 1JN 3:14, 1JN 4:7, 1JN 4:16, 1JN 4:20

Love maintains fellowship

1PE 4:8 See also PRO 10:12, PRO 17:9; EPH 4:2

Love promotes sacrificial service

1TH 2:8 See also PRO 17:17; 2CO 12:15; GAL 5:13; PHP 2:30, PHP 4:10; 1TH 1:3

Expressing love for one another

In caring for the sick

MAT 25:36 See also JOB 2:11; GAL 4:14

In meeting material needs

MAT 25:35 See also DEU 15:7–15:8; 1JN 3:17

In affectionate greetings

2CO 13:12 See also GEN 33:4, GEN 45:14–45:15; ACT 20:37; ROM 16:16; 1CO 16:20; 1PE 5:14

Examples of the demonstration of love for one another

GEN 14:14–14:16 Abraham for Lot; ; EXO 32:31–32:32 Moses for Israel; ; 1SA 18:3 Jonathan; ; LUK 7:2–7:6 the Roman centurion for his servant; ; LUK 10:29–10:37 the good Samaritan; ; ACT 4:32, ACT 16:33 the Philippian jailer; ; ACT 20:38; ; ROM 16:4; ; 2CO 2:4; ; EPH 1:15; ; PHP 1:8, PHP 4:1; ; 2TI 1:16–1:17 Onesiphorus; ; PHM 1:12; ; 3JN 1:6

Paul's love for his churches

Corinth: 2CO 1:3–1:6, 2CO 2:4; GAL 4:19 Galatia; PHP 1:3, PHP 1:7, PHP 4:1; 1TH 2:7–2:8, 1TH 3:7–3:10, 1TH 3:12

8299: love, in relationships

Human love is ennobled by being patterned on God's love for his people. It is also safeguarded by God's commands.

The love between husband and wife

Conjugal love is commanded

COL 3:18–3:19 See also GEN 2:24; DEU 24:5; PRO 5:18–5:20; ECC 9:9; EPH 5:22, EPH 5:28, EPH 5:33; 1PE 3:7

It is patterned on God's love for his people

ISA 54:5; EPH 5:25–5:27 See also ISA 62:5; JER 3:14; EZK 16:8; HOS 2:19; 2CO 11:2; REV 19:7

The power of human love

SNG 8:6–8:7 See also GEN 29:20, GEN 29:30; PRO 6:34–6:35

Examples of love in courtship and marriage

GEN 24:67 Isaac and Rebekah; ; GEN 29:18 Jacob and Rachel; ; JDG 16:4 Samson and Delilah; ; 1SA 1:5 Elkanah and Hannah; ; EST 2:17 Xerxes and Esther; ; SNG 1:2, SNG 4:10; ; HOS 3:1; ; MAT 1:19 Joseph and Mary

Safeguards on human love

Sexual immorality is condemned

1CO 7:2 See also LEV 18:22 homosexual acts forbidden; LEV 19:29 prostitution forbidden; DEU 23:17–23:18; MAT 5:32; ACT 15:29; ROM 1:26–1:27; 1CO 5:1, 1CO 6:18, 1CO 10:8; EPH 5:3; COL 3:5; 1TH 4:3

Adultery is condemned

EXO 20:14 See also LEV 20:10; DEU 5:18; PRO 6:24; 1CO 6:9; HEB 13:4

Restrictions on divorce

MAT 19:9 See also MAL 2:16; MAT 5:32; MRK 10:11–10:12; LUK 16:18; 1CO 7:10–7:11

Lust is condemned

MAT 5:28 See also JOB 31:1; PRO 6:25; 1CO 7:9; EPH 4:19; 1TH 4:5

Polygamy is forbidden

1TI 3:2 See also DEU 17:17; MAL 2:15; 1TI 3:12; TIT 1:6

8300: love, and the world

Scripture promotes the love of family, home and country and contains many examples of such love.

Parental love

Aspects of parental love

PRO 13:24; EPH 6:4 See also DEU 6:7; 2CO 12:14; COL 3:21; 1TI 3:4; 2TI 3:15

Examples of maternal love

GEN 21:16 Hagar; ; EXO 2:3 Moses' mother; ; JDG 5:28; ; 1SA 2:19 Hannah; ; 2SA 21:10; ; 1KI 3:26, 1KI 17:18; 2KI 4:20, 2KI 4:27; MAT 15:22 parallel MRK 7:26; ; LUK 2:48, LUK 7:12–7:13 the widow of Nain; ; JHN 19:25

Examples of paternal love

GEN 22:2 Abraham; ; GEN 31:28, GEN 37:35, GEN 42:38; 2SA 12:16, 2SA 13:39; MRK 5:23 parallel LUK 8:41–8:42 Jairus

Love for parents

EXO 20:12; 1TI 5:4 See also GEN 46:29 Joseph; LEV 19:3; JDG 11:36; 1SA 22:3 David; 1KI 19:20 Elisha; JER 35:8; MAT 15:4 parallel MRK 7:10; LUK 2:51; JHN 19:26–19:27; EPH 6:1; COL 3:20

Other instances of family love

GEN 34:7, GEN 45:14–45:15 Joseph and his brothers; ; RUT 1:16–1:17; ; 2SA 13:22; EST 2:7, EST 2:11

Love of home and country**Examples of love of home**

GEN 31:30, GEN 49:29, GEN 50:25; ; NUM 10:30; ; RUT 1:6; ; 2SA 10:12, 2SA 19:37, 2SA 23:15; ; NEH 4:14

Exhortations to patriotism

PSA 122:6, PSA 137:5–137:6 See also 2SA 1:20; EST 4:8; JER 51:50

Examples of patriotism

1SA 17:26, 1SA 27:8–27:10; ; NEH 1:3–1:4, NEH 2:5; ; EST 8:6; ; PSA 137:1; ; JER 51:51; ; ROM 9:3

8301: love, and enemies

God loves even those who oppose him and believers must follow his example in loving their enemies.

God's love for sinners

ISA 53:6; JHN 3:16; 2PE 3:9 See also GEN 18:32; LAM 3:33; EZK 18:23; MAT 5:45; ROM 5:8, ROM 8:32; 2CO 5:19; 1JN 4:9–4:10

The example of Jesus Christ

MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34 **1PE 3:18** See also ISA 53:5; MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45; LUK 23:34; ROM 5:6; 2CO 5:14, 2CO 8:9; HEB 13:12; 1PE 2:21, 1PE 2:24; 1JN 2:2

God's people must love their enemies

LEV 19:18; LUK 6:35–6:36 See also EXO 23:4; PRO 24:17, PRO 25:21; MAT 5:44; LUK 6:27; COL 3:13; 1TH 5:15; 2TI 2:25; 1PE 3:9

Examples of love for enemies

GEN 50:20–50:21 Joseph; ; NUM 12:13; ; 1SA 24:17, 1SA 26:21; ; 2SA 19:23; ; 2KI 6:22 the king of Israel; ; ACT 7:60 Stephen; ; ACT 9:17 Ananias; ; 1CO 4:12

8302: love, abuse of

Scripture warns that love can be misdirected and shows a number of examples.

Exaggerated love of self**Self-interest is condemned**

PHP 2:3–2:4 See also MAT 16:25 parallels MRK 8:35, LUK 9:24; ROM 14:15, ROM 15:1; 1CO 8:9, 1CO 10:24; GAL 5:26; JAS 3:14–3:15

Examples of self-love

EST 6:6 Haman; ; ISA 5:8; ; DAN 4:30 Nebuchadnezzar; ; 2TI 3:2; ; JAS 5:5

Love of prestige**Pride in one's position or reputation is condemned**

PRO 25:27; 1CO 13:4 See also PRO 21:4, PRO 25:6–25:7; MAT 23:12 parallel LUK 14:11; ROM 12:10; JAS 3:1

Examples of the love of prestige

2SA 15:1 Absalom; ; 1KI 1:5 Adonijah; ; ISA 14:13 the king of Babylon; ; JER 46:5; ; EZK 28:2; ; MAT 20:21, MAT 23:6–23:7 parallel LUK 20:46; ; LUK 14:7, LUK 22:24; ; JHN 12:43 the man of lawlessness; ; 2TH 2:4; ; 3JN 1:9

Love of the world**Love of the world is condemned**

1JN 2:15 See also EXO 23:2; MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:36–8:37, LUK 9:25; ROM 12:2; COL 3:2; 2TI 2:4; TIT 2:12; JAS 4:4

Examples of the love of the world

MAT 24:38; ; LUK 14:18 those invited to the great banquet; ; 2TI 4:10 Demas

Love of money**Love of money is condemned**

1TI 6:9–6:10 See also PSA 62:10; PRO 28:20; ECC 5:10; LUK 12:15

Examples of the love of riches

JOS 7:21 Achan; ; 2KI 5:20 Gehazi; ; MIC 3:11; ; MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23 the rich young man; ; MAT 26:15 Judas Iscariot; ; LUK 16:14; ; JHN 12:6; ; ACT 16:19, ACT 24:26 Felix; ; 2PE 2:15

Love of sin

The love of sin is condemned

2TH 2:12 See also JOB 15:16; PRO 2:14, PRO 17:19; ROM 1:32; 2PE 2:10

Examples of the love of sinning

1KI 21:25 Ahab and Jezebel; ; JER 14:10; ; MIC 3:2; ; 2PE 2:13–2:14

Love of other gods

Idolatry is condemned

DEU 6:13–6:14 See also EXO 20:3; LEV 26:1; DEU 12:30; ACT 17:29; 1JN 5:21

Examples of the love of idols

EXO 32:4 the golden calf; ; JDG 2:11–2:12; ; 2KI 17:15; ; DAN 5:4 Belshazzar; ; ACT 17:16 the city of Athens; ; ROM 1:23

8304: loyalty

A commitment to an ongoing relationship and to the attitude and behaviour demanded by it. It is evident in human relationships and also in the covenant relationship between God and his people.

God's loyalty to his people

God's covenant loyalty

DEU 7:9 See also 1KI 8:23 parallel 2CH 6:14; NEH 1:5; PSA 25:10, PSA 89:28, PSA 103:17–103:18, PSA 106:45; ISA 54:10, ISA 55:3

God's faithfulness to his promises

HEB 10:23 See also 1KI 8:56; PSA 91:14–91:16; 1CO 1:9

Loyalty to God

The loyalty of God's people

1CH 29:18; JER 2:2 See also 1KI 8:61; 2CH 32:32, 2CH 35:26, 2CH 17:6

Examples of those loyal to God

NUM 12:7 Moses; ; NUM 14:24 Caleb; ; JOS 24:14–24:15 Joshua and his family; ; JOB 23:11 Job; ; ISA 38:3 Hezekiah; ; ACT 4:19 Peter and John; ; ACT 20:24 Paul

Failure to show loyalty to God

HOS 6:4 See also PSA 78:8, PSA 78:37

Divided loyalties

2KI 17:33 See also MAT 6:24; LUK 16:13; 1CO 10:21; JAS 1:8

Loyalty in human relationships

Loyalty and covenant

ISA 20:8

The loyalty of friends

ISA 20:42; PRO 17:17 See also 2SA 16:17; PRO 27:10

Loyalty within the family

RUT 1:16–1:17 See also GEN 20:13, GEN 38:8, GEN 47:29; DEU 25:5; RUT 3:9; 1CO 7:3

Loyalty to those in authority

ROM 13:1 See also EZR 7:26; ECC 8:2; MAT 17:27, MAT 22:21; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Examples of loyalty to rulers

2SA 15:21 See also 1SA 22:14 David's loyalty to Saul; 2SA 3:8 Abner's loyalty to Saul's family; 1KI 12:20 the loyalty of Judah to David's house; 1CH 12:33 the men of Zebulun's loyalty to David

The loyalty of believers

ROM 12:10; PHP 4:3 See also 1CO 4:17 Timothy; 1CO 16:15–16:16 the household of Stephanas; COL 1:7 Epaphras; COL 4:7 Tychicus; COL 4:9 Onesimus

8305: meekness

An attitude of humble, submissive and expectant trust in God, and a loving, patient and gentle attitude towards others.

Meekness required by God

ZEP 2:3 See also PRO 16:19; 1PE 3:4

God's promises to the meek

PSA 37:11; MAT 5:5; 1PE 5:5 See also PSA 25:9, PSA 69:32 In Scripture, "the poor" frequently represent the humble, godly poor; PSA 147:6; ISA 29:19, ISA 66:2; ZEP 3:11–3:12; JAS 4:6

God acts to save the meek

PSA 34:5–34:6 See also 2SA 22:28; PSA 10:12, PSA 10:17, PSA 18:27, PSA 45:4, PSA 76:9, PSA 149:4; PRO 3:34

Meekness is a correct attitude in prayer

PSA 40:17 See also PSA 70:5

Godly wisdom produces meekness

JAS 3:13

Examples of meekness

Moses

NUM 12:3

David

See also 2SA 16:11–16:12

Ahab

1KI 21:27

Job

JOB 1:21

Jeremiah**JER 11:19** See also JER 26:14**Mary, the mother of Jesus Christ**

LUK 1:38

Stephen

ACT 7:60

Paul

2TI 4:16

Meekness in the life of Jesus Christ**MAT 11:29; 2CO 10:1** See also ISA 53:7; MAT 21:5; MRK 14:61; LUK 23:34; 1PE 2:23**Meekness is expected in the life of the Christian****A necessary characteristic****EPH 4:2** See also GAL 5:23; PHP 2:3, PHP 4:5; COL 3:12; TIT 3:2; 1PE 3:8**Towards enemies**

MAT 5:39–5:41; ; ROM 12:17–12:20

In leadership

1TI 6:11

In witness

1PE 3:15

In discipline**GAL 6:1** See also 1CO 4:21; 2TI 2:25; HEB 5:2**In the family**

EPH 5:22, EPH 5:24, EPH 6:1; ; COL 3:18–3:20

In society

ROM 13:1–13:2, ROM 13:5; ; 1TI 2:2

8306: mercifulness

An attitude of compassion and care, grounded in the nature of God himself, made manifest in the life and ministry of Jesus Christ, and expected of believers.

The mercifulness of God**DEU 4:31; PSA 78:38; JER 3:12** See also DEU 7:7–7:8; NEH 9:31; ZEC 1:16; LUK 1:50–1:54; JAS 5:11**The expression of God's mercifulness****In the forgiveness of sins****PSA 78:38** See also 2SA 24:14; 1KI 8:50; PSA 26:11, PSA 51:1; DAN 9:9**In response to prayer****PSA 6:2, PSA 27:7** See also 1KI 8:28; PSA 9:13**The mercifulness of Jesus Christ****MAT 9:36; HEB 2:17** See also MAT 8:16; HEB 4:16**The mercifulness expected of believers****LUK 6:36** See also MIC 6:8; ZEC 7:9; MAT 9:13, MAT 18:21–18:35 the parable of the unmerciful servant; MAT 23:23; LUK 10:29–10:37 the parable of the good Samaritan; ROM 12:8; EPH 4:32–5:2; JAS 2:12–2:13, JAS 3:17; JUD 1:22–1:23**The blessing promised to the merciful****MAT 5:7** Jesus Christ to his disciples.**8307: moderation**

The classic virtue of temperate conduct, especially the avoidance of extremes. Scripture commends moderation as a way of life for Christians, while stressing the need for total commitment to God.

The ideal of moderation**ECC 7:16–7:18****Moderation in a legal context****EXO 21:23–21:25** The purpose of this legislation was not to encourage vengeance but to moderate or restrain it. See also LEV 24:17–24:22; NUM 35:9–35:15 parallels DEU 4:41–4:43, DEU 19:1–19:10 One purpose of cities of refuge was to moderate the revenge of families of the murdered.**Moderation in personal and social relations****PRO 17:27** See also GEN 43:29–43:31; PRO 12:16, PRO 23:4; GAL 5:22–5:23**Moderation in personal ethics****TIT 2:11–2:12** See also PRO 15:16 Moderation in matters of wealth is affirmed. **MAT 5:33–5:37; COL 4:6 EPH 5:18; 1TH 5:6–5:8; 1TI 3:2–3:3, 1TI 3:8, 1TI 3:11; TIT 1:7–1:8, TIT 2:2–2:8****Moderation in religious activity****ECC 7:16–7:17** See also MAT 23:23–23:26; 1CO 14:26–14:33**Moderation must not lead to being spiritually lukewarm****REV 3:15–3:16** See also REV 3:1–3:2**8308: modesty**

An attitude of humility, avoiding improper self-exaltation or excessive flamboyance. Scripture urges modesty in personal behaviour, forms of dress and forms of behaviour.

Modesty as an attitude of humility**ROM 12:3** See also PRO 25:6–25:7, PRO 29:23; LUK 22:25–22:27 parallels MAT 20:25–20:28, MRK 10:42–10:45; ROM

11:20–11:21; 2CO 10:13–10:16, 2CO 12:5–12:6; PHP 2:5–2:8; 1PE 5:5

Believers should dress modestly

1TI 2:9–2:10 See also ISA 3:16–3:24; 1PE 3:3

Examples of those who acted with modesty

GEN 32:9–32:10 Jacob; ; GEN 41:15–41:16 Joseph; ; JDG 6:15 Gideon; ; 1SA 9:19–9:21 Saul; ; 2SA 7:18 David; ; JER 1:6 Jeremiah; ; DAN 2:27–2:30 Daniel; ; MAT 8:5–8:9 parallel LUK 7:6–7:8 a centurion

8309: morality

Conformity to the standards of right living, especially in the sight of God. Scripture stresses that morality is grounded in the nature of God himself, and provides practical guidance concerning moral living and decision-making.

8310: morality, and creation

Human beings have been created moral creatures in the likeness of God, who is the source and standard of all that is good.

Morality is grounded in the nature of God himself

DEU 32:4; LUK 18:18–18:19 See also EXO 33:19, EXO 34:5–34:7; PSA 25:8–25:9, PSA 119:68

Human beings are morally aware

They are created in God's image

GEN 1:26–1:27

They have a conscience

ROM 2:14–2:15 See also 2CO 4:2

They have been given a moral law

GEN 2:16–2:17; ; MRK 10:6–10:9; ; GEN 2:23–2:24 Standards for marriage are implicit in the creation.

They are capable of sharing moral ideals

JHN 1:9; ; ROM 13:1–13:7; ; EPH 3:15 “whole family” is literally “all fatherhood”, implying that every understanding of fatherhood and family is derived from God; ; PHP 4:8 referring to pagan virtues; ; TIT 3:1; ; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Immoral acts are unnatural

ROM 1:26–1:27

God's judgment implies moral responsibility

JER 17:10; ; EZK 18:20–18:21; ; AMO 1:6; ; ROM 2:5–2:11

Human beings are morally flawed

ROM 3:23 See also PSA 64:6; ISA 32:6; JER 17:9; ROM 1:28–1:32, ROM 8:7; 1TI 4:2

8311: morality, and redemption

The morality which is appropriate for God's own people is expressed in the OT law, and in the person and teaching of Jesus Christ.

Relationship with God is expressed in moral terms

In the moral standards God expects of his people

LEV 11:44–11:45; MAT 5:48 See also MAT 5:43–5:44 parallel LUK 6:27–6:28; LUK 6:35–6:36; EPH 4:31–5:3; 1PE 1:15–1:16; 3JN 1:11

In God's moral laws

ISA 51:4; ROM 7:12 See also EXO 20:1–20:7; DEU 6:25; PSA 119:137–119:138, PSA 147:19–147:20; PRO 29:18; ISA 51:7

In God's denunciation of immorality and religious hypocrisy

AMO 2:6–2:7 See also ISA 1:15–1:23; AMO 5:21–5:24; MIC 6:8; EPH 5:5; COL 3:5–3:7

In the life and teaching of Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14 See also MAT 5:17–5:20; JHN 1:17–1:18, JHN 3:19; HEB 4:15

The incentive for moral change lies in what God has done in redemption

In the OT

DEU 24:17–24:18 See also LEV 19:13–19:18, LEV 19:35–19:36; DEU 15:12–15:15, DEU 24:21–24:22

In the NT

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also ROM 12:1–12:2

Moral change brought about by God's work of renewal

EZK 36:26–36:27; 1CO 6:9–6:11 See also ROM 8:3–8:4, ROM 8:11–8:14; GAL 5:19–5:24; EPH 4:22–4:24; PHP 2:12–2:13; COL 3:8–3:12; HEB 8:10; JER 31:33

8313: nurture

The activity of caring for others and nourishing them in the life of faith. This is necessary not only for children in the home but also for new or weak believers in the church.

The nurture of children in the home

By parental instruction and example

DEU 4:9–4:10 See also DEU 6:4–6:9, DEU 11:18–11:21; PRO 22:6; EPH 6:4; COL 3:21; 2TI 1:5, 2TI 3:15

Examples of parental care

PRO 1:8–1:10 See also PRO 2:1–2:5, PRO 3:1–3:2, PRO 4:1–4:4, PRO 5:1–5:2, PRO 6:1–6:3, PRO 6:20–6:24

The nurture of young believers in the church

By the caring attitude of leaders

1TH 2:7–2:12 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; ACT 20:18–20:20; 1CO 4:14–4:15; 1TH 3:10; TIT 1:9; 1PE 5:1–5:3

By the leader's pattern of life

TIT 2:6–2:7 See also ACT 20:33–20:35; 1CO 4:16–4:17, 1CO 11:1; PHP 4:9; 1TH 1:5–1:6

By the caring attitude of fellow believers

1TH 5:14–5:15 See also ROM 14:1; 1CO 8:9–8:13; GAL 6:1–6:2; 1TH 5:11; TIT 2:3–2:5

By appropriate teaching

1PE 2:2 See also 1CO 3:2, 1CO 14:20; HEB 5:11–5:14

By encouraging spiritual growth

2PE 3:18 See also 2CO 3:18; EPH 4:15; 2TH 1:3

8314: orthodoxy

The holding of religious beliefs that are in harmony with the accepted views of the community of faith. Right belief (orthodoxy) is to show itself in right practice (orthopraxis).

8315: orthodoxy, in OT

The acceptance of God's revelation of himself to his people that should lead to worship and obedience.

Foundational truths about Israel's God

God is one

DEU 6:4

God is unique

DEU 4:39 See also DEU 4:35; PSA 97:9; ISA 44:6–44:8

God is self-existent

EXO 3:14

God is the Creator

ISA 40:28 See also GEN 1:1, GEN 2:7; JOB 38:4

God will not tolerate rivals

EXO 20:3–20:6 parallel **DEU 5:7–5:8**; ; **DEU 8:19–8:20**, **DEU 13:6–13:8**; ; **ISA 42:8**

God commands universal worship

PSA 86:9–86:10 See also **ISA 19:21**; **ZEC 8:20–8:22**

Right belief is passed on through the community of faith

PSA 145:4 See also **EXO 12:24–12:27**; **DEU 6:6–6:8**, **DEU 6:20–6:25**; **JOS 4:20–4:24**; **PSA 78:2–78:6**

Right belief demands right practice

Reverent fear

DEU 10:12–10:13

Worship

See also **DEU 12:4–12:7**; **2KI 17:35–17:39**; **1CH 16:28–16:29** parallel **PSA 96:7–96:9**; **PSA 95:6–95:7**

Observance of festivals

DEU 16:1–16:2, **DEU 16:9–16:17**

Offering acceptable sacrifices

LEV 1:2–1:4, **LEV 5:5–5:6**; ; **MAL 1:7–1:8**

Faithfulness to the covenant

DEU 29:9–29:15; ; **PSA 25:10**

Devotion to God

DEU 6:5 See also **DEU 11:1**; **1CH 22:19**; **PSA 31:23**; **HOS 6:6**

Trust in God's faithfulness

PSA 4:5, **PSA 33:4** See also **PSA 37:3–37:5**, **PSA 115:9–115:11**, **PSA 119:89–119:93**

Obedience

DEU 5:32 See also **DEU 6:1–6:3**, **DEU 26:16–26:19**; **ISA 15:22**; **ISA 30:21**; **JER 7:21–7:23**

Justice in society

MIC 6:8 See also **PSA 106:3**; **PRO 21:3**; **ISA 1:11–1:17**, **ISA 56:1**

Walking in God's ways

God's ways are right

HOS 14:9 See also **PRO 10:29**

Walking in God's ways brings his blessing

GEN 18:19; ; **DEU 5:33**, **DEU 28:9**, **DEU 30:19–30:20**

Examples of kings who walked in God's ways

2SA 22:22 parallel **PSA 18:21** David; ; **2CH 14:2–14:4** parallel **1KI 15:11–15:12** Asa; ; **2CH 17:3–17:6** Jehoshaphat; ; **2CH 26:4** parallel **2KI 15:3** Uzziah (and Amaziah); ; **2CH 29:2** parallel **2KI 18:3** Hezekiah; ; **2CH 34:2** parallel **2KI 22:2** Josiah

8316: orthodoxy, in NT

Acceptance of the truth, especially about Jesus Christ, that is revealed by the Holy Spirit in the gospel and is passed on through the teaching of sound doctrine.

Orthodoxy is based on Jesus Christ who is the truth

EPH 4:21 See also **JHN 1:14**, **JHN 14:6**

Orthodoxy is revealed in the gospel

GAL 1:11–1:12; **2TI 1:13–1:14** See also **2CO 11:3–11:4**; **GAL 1:6–1:9**, **GAL 2:5**, **GAL 2:14**; **COL 1:5–1:6**; **1TI 1:9–1:11**

Orthodoxy is expressed in simple summaries of faith

1TI 3:16 See also ROM 1:3–1:4; 1CO 15:3–15:5; PHP 2:5–2:11

Orthodoxy is maintained through God's true ministers

1TI 2:7 See also 1TI 4:6; 2TI 2:2, 2TI 2:15

Orthodoxy must be defended against error

TIT 1:9 See also 1TI 6:20–6:21

Orthodoxy is shown by the attitude to the incarnation

1JN 4:2–4:3 See also 1JN 4:15, 1JN 5:1, 1JN 5:10

Orthodoxy is revealed by the Holy Spirit

JHN 16:13 See also JHN 14:17, JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26; 1JN 2:27

Orthodoxy is demonstrated in believers' behaviour

Walking as children of light

JHN 3:19–3:21; ; EPH 5:8; ; 1JN 1:7

Following Jesus Christ's example

JHN 13:15; ; 1CO 11:1; ; 1PE 2:21; ; 1JN 2:6

Loving and obeying Jesus Christ

JHN 14:15, JHN 14:21, JHN 14:23, JHN 15:10; ; 1JN 2:3–2:5

Right belief requires right action

JAS 2:19 See also JAS 2:14–2:18, JAS 2:20–2:26

Signs of a fall from orthodoxy

False prophecy

1JN 4:1 See also MAT 7:22–7:23; MRK 13:21–13:22 parallel MAT 24:11

Empty religion

MAT 15:9 parallel MRK 7:7 See also ISA 29:13; MRK 7:8–7:9 parallel MAT 15:3

False teaching

1TI 4:1–4:2; 2TI 4:3–4:4 See also 1TI 1:6–1:7, 1TI 6:3–6:5; TIT 1:10–1:14; 2PE 2:1–2:2

Examples of false teachings contrary to orthodoxy

Christians are obliged to obey the entire OT law

GAL 5:1–5:12

Justification comes only through the OT law

GAL 2:15–2:21

The resurrection has already taken place

2TI 2:16–2:18

Christians do not sin

1JN 1:8–1:10

8318: patience

The quality of forbearance and self-control which shows itself particularly in a willingness to wait upon God and his will. Believers are called upon to be patient in their expectations of God's actions, and in their relationships with one another.

God's patience

EXO 34:6–34:7; ROM 2:4 See also NEH 9:30; ISA 48:9, ISA 65:2; JOL 2:13; JON 4:2; NAM 1:3; ACT 17:30; ROM 3:25, ROM 9:22; 1PE 3:20; 2PE 3:9

The patience of Jesus Christ

1TI 1:16 See also MAT 17:17 parallels MRK 9:19, LUK 9:41; JHN 14:9; 2PE 3:15; REV 2:21

Other examples of patience

2TH 1:4 the Thessalonian believers; ; HEB 6:15; ; JAS 5:11 Job; REV 1:9, REV 2:2

Patience is part of the fruit of the Spirit

GAL 5:22 See also COL 1:10–1:11

God's people should exercise patience

PRO 19:11; COL 3:12 See also PRO 14:29, PRO 16:32, PRO 25:15; MAT 6:14–6:15, MAT 18:35

People who need particular patience

Christian leaders

2TI 4:2 See also 2TI 3:10

Christian masters

EPH 6:9

Patience is necessary in church life

EPH 4:2 See also ROM 15:1; COL 3:13; 1TH 5:14

God's word is to be received with patience

HEB 13:22 See also PRO 2:1–2:5; 2TI 4:3

Patience is a characteristic of love

1CO 13:4

Patience is an aspect of faith and hope

PSA 33:20; JAS 5:7–5:8 PSA 5:2, PSA 27:14, PSA 37:7, PSA 37:34, PSA 38:15; PSA 119:166, PSA 130:5–130:6; ; PRO 20:22; ; ISA 8:17, ISA 30:18; ; LAM 3:24, LAM 3:26; ; MIC 7:7; ; ZEP 3:8; ; ACT 1:4 Jesus Christ's instructions to the apostles to wait for the Holy Spirit; ; ROM 8:25, ROM 12:12; ; TIT 2:13; ; HEB 6:12, HEB 6:15 the example of Abraham; ; JAS 5:10; ; REV 6:11

8319: perception, spiritual

The ability to see beneath the outward form to the underlying, often hidden, reality. It is a necessary gift in dealing with people, understanding spiritual teaching and interpreting events. Perception is important for effective service, though is often lacking, even among God's people.

Perception in dealing with people

God's knowledge of human hearts

PSA 139:1–139:4 See also PSA 17:3, PSA 44:21; PRO 24:12

Jesus Christ's perception of those around him

JHN 2:24–2:25 See also ISA 11:1–11:4; MAT 9:3–9:4 parallels MRK 2:7–2:8, LUK 5:21–5:22; JHN 4:16–4:19; REV 2:23

True understanding by God's servants

NEH 6:1–6:2; ; JOB 21:27; ; ACT 5:1–5:3

Perception of spiritual truth

Recognising God's ultimate authority

REV 4:1–4:2 See also 2KI 6:15–6:17; DAN 7:8–7:14

Understanding Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 13:10–13:11 parallels MRK 4:10–4:11, LUK 8:9–8:10 See also MAT 13:16–13:23 parallels MRK 4:13–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15 The parable of the sower is about the way Jesus Christ's teaching in parables is received.

Understanding who Jesus Christ is

MAT 16:15–16:17 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20 See also ACT 8:30–8:35; ISA 53:7–53:8

Understanding about Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

LUK 24:45–24:46 See also LUK 24:30–24:35; JHN 12:16

Perception to interpret events

2SA 5:11–5:12 The building of a palace in the newly captured Jerusalem confirms to David his election by God; **ISA 43:9–43:12** Through his miraculous direction of his people's history, God is perceived as the one, true God. See also ISA 41:18–41:20, ISA 64:4; JON 1:12 Jonah recognises God's hand in the storm; ACT 10:34–10:35 Through the circumstances of his guidance, Peter realises that God's salvation is for Gentiles too.

Perception leading to effective service

1KI 3:9 parallel 2CH 1:10 See also 1SA 16:7–16:13 Samuel perceives that David is to be king; 2KI 4:8–4:10 A Shunammite's perception of Elisha leads her to extend hospitality to him; HEB 11:27 Moses' perception of the invisible God

Lack of perception

By those in the OT

ISA 43:19 See also EXO 5:2 Pharaoh; NUM 22:31–22:34 Balaam; DEU 32:28–32:29 Israel in the wilderness; ISA 29:10–29:12 the people of Jerusalem; ISA 42:20 Israel

By some Jews in the NT

MAT 13:13–13:15 parallels MRK 4:12, LUK 8:10; ; ISA 6:9–6:10; ; LUK 12:56; ; JHN 3:3–3:4; ; ACT 28:26

By Jesus Christ's disciples

MAT 15:16 parallel MRK 7:18 not understanding what makes a person unclean; ; MAT 16:9 parallel MRK 8:17–8:18 not understanding about the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees; ; MAT 16:22 parallel MRK 8:32 Peter cannot accept that Jesus Christ must be crucified; ; JHN 14:9 Philip does not understand that Jesus Christ reveals the Father; ; JHN 20:9 not understanding about the resurrection; JHN 20:14, JHN 21:4

8320: perfection

The state of completion and total self-sufficiency, characterised by an absence of any flaw or fault. This perfection is found in God himself and is the ultimate goal of the Christian life.

8321: perfection, divine

The state of being whole, complete or without defect in any way.

Only God is absolutely perfect

In his nature and character

DEU 32:4 See also ECC 3:14; MAT 5:48; ROM 11:33–11:36

In his word

PSA 12:6 See also PSA 19:7; PRO 8:8–8:9, PRO 30:5; 2TI 3:16–3:17; JAS 1:25

In his morality

HAB 1:13 See also 2SA 22:26–22:27; JOB 4:17; 1JN 3:3

In his will and providence

2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30 See also ROM 12:2; JAS 1:17

In his knowledge

JOB 37:16 See also PSA 139:4; ISA 40:13–40:14; HEB 4:13

In his faithfulness

ISA 25:1

God's perfect creation

In its original condition

GEN 2:1–2:2 See also GEN 1:10, GEN 1:12, GEN 1:18, GEN 1:21, GEN 1:25, GEN 1:31; ISA 40:25–40:26; HEB 4:3

The coming new creation**1CO 13:10** See also 2PE 3:13; REV 21:1–21:5, REV 22:1–22:5**God's perfect self-revelation in Jesus Christ****JHN 14:9** See also JHN 1:14; 2CO 4:4; COL 1:15; HEB 1:3**The moral perfection of Jesus Christ as God's Son****1PE 2:22** See also ISA 53:9; 2CO 5:21; HEB 2:10, HEB 4:15, HEB 5:9, HEB 7:26; 1JN 3:5**The perfect sacrifice of Jesus Christ****HEB 9:14** LEV 22:21; ; NUM 19:2; 1PE 1:19**8322: perfection, human**

Human wholeness in the image of God, given at creation and lost in the fall, is to be fully restored in Jesus Christ.

Humanity was created perfect**GEN 1:26–1:27** See also GEN 5:1; EZK 28:12–28:15 The king of Tyre is described in terms of the creation and fall of humanity; JAS 3:9**Perfection was lost through sin****ROM 3:23** See also GEN 2:17, GEN 3:16–3:19, GEN 3:23; JOB 15:14–15:16; EZK 28:15–28:17; ROM 1:21**The need for moral perfection****DEU 18:13** See also GEN 17:1; JOB 25:4; PSA 24:3–24:4**Human inability to keep God's law perfectly****HEB 7:19** See also HEB 7:11, HEB 10:1**Perfection and redemption****God's purpose for believers****COL 1:22** See also DAN 11:35, DAN 12:10; EPH 5:27 God's purpose for the church; HEB 10:14, HEB 11:40, HEB 12:23; JAS 1:4; JUD 1:24**The aim of Christian ministry****COL 1:28** See also 2CO 11:2**The aim of the Christian****PHP 3:12** See also 2CO 13:9–13:11; EPH 4:13; HEB 6:1; JAS 1:4**Characteristics of perfection****Perfect love****MAT 5:48** Jesus Christ patterning his disciples' love on the love God has for all people. See also 1JN 4:12, 1JN 4:18**Perfect holiness****2CO 7:1** See also PHP 1:10, PHP 2:15; JAS 1:27; 2PE 3:14**Perfect obedience****1TI 6:14; ; 1JN 2:5****Perfect speech****JAS 3:2****Perfect unity with other believers****JHN 17:23** See also 1CO 1:10; COL 3:14**Perfect joy****JHN 15:11** See also JHN 3:29, JHN 16:24; 1JN 1:4; 2JN 1:12**Perfect peace****ISA 26:3** See also PSA 119:165; PHP 4:7**Perfect knowledge****1CO 13:9–13:12** See also ROM 15:14 Although complete knowledge is inaccessible here and now, believers have all they need to live the Christian life; COL 2:2**Perfection in describing human physical beauty****2SA 14:25–14:27; ; SNG 4:7, SNG 5:2, SNG 6:9****False claims to perfection****JOB 36:4; ; PSA 64:6, PSA 119:96; ; EZK 27:3–27:4; ; PHP 3:6****8324: purity**

An absence of blemish or stain, especially sin. The state of being morally and spiritually pure, which is seen by Scripture as the result of being the people of God and also as an expected distinguishing mark of the church.

8325: purity, nature of

The OT recognises a close link between outer cleanliness and inner purity. In the NT, special emphasis is placed on inner purity resulting from spiritual renewal.

Physical cleansing from impurity by washing or refining**GEN 18:4; ; JOB 9:30; ; PSA 12:6****Ritual impurity must be avoided or cleansed****LEV 10:10–10:11** See also ISA 35:8, ISA 52:1, ISA 52:11; MRK 7:2, MRK 7:4**Sexual sources of ritual impurity****Childbirth****LEV 12:2** See also LEV 12:5; LUK 2:22**Sexual intercourse****EXO 19:15; ; LEV 15:18; ; 1SA 21:4****Seminal emission****LEV 15:16–15:17; ; DEU 23:10–23:11; ; 1SA 20:26**

Menstruation

LEV 15:19–15:20; ; 2SA 11:2–11:4; ; EZK 18:6

Abnormal discharge

LEV 15:1–15:2, LEV 15:25–15:27; ; MAT 9:20 parallels MRK 5:25, LUK 8:43

Other sources of ritual impurity**Dead bodies**

NUM 19:11–19:16

Unclean creatures

GEN 7:2 See also LEV 11:24, LEV 11:46–11:47; DEU 14:3; HOS 9:3

Skin diseases

LEV 13:45 See also MAT 8:2–8:4 parallels MRK 1:40–1:44, LUK 5:12–5:14

Mildew

LEV 14:36

Contact with a sin offering

LEV 16:26

Cleansing from ritual impurity

LEV 14:8 See also LEV 16:26; NUM 19:17–19:21, NUM 19:9, NUM 19:17–19:21, NUM 31:22–31:23 Fire is also a purifying agent.

Contact with God demanded purity

EXO 19:10 See also EXO 19:14–19:15, EXO 30:18–30:21; HEB 10:22

Ritual purity is not required under the new covenant

MAT 15:11 parallel MRK 7:15 What concerns God is moral impurity, associated with actions, not ritual impurity, associated with food, etc. See also ACT 10:12–10:15, ACT 21:26 Paul took part in Jewish purification rites in accordance with his Jewish heritage; ROM 14:14; GAL 2:11–2:12 Peter temporarily relapsed into the habit of treating Gentiles as unclean; GAL 2:14–2:15; 1TI 4:4

8326: purity, moral and spiritual

Moral and spiritual purity is demanded by God of his people. God calls his people to be holy, just as he is holy.

Divine purity**The purity of God**

HAB 1:13 See also JOB 4:17; PSA 18:26; 1JN 1:5

The purity of Jesus Christ

1JN 3:3 See also MAT 17:2; HEB 7:26

Fellowship with God demands purity

PSA 24:3–24:4; MAT 5:8 See also PSA 51:6, PSA 73:1

God's people are to live pure lives

COL 3:5 See also LEV 18:30; JOB 31:1; PSA 51:10; 1CO 5:7–5:8 Yeast is a symbol of sin; 1CO 6:15–6:20; 1TH 4:3; TIT 1:15, TIT 2:5; HEB 13:4; JAS 1:27, JAS 4:8

Purity is unobtainable by human effort**Because of the sinful human nature**

JOB 14:4 See also JOB 15:14, JOB 25:4; ECC 7:20

Because of the tendency to idolatry

HOS 8:5

Because of self-deception

PRO 30:12 See also PRO 20:9

Because of an unwillingness to be cleansed

EZK 24:13

Symbols of purification from sin

PSA 51:7 See also ISA 6:6 fire; MRK 1:4 water baptism; 2CO 11:2 virginity; 2PE 3:14 spotlessness

God promises to purify his people

EZK 36:25 See also ZEP 3:9; ZEC 13:1

Purification through Jesus Christ**Through pardon offered in his death**

HEB 9:14 See also HEB 12:24; 1JN 1:7

Through his word

JHN 15:3 See also JHN 13:10

Through his presence in resisting temptation

JAS 4:7–4:8 See also 1PE 5:9

Through hope built on his promises

TIT 2:12–2:13 See also 1JN 3:3

Purification through judgment**In the OT**

LEV 18:28 See also DEU 13:5, DEU 17:7, DEU 17:12; JDG 20:13; MAL 3:2–3:4

In the NT

1CO 5:13

Symbols of purity**Whiteness**

DAN 7:9 See also PSA 51:7; ISA 1:18; MAT 17:2 parallel MRK 9:3; MAT 28:3; MRK 16:5; JHN 20:12; REV 1:14

Light

1JN 1:7 See also JOB 25:5; EZK 1:27; 2CO 6:14; EPH 5:8–5:9

Washing**PSA 26:6** See also PSA 51:2**Fire****DAN 7:9–7:10** See also ISA 33:14; EZK 8:2; REV 1:14–1:15**8328: quietness**

A calm, peaceful and restrained attitude to life and way of approaching God frequently commended in Scripture even in adverse circumstances. It is also a condition experienced by God's friends and enemies when confronted by his majesty.

Quietness of life**A quiet manner of life commended****1TI 2:1–2:2** See also PSA 35:20, PSA 131:1–131:2; MAT 12:19; ISA 42:2; 1TH 4:11; 2TH 3:12; 1TI 2:11; 1PE 3:1–3:4**A quiet temperament****GEN 25:27****Quiet activity****MAT 1:19** See also JDG 4:21; RUT 3:7; EZK 24:17; ACT 16:37**The wisdom of being quiet****AMO 5:13** See also GEN 34:5; JDG 18:19–18:20; EST 7:4; PRO 15:18; ECC 9:17; ACT 19:35–19:36**Quietness in different circumstances****In peace and rest****PSA 23:2** See also 1CH 4:40; PRO 17:1; ISA 32:17; MRK 6:31**After conflict****1CH 22:9** See also JOS 11:23, JOS 14:15; JDG 3:11, JDG 5:31, JDG 8:28; 2CH 14:1, 2CH 20:30; ISA 14:7; JER 30:10 parallel JER 46:27; ZEC 1:11**When in distress**

2SA 13:20; ; NEH 8:9–8:11; ; ISA 7:4

Because of a sense of shame

GEN 3:8; ; NEH 5:8; ; MRK 9:34

When before a higher authority

JDG 3:19; ; MRK 1:25 parallel LUK 4:35

God's quiet voice

1KI 19:12–19:13

Absence of quietness**Because of inner conflict****JOB 3:26** See also RUT 3:18; JOB 6:24; ROM 7:21–7:24**Because of sin****ISA 57:20–57:21****The quietness of God****God chooses quietness****ISA 18:4** See also JOB 34:29; ISA 42:14; EZK 16:42**God rejects quietness****ISA 62:1****God brings quietness****PSA 76:8** See also PSA 46:10, PSA 65:7, PSA 89:9, PSA 107:29; ISA 24:8, ISA 25:5; ZEP 3:17; MAT 8:26 parallels MRK 4:39, LUK 8:24**Quietness before God****Being quiet before God****PSA 37:7; ISA 30:15** See also EXO 14:14; LAM 3:26; 1CO 14:28, 1CO 14:34–14:35; REV 8:1**Quietness in prayer****MAT 6:6** See also NEH 2:4; MRK 6:46 parallel MAT 14:23; LUK 5:16, LUK 6:12, LUK 9:18**Quietness as calmness****In contrast with the storm****MAT 8:26** parallels MRK 4:39, LUK 8:24 See also PSA 107:30; JON 1:11–1:15**In contrast with rashness****ECC 10:4** See also PRO 15:18**In contrast with unrest****ISA 7:4** See also NEH 8:11**In contrast with anger****EZK 16:42****8329: readiness**

A state of preparedness for future needs or happenings, whether predictable or uncertain. God through Jesus Christ prepared all that was necessary for the salvation of sinners. God's people are exhorted to be ready for warfare (physical and spiritual), death and the second coming of Jesus Christ. All humanity should be ready for future judgment.

God has prepared everything for the salvation of sinners**MAT 22:4** A wedding banquet is often used to portray the blessings of salvation and the gathering of Jesus Christ with the redeemed in heaven. See also LUK 14:16–14:17; 1PE 1:5

Exhortations to and descriptions of readiness for war

Against earthly enemies

JOL 3:9–3:10 See also 1KI 20:12; 1CH 12:23–12:35, 1CH 12:33–12:37; 2CH 25:5; JER 51:11–51:12; DAN 11:10

Against spiritual forces of evil

EPH 6:11–6:18

God's people should always be ready

To face temptation

1PE 5:8 See also PSA 39:1; MAT 26:41 parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:46; 1CO 10:12

To face death

2KI 20:1 parallel ISA 38:1 See also GEN 46:30; ACT 21:13

To serve

EPH 4:11–4:12; 1PE 1:13 See also NUM 8:11; 1SA 25:41; JHN 9:4; 2CO 8:19, 2CO 9:2; 2TI 2:21; TIT 3:1

To speak the truth

1PE 3:15 See also PRO 22:17–22:18; JER 1:17; 2TI 4:2

For the second coming of Christ

1JN 2:28 See also MAT 24:42–24:44, MAT 24:45–24:51 parallel LUK 12:42–12:46; MAT 25:1–25:12, MAT 25:13; MRK 13:33–13:37; LUK 12:35–12:40; 1TH 5:8; REV 3:11, REV 16:15, REV 19:7

All humanity should be ready for future judgment

LUK 12:47–12:48 This is one of many parables that Jesus Christ taught about his second coming and the need to be ready when he returns. See also AMO 4:12; 1PE 4:5

8330: receptiveness

An openness to people and ideas which needs to be tempered by discernment. It is an attitude which God desires and which he shows to all who call to him.

Receptiveness as a human quality

It is characterised by an open attitude

MAT 13:16–13:17 See also PRO 18:15, PRO 20:12

It is an aspect of love

JHN 19:26–19:27 See also RUT 4:3–4:5, RUT 4:13; MAT 18:5 parallels MRK 9:37, LUK 9:48; MAT 25:35; ACT 2:44–2:45, ACT 4:32; 1CO 13:6–13:7; GAL 4:14

Thoughtful receptiveness requires discernment

1JN 4:1 See also 1CO 2:14; PHP 1:10; 1TH 5:21; HEB 5:14

Thoughtless receptiveness is dangerous

2CO 11:3–11:4 See also DEU 11:16; 1KI 11:4; PRO 7:21; COL 2:8; HEB 13:9; 2JN 1:10

Spiritual receptiveness is fruitful

JHN 15:5 See also PSA 1:3; PRO 3:5–3:6, PRO 6:20–6:22; JER 17:7–17:8; JHN 20:29

God is receptive to human beings

To their needs

MAT 9:36 See also 2KI 14:26; PSA 103:13–103:14; ISA 63:9; MAT 6:8, MAT 15:32 parallel MRK 8:2–8:3; LUK 7:13; 1PE 5:7

To their cries

PSA 38:9 See also EXO 3:7; 1KI 9:3 parallel 2CH 7:12; PSA 6:8–6:9, PSA 40:1; ISA 65:24; 1PE 3:12

To their repentance

HOS 14:1–14:4 See also 2SA 12:13; EZK 18:27–18:28; JOL 2:13; JON 3:10, JON 4:2; LUK 15:7, LUK 15:10, LUK 18:13–18:14

God's receptiveness may be withdrawn

ZEC 7:13 See also PSA 66:18; PRO 21:13; ISA 59:2; JER 11:11; MAT 7:23, MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; PSA 22:1; JAS 1:7

People should be receptive to God

Spiritual receptiveness begins by receiving Jesus Christ

JHN 1:12–1:13 See also MAT 10:40; ACT 2:41, ACT 16:14; COL 2:6

Spiritual receptiveness requires openness to God's Spirit

1CO 2:12–2:16 See also ROM 8:5, ROM 8:16; 1CO 7:40; GAL 5:16, GAL 5:25; REV 2:7

Receptiveness involves seeking and listening

ISA 50:4–50:5 See also DEU 4:29; 1CH 28:9; PSA 119:11; PRO 8:34; MAT 7:8 parallel LUK 11:10; LUK 10:39; EPH 1:18; JAS 1:19

Receptiveness involves accepting and learning

MRK 10:15 parallel LUK 18:17 See also PSA 1:2; LUK 11:1; JHN 3:27, JHN 6:45; ACT 8:30–8:31, ACT 17:11; 1TH 2:13; 1JN 2:27

Receptiveness requires obedience and action

JHN 14:23 See also 1SA 15:22; ISA 58:6–58:7; MAT 7:21; JHN 5:17, JHN 7:17; JAS 1:25, JAS 2:14; 1PE 4:10

Refusing to be receptive to God

ZEC 7:11–7:12 See also 2CH 24:19; JER 32:33; MAT 10:14 parallels MRK 6:11, LUK 9:5; JHN 1:11; ACT 7:51–7:53; JAS 1:7–1:8

8331: reliability

The quality of consistency and dependability which is the basis for confidence and reliance. It is exemplified

by God in his changelessness and is required of God's people in their service and witness. Scripture gives warning, too, of those things which may prove unreliable.

The reliability of God

God's character and nature are reliable

DEU 32:4 See also 1SA 2:2; PSA 18:2, PSA 62:7, PSA 78:35; ISA 26:4

God is faithful to his covenants

DEU 7:9 See also GEN 9:15–9:16; PSA 105:8–105:11, PSA 111:5; ISA 54:10; EZK 16:60

God's love is reliable

PSA 89:1–89:2 See also EXO 20:6 parallel DEU 5:10; EXO 34:6–34:7; NUM 14:18; PSA 103:17–103:18; LAM 3:22–3:24; 1JN 4:16

God's promises are reliable

1KI 8:56 See also JOS 21:44–21:45, JOS 23:15; JER 29:10; HEB 6:13–6:18

God's presence is reliable

DEU 31:6 See also GEN 28:15; ISA 41:10; MAT 28:20; ACT 18:10

God's strength and protection are reliable

PSA 46:1; 1CO 1:8–1:9 See also JOS 14:9; 2CH 13:18, 2CH 16:8; PSA 71:5–71:7; PHP 1:6; 2TH 3:3; JUD 1:24

God's words are reliable

JHN 8:26 See also PSA 33:4; EZK 12:25; MAT 5:18; LUK 21:33; ROM 3:4

The reliability of times and seasons

GEN 8:22 See also GEN 1:14; PSA 104:19; ECC 1:4–1:5

The reliability of God's people

Reliability in witness

ISA 8:2 See also PRO 12:17, PRO 14:5, PRO 14:25; JHN 19:35; ACT 4:20

Reliability in teaching

PRO 22:20–22:21 See also ECC 12:10; 2TI 2:2

Reliability of character

1TI 3:2–3:10; ; TIT 1:6–1:9

Examples of reliable people

GEN 21:23–21:24 Abraham; NUM 12:7; ; HEB 3:5; NUM 14:24; ; JOS 14:9–14:12; 2CH 34:12 men working on the temple; ; NEH 7:2 Hanani; ; EZK 44:15 Priests; ; MAL 2:6 Levi; ; 1CO 4:17 Timothy; ; COL 1:7 Epaphras; ; COL 4:7–4:9 Tychicus and Onesimus; ; 2TI 4:11 Luke

Warnings against unreliability

Examples of unreliable people

PSA 78:57 See also 1SA 29:6 David was trusted by Achish, but was secretly deceiving him; JER 2:21 the people of Israel; EZK 13:9; ZEC 10:2; MAT 7:15 GAL 2:4 Judaisers; HOS 10:4 Israel's kings

Examples of things proving unreliable

JER 17:5 See also 2KI 18:21 parallel ISA 36:6 false dependence upon Egypt; PSA 33:16; HOS 10:13 ISA 30:12–30:13 false dependence upon human scheming; GAL 3:18; COL 2:8

8332: reputation

The estimation of a person in the sight of God or other people. Scripture stresses the importance of believers having a good reputation with those outside the faith.

God's defence of his own reputation

God's actions in history to uphold his reputation

EXO 9:13–9:16 See also EZK 20:9–20:10

God's rebukes his people for failing to uphold his reputation

MAL 2:2 See also MAL 1:6–1:11

God's promises to uphold his reputation

EZK 36:22–36:23 See also ISA 42:8

The reputation of believers

Believers must seek a good reputation with God

ACT 24:16 See also 2CO 5:9–5:10; 1TH 4:1

Believers must have a good reputation with outsiders

ACT 5:13–5:16 See also ACT 2:46–2:47, ACT 24:16; 1TI 3:7

Believers must not boast to improve their own reputation

2CO 10:17–10:18 See also 1CO 3:5–3:7; PHP 3:4–3:9

Believers must not seek a good reputation through outward show

MAT 6:16–6:18 See also MAT 6:1–6:8, MAT 23:2–23:12

Believers may find that serving God leads to a bad reputation with unbelievers

ACT 17:5–17:8 See also 1KI 19:1–19:5; LUK 23:1–23:2

Good reputations

Examples of God-fearers with a good reputation

LUK 7:3–7:5 the centurion; ; ACT 10:1–10:4 Cornelius

Examples of believers with a good reputation

DAN 6:3–6:5 Daniel; ; ACT 9:36–9:39 Dorcas; ; ACT 16:1–16:2 Timothy; ; ACT 22:12–22:13 Ananias; ; ROM 1:8 the church at Rome

The blessing of a good reputation

PRO 22:1 See also ECC 7:1

Bad reputations**The reputation of sinners is known to God**

GEN 18:20–18:21 See also REV 3:1–3:2, REV 18:4–18:5

Examples of reputed sinners

1KI 16:29–16:33, 1KI 21:25–21:26; ; 2KI 21:16–21:17

Outward reputation cannot compare with a righteous heart

ISA 16:7 See also 1CH 29:14–29:19; REV 3:1–3:3

8333: reverence

The proper sense of awe, respect and wonder that is inspired and demanded by an encounter with, or meditation upon, the character and activity of the living God.

8334: reverence, and God's nature

Reverence for God results from considering his nature and all that he has done.

Believers should revere God and meditate upon his deeds

ISA 12:24 See also JOS 24:14; JOB 25:2, JOB 37:23–37:24; JER 32:40–32:41; MAL 2:5

Reverence is to be reserved exclusively for God

DEU 6:13–6:14

Reverence for God's creative activity

DEU 10:20–10:21 See also ISA 12:18; 1CH 16:25; PSA 33:8–33:9; ECC 3:14; JER 5:22–5:24; HAB 3:2

Reverence for God's eternal existence

1TI 1:17 See also 1TI 6:16

Reverence for God's name

MAL 4:2 See also ISA 59:19; MAL 1:14; REV 11:18

Reverence for God's holiness

ISA 8:13 See also PSA 96:4; ISA 29:23; JER 10:7; REV 15:4

Reverence for God's word

ISA 66:2 See also DEU 4:10–4:11; EZR 9:4, EZR 10:3

Reverence for God's works

ECC 3:14 See also EXO 14:31; PSA 64:9

Reverence for God's mercy and compassion

PSA 5:7, PSA 22:23, PSA 130:4

Reverence for God's intervention in healing

MAT 9:8 parallels MRK 2:12, LUK 5:26

Reverence for God's judgment

EXO 14:31; ; AMO 3:8; ; JON 1:16; ; REV 14:7

Reverence for God's anger

DEU 6:14–6:15; ; PSA 2:11–2:12, PSA 76:7

Gentile nations will also revere and fear God

PSA 67:7 See also JOS 4:24; 1KI 8:43 parallel 2CH 6:33; 2CH 20:29; PSA 76:11–76:12, PSA 102:15; ISA 59:19; JER 33:9

Reverent fear of God is not mere terror but includes trust

EXO 20:20 See also GEN 28:16–28:17 Jacob feels reverent awe in the presence of the God who has just promised to bless him; PSA 2:11; ACT 9:31

Reverent fear of God is a remedy against other fears

PSA 56:4; ; LUK 12:4–12:5; ; 1PE 3:14–3:15

8335: reverence, and blessing

Reverence for God brings favour to individual believers, their families and the community to which they belong.

God's blessing is conditional upon reverence for him

PSA 128:1 See also PSA 115:1; ECC 8:12; JER 32:39

The characteristics of reverence**Wisdom is based on reverence for God**

PSA 111:10 See also PRO 1:7, PRO 9:10

Reverence is pure and eternal

PSA 19:9

Reverence will characterise the Messiah

ISA 11:2–11:3

God responds to those who revere him

PSA 147:11 See also PSA 25:14; MAL 3:16–3:18; ACT 10:35

Reverence brings God's special attention and compassion

NEH 1:11; ; PSA 33:18, PSA 103:13, PSA 103:17, PSA 145:19; ; LUK 1:50

God is good to those who revere him

PSA 31:19; ; ISA 33:6

Reverence brings God's protection and deliverance
PSA 34:7, PSA 60:4, PSA 115:11; ; PRO 14:26

God meets the needs of those who revere him
EXO 1:21; ; PSA 34:9, PSA 111:5; ; JER 5:24–5:25

Reverence for God is rewarded

God rewards the reverent with prosperity
DEU 6:24 See also JOB 1:9; PSA 25:12–25:13, PSA 85:9, PSA 112:1, PSA 128:4; PRO 22:4; MAL 4:2

Those who revere God avoid his judgment
DEU 28:58–28:67

God rewards reverence with long life and future hope
PRO 10:27, PRO 14:27, PRO 19:23, PRO 23:17–23:18; ; ECC 8:13

God's blessings on those who revere him are a witness to the nations
JER 33:9

Reverence ensures success in leadership
2SA 23:3 David; ; 2CH 26:5 Uzziah; ; ACT 9:31

8336: reverence, and obedience

Reverence towards God expresses itself in the actions, as well as the words and worship of believers. True reverence for God leads to obedience towards him.

Reverent fear is expressed in worship
JON 1:16

Reverence in worship is expressed in bodily attitudes
Bowing: EXO 12:27; ; PSA 95:6; GEN 17:3; ; NUM 14:5; ; DAN 10:15; ; REV 5:14; EXO 3:5 removing shoes; ; EXO 3:6 covering the face; EZR 9:5; ; DAN 6:10; ; EPH 3:14

Reverence can be learnt through religious observances

A shared meal in God's presence
DEU 14:23

Hearing God's word
DEU 4:9–4:14, DEU 31:12–31:13

Reading God's word
DEU 17:18–17:19

Reverence motivates people to avoid doing wrong

PRO 16:6 See also EXO 20:20; 2CH 19:9–19:10; JOB 1:1, JOB 28:28; PRO 3:7, PRO 8:13, PRO 14:16; 2CO 7:1

Reverence leads people to obey God's law

ECC 12:13 See also DEU 10:12–10:13, DEU 13:4; NEH 5:14–5:18 generous treatment of dependants; 2CO 5:11 evangelism; EPH 5:21 mutual submission; COL 3:22 obedience to masters

Reverence is characterised by fearing God
ECC 8:12; ; ACT 2:5

Gentile believers were called ``God-fearing''
ACT 10:2, ACT 13:26, ACT 13:50, ACT 17:4, ACT 17:17

8337: reverence, and social behaviour

Reverence for God leads to proper respect for others and right relationships among the people of God.

Reverence for God affects believers' attitudes

Reverence produces respect for others
EPH 5:21 See also 1PE 2:17

Reverence affects social attitudes
LEV 19:14, LEV 25:17; ; EPH 6:5; ; LEV 25:36, LEV 25:43

Attitudes to work are affected by reverence to God
EXO 1:17 a conflict of duty; ; EXO 18:21 appointments in administration; ; 2CH 19:7 justice; ; 2CH 19:9

Reverence for God affects believers' behaviour
LEV 19:14, LEV 19:32, LEV 25:14–25:17, LEV 25:35–25:36; ; PSA 15:4; ; PRO 31:30 Reverence for God should be respected; ; COL 3:22 Reverence for God inspires a slave's respect for his master.; TIT 2:2–2:3; ; 1PE 3:1–3:2

Reverence for God may reduce hostility
2CH 17:10

Lack of reverence has an adverse effect on behaviour
DEU 25:18; ; NEH 5:7–5:9; ; PSA 36:1

Reverence can be shown to fellow human beings as God's representatives
JOS 4:14; ; ACT 10:25

8339: self-control

Physical and emotional self-mastery, particularly in situations of intense provocation or temptation.

Self-control is the mark of a wise person
PRO 29:11 See also PRO 1:1–1:5

Self-control is an aspect of Christian character
GAL 5:22–5:23; TIT 2:11–2:12 See also 1TI 3:2; TIT 1:8, TIT 2:2, TIT 2:5–2:6; 2PE 1:5–1:9

Self-control affects the whole person

Physical self-control

1CO 9:26–9:27 See also 1CO 7:36–7:38; 1TH 4:3–4:7

A mental discipline

1PE 1:13 See also 1TH 5:6–5:8; 1PE 4:7, 1PE 5:8

Controlled speech

PSA 141:3; JAS 1:19 See also PSA 17:3; PRO 16:23, PRO 21:23; ECC 5:2; JAS 3:1–3:12

Self-control in response to persecution

MAT 5:39–5:40 parallel LUK 6:27–6:29 See also 1PE 2:18–2:23

Examples of self-control

GEN 39:7–39:12 Joseph; ISA 24:1–24:7, ISA 26:7–26:12; ; 2SA 16:9–16:10; JOB 31:1, JOB 31:30; ISA 53:7 the servant, understood in the NT as a prophecy concerning Jesus Christ; ; MRK 14:61; ; MAT 27:27–27:30; 1CO 4:12–4:13, 1CO 9:24–9:27

The dangers of a loss of self-control

PRO 18:7; JER 14:10 See also 1SA 18:10–18:11 Saul; 2SA 13:7–13:14 Amnon; PSA 106:32–106:33 Moses; PRO 6:1–6:3, PRO 29:18; ACT 24:25; ROM 1:24–1:31; 1CO 7:5 aimed at those who thought that abstaining from sexual relations in marriage was spiritual; 1CO 7:9; COL 2:23–2:24, 2PE 2:18–2:19; JUD 1:4

8340: self-respect

A sense of personal worth and dignity. Scripture points to the need for believers to ground their self-respect in God himself, rather than trusting in the opinion and valuation of other individuals or society as a whole.

Self-respect is often assumed

MAT 22:39 parallel MRK 12:31 See also MAT 7:12, MAT 19:19; ROM 12:3; EPH 5:29

Examples of those who had self-respect

JOB 12:3 See also JOB 10:16; PRO 31:25; PHP 3:4

The basis of self-respect

A relationship with God

PSA 139:13–139:14 See also PSA 30:6; 1CO 3:16–3:17, 1CO 6:12–6:20; 2CO 6:16; EPH 2:22; 1TI 4:4

Equality in God's community

JAS 1:9–1:10 See also 1CO 12:22–12:25

A clear conscience and faithfulness to God

2CO 1:12 See also JHN 7:18; GAL 6:4; HEB 13:18

God's strength is a source of self-respect

DAN 10:19 See also EXO 15:2; 2SA 22:33; PSA 71:5, PSA 89:17, PSA 118:14; 2TI 4:17

Self-respect results from disciplined living

JOB 4:6 See also PRO 20:3; 1TH 4:4; TIT 2:2

Self-respect can be lost through humiliation

JER 31:19 See also 2SA 10:1–10:5 parallel 1CH 19:1–19:5; 2SA 13:1–13:22; DAN 4:33

Self-respect can rest on wrong foundations

GAL 6:3 See also DEU 8:17–8:18; JOB 20:6–20:7; PHP 3:4–3:7

Ways in which self-respect can be undermined

By others

JOB 30:1–30:15

By the effects of sin and the work of Satan

MRK 5:2–5:5 parallel LUK 8:27–8:29; ; MRK 5:25–5:28 parallels MAT 9:20–9:22, LUK 8:43–8:48; ; LUK 15:13–15:16, LUK 17:12–17:13

By unwise spiritual zeal

GAL 6:1; ; 1TI 5:1–5:2; ; JUD 1:22

8341: separation

A setting apart. Separation is at the heart of the biblical idea of holiness. God is separate from his creation and has set apart his people from the world. Sin causes alienation between God and humanity, making necessary the reconciling work of Jesus Christ. The end of the age will bring the final separation between the righteous and the wicked.

God is without equal

EXO 15:11 See also PSA 89:6; ISA 40:25–40:26

God is separate from his creation

ISA 40:22 See also GEN 1:1; ISA 29:16, ISA 45:11–45:12; ROM 1:25

The separateness of God's people

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; DEU 14:2; PSA 135:4 **1PE 2:9** See also 1CO 6:19–6:20; TIT 2:14

Separation from the world

LEV 20:26 See also NUM 23:9; NEH 9:2, NEH 10:28 **JHN 15:18–15:19** See also JHN 17:16; PHP 3:20; 1PE 2:11

Separation from sin

2CO 6:17 See also ISA 52:11; LEV 15:31; EZR 6:21; 1CO 6:18, 1CO 15:34; 2CO 7:1

Avoidance of evil association

1CO 15:33 See also PRO 13:20 DEU 7:2–7:3; JOS 23:7 EZR 4:3, EZR 10:11; PSA 119:115; 2CO 6:14

Excommunication

Israelites refusing to follow God's commands to be cut off from God's people: LEV 18:29; ; NUM 15:30, NUM 19:20; ; MAT 18:15–18:17 separation from unrepentant believers; ; ROM 16:17 separation from false teachers; ; 1CO 5:9–5:13 separation from wilfully sinful believers; ; 2TH 3:6 separation from wilfully disobedient believers; ; TIT 3:9–3:11 separation from divisive people

Separation for service to God

NUM 6:2–6:3 the Nazirites; ; NUM 16:9 the Levites; ; 1CH 23:13 Aaron and his descendants; ; 1CH 25:1 prophets; ; JER 1:5 Jeremiah; ROM 1:1; ; GAL 1:15

Separation of holy places

EXO 26:33 the Most Holy Place separated by a curtain; ; EXO 33:7 the Tent of Meeting placed outside the camp; ; EZK 42:20 Ezekiel's temple separated by a wall

Separation caused by sin

Separation from God

ISA 59:2 See also HAB 1:13; EPH 4:18; COL 1:21

Separation at the final judgment

MAT 25:32–25:33 See also MAT 13:40–13:42, MAT 13:47–13:50

Separation of people from one another

RUT 1:16–1:17 Ruth will not be separated from Naomi; ; 2KI 2:11 Elisha separated from Elijah; ; PHM 1:15 Philemon separated from Onesimus; ; JHN 4:9 separation between Jews and Samaritans; ; EPH 2:11–2:12 separation between Jews and Gentiles

The pain of separation

ACT 20:37–20:38 See also 1SA 20:41; JHN 16:20 Jesus Christ foretells his death and resurrection; 2TI 1:4

The pain of separation through death

ACT 8:2 See also GEN 37:33–37:35; JER 31:15; MAT 2:18

Husband and wife not to be separated

MAT 19:5–19:6 parallel MRK 10:7–10:9 See also GEN 2:24; 1CO 7:10–7:13

Reconciliation through Jesus Christ ends the separation from God

2CO 5:18–5:20 See also MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; PSA 22:1 Reconciliation with God is possible because Jesus Christ bore the punishment of separation from God that human sin deserves; MAT 27:51 parallels MRK 15:38, LUK 23:45; ROM 8:35–8:39 Nothing can separate believers from God's love shown in Christ; EPH

2:14–2:15 Jew and Gentile reconciled through mutual reconciliation to God

8342: servanthood

The state of being the servant of others, especially of God. Scripture stresses the privileges and responsibilities of being a servant of God and points to Jesus Christ as the model of servanthood.

8343: servanthood, in society

Servants and slaves were an important feature of everyday life in biblical times. The idea of servanthood is used both literally and metaphorically throughout Scripture.

Laws of servanthood

EXO 21:2–21:6 parallel DEU 15:12–15:18 The words “servant” and “slave” are the same in Hebrew, but according to OT law, an Israelite servant was to be accorded more rights than a foreign slave. See also GEN 17:13; EXO 12:44, EXO 20:10 parallel DEU 5:14; LEV 25:39–25:55; DEU 21:10–21:14, DEU 29:10–29:11; 1CH 2:34–2:35

Citizens referred to as servants of the king

1SA 17:34 See also 2SA 18:29; 2KI 5:6; EZR 4:11; PRO 14:35; MAT 18:23

Kings as servants of other kings

2KI 16:7 See also 2SA 10:19 parallel 1CH 19:19; 2KI 17:3, 2KI 24:1; ISA 60:10

Servant as a self-designated title of respect

2SA 9:2 See also GEN 19:2, GEN 32:4; 1SA 17:34; 2SA 14:6; 2KI 2:15–2:16, 2KI 4:1, 2KI 6:3; DAN 1:12–1:13, DAN 2:4

Servanthood in Proverbs

PRO 14:35 See also PRO 11:29, PRO 12:9, PRO 17:2, PRO 29:19, PRO 30:10, PRO 30:21–30:23

Servanthood in the NT

MAT 23:8–23:12 See also MAT 6:24; LUK 17:7–17:10; JHN 15:20; ROM 12:3–12:8

8344: servanthood, in life of believers

Servanthood as an expression of subservience is an integral aspect of a person's relationship with God.

Servants of God in the OT

Abraham

GEN 18:5 See also GEN 26:24; DEU 9:27; PSA 105:6, PSA 105:42

Moses

EXO 14:31 See also NUM 12:7–12:8; DEU 34:5; JOS 1:1–1:2, JOS 1:7, JOS 1:13, JOS 1:15, JOS 8:31, JOS 8:33, JOS 11:15, JOS 22:2, JOS 22:4–22:5; 2KI 18:12; 2CH 1:3; HEB 3:5; REV 15:3

Joshua

JDG 2:8 See also JOS 24:29

David

2SA 3:18 See also 2SA 7:5 parallel 1CH 17:4; 2SA 7:8 parallel 1CH 17:7; 2SA 7:18–7:20, 2SA 7:25; 1CH 21:8; PSA 78:70, PSA 89:3, PSA 89:20, PSA 132:10; EZK 34:23–34:24; LUK 1:69; ACT 4:25–4:26

Jesus Christ and servanthood**Jesus Christ's teaching on servanthood**

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 See also MAT 25:31–25:46; JHN 12:26, JHN 13:13–13:17, JHN 15:15, JHN 15:20

Parables on servanthood

MAT 20:1–20:16, MAT 24:45–24:51 parallel LUK 12:42–12:46; ; MAT 25:14–25:30 parallel LUK 19:12–19:27; ; LUK 12:35–12:40, LUK 17:7–17:10

Servants of God in the NT

ACT 16:17 See also ACT 2:18, ACT 4:29; 2PE 1:1; JUD 1:1

Paul as a servant**A servant of God**

ROM 15:17 See also ROM 1:9; 2CO 6:4; 2TI 1:3

A servant of Jesus Christ

ROM 1:1 See also GAL 1:10; PHP 1:1

A servant of the gospel

EPH 3:7 See also COL 1:23

A servant of the church

2CO 4:5 See also 2CO 13:4; COL 1:24–1:25

Christian servanthood**Gifts of service**

1PE 4:10 See also ROM 12:7; 1CO 12:5; EPH 4:12; 1PE 2:16

Examples of service

ROM 12:11 See also 2CO 9:12–9:13; EPH 6:6–6:7; COL 3:22–3:24; REV 2:19

Christian leadership entails service

1PE 5:2 See also ACT 6:2–6:4; 1TI 3:10, 1TI 3:12–3:13

8345: servanthood, and worship of God

The biblical understanding of servanthood has its foundation in people serving God in worship. The terms for “service” and “worship” are often interchangeable.

Worship is a central aspect of serving God

EXO 3:12 See also EXO 4:23, EXO 8:1, EXO 8:20, EXO 10:8; JOS 22:27; PSA 100:2, PSA 102:22; LUK 4:8

Worship entails total obedience, not merely correct religious observances

DEU 10:12–10:13 See also AMO 5:22–5:24; MIC 6:6–6:8

Worship and service to God must be exclusive

MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8 See also DEU 6:13

Serving false gods**Worshipping false gods forbidden**

EXO 20:3–20:5 parallel DEU 5:8–5:9 See also EXO 23:24, EXO 34:14; JOS 23:7

Warnings against serving false gods

2CH 7:19–7:20 See also DEU 7:3–7:4; JOS 23:16, JOS 24:20

Examples of idolatrous service

1KI 16:31 See also JDG 2:11, JDG 2:13; 2KI 17:33; JER 2:20, JER 11:10; ROM 1:25

Refusal to serve false gods

DAN 3:12 See also JOS 24:16–24:18; DAN 3:18, DAN 3:28–3:29

Judgment for serving false gods

JDG 10:11–10:13 See also JDG 10:6–10:10; EZK 20:30–20:38

The service of the Levites and the priesthood**Consecration of the priesthood**

EXO 29:1 See also EXO 28:1, EXO 28:41, EXO 29:44, EXO 40:12–40:16; NUM 3:9–3:13

Service in the Tent of Meeting

NUM 4:3, NUM 4:23, NUM 4:30, NUM 4:35, NUM 4:39, NUM 4:43, NUM 18:7

Service in the temple

1CH 23:2–23:5 See also 1CH 23:24–23:32, 1CH 24:3, 1CH 24:5, 1CH 24:19, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 25:6–25:8 musicians and singers; 1CH 26:12 gatekeepers; 1CH 26:20 treasurers; 1CH 26:29–26:32; EZR 7:7, EZR 8:20; NEH 7:46, NEH 7:60

The promise of restored service in the new temple

EZK 44:15 See also EZK 44:10–44:14, EZK 44:24, EZK 45:5

Examples of priestly service

LUK 1:5, LUK 1:8–1:10, LUK 1:23

The true service of Jesus Christ as high priest

HEB 8:1–8:2 Hebrews sees the OT priesthood and its services as superseded by Jesus Christ. See also HEB 8:3–8:6

The Christian's life as an act of worship

ROM 12:1 See also REV 1:6, REV 5:10

8347: spiritual growth

Scripture uses a number of images to emphasise that believers are meant to grow in their faith, understanding, holiness and commitment. It also provides advice on how this may be achieved.

8348: spiritual growth, nature of

Having given spiritual life to his people, God expects them to grow to maturity.

God desires the spiritual growth of his people

MAT 5:48; HEB 6:1 See also 2CO 13:9–13:11; EPH 1:4, EPH 2:10, EPH 3:17–3:19; PHP 3:12; 1TH 4:1, 1TH 4:7; 2TI 1:9

Christlikeness is the goal of spiritual growth

ROM 8:29 See also EPH 4:13–4:15; PHP 2:5; 1JN 3:2–3:3

Aspects of spiritual growth

Growth in grace

2PE 3:18 See also PRO 4:18; 1PE 2:1–2:3

Growth in faith

2TH 1:3 See also 2CO 10:15

Growth in love

1TH 3:12 See also ROM 5:5; 1CO 14:1; PHP 1:9; 1TH 4:9–4:10; HEB 10:24; 1JN 4:7–4:21, 1JN 5:1–5:3

Growth in understanding

PSA 119:27; 1CO 14:20 See also PSA 119:97–119:99; ROM 12:2, ROM 16:19; 1CO 13:11; EPH 1:17–1:19; PHP 1:9–1:10; COL 1:9; HEB 5:14

Growth in holiness

2CO 7:1 See also EPH 5:25–5:26; HEB 2:11, HEB 10:10–10:14, HEB 12:14, HEB 13:12; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Growth in fruitfulness

JHN 15:16 See also MAT 13:23 parallels MRK 4:20, LUK 8:15; JHN 15:2, JHN 15:8; PHP 1:11; COL 1:10

Growth in contentment

PHP 4:11–4:12 See also 1TI 6:6; HEB 13:5

Examples of spiritual growth

In individuals

1SA 2:26 Samuel; ; LUK 1:80 John the Baptist; LUK 2:40, LUK 2:52; ACT 9:22; ; 1CO 9:26–9:27; ; PHP 3:12–3:14; ACT 18:26 Apollos; ; PHM 1:11 Onesimus; ; 3JN 1:2–1:3 Gaius

In the church

ACT 9:31, ACT 11:26, ACT 16:5; ; 2CO 10:15; ; COL 1:6; ; 1TH 2:13; ; 2TH 1:3

8349: spiritual growth, means of

God has provided various means by which believers may grow spiritually.

God supplies the resources for spiritual growth

PHP 2:13; 2PE 1:3 See also JHN 1:16, JHN 4:14, JHN 15:2, JHN 15:5; 1CO 10:13; 2CO 3:18, 2CO 9:10; GAL 5:22–5:23; PHP 1:6; COL 2:19; JAS 1:17, JAS 4:6; JUD 1:24

God's people must make efforts to grow spiritually

PHP 2:12; 2PE 1:5–1:9 See also ROM 6:19; 2CO 7:1; GAL 5:16, GAL 5:25; EPH 5:15–5:16, EPH 6:11–6:13; 1TI 4:7, 1TI 6:11–6:12; 2TI 1:6; 2PE 3:14; 1JN 3:3; JUD 1:20

Specific means of spiritual growth

Death to self-interest

COL 3:5 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; ROM 6:6, ROM 6:12, ROM 8:13; EPH 4:22; COL 3:9; 1PE 1:14, 1PE 2:11

The Scriptures

2TI 3:16–3:17 See also JOS 1:8; PSA 19:7–19:8, PSA 119:9–119:11; JHN 17:17; EPH 6:17; COL 3:16; 1PE 2:2; 1JN 2:14

Prayer

MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4 **COL 4:2** See also 1CH 16:11; MAT 7:11 parallel LUK 11:13; MAT 26:41 parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:46; JHN 16:24; ACT 4:29–4:31; EPH 6:18; 1TH 5:17; JAS 1:5

Focusing on Jesus Christ

HEB 3:1 See also MAT 11:29; JHN 13:15; ROM 15:5; PHP 2:5; HEB 12:2–12:3; 1PE 2:21; 1JN 2:6

The role of the Holy Spirit in spiritual growth

EPH 3:16–3:18 See also EPH 1:13–1:14, EPH 1:17, EPH 2:19–2:22

Christian leadership

EPH 4:11–4:13 See also 1CO 4:16, 1CO 11:1; PHP 1:25, PHP 3:17; HEB 13:7, HEB 13:17; 1PE 5:2–5:3

Faith in God

EPH 6:16 See also HEB 11:6; 1JN 5:4

Suffering and testing

ROM 5:3–5:4 See also JOB 23:10; PSA 119:67; ZEC 13:9; HEB 12:10–12:11; 1PE 1:6–1:7; JAS 1:2–1:4

Perseverance

HEB 12:1 See also PHP 3:12–3:14; 1TI 4:15

Cultivating wholesome thinking

PHP 4:8

God will bring the spiritual growth of believers to completion

1JN 3:2 See also EPH 5:25–5:27; PHP 1:6; JUD 1:24–1:25; REV 21:2

8351: teachableness

A quality in those who desire to learn, present in the disciples of Jesus Christ and seen in Christ's relationship to his Father. Unwillingness to receive the truth leads to spiritual darkness.

The importance of teachableness

For spiritual growth

HEB 12:5–12:12 See also HEB 5:11–5:14

For a life of obedience

PHP 4:9 See also JAS 1:25; REV 3:3

For discerning God's guidance

PRO 3:5–3:6 See also PSA 25:4–25:5; ROM 12:2

The requirements for teachableness

Eagerness to learn

PRO 18:15; ISA 50:4–50:5 See also 2CH 26:3–26:5; PSA 27:11, PSA 43:3, PSA 86:11, PSA 119:9–119:11, PSA 139:23–139:24, PSA 143:8–143:10

Willingness to learn

From God: EXO 15:26; ; DEU 5:27; EXO 20:18–20:19; ; DEU 18:15, DEU 31:12; ; NEH 8:3, NEH 8:9; PSA 34:11; ; PRO 4:10–4:13, PRO 4:20–4:21, PRO 8:32–8:33, PRO 13:1, PRO 23:22–23:23; PRO 1:5, PRO 19:20, PRO 22:17, PRO 25:12; MAT 12:42 parallel LUK 11:31; ; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; ; JHN 10:27; LUK 12:11–12:12; ; REV 2:7

Readiness to ask for help

ACT 8:30–8:31 See also MRK 4:10, MRK 9:11, MRK 9:28, MRK 10:10, MRK 13:4; LUK 3:12, LUK 11:1

Readiness to pray for wisdom

JAS 1:5 See also 2CH 20:12; PSA 143:8–143:10

Readiness to pray for spiritual insight

EPH 1:17–1:19 See also EPH 3:16–3:19; COL 1:9

Humility

1CO 3:18–3:20 See also JOB 6:24; PRO 11:2; MAT 11:29, MAT 18:3–18:4; 1CO 8:1–8:2; JAS 1:21

Living by truth already known

JHN 8:31–8:32 See also 2PE 1:5–1:8

Jesus Christ was willing to be taught by the Father

JHN 15:15 See also JHN 5:30, JHN 8:26–8:28

Hindrances to teachableness

The activity of the devil

2CO 4:4 See also 2TI 2:25–2:26

Not having the Holy Spirit

1CO 2:14

Unwillingness to be taught

ISA 48:17–48:18 See also PSA 32:9, PSA 81:11–81:12; MAT 13:14–13:15 parallels MRK 4:12, LUK 8:10; ISA 6:9–6:10; LUK 11:52 The “key to knowledge” is the fulfilment of the OT Scriptures in Jesus Christ; LUK 16:31, LUK 19:41–19:44; JAS 1:22–1:24

Reliance on the wisdom of the world

1CO 1:19–1:20 See also ISA 29:14; ROM 1:21–1:23; 2CO 10:4–10:5

Being afraid to ask questions

MRK 9:32 parallel LUK 9:45

8352: thankfulness

Heartfelt gratitude to God, expressed in response to his love and mercy.

Thankfulness for God's goodness

PSA 100:4–100:5 See also 1CH 16:8, 1CH 16:34–16:35; 2CH 7:3–7:6; EZR 3:10–3:11; PSA 68:19, PSA 106:1, PSA 116:12–116:14, PSA 136:1–136:3, PSA 136:26; ISA 63:7; 1TH 5:18; HEB 12:28

Thankfulness for deliverance

From adversity

PSA 35:9–35:10 See also PSA 31:7–31:8, PSA 31:21–31:23, PSA 44:6–44:8, PSA 66:8–66:9, PSA 66:16–66:20, PSA 103:1–103:5

From slavery in Egypt

EXO 15:20–15:21 See also EXO 15:1–15:18; PSA 105:1–105:45, PSA 136:1–136:26

From the power of death

1CO 15:53–15:57

Thankfulness for answered prayer

1SA 2:1–2:10 See also PSA 30:1–30:12, PSA 66:16–66:20, PSA 138:1–138:5; JHN 11:40

Thankfulness for others

PHM 1:4 See also NEH 11:17; ROM 1:8; PHP 4:6; COL 1:10, COL 4:2; 1TI 2:1; 2TI 1:3

Thankfulness for Jesus Christ

2CO 9:15 See also LUK 2:25–2:32, LUK 2:36–2:38; COL 2:6, COL 3:15–3:17

Thankfulness for God's provision

MAT 14:19 parallels MRK 6:41, LUK 9:16, JHN 6:11 See also PSA 147:7-147:9; MAT 15:36 parallel MRK 8:6; MAT 26:26-26:27 parallels MRK 14:22-14:23, LUK 22:17-22:19; LUK 24:30; ACT 27:35; ROM 14:6; 1TI 4:3

Means of expressing thankfulness to God

In song

EPH 5:19-5:20 See also PSA 69:30, PSA 95:2, PSA 96:1; ISA 55:12

In music

PSA 27:6, PSA 92:1-92:3

In dance

PSA 149:3

In worship

PSA 95:2, PSA 100:4; ; HEB 12:28

8353: tolerance

The virtue of being prepared to accept people and their viewpoints. While commended within the church, Scripture insists that believers must have a vital concern for maintaining and defending the truth.

Toleration should be exercised for the benefit of those whose faith is weak

ROM 14:1 See also ROM 14:2-14:6, ROM 14:13-14:22; 1CO 8:8-8:13

Examples of tolerance

By Jesus Christ: MAT 19:13-19:14 parallels MRK 10:13-10:14, LUK 18:15-18:16 in contrast to the disciples' intolerance; ; MRK 9:33-9:36 parallel LUK 9:46-9:47; ; MRK 9:38-9:40 parallel LUK 9:49-9:50; PHP 1:17-1:18 by Paul

Limits to toleration

Evil cannot be tolerated

HAB 1:13

Wickedness cannot be tolerated

REV 2:2

Serious doctrinal errors cannot be tolerated

GAL 2:4; 2TH 2:1-2:3 See also 1TI 6:3-6:5, 1TI 6:20-6:21; 2TI 4:3-4:4; 2PE 2:1

Sexual sin should not be tolerated

1CO 5:1-5:5, 1CO 6:18-6:20; ; REV 2:14

Idolatry should not be tolerated

1CO 10:7; ; 1JN 5:21

8354: trustworthiness

That quality of truthfulness and dependability which rewards faith. God is trustworthy and his people are called to be trustworthy in their dealings with other people. Scripture warns against pinning one's hopes on people and things that will prove untrustworthy.

God is trustworthy

God's words are trustworthy

2SA 7:28 See also PSA 19:7, PSA 111:7; DAN 2:45; 1TI 1:15, 1TI 4:9-4:10; REV 21:5

God rewards trust in him

PSA 22:4-22:5 See also PSA 20:6-20:8, PSA 21:7, PSA 125:1; ISA 25:9; 2TI 1:12

Qualities of those who are trustworthy

Integrity in business dealings

DEU 25:13-25:16 See also LEV 19:36; PRO 11:1, PRO 20:23; HOS 12:7; MIC 6:11

Honesty in handling money

2KI 12:15 See also 2KI 22:7; LUK 16:10-16:12

Not corrupted by greed

EXO 18:21 Qualities of the elders appointed by Moses. See also 1SA 8:3; PRO 13:11; EZK 28:18; 1TI 3:8

Ability to keep confidences

PRO 11:13 See also PRO 20:19, PRO 25:9

Truthfulness

PRO 12:17 See also PRO 16:13; ZEC 8:16-8:17; EPH 4:15, EPH 4:25 **PRO 13:17** See also PRO 24:26, PRO 25:13, PRO 27:6

Faithfulness with what is entrusted

LUK 12:48 See also MAT 25:14-25:27 parallel LUK 19:12-19:23 **1CO 4:1-4:21** 1CO 9:17; 1TI 6:20; 2TI 1:14; JUD 1:3

Trustworthiness required in leaders

1PE 5:2-5:3 See also 1TI 3:11 trustworthiness also required in wives of deacons (NIV text) or deaconesses (NIV footnote); TIT 1:7

Examples of people considered trustworthy

GEN 39:6 Joseph; ; NUM 12:7 Moses; ; 1SA 27:12 David. Though trusted by Achish, David was deceiving him; ; 2KI 22:5-22:7 parallel 2CH 34:10-34:12 those supervising work on the temple; ; NEH 13:13 Nehemiah's treasurers; ; DAN 6:4 Daniel; ; ACT 12:20 Blastus, Herod's treasurer; ; 1TH 2:4 Paul, approved by God

People proving to be untrustworthy

ISA 2:22; ; JER 17:5; ; EZK 16:15

Oneself

PSA 49:13; ; PRO 28:26

People in positions of power

PSA 146:3; ; ISA 20:5

Friends and family

PSA 27:10, PSA 41:9; ; JER 9:4, JER 38:22; ; MIC 7:5

Things proving to be untrustworthy

JOB 15:31 See also JOB 8:13–8:19

Fortifications

DEU 28:52; ; JER 5:17

Military strength

PSA 20:7, PSA 44:6; ; ISA 31:1; ; LUK 11:22

Wealth

JOB 31:24; ; PSA 52:7; ; PRO 11:28; ; JER 48:7; ; LUK 12:15–12:20

Idols

ISA 42:17; ; JER 13:25; ; HAB 2:18

Deceptive words

PSA 5:9; ; JER 7:4, JER 7:8, JER 28:15

8355: understanding

God-given perception of the nature and meaning of things, resulting in sound judgment and decision-making; in particular the ability to discern spiritual truth and to apply it to human disposition and conduct.

The source of understanding**Understanding belongs to God**

JOB 12:13; PSA 136:5 See also PSA 147:5; PRO 3:19; JER 51:15, JER 15:15 God's understanding gives rise to compassion.

Understanding is a gift from God

PRO 2:6; ISA 29:24 See also 1KI 4:29; JOB 38:36; ISA 32:3–32:4; DAN 1:17, DAN 2:21, DAN 2:30, DAN 9:22; ROM 15:21; ISA 52:15

Understanding spiritual truth**Understanding truth about God**

1JN 5:20 See also PRO 2:5, PRO 9:10; ISA 40:21, ISA 40:28, ISA 43:10; JER 9:24; JHN 10:38; ROM 1:20

Understanding God's purposes

DEU 9:6 God's reason for choosing Israel; ; 1CH 28:19 God's plans for the temple; ; JOB 34:10–34:11 the reason for Job's suffering; ; PSA 73:16–73:17 God's dealings with the wicked; ; ISA 57:1–57:2 God's purpose in taking the righteous; ; JER 9:12–9:13 the reason for the exile;

JER 23:20, JER 30:24; DAN 8:15–8:16 God's purposes in history; EPH 5:17; ; COL 1:9

Understanding God's word

PSA 119:73; LUK 24:45 See also NEH 8:8, NEH 8:12; PSA 119:27, PSA 119:125; MAT 24:15 parallel MRK 13:14; LUK 24:27; ACT 8:30–8:31; JHN 12:16

Understanding Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 13:11 parallels MRK 4:11, LUK 8:10; ; MAT 16:12, MAT 17:13; ; MRK 4:33, MRK 8:17; ; JHN 2:22

Understanding God's salvation

EPH 1:18 See also ISA 41:20; ROM 13:11; EPH 1:9, EPH 3:4, EPH 3:17–3:19; COL 2:2; PHM 1:6

Human understanding is limited

JOB 36:26, JOB 37:5; PRO 3:5 See also JOB 26:14, JOB 36:29, JOB 42:3; PRO 20:24; ECC 11:5; ISA 40:13–40:14, ISA 55:8–55:9; 1CO 13:12

Gaining understanding**Through faith**

HEB 11:3 See also MAT 16:8–16:9

Through God's Spirit

1CO 2:12 See also 1CH 28:12; JOB 32:8; ISA 11:2; JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13–16:15; 1CO 2:14; EPH 1:17

Through God's word

PSA 119:130 See also DEU 4:6; PSA 111:10; DAN 9:2; JHN 20:9

Through wise teaching

PSA 49:3 See also JOB 8:8–8:10; PRO 1:2, PRO 4:1, PRO 15:32; ECC 12:9

Lack of understanding of spiritual truth**Not knowing God**

ISA 1:3 See also DEU 32:28–32:29; ISA 27:11; JER 4:22; ROM 10:19; DEU 32:21

Lack of understanding due to hardened hearts

DEU 29:4; ISA 6:9–6:10 See also JOB 17:4; ISA 44:18, ISA 48:8; JER 5:21; EZK 12:2; MAT 13:13–13:15 parallels MRK 4:11–4:12, LUK 8:10; MRK 6:52; JHN 12:40; ACT 28:26–28:27; EPH 4:18

Not understanding God's purposes

PSA 82:5, PSA 92:6–92:7; ; ISA 5:13, ISA 19:12; ; MIC 4:12; ; LUK 12:56; ; 1CO 2:8

Not understanding Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 13:19; MRK 4:13, MRK 9:32; ; JHN 4:32–4:33, JHN 8:27, JHN 11:13, JHN 16:18; LUK 2:50 by Jesus Christ's parents; JHN 2:20–2:21, JHN 6:51–6:52, JHN 8:43; JHN 4:11 by the Samaritan woman

Understanding people and situations

1CH 12:32; ; EST 1:13; ; JOB 13:1; ; PRO 20:5; ; JHN 7:24

Understanding languages

GEN 11:7; ; DEU 28:49; ; PSA 81:5; ; ISA 36:11; ; ACT 2:6; ; 1CO 14:2

Those who have understanding

The wise

DEU 32:29; ; 1KI 4:29; ; PRO 8:14; ; HOS 14:9

Good leaders

JER 3:15 See also DEU 1:13; 1CH 22:12; 2CH 30:22; PRO 28:2PRO 28:16; ISA 56:11

The results of understanding

Seeking God

PSA 14:2 See also PSA 53:2; ROM 3:11

Obedience

PSA 119:34 See also NEH 10:28; PSA 32:9, PSA 119:100; PRO 28:7

Taking the right path

PRO 2:9 See also PSA 119:104; PRO 15:21

Life

PSA 119:144; ; PRO 16:22

Sensible living

JOB 28:28 avoidance of evil; ; PRO 11:12 slowness to criticise; ; PRO 12:11 conscientious labour; ; PRO 13:15 winning favour; ; PRO 17:27 showing restraint and an even temper; ; JAS 3:13 good deeds and humility

The results of a lack of understanding

Foolish behaviour

PRO 6:32 committing adultery; ; PRO 7:7 being easily seduced; ; PRO 17:18 making rash commitments; ; PRO 18:1-18:2 selfishness and self-importance; ; PRO 24:30-24:31 idleness leading to ruin; ; HOS 4:11 Drunkenness clouds understanding.

Death

PRO 10:21, PRO 21:16; ; HOS 4:14

8356: unselfishness

Putting the concerns and interests of others before one's own. Jesus Christ was the supreme example of this and believers should follow his example, denying themselves in order to serve others.

The supreme example of selflessness is that of Jesus Christ himself

In his life and work

JHN 5:30; ROM 15:3 See also MAT 15:32; JHN 13:3-13:5; 2CO 8:9

In his dying for others

MAT 20:26-20:28 parallel MRK 10:43-10:45**PHP 2:5-2:8** See also ISA 53:3-53:12; JHN 10:17-10:18; ROM 5:6-5:8; 1CO 15:3; 2CO 5:14; 1TH 5:10; 1PE 2:22-2:24, 1PE 3:18; 1TI 2:6

Unselfishness is a result of a relationship with Jesus Christ

Christian discipleship begins with a denial of self-interest

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23**MRK 10:45** See also ROM 6:6; 2CO 5:15; EPH 4:22; COL 3:9

It springs from an experience of life with Jesus Christ

PHP 1:21-1:24 See also PHP 3:7-3:11

It is inspired by the example of Jesus Christ

PHP 2:4-2:5 See also JHN 13:14-13:15; 1JN 3:16, 1JN 4:19-4:21

It is the result of the Spirit's work in the believer

GAL 5:22-5:26

Putting others first is fundamental in Christian behaviour

ROM 12:10; 1CO 10:23-10:24 This was particularly so when it came to the exercise of personal scruples. See also ROM 14:7, ROM 15:1-15:2; 1CO 8:9; EPH 4:32-5:2; COL 3:13; 1TI 6:18

Unselfishness involves a proper attitude to one's own self-importance

PHP 2:3 See also ROM 12:16; GAL 6:2-6:3; EPH 4:2, EPH 5:21; 1PE 3:8, 1PE 5:5

Unselfishness is expressed in Christian service

LUK 22:26; GAL 5:13 See also 1PE 4:10, 1PE 5:2

Examples of unselfish behaviour

Those who put others first

GEN 13:8-13:9 Abraham; ; EXO 32:31-32:32 Moses; ; RUT 1:16-1:17 Ruth; ; 1SA 12:3-12:5 Samuel; ; NEH 5:14-5:18 Nehemiah; ; MRK 12:41-12:44 a poor widow; ; MAT 15:21-15:28 a mother; ; MAT 26:6-26:13 parallel MRK 14:3-14:9 a woman with a jar of perfume; ; JHN 3:27-3:30 John the Baptist; ; ACT 4:32-4:37 the first Christians; ; ROM 16:3-16:4 Priscilla and Aquila; ; 1CO 16:15 the household

of Stephanas; ; PHP 2:20–2:21 Timothy; ; PHP 2:29–2:30 Euphroditus

Paul's ministry was motivated by the interests of others

1CO 10:32–10:33, 1CO 11:1 See also ACT 20:33–20:35; 1CO 9:3–9:15, 1CO 9:19–9:23; 2CO 11:23–11:29, 2CO 13:4; PHP 2:17; 1TH 2:8–2:9, 1TH 2:19–2:20

8357: weakness

A lack of strength, whether physical or spiritual. Scripture attributes weakness to human sin and foolishness and urges believers to find their true strength in God alone.

8358: weakness, physical

Lack of human strength may have a number of causes. Believers should be caring and compassionate towards the weak.

Causes of human physical weakness

Sin

ROM 8:3 See also PSA 90:10; ROM 5:6; HEB 5:2

Divine action

GEN 32:25 Through wrestling with God, Jacob carried a physical reminder for the rest of his life. See also GEN 32:32; HEB 11:21

Disobedience

JDG 16:20 See also JDG 16:7, JDG 16:11, JDG 16:13, JDG 16:17; JOB 18:7; EZK 7:17, EZK 21:7; 1CO 11:30

Satanic action

2CO 12:7 See also ISA 14:12; MRK 9:17–9:18; LUK 13:11

Disease or disability

PSA 6:2, PSA 31:9–31:10; ; JHN 5:7; ; GAL 4:13–4:14

Weakness from birth

ACT 3:2

Weakness in old age

GEN 27:1 See also 2SA 19:34–19:37; 1KI 1:1

Persecution

2CO 11:30 See also NUM 11:14–11:15; 1KI 19:3–19:6; MAT 26:38, MAT 27:32 The physical weakness of Jesus Christ after flogging led to Simon carrying the cross; ACT 14:19–14:20; 1CO 2:3 Weakness and fear are often associated; 2CO 11:23–11:29

Being faced with opposition

NUM 13:18; ; 2SA 3:29; ; NEH 6:9

Corporate weakness

2CH 20:12 See also LEV 26:36; JDG 6:15; 2SA 3:1; LAM 1:6

Believers' responsibility to the weak

ACT 20:35 See also PSA 41:1; EZK 34:4; ROM 14:1, ROM 15:1; 1CO 8:9, 1CO 9:22; 1TH 5:14

The weakness of God

2CO 13:4 See also 1CO 1:25; HEB 4:15

8359: weakness, spiritual

Human standards of strength and weakness are overturned by God's perspective and may be used for his glory.

Spiritual weakness leads to increased reliance on God

2CO 12:10 See also MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38; ROM 4:19; 1CO 1:27–1:29, 1CO 2:2–2:5

Weakness demonstrates the power of God

1CO 1:27 See also ISA 40:29–40:31, ISA 50:4; JER 31:25; 2CO 12:5–12:10

God helps those who are weak

ROM 8:26 See also ISA 40:29; EZK 34:16; JOL 3:10; HEB 11:34

Spiritual weakness should not be despised

ROM 15:1 See also MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38; ROM 14:1; 1CO 4:10, 1CO 8:7–8:12, 1CO 9:22

Overcoming spiritual weakness

The importance of overcoming weakness

HEB 12:12 See also JOS 1:6–1:7; JOL 3:10; MAT 6:28–6:33; 1CO 16:13; HEB 11:11

Weakness can be overcome by trusting in God

ROM 4:20 See also MAT 8:26, MAT 14:30–14:31; 2TI 1:6–1:8; JAS 1:6

8361: wisdom

The quality of knowledge, discernment and understanding characteristic of God himself. True wisdom, seen in the ministry of Jesus Christ, is a gift of the Holy Spirit. Scripture affirms that true human wisdom is a gift from God and points out the folly of trusting in mere human wisdom.

8362: wisdom, of God

See [1180: God, wisdom of](#)

8363: wisdom, of Jesus Christ

See [2081: Jesus Christ, wisdom of](#)

8364: wisdom, of Holy Spirit

See [3050: Holy Spirit, wisdom of](#)

8365: wisdom, nature of human

The human quality which enables the planning and successful achievement of a desired goal. It may be expressed as technical skill, practical instruction and astuteness in political affairs. True wisdom includes spiritual discernment and, above all, the reverence and knowledge of God.

Wisdom as human skill**For work on the tabernacle**

EXO 36:1 See also EXO 28:3 making the priestly robes; EXO 31:2–31:6 parallel EXO 35:30–35:35 craftsmanship and design in metalwork, stone, wood, embroidery and weaving; EXO 35:25–35:26 spinning; EXO 36:8 making and hanging curtains

For work on the temple

1CH 22:15 See also 1CH 28:21; 2CH 2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14 parallel 1KI 7:13–7:14 Hiram-Abi, skilled in bronze work

Other skills

Making idols: ISA 40:20; ; JER 10:9; JER 9:17 professional mourning; ; EZK 27:8–27:9 seamanship

Wisdom as instruction in practical living

PRO 14:8; ECC 12:11 See also PRO 6:6, PRO 10:5, PRO 10:8–10:9, PRO 19:11, PRO 20:1, PRO 21:20, PRO 29:11; ECC 7:7, ECC 10:12

Wisdom as political astuteness**Wisdom brings political success**

PRO 21:22; ; ECC 9:14–9:15; ; ISA 10:13; ; EZK 28:4–28:5

Wisdom in giving political advice

GEN 41:8; ; EST 1:13; ; ISA 19:11; ; JER 51:57; ; DAN 4:6, DAN 5:8; ; OBA 1:8; 1CH 26:14, 1CH 27:32–27:33

Wisdom in government

GEN 41:33–41:36; ; 2SA 14:20; ; 1KI 5:12; ; DAN 2:48

Wisdom associated with mystic arts

GEN 41:8; ; EXO 7:11; ; PSA 58:5; ; DAN 2:7, DAN 5:7, DAN 5:11

Wisdom as spiritual discernment**Understanding the plan of God**

GEN 41:39 See also JER 9:12; REV 13:18, REV 17:9

Understanding God's ways

HOS 14:9 See also JOB 11:6; PSA 107:43; DAN 12:10

Wisdom expressed in a right relationship with God**Wisdom as reverent submission to God**

JOB 28:28 See also PSA 111:10; PRO 1:7, PRO 3:7, PRO 9:10; ECC 12:13; MIC 6:9

Wisdom as the knowledge of God

PRO 30:3; ISA 11:2 See also EPH 1:17; COL 1:9

Wisdom as obedience to God's command

DEU 4:6 See also PSA 119:34, PSA 119:73

Wisdom personified**Wisdom calls out an invitation**

PRO 8:1–8:4, PRO 9:1–9:6

Wisdom teaches what is right

PRO 8:5–8:21

Wisdom existed before creation

PRO 8:22–8:32

Human wisdom can be opposed to God

1CO 1:18–1:25 See also 1CO 4:10

8366: wisdom, source of human

True wisdom belongs to God and may be given by him alone. It cannot be received by those who put confidence in worldly wisdom which is based upon human cleverness and insight without God's revelation and which will come to nothing.

True wisdom comes from God**It is given by God alone**

JOB 12:13 See also EXO 28:3; JOB 38:36; ECC 2:26; JAS 3:17

It is received through God's word

PSA 19:7 See also PSA 119:99–119:100, PSA 119:130; ECC 8:5; JER 8:8–8:9; HOS 4:6; MAT 7:24; COL 3:16; 2TI 3:15

It is received through submission to God

PRO 15:33 See also ISA 33:6

It is imparted by God's Spirit

EPH 1:17 See also EXO 31:3 parallel EXO 35:31; JOB 32:8; DAN 4:18, DAN 5:14; ACT 6:3, ACT 6:10; 1CO 12:8; EPH 3:5

It is given in response to prayer

JAS 1:5 See also 1KI 3:9 parallel 2CH 1:10; PRO 2:3–2:6; DAN 10:12; COL 1:9

The emptiness of worldly wisdom**Worldly wisdom is foolishness to God**

1CO 3:19–3:20 See also JOB 5:13; PSA 94:11; ROM 1:21–1:23

God cannot be known by worldly wisdom

1CO 1:21 See also ECC 8:16–8:17; ISA 55:9; ROM 11:33–11:34; 1CO 1:17, 1CO 2:4–2:5, 1CO 2:11–2:13

Worldly wisdom builds pride and false hope

ISA 47:10 See also PRO 3:7, PRO 26:12, PRO 28:11; ISA 5:21; JER 9:23; COL 2:23; 1CO 4:10; 2CO 11:18–11:19

Worldly wisdom will be confounded

ISA 29:14 See also 1CO 1:19–1:20; JOB 5:12–5:13; PRO 21:30; ISA 19:11, ISA 44:25; JER 51:57; EZK 28:6–28:7, EZK 28:17; 1CO 1:25

The revelation of divine wisdom**It is revealed in Jesus Christ**

1CO 1:23–1:24 God's wisdom, which is hidden from those who rely on human wisdom, is the message of Christ crucified. See also 1CO 1:30, 1CO 2:6–2:8; COL 1:15–1:17

It is rejected by the worldly-wise

1CO 2:14 See also 1CO 1:18, 1CO 1:22–1:23

It is revealed to the unlearned

MAT 11:25 parallel LUK 10:21 **1CO 3:18** God's wisdom may be received only by those willing to give up all reliance on their own human insight and understanding. See also 1CO 1:26–1:27

It is revealed through the church

EPH 3:10

God-given wisdom is superior to worldly wisdom

LUK 21:15 See also GEN 41:15; EXO 7:11–7:12; 1KI 4:30; DAN 1:20, DAN 5:7; ACT 6:10

8367: wisdom, importance of human

True wisdom may bring material reward but its value far exceeds earthly riches. To those who receive it, it opens a path to life and security and equips for leadership and right conduct.

The supreme value of true wisdom**It is priceless**

PRO 4:7 See also PRO 3:13, PRO 8:10–8:11

It leads to life

PRO 15:24 See also PRO 11:30, PRO 13:14, PRO 16:22, PRO 24:14; DAN 12:3

It brings prosperity

PRO 8:18 The benefits of wisdom may include material prosperity, but more important is the moral and spiritual prosperity which it brings. See also PRO 3:1–3:2, PRO 19:8, PRO 19:8, PRO 21:20–21:21, PRO 24:3; JER 10:21

It gives security

PRO 4:6 See also PRO 1:33, PRO 2:6–2:11, PRO 14:3, PRO 28:26; ECC 8:5

The application of wisdom**It touches the whole person**

1KI 3:12 In Hebrew, the “heart” represents the centre of human personality. See also JOB 38:36; PSA 51:6; PRO 2:2, PRO 16:23, PRO 22:17

It results in right action

COL 4:5; JAS 3:13 See also PSA 119:34; PRO 1:3, PRO 4:11, PRO 15:21, PRO 23:19; JER 4:22; HOS 14:9; ROM 16:19; EPH 5:15; COL 1:9–1:10; JAS 3:14–3:17

It results in watchfulness

MAT 25:1–25:10 See also PRO 14:8, PRO 22:3 parallel PRO 27:12

Wisdom is necessary for leaders**Wisdom to govern**

PRO 8:15–8:16; ACT 6:3 See also DEU 1:13; 1KI 5:7; 1CH 22:12; PSA 2:10, PSA 105:22; PRO 28:2; ECC 1:16; ISA 56:11; JER 3:15

Wisdom to administer justice

1KI 3:28 See also 1KI 3:9 parallel 2CH 1:10; PSA 37:30; PRO 20:26, PRO 24:23; MAT 24:45 parallel LUK 12:42; 1CO 6:5

The teaching of wisdom**The wise give instruction**

ECC 12:9 See also PSA 37:30, PSA 49:3; PRO 1:20–1:21, PRO 5:1, PRO 8:1, PRO 16:21, PRO 31:26; DAN 11:33; 1CO 2:6–2:7; COL 1:28, COL 3:16

The wise listen to instruction

PRO 1:5, PRO 15:31 See also PRO 4:1, PRO 9:9, PRO 10:8, PRO 13:20, PRO 15:12, PRO 19:20

Examples of those endowed with wisdom

ACT 7:10 Joseph; ; DEU 1:15 the elders of Israel; ; DEU 34:9 Joshua; 2SA 14:20; ; PSA 78:72; 1KI 3:16–3:28, 1KI 4:29–4:34, 1KI 10:4–10:8 parallel 2CH 9:3–9:7; ; 1CH 22:12–22:13; ; MAT 12:42 parallel LUK 11:31; EZR 7:25 Ezra; ; ISA 11:2 the Messiah; ; DAN 1:17 Daniel and his three friends; DAN 2:19–2:23, DAN 2:27–2:28, DAN 5:11–5:12; 2PE 3:15 Paul

8369: worthiness

Only God truly merits honour and praise but he graciously considers those who humbly serve him with wholehearted devotion to be worthy disciples.

God the Father is worthy of honour and praise

PSA 145:3 See also 2SA 22:4 parallel PSA 18:3; 1CH 16:25 parallel PSA 96:4; PSA 48:1; REV 4:11

Jesus Christ is worthy of honour and praise

REV 5:12 See also MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; PHP 2:9–2:11; HEB 2:9, HEB 3:3; 2PE 1:17; REV 5:9

People are considered worthy by others

LUK 7:4–7:5 Note that the centurion did not consider himself to be worthy (Lk 7:7). See also GEN 39:4, GEN 41:38–41:40; 1SA 16:6; 1KI 1:42; DAN 1:18–1:20, DAN 2:46–2:48, DAN 3:28–3:30; ACT 14:11–14:13

God considers no person (other than Jesus Christ) to be worthy by nature

REV 5:4 See also PSA 14:3, PSA 143:2; ECC 7:20; ROM 3:10–3:12, ROM 3:23

Worthiness, like righteousness, is credited to a person by God

2TH 1:11 See also LUK 20:35; ROM 2:29; 2CO 10:18

Examples of people who are considered worthy by God**Those who put God first and deny themselves**

MAT 10:37–10:38 See also 1SA 2:30; LUK 9:62; ROM 12:1–12:2

Those who suffer persecution for the sake of Jesus Christ

ACT 5:41 See also MAT 5:10–5:12; 2TH 1:5; 1PE 2:19–2:20

Those whose lives show Christlike godliness

COL 1:10 See also 1SA 16:7; EPH 4:1–4:2; 1TH 2:12; 1TI 3:8–3:9, 1TI 3:11; TIT 2:2; REV 3:4

Those who stand firm for the gospel

PHP 1:27; ; 1TH 2:4; ; 2TI 2:15

Those who are faithful in the use of resources which God has given them

MAT 25:21–25:23 See also MAT 24:45–24:47 parallel LUK 12:42–12:44; LUK 19:17; 1TI 5:17

Those who welcome God's people

MAT 10:11 See also MAT 10:41–10:42; ROM 16:2; 3JN 1:6

Examples of worthy people

GEN 6:8–6:9 Noah; ; DEU 1:36 Caleb; ; DEU 34:10 Moses; ; JOB 1:8 Job; DAN 9:23, DAN 10:19; LUK 1:28 Mary; ; JAS 2:23 Abraham

8370: zeal

A single-minded desire, characterised by enthusiasm and devotion. In Scripture it is often directed towards God, but God is also credited with zeal for his people and for the honour of his name. Misdirected or inappropriate zeal can degenerate into fanaticism.

Zeal for God

1KI 19:9–19:10 See also NUM 25:1–25:13; 1KI 19:13–19:14; 2KI 10:15–10:28; PRO 23:17

Zeal for God's house

PSA 69:7–69:9 See also JHN 2:13–2:17

Zeal for God's service

ROM 12:11 See also NEH 3:20; 2CO 8:16–8:22

Zeal for God's law

ACT 21:20 See also PSA 119:137–119:144

Zeal for the nation

2SA 21:2

God's zeal**Manifested in wrath against sin**

ISA 42:13 See also NUM 25:10–25:11; DEU 29:18–29:21; ISA 59:12–59:19; EZK 5:8–5:13, EZK 36:5–36:7, EZK 38:18–38:23

Manifested in concern for his people

ISA 26:11 See also 2KI 19:29–19:31 parallel ISA 37:30–37:32; ISA 9:1–9:7, ISA 63:15; EZK 39:25

Misdirected zeal

PRO 19:2 See also ACT 21:40–22:5; ROM 10:1–10:4; 1CO 13:3; GAL 1:13–1:14, GAL 4:17–4:18; PHP 3:6

Zeal for national identity: the Zealots

ACT 1:13 See also MAT 10:2–10:4 parallels MRK 3:16–3:19, LUK 6:14–6:16

8400: The tasks of the believer

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- 8477: self-examination
- 8481: self-sacrifice
- 8482: spiritual warfare
- 8488: tithing
- 8489: urgency
- 8490: watchfulness
- 8495: witnessing

8401: challenges

God makes demands on his people and, often through spiritual leaders, confronts believers with their sin. He also calls to account false gods and those who exalt themselves against him. The wicked vainly challenge God by questioning his authority, seeking to resist his power and opposing his people.

God's challenge to his people

The challenge to obedience

DEU 30:15–30:18 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; DEU 29:9; AMO 5:14–5:15

The challenge to serve him alone

1KI 18:21 See also JOS 24:14–24:15; JER 3:12–3:14

The challenge to discipleship

MAT 16:24–16:26 parallels MRK 8:34–8:36, LUK 9:23–9:25 See also MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 9:57–9:62 parallel MAT 8:19–8:22; JHN 21:17–21:19

Challenging one another's sin

The call to rebuke and admonish

LUK 17:3; COL 3:16 See also LEV 19:17; 1TH 5:14; 2TH 3:14–3:15; 2TI 4:2; TIT 2:15, TIT 3:10

Sin challenged by spiritual leaders

NEH 9:30 See also NEH 9:26

Examples of leaders who challenged the sins of others

2SA 12:1–12:7 The prophet Nathan challenges David; ; 2CH 26:18 Azariah the priest challenges Uzziah; ; EZK 16:2 Ezekiel was called to confront Jerusalem; ; HOS 2:2 Hosea challenges the unfaithfulness of Israel; ; ACT 5:3–5:4 Peter confronts Ananias; ; GAL 2:11–2:14 Paul challenges Peter.

God's sovereignty is unchallengeable

It cannot be questioned

ISA 45:9–45:11 See also JOB 9:12; JER 18:6

His purposes cannot be thwarted

ISA 14:27 See also JOB 42:2; ISA 46:10; DAN 4:35, DAN 5:21

No-one can stand against him

JER 49:19 See also JER 50:44; 2CH 20:6; JOB 41:10

God's challenge to the wicked

He challenges false gods

1KI 18:22–18:24 See also ISA 41:1, ISA 41:21–41:23

He challenges human pride

ISA 23:9 See also ISA 13:19; EZK 28:2; DAN 5:20

Challenges to God and his people

To God

ISA 14:13–14:14; ACT 4:26–4:27 See also PSA 2:2; GEN 3:4–3:5 The serpent challenges God's word; ISA 5:19 Isaiah's opponents challenge God to do what he has announced. DAN 11:36; 2TH 2:4; REV 13:5–13:6 MAT 4:1 parallels MRK 1:12–1:13, LUK 4:1–4:2 Jesus Christ is tempted by the devil; MAT 16:22 Jesus Christ is challenged by Peter; JHN 8:13 the Pharisees challenge Jesus Christ

To God's people

ISA 17:8–17:11; PSA 42:10 See also PSA 42:3, PSA 79:10; DAN 7:25, DAN 8:11; JOL 2:17; EPH 6:10–6:12 God's people are equipped to stand against the devil's attacks; REV 13:7

Further examples of challenges

JDG 14:4; ; 2KI 14:8 parallel 2CH 25:17

8402: claims

The assertion of rights and recognition due. God as Creator and Redeemer makes claims on his world and on his people. The claims of Jesus Christ about himself as God and Messiah call for a response. In human relationships, too, claims are made by individuals about themselves and, as a result, on others.

The basis for God's claims

God's ownership of the world

PSA 24:1–24:2 See also DEU 10:14; JOB 41:11; PSA 47:9, PSA 89:11; EZK 18:4

God owns his people as Creator

DEU 32:6; ; ISA 43:6–43:7, ISA 43:15

God owns his people as Redeemer

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also EXO 20:2–20:3 parallel DEU 5:6–5:7; LEV 25:55; ISA 43:1; ROM 14:8

The priority of God's claims

God's claim to first place

MAT 6:33 parallel LUK 12:31

God's claim on the firstborn

See also EXO 13:2, EXO 34:19; LEV 27:26; NUM 3:13; NEH 10:36

God's claim to the firstfruits

DEU 26:1–26:2; ; NEH 10:35; ; PRO 3:9

God's claim to the tithe

LEV 27:30; ; MAL 3:8–3:10

Acknowledging God's claims on human life

Wholehearted devotion to God

DEU 6:4–6:5 See also MAT 22:37 parallel MRK 12:30

Obedience to God's law

LEV 18:4–18:5 See also LEV 19:37, LEV 22:31; EZK 20:19

The call to holiness

LEV 11:45 See also LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7, LEV 20:26; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Honouring God's name

LEV 19:12, LEV 22:32–22:33

Observing the Sabbath

LEV 19:3, LEV 19:30, LEV 26:2; ; EZK 20:20

Not worshipping idols

LEV 19:4, LEV 26:1; ; JDG 6:10; ; ISA 42:8

The claims of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ's claim to fulfil the OT

MAT 5:17 See also LUK 4:17–4:21, LUK 24:27; JHN 5:39

Jesus' claim to be the Messiah

LUK 23:2 See also MAT 23:10; MRK 9:41; LUK 22:67; JHN 4:25–4:26

Jesus Christ's claim to be king of the Jews

MAT 27:11 parallels MRK 15:2, LUK 23:3; ; JHN 19:12, JHN 19:21

Jesus Christ's claim to divinity

JHN 10:33, JHN 19:7 See also MAT 26:63–26:64 parallels MRK 14:61–14:62, LUK 22:70; MAT 27:43; MRK 2:7 parallel LUK 5:21 Forgiveness of sin was recognised as the prerogative of God alone. Jesus Christ's claim to forgive sin is thus a claim to be God; JHN 10:30, JHN 14:9

Jesus Christ's claim to universal lordship

MAT 28:18 See also MAT 25:31–25:32; LUK 22:69; JHN 17:2

The "I am" claims of Jesus Christ

JHN 8:58 See also JHN 6:35 the bread of life; JHN 8:12 the light of the world; JHN 10:7 the gate for the sheep; JHN 10:11 the good shepherd; JHN 11:25 the resurrection and the life; JHN 14:6 the way and the truth and the life; JHN 15:1 the true vine

The need to acknowledge Jesus Christ's claims

JHN 8:24–8:30 See also JHN 14:11

Human claims

Those making claims about themselves

PSA 73:9 the proud boasting of the wicked; ; JER 23:34 false prophets claim to speak God's word; ; MAT 24:5 parallels MRK 13:6, LUK 21:8 false Christs; ; ACT 5:36 Theudas; ; ACT 8:9 Simon the sorcerer claimed to be someone great; ; ROM 1:22 idolaters claim to be wise; ; JUD 1:16 false teachers in the church; ; REV 2:2 false apostles

Claims must be verified by actions

JAS 2:14 See also PRO 20:6; TIT 1:16; 1JN 1:6, 1JN 2:6, 1JN 2:9

Making claims on others

2SA 15:3 grievances brought for judgment; ; 2SA 19:43 Israel's claim on David as their king; ; NEH 2:20 Nehemiah's enemies have no claim on Jerusalem.

Claims made about others

PSA 35:20 false accusations made against the righteous; ; MAT 5:11 parallel LUK 6:22 Believers will be slandered by their enemies; ; LUK 11:18–11:20 parallel MAT 12:26–12:28 The Jews claim that Jesus Christ's powers are demonic; ; ROM 3:8 slanderous claims made against Paul

8403: commands

Demands made of his people, or obligations laid upon his people, by God. Scripture stresses that being the people of God involves responsibilities as well as privileges, and sets out the demands which God justly makes of his people.

8404: commands, in OT

The OT sets out the commands of God to his people Israel, indicating both their extent and their importance.

The reason for God's commands: the need to be holy

LEV 11:44–11:45 See also LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7–20:8, LEV 20:26, LEV 21:8

God's commands to Israel

DEU 5:31–5:33 See also EXO 16:23–16:24, EXO 17:1, EXO 25:22, EXO 34:32; NUM 9:18–9:20; DEU 15:11 The LORD commands generosity and kindness to the poor; DEU 15:15, DEU 24:17–24:18, DEU 24:21–24:22; 2CH 29:25–29:26; NEH 8:1, NEH 9:13–9:14

Demands made by God upon individuals

GEN 2:16–2:17 Adam; ; GEN 7:16 Noah; ; GEN 21:4 Abraham; LEV 6:9; ; NUM 33:38; NUM 24:13 Baalam; DEU 31:23; ; JOS 4:16–4:17; 2SA 5:25 King David; ; 1KI 3:14 King Solomon; ; 1KI 18:36 Elijah; JER 1:7, JER 26:2; EZK 37:9–37:10 Ezekiel

God's commands to non-human agencies

The universe

PSA 33:6–33:9, PSA 148:4–148:6

The living creation

2CH 7:13; ; JOB 39:27; ; AMO 9:3; ; JON 2:10

The non-living creation

JOB 37:11–37:12; ; PSA 78:23–78:24; ; ISA 5:6; ; JER 31:35

The angels

PSA 91:11, PSA 103:20

The sword, symbolising the judgment of God

JER 47:6–47:7; ; AMO 9:4

Commands of the leaders of God's people

DEU 31:24–31:26 Moses; ; JOS 1:16–1:18 Joshua; ; 1KI 18:40 Elijah; ; NEH 13:22 Nehemiah

Commands given by kings

Over Israel and Judah

1KI 2:46; ; 1CH 28:20–28:21; ; 2CH 14:4

Over heathen nations

GEN 12:20; ; EXO 1:22; ; EZR 4:3; ; EST 1:12, EST 1:15, EST 2:8, EST 3:2, EST 3:13; ; DAN 3:20–3:22, DAN 5:29

Parental commands

DEU 32:44–32:46; ; PRO 3:1, PRO 6:20, PRO 7:1–7:2

The nature of God's commands

PSA 19:7–19:10 See also 1CH 16:15; PSA 119:86, PSA 119:96, PSA 119:151, PSA 119:172

God's commands are to be loved

PSA 119:47–119:48 See also 1KI 8:61; 1CH 29:19; JOB 23:12; PSA 112:1, PSA 119:16, PSA 119:35, PSA 119:127–119:128, PSA 119:131, PSA 119:143

God's commands are to be obeyed

God commands obedience

ECC 12:13 See also DEU 4:2, DEU 26:16–26:18; JOS 22:5; JER 7:22–7:23

Warnings against and examples of disobedience

2KI 17:13–17:14 See also 1SA 13:13–13:14; 1KI 11:10–11:11; LAM 1:18; DAN 9:4–9:6

The consequences of obedience

DEU 6:1–6:3 See also GEN 26:4–26:5; EXO 15:26; DEU 4:1, DEU 8:1; 1KI 11:38

The consequences of disobedience

1SA 12:14–12:15 See also DEU 11:26–11:28, DEU 30:1–30:3; 1KI 9:4–9:9; NEH 1:7–1:9; JER 22:4–22:5

8405: commands, in NT

The NT sets out the commands of God and Jesus Christ for the church.

Commands made by God

MAT 22:36–22:40 parallel MRK 12:28–12:31 See also MAT 15:3 parallel MRK 7:9; MRK 7:8; ACT 13:46–13:47, ACT 17:30; ROM 1:32; 1TI 1:1; TIT 1:3; 1JN 3:23, 1JN 4:21; 2JN 1:4

Commands made by Jesus Christ

In the Gospels

JHN 13:34 See also MAT 8:26–8:27 parallels MRK 4:39–4:41, LUK 8:24–8:25; MAT 28:19–28:20; MRK 1:25–1:27 parallel LUK 4:35–4:36; MRK 5:43 parallel LUK 8:56; MRK 9:25; JHN 15:12, JHN 15:17

In the rest of the NT

1CO 9:14 See also ACT 10:42; 1CO 7:10–7:11, 1CO 14:37; 1TH 4:2, 1TH 4:16; 2PE 3:2 “the command” (see 2Pe 2:21) here refers to Christianity considered as a body of ethical teaching

Commands made by the apostles

1JN 2:7–2:8 They received the command to love at the beginning of their Christian experience. See also ACT 10:48, ACT 16:4 The Greek word translated “decisions” literally means “decrees”; ACT 16:18; 2TH 3:4, 2TH 3:6, 2TH 3:11–3:12; 1TI 1:3–1:5, 1TI 4:11, 1TI 6:17–6:18 1TI 6:13–6:14

Obedience to the NT commands

Obedience is a requirement

1JN 2:3–2:4 See also MAT 5:19 “these commandments” probably refers to the OT law as fulfilled by Jesus Christ (see Mt 5:17–18); MAT 19:17; LUK 17:10; JHN 15:10; 1CO 7:19; 2PE 2:21; 1JN 3:21–3:24; 2JN 1:5–1:6; REV 14:12

Obedience is an expression of love and faithfulness

JHN 14:21 See also JHN 14:15, JHN 15:14; 1JN 5:2–5:3; REV 12:17

Commands given by secular authorities

MAT 8:9 parallel LUK 7:8 the Roman centurion; ; MAT 14:9–14:10 parallel MRK 6:27 Herod orders the beheading of John the Baptist; ; MAT 27:64–27:65; ; LUK 2:1; ; ACT 12:19, ACT 16:22–16:24, ACT 18:2 Claudius ordered all the Jews to leave Rome; ; ACT 21:34, ACT 23:10, ACT 23:35, ACT 25:6, ACT 25:17, ACT 25:21, ACT 25:23

Commands given by religious authorities

JHN 11:57; ; ACT 4:15, ACT 5:28, ACT 5:40, ACT 23:2–23:3

Commands that came through Moses referred to in the NT

HEB 9:19–9:20 See also MAT 8:4 parallel MRK 1:44; MAT 19:7–19:8 parallel MRK 10:3–10:4; JHN 8:5; ROM 7:8–7:13; HEB 12:18–12:21

8407: confession, of Jesus Christ

A public declaration of faith in Jesus Christ, acknowledging both his divinity and his lordship. Without such, salvation is impossible.

Confession of faith in Jesus Christ is necessary for salvation

ROM 10:9–10:10 See also MAT 10:32–10:33 parallel LUK 12:8–12:9; MRK 8:38; 2TI 2:12; 1JN 4:15, 1JN 2:23

Confessing Jesus Christ as Lord is only possible by the Holy Spirit

1CO 12:3

Results of confessing faith in Jesus Christ

Baptism

ACT 2:38–2:41 See also ACT 18:8, ACT 22:16

A change in lifestyle

MAT 7:21–7:23; 2TI 2:19 See also LUK 19:8–19:9; 1TI 6:12; HEB 13:15; 1JN 1:6, 1JN 2:4

Persecution

JHN 9:22 See also JHN 12:42–12:43; 2TI 3:12

Demons confessed Jesus Christ’s divinity

LUK 4:41 See also MAT 8:28–8:29 parallels MRK 5:7, LUK 8:28

Ultimately all will confess Jesus Christ’s lordship

PHP 2:9–2:11

Notable confessions of faith in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:49 See also MAT 14:33, MAT 16:16 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20; JHN 6:69, JHN 11:27, JHN 20:28

The refusal to confess Jesus Christ

MAT 10:32–10:33 parallel LUK 12:8–12:9 See also 2TI 2:12

8408: decision-making

The ability to arrive at a decision after due consideration of all the factors involved. The Christian life involves making decisions at many levels. Scripture offers guidance concerning how such decisions should be made, and provides examples of good and bad decision-making.

8409: decision-making, and providence

People need guidance from God about how they should make up their minds on difficult issues. God gives them this through the Holy Spirit, the Scriptures, individuals, groups and other external means.

Decisions should be grounded in a relationship with God

PRO 3:5–3:6 See also PSA 23:1–23:3, PSA 25:4–25:5, PSA 25:8–25:9, PSA 25:12; PRO 9:10 Wisdom involves making right moral decisions; MAT 6:31–6:33 parallel LUK 12:29–12:31

God guides decision-making

Through Scripture

2TI 3:16–3:17 See also PSA 19:7–19:11, PSA 119:9, PSA 119:11, PSA 119:98–119:100, PSA 119:104–119:105, PSA 119:130; MAT 4:4 parallel LUK 4:4; DEU 8:3; MAT 4:7 parallel LUK 4:12; DEU 6:16; MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8; DEU 6:13

Through supernatural intervention

ACT 18:9 See also GEN 28:10–28:15; 1SA 16:6–16:7, 1SA 16:12; ISA 30:19–30:21; JER 32:6–32:9; ACT 9:10–9:16, ACT

10:9–10:16, ACT 11:27–11:30, ACT 21:10–21:11, ACT 26:19; 1CO 14:29–14:30

Through prayer

JAS 1:5–1:6 See also 1KI 3:9–3:12; PRO 2:3–2:6; MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; MAT 21:22; EPH 6:18

Through circumstances

ACT 6:1–6:4 See also NUM 13:1–13:3; DEU 32:28–32:29; JOS 2:23–2:24; RUT 2:2–2:3; 1KI 3:26–3:28; ACT 15:19–15:22, ACT 16:3, ACT 20:3, ACT 20:16; 1CO 16:8–16:9

The work of the Holy Spirit in decision-making

JHN 14:16–14:17 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13–16:15; ACT 8:29, ACT 10:19, ACT 13:2, ACT 15:28, ACT 16:6–16:10; 1JN 2:20, 1JN 2:27

Motivation in decision-making

MAT 6:33; COL 3:17 See also PSA 139:23–139:24; MAT 20:25–20:28, MAT 23:23; ROM 12:1; 1CO 10:31; 2CO 5:9; PHP 4:8–4:9; 1TH 4:1, 1TH 5:8; 1PE 2:12, 1PE 4:11

Humility is essential for divine guidance

PSA 25:9 See also DEU 10:12–10:13; PSA 25:14, PSA 34:9–34:10, PSA 73:1, PSA 84:11; ISA 58:9–58:11; DAN 9:20–9:23

The need to test guidance

1TH 5:19–5:22

8410: decision-making, examples of

Scripture provides examples of good and bad decision-making, as well as offering guidance as to how decisions ought to be made.

Examples of good decision-making

JOS 24:15 See also GEN 13:8–13:9, GEN 35:2–35:4; EXO 18:24–18:25, EXO 32:26; RUT 1:15–1:16; 1SA 14:6–14:7, 1SA 24:4–24:7; NEH 4:21–4:23; EST 4:15–4:16; PSA 27:4; DAN 1:8, DAN 3:18; MAT 4:19–4:20; MRK 2:14 LUK 10:38–10:42, LUK 19:8; ACT 4:36–4:37, ACT 5:35–5:39; HEB 11:25–11:26

Examples of bad decision-making

GEN 3:6 See also GEN 12:10–12:13, GEN 13:10–13:11, GEN 16:1–16:3; EXO 32:1–32:4; NUM 13:31, NUM 16:1–16:3; JOS 7:21 Achan disobeyed the LORD's instructions; JDG 8:23–8:27, JDG 14:3, JDG 16:1; 1SA 13:8–13:9 Saul made the offering in Samuel's absence; 2SA 11:2–11:4; 1KI 12:8–12:15 Rehoboam followed bad advice; 2KI 24:1; HOS 2:5; JON 1:1–1:3; MRK 10:22; LUK 15:13; ACT 5:1–5:2, ACT 24:27; MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:4–22:6 Judas decided to betray Jesus Christ for money; MRK 15:1 parallel MAT 27:1–27:2 the decision to put Jesus Christ to death

The sovereignty of God in decision-making

GEN 50:19–50:20 See also GEN 45:8; NUM 24:13 Balaam could only curse or bless at the LORD's bidding; JDG 6:39–6:40, JDG 14:4; 1SA 2:25; 2CH 25:20; PSA 103:13–103:14; JOL 2:25–2:26; MIC 7:8–7:9 ACT 2:23–2:24, ACT 4:27–4:28 ROM 8:28–8:30

Decisions have to be made

DEU 30:19–30:20 See also 1KI 18:21; EZK 18:30; MAT 27:17, MAT 27:21; MRK 10:21; ACT 2:38–2:40, ACT 16:30–16:31; 2CO 1:15–1:17; GAL 3:2

Good decision-making involves consideration for others

MIC 6:8 See also JOB 31:16–31:23; ISA 1:17; JER 22:3; AMO 5:14–5:15; MAT 5:13–5:16, MAT 25:35–25:36; JAS 1:27

All decision-making must be subject to the will of God

JAS 4:13–4:15 See also PSA 127:1; MAT 26:39, MAT 26:42; LUK 12:16–12:21

8412: decisions

The end result of a process of reflection upon possible courses of action, informed and sustained by a concern to please God.

Factors that should affect believers' decision-making

Desire to know God's will

PSA 25:4–25:5 See also PSA 143:8; HOS 4:6 Ignoring God's will leads to destruction; JHN 10:27, JHN 14:15–14:17

Confidence in God's readiness to reveal his will

PSA 25:8–25:9 See also PSA 16:7, PSA 25:12–25:14, PSA 48:14, PSA 73:23–73:24; PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 30:19–30:21; JER 9:23–9:24

Belief in God's overall plan for his people

ROM 8:28–8:30 See also EPH 1:3–1:14; PHP 2:12–2:13; HEB 11:39–11:40

God's promise to guide believers in their decisions

ISA 58:11 See also PSA 32:8–32:9; ISA 42:16, ISA 48:17; JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13

Knowledge of scriptural principles

MRK 12:29–12:31 parallel MAT 22:35–22:40 See also DEU 6:4–6:5; LEV 19:18; EXO 20:1–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21; MAT 7:12 parallel LUK 6:31; ROM 13:9–13:10; GAL 5:14; JAS 2:8

A willingness to trust God

HEB 11:17–11:19 See also GEN 15:4–15:6; 2CH 20:20; PSA 25:1–25:2, PSA 31:5, PSA 143:8; ISA 12:2; LUK 1:45; ROM 4:3, ROM 4:20–4:24; GAL 2:16, GAL 2:20; HEB 11:1–11:39

8413: edification

The building up and strengthening in the faith of believers and churches. Believers are strengthened by God and are urged, too, to build up one another. The church is edified through God's word, through the Holy Spirit and the proper use of spiritual gifts, through the church's appointed ministries and through the mutual love, support and encouragement of its members.

God edifies his people by strengthening them

ISA 40:29–40:31; EZK 34:16 See also PSA 29:11, PSA 73:26; ISA 40:11, ISA 41:10; 2TH 2:16–2:17, 2TH 3:3; HEB 13:9

The edification of believers

God builds up the community of faith

1PE 2:4–2:5 See also JER 24:6–24:7, JER 31:4, JER 42:10; EPH 2:19–2:22

Believers are to build themselves up

JUD 1:20 See also COL 2:6–2:7

Believers are to build one another up

ROM 15:2 See also ROM 14:19; EPH 4:29; HEB 3:13

The means of edification

God's word

ACT 20:32 See also PSA 119:28; ROM 4:20 Abraham was strengthened in his faith by his acceptance of God's promise; ROM 15:4; 2TI 3:15–3:17; 1PE 2:2

The Holy Spirit

EPH 3:16 See also ACT 9:31

Spiritual gifts

1CO 14:26 See also ROM 1:11; 1CO 12:7, 1CO 14:3–14:4, 1CO 14:12

Appointed ministries

EPH 4:11–4:12 JER 3:15, JER 23:4; ; EZK 34:4; ; ZEC 11:16; ACT 15:41, ACT 18:23; ; 2CO 12:19; ACT 16:4–16:5 The message from the Jerusalem apostles results in believers being strengthened.; 2CO 10:8, 2CO 13:10

Love and encouragement

EPH 4:15–4:16; 1TH 5:11 See also ROM 1:12, ROM 14:20–14:21; 1CO 8:1, 1CO 8:10–8:13, 1CO 10:23–10:24; HEB 12:12–12:13; ISA 35:3–35:4

Examples of those who edified others

DEU 3:28 Moses; ; JOB 4:3–4:4 Job; ; ISA 40:1–40:2 Isaiah; ; LUK 22:32 Simon Peter; ; ACT 14:22 Paul and Barnabas; ; ACT 15:32 Judas and Silas; ; 1TH 3:2 Timothy; ; PHM 1:7 Philemon

The goal of edification

EPH 4:13 EPH 4:14; ; PHP 1:9–1:10; ; HEB 5:14; 1TH 3:13 Edification results in right living.

8414: encouragement

Giving someone confidence and courage to do something. Scripture encourages believers to trust in God and to rely on the enabling of the Holy Spirit.

8415: encouragement, examples of

Believers can encourage one another to have greater confidence in God and so to be bolder in living out their faith.

In the OT

2CH 32:6–32:7 King Hezekiah encourages his people. See also JDG 20:21–20:22; 1SA 23:16; 1CH 11:10; 2CH 30:22, 2CH 35:2 King Josiah; NEH 9:26; DAN 2:18; ZEC 8:20–8:22; MAL 3:16

In the NT

ACT 11:22–11:23; 1TH 2:11–2:12 See also ACT 4:36, ACT 13:43, ACT 14:21–14:22 Paul and Barnabas; ACT 15:32, ACT 16:40, ACT 18:27–18:28, ACT 20:1–20:2 after Paul's ministry in Ephesus; ROM 1:11–1:12 Paul to the church at Rome; 2CO 7:4, 2CO 7:13; EPH 6:21–6:22 Paul's fellow-worker, Tychicus; PHP 1:14 Paul in prison; COL 4:8; 1TH 3:2 Timothy; 1TH 3:7; PHM 1:7; HEB 13:22; 1PE 5:12

Encouragement as exhortation in the life of faith

COL 1:28 Paul describes his ministry. See also LUK 3:18 John the Baptist; ROM 12:1, ROM 15:30; 1CO 4:16, 1CO 16:15–16:16; 2CO 2:7–2:8 dealing with a repentant member; 2CO 6:1; EPH 4:1; 1TH 4:10; HEB 13:19; 1PE 2:11; JUD 1:3

Commands to encourage others

ISA 35:3–35:4 DEU 1:38, DEU 3:28; 2SA 19:7 to David; ; ISA 1:17; ; ROM 12:6–12:8, ROM 15:2; ; 1CO 14:12; ; COL 3:16; ; 1TH 4:18, 1TH 5:11, 1TH 5:14; ; 1TI 5:1; ; 2TI 4:2; ; TIT 1:9 the church overseer; ; TIT 2:15; ; HEB 3:13, HEB 10:25

Failure to encourage

EZK 34:4 Condemnation of Israel's leaders. See also JOB 16:2; PSA 69:20; ECC 4:1; EZK 16:49; ZEC 10:2

Refusing to be comforted

GEN 37:34–37:35 See also PSA 77:2; JER 31:15; MAT 2:18

Scripture censures those who encourage others to do evil

2CH 22:2–22:3 See also 2SA 11:25 after David and Joab had arranged Uriah's death; PSA 64:5 evildoers; ISA 41:7 makers of idols; JER 23:14, JER 29:8; EZK 13:22–13:23; 1CO 8:9–8:10

8416: encouragement, promises of God's

God promises continual support for his people, particularly when they become weary, depressed or disillusioned.

God's encouragement affirmed

PSA 10:17–10:18 See also 1CH 29:12; PSA 89:20–89:21; ISA 41:10, ISA 49:13; JER 29:11; ZEC 1:17; ACT 20:32; 1PE 5:10

Means by which God encourages believers

Meditation on his law and word

JOS 1:8–1:9; ROM 15:4 See also PSA 1:1–1:3; HEB 12:5

Experience of the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:16–14:17 The word used for Spirit here means "Counsellor" or "one who encourages or comforts". See also ACT 9:31; ROM 8:18–8:27; PHP 2:1

Experience of God's encouragement

2CO 4:16–4:18 See also 1SA 30:6; PSA 86:17; ISA 52:9; DAN 10:18–10:19; ACT 9:31, ACT 23:11; 2CO 1:3–1:4; 2TI 4:17; HEB 6:18, HEB 12:5; 1PE 1:3

God's encouragement experienced through the words and actions of others

JDG 7:11 Gideon and the dream of the Midianite soldier; ; 2CH 15:8; ; EZR 6:22 the returned exiles helped by the king of Assyria; ; ACT 28:15; ; 2CO 7:4, 2CO 7:13

Commands to be encouraged

1CO 16:13 See also DEU 31:6–31:8; JOS 1:6–1:8, JOS 1:18, JOS 10:25; 1CH 22:13, 1CH 28:20; 2CH 19:11, 2CH 32:7 King Hezekiah; EZR 10:4; PSA 27:14; ISA 54:2 growth of the nation of Israel after the exile; MAT 14:27 parallel MRK 6:50ACT 27:22, ACT 27:25, ACT 27:36

Effects of being encouraged

ISA 40:30–40:31 See also PSA 25:3; ROM 15:5; 1CO 14:3; 2CO 3:12; PHP 2:1–2:2; COL 2:2; 1TH 2:11–2:12

Prayers for encouragement

2TH 2:16–2:17 See also NEH 6:9; PSA 119:28; ISA 38:14; ROM 15:5–15:6; COL 1:10–1:12

8418: endurance

The ability to persevere in a task or calling. The Christian is called to endure in the face of trial or opposition, and his endurance brings spiritual rewards.

Endurance commended as a virtue for God's people

JOS 1:7; GAL 6:9 See also DEU 5:32; JOS 23:8; JOB 17:9; ACT 11:23, ACT 13:43, ACT 14:22; EPH 4:14; 1TI 6:11; 2TI 2:3; 1PE 2:20; REV 13:10

Endurance is a hallmark of true Christian profession

MAT 10:22 parallel MRK 13:13**LUK 9:62** See also ACT 20:24; 2TI 2:12

Christian endurance originates with God

ROM 15:5 See also 2CO 1:8–1:9; COL 1:10–1:11; 2TH 3:5

Christian endurance involves standing firm

1CO 15:58; PHP 1:27 See also GAL 5:1; PHP 4:1; 2TH 2:15; 2TI 3:14, 2TI 4:5

The results of enduring

Salvation

HEB 10:36; JAS 1:12 See also ROM 2:7, ROM 15:4; 1TI 4:16; 2TI 2:10; HEB 12:7–12:9

Protection

REV 3:10 See also 2TH 3:3–3:4

Spiritual fruit

JAS 1:4 See also LUK 8:15; ROM 5:3–5:5

Encouragement for others

2CO 1:6 See also 1PE 5:9; HEB 12:1–12:3; REV 1:9

Examples of endurance

PSA 123:3–123:4; ; 1CO 4:12; ; 1TH 1:3; ; 2TH 1:4; ; 2TI 3:10–3:11; ; JAS 5:11; ; REV 2:3

8419: enlightenment

The illumination of the mind, especially by the word of God, leading to delight and increased pleasure in God.

Enlightenment as God-given understanding and insight

PSA 43:3; MIC 7:8–7:9; JHN 8:12; EPH 1:18 See also 2SA 22:29; EZR 9:8; JOB 29:2–29:3; PSA 18:28, PSA 36:10, PSA 97:11; ISA 9:2, ISA 42:6, ISA 42:16, ISA 49:6, ISA 60:1; DAN 2:22; LUK 2:32; JHN 1:9, JHN 9:5, JHN 12:46; ACT 13:47, ACT 26:18, ACT 26:23; 2CO 4:6; HEB 6:4, HEB 10:32; 1PE 2:9

Enlightenment through the word of God

PSA 119:130 See also PSA 19:8; PRO 6:23; ISA 51:4; 2PE 1:19

God needs no enlightenment

ISA 40:14

8420: equipping

The providing of all necessary facilities for achieving a task. Scripture suggests that God does not provide tasks for believers without also providing the gifts which are needed to equip believers for those tasks.

8421: equipping, physical

Scripture provides illustrations of situations in which people are equipped to carry out physical actions.

Manual workers are equipped for their tasks

1KI 5:13–5:14 See also GEN 4:22, GEN 11:3, GEN 24:15; EXO 25:1–25:9; 1KI 5:10, 1KI 19:21; EZR 1:5–1:6; NEH 2:7–2:8

Musicians are equipped to play

ISA 30:29 See also GEN 4:21; JOS 6:4; 1SA 16:16–16:18; 1CH 25:6–25:7; PSA 150:3–150:5; REV 5:8, REV 15:2

Travellers are equipped for their journeys

2SA 12:4 See also GEN 42:25, GEN 45:19–45:23; NEH 2:7; JER 9:2; LUK 11:6

Those equipped with signs of authority

GEN 41:42 Joseph; ; GEN 49:10; ; EXO 4:17 Moses; ; EST 3:10 Haman; ; EST 4:11, EST 5:2; ; MAT 16:19; ; ACT 9:2

Equipping for burial

GEN 23:8–23:9; ; MRK 14:8; ; LUK 23:56; ; JHN 19:38–19:42

Soldiers are equipped for battle

Israel's armies

EXO 13:18 See also NUM 31:5, NUM 32:20–32:22; JOS 4:13, JOS 6:8; JDG 7:16; 1SA 17:36–17:39; 1KI 4:26; 1CH 12:2; 2CH 14:8

David

1SA 17:40 See also 1SA 22:9–22:10; 2SA 22:40 parallel PSA 18:39

Israel's enemies

EXO 14:6–14:7 See also 1SA 17:5–17:7; 2SA 21:16; JER 6:23, JER 46:4, JER 50:42; DAN 11:13; MAT 26:47 parallel MRK 14:43

Those providing protection are equipped

NEH 4:16–4:18; ; ACT 23:23–23:25

8422: equipping, spiritual

Scripture provides examples of individuals who have been equipped to carry out tasks or responsibilities of a spiritual nature.

Jesus Christ was equipped for his work

ISA 61:1–61:2 See also PSA 72:1; ISA 50:4–50:7; MAT 12:18; ISA 42:1; LUK 4:18–4:19, LUK 19:31; JHN 3:34; ACT 10:38; HEB 10:5

God's people are equipped for service

In the OT

EXO 4:10–4:12 EXO 31:1–31:6, EXO 35:30–36:2; LEV 8:7–8:9; ; JDG 3:10; JDG 6:14, JDG 6:34; JDG 11:29, JDG 14:19 Samson; ; 1SA 10:10; 1KI 3:7–3:9; ; 2CH 2:12; 2KI 2:9 Elisha; ; NEH 13:9; ; ISA 6:6–6:7; ; JER 1:9; ; EZK 1:1, EZK 3:23

In the NT

2TI 2:20–2:21 See also MAT 4:19; LUK 1:15 John the Baptist; LUK 1:41, LUK 1:67 Zechariah; LUK 12:33; ACT 4:8 Peter; ACT 6:3, ACT 9:17 Ananias; ACT 11:24 Barnabas; ROM 13:12; EPH 4:12, EPH 6:11–6:18; PHP 4:19; 2TI 3:16–3:17; HEB 13:20–13:21; 1PE 3:15

Believers are equipped for spiritual tasks

By the call of Jesus Christ

MAT 4:19 parallel MRK 1:17 See also MRK 10:24–10:31; LUK 9:1–9:2, LUK 10:1–10:3; JHN 1:35–1:42

By spiritual gifts

1CO 12:7 See also ACT 6:3–6:6; ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:8–12:11, 1CO 12:27–12:31; EPH 4:7, EPH 4:11–4:12

By the word of God

2TI 2:15 See also COL 3:16; 2TI 3:16–3:17; 2PE 1:19; 1JN 2:14

By the empowering of the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:4, ACT 4:31, ACT 13:9; ; EPH 5:18

For spiritual conflict

EPH 6:11 See also ROM 13:12; EPH 4:20–4:24, EPH 6:12–6:18; COL 3:12–3:15; 1TH 5:8; 1TI 6:12; HEB 13:21; 1PE 3:15

8424: evangelism

The proclamation of the good news of Jesus Christ, which arises naturally from believers' love for God and appreciation of all that God has done for them. The NT stresses the importance of evangelism, and provides guidance as to how it should be carried out.

8425: evangelism, nature of

Evangelism focuses on the proclaiming of the good news of the coming of the kingdom of God in Christ,

including the forgiveness of sins and the hope of eternal life, through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.

Evangelism as the proclamation of good news

ISA 52:7; MRK 16:15 See also 2SA 18:31; 2KI 7:9; ISA 40:9; ISA 41:27; NAM 1:15; ACT 14:7, ACT 14:15; ROM 10:15; ROM 15:16; 1TI 2:7; 2TI 1:11

Jesus Christ as the focus of evangelism

The gospel message is revealed by God

GAL 1:11–1:12 See also ROM 16:25–16:26; GAL 1:15–1:16; EPH 3:3–3:6

The gospel message centres on Jesus Christ

MRK 1:1; EPH 3:8 See also LUK 1:19, LUK 2:10, LUK 3:16–3:18; ACT 11:20; ROM 1:9; 2CO 4:4

The announcement of God's kingdom

ACT 28:31 See also MAT 24:14; MRK 1:14–1:15; LUK 4:43, LUK 8:1, LUK 9:2; ACT 8:12

God's promises are fulfilled in Jesus Christ

LUK 4:18–4:19 See also ISA 61:1–61:2; MAT 11:3–11:5 parallel LUK 7:20–7:22; ACT 5:42, ACT 8:35, ACT 9:22, ACT 13:32–13:33; ROM 1:2–1:4

Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

1CO 15:3–15:4 See also ACT 2:22–2:24, ACT 3:15, ACT 17:18; 1CO 15:14, 1CO 1:23; 2TI 2:8

The announcement of God's salvation

ROM 1:16–1:17 See also PSA 40:10, PSA 96:2–96:3 parallel 1CH 16:23–16:24; 1CO 1:21, 1CO 15:1–15:2; EPH 1:13; 2TH 2:13–2:14

The call to repentance for the forgiveness of sins

LUK 24:47 See also MAT 4:17, MAT 12:41 parallel LUK 11:32; MRK 1:4 parallels MAT 3:2, LUK 3:3; ACT 2:38

The announcement of peace with God

ACT 10:36 See also EPH 2:17–2:18, EPH 6:15

Evangelism and miracles

MAT 4:23 Miracles are part of the gospel proclamation, demonstrating that the kingdom of God has come; **1CO 2:4–2:5** See also MAT 9:35, MAT 10:7–10:8; LUK 9:6, LUK 11:20; ROM 15:18–15:19; 1TH 1:5; HEB 2:3–2:4

8426: evangelism, motivation for

Evangelism arises from a natural response to the grace of God, a concern for those who have yet to hear the good news and a desire to be faithful to the great commission to bring the good news to the ends of the earth. Evangelism is guided and directed by the Holy Spirit.

Motives for evangelism

Recognising God's call

2TI 1:11 See also ISA 6:8–6:9; JON 1:1–1:2; ACT 22:14–22:15; 2CO 4:1; 1TI 2:7

A divine compulsion

1CO 9:16–9:17 See also JER 20:9; AMO 3:8; ACT 4:20

A God-given responsibility

EZK 3:17–3:20 See also EZK 33:7–33:9; 1CO 3:10–3:15; 2CO 5:10–5:11

A desire to win the lost

ROM 10:1; 1CO 9:19–9:23 See also ACT 20:19–20:20; ROM 1:14–1:15, ROM 9:1–9:3, ROM 11:14, ROM 15:17–15:20; 2CO 5:20

A recognition of coming judgment

JUD 1:23 See also JAS 5:20; 2PE 3:9

Responding to God's grace

2CO 5:14–5:15 See also 2CO 5:18–5:19; EPH 3:7; 1TI 1:12–1:16

Confidence in the gospel

ROM 1:16–1:17 See also ISA 55:10–55:11; 1CO 1:17–1:18; 2CO 10:4–10:5; 2TI 1:8–1:9

God directs and guides evangelism

Divine guidance in evangelism

ACT 8:26–8:29, ACT 16:6–16:10 See also ACT 5:19–5:20, ACT 9:10–9:11, ACT 10:19–10:20, ACT 11:12, ACT 13:2, ACT 18:9–18:11

God opens the door for evangelism

2CO 2:12 See also ACT 14:27; 1CO 16:9; COL 4:3; REV 3:8

Areas of ministry assigned by God

GAL 2:7–2:9 See also ACT 9:15

The Holy Spirit empowers evangelism

ACT 1:8 See also MAT 10:19–10:20 parallels MRK 13:11, LUK 12:11–12:12; JHN 15:26–15:27; 1TH 1:5

Evangelism as a result of persecution

ACT 8:4–8:5 See also ACT 11:19–11:21, ACT 13:50–13:51, ACT 14:6–14:7, ACT 18:2

8427: evangelism, kinds of

Scripture recognises that evangelism takes place in a variety of contexts, and offers models for evangelism in today's church.

Public evangelism

Preaching in synagogues

ACT 14:1 Paul begins his evangelism in Gentile cities by building links within the Jewish community. ACT

13:14–13:16, ACT 13:42–13:44; ACT 17:2 in Thessalonica; ; ACT 17:10 in Berea; ; ACT 17:17 in Athens; ; ACT 18:4 in Corinth; ; ACT 19:8 in Ephesus

Preaching in recognised meeting-places

ACT 17:19–17:23 See also ACT 5:25, ACT 10:27–10:28, ACT 16:13, ACT 19:9

Making a public defence to accusers

ACT 21:37–22:1 See also ACT 4:7–4:12, ACT 7:1–7:2, ACT 24:10, ACT 26:1

Personal evangelism

Giving personal testimony

1JN 1:1–1:3 See also MRK 5:19; JHN 4:39; ACT 26:9–26:18; 1CO 7:16; 1PE 3:1–3:2

Evangelism in homes

ACT 10:24–10:25 Peter visits Cornelius' home to speak to those assembled. LUK 5:29; ; ACT 18:26, ACT 28:30–28:31; ACT 9:17 parallel ACT 22:12; ; ACT 16:32–16:34

Evangelism in strategic areas

Going to major centres

ACT 16:12 Philippi; ; ACT 17:1 Thessalonica; ; ACT 17:15 Athens; ; ACT 18:1 Corinth; ; ACT 18:19 Ephesus; ACT 23:11, ACT 28:14

Going into new territories

ROM 15:20, ROM 15:23–15:24; ; 2CO 10:15–10:16

Evangelism among strategic people

Speaking to prominent people

ACT 18:8 Though the gospel is for all people without distinction, evangelism among certain people and groups enabled the message to spread further. See also ACT 13:7 Paul before Sergius Paulus, proconsul of Cyprus; ACT 24:24 Paul before Felix and his wife; ACT 25:8–25:9 Paul before Festus; ACT 25:11–25:12 Paul appeals to Caesar; ACT 26:2–26:3 Paul before King Agrippa; ACT 28:7–28:8 Paul in the home of the chief official on Malta

Evangelising households

ACT 16:34 The conversion of the head of the household was often accompanied by the conversion of the whole family group. See also JHN 4:53; ACT 11:14, ACT 18:8

Using literature in evangelism

JHN 20:30–20:31 See also LUK 1:1–1:4; ACT 1:1–1:2

Appealing to Scripture in evangelism

ACT 26:22–26:23 See also ACT 8:35, ACT 10:43, ACT 13:22–13:23; ROM 1:2–1:3, ROM 16:25–16:26; 1CO 15:3–15:4

Signs and wonders in evangelism

Miracles confirm the message

ACT 8:6 See also MRK 16:17–16:20; ACT 4:14, ACT 19:10–19:12; 1CO 2:4–2:5; HEB 2:3–2:4

Miracles give opportunity for preaching

ACT 3:9–3:16 See also ACT 2:5–2:14, ACT 14:8–14:11, ACT 16:26–16:31

Miracles result in people believing

ACT 9:40–9:42 See also JHN 7:31, JHN 11:45; ACT 9:33–9:35, ACT 13:10–13:12

The response to evangelism

Acceptance of the message

ACT 2:37–2:41 See also ACT 4:4, ACT 17:4, ACT 17:34, ACT 19:17–19:20; 1TH 2:13

Rejection of the message

HEB 4:2 See also ROM 10:16; ACT 13:50–13:51, ACT 17:32, ACT 18:6

8428: example

A person who acts as an illustration or model. Scripture provides examples of both good and bad conduct for the guidance of believers.

Scripture provides examples to inform and warn believers

Israel is an example to believers

1CO 10:6 See also 1CO 10:11

Job as an example of perseverance and patience

JAS 5:10–5:11

The example of Jesus Christ is of special importance to Christians

JHN 13:15; 1CO 11:1 See also MAT 11:29, MAT 16:24; PHP 2:5–2:11; 1TI 1:16; HEB 3:1–3:2, HEB 12:2; 1PE 2:21

The apostles set an example for believers to follow

PHP 3:17 See also 2TH 3:7

Christian leaders are to provide examples to their people

1PE 5:3; TIT 2:7 See also 1TI 4:12

Examples drawn from everyday life

GAL 3:15; ; JAS 3:4

Biblical examples to be imitated

Faith

MAT 15:22 a Canaanite woman; ; JHN 4:4–4:29 a Samaritan woman; ; JHN 20:24–20:29 doubting Thomas; ; ROM 4:18–4:21 Abraham; ; HEB 11:4–11:38 various OT figures

Forgiving one's enemies and assailants

GEN 33:1–33:11 Esau; ; GEN 45:5–45:15 Joseph; ; 1SA 24:8–24:22 David; ; LUK 23:34 Jesus Christ; ; ACT 7:59 Stephen

Generous giving

RUT 2:15–2:19 Boaz; ; JOB 29:11–29:16 Job; ; MRK 12:41–12:44 a widow; ; ACT 10:2 Cornelius

Praise

EXO 15:1–15:2 Moses; ; EXO 18:9–18:12 Jethro; ; 1CH 29:10–29:13 David; ; DAN 2:19–2:23 Daniel; ; LUK 1:57–1:68 Zechariah

Biblical examples to be avoided

LEV 20:23; ; PRO 22:24–22:25; ; EZK 20:18; ; HEB 4:11; ; 2PE 3:17

8429: fasting

Abstaining from food, and possibly drink, for a limited period of time as a mark of religious commitment and devotion or as an expression of repentance for sins.

8430: fasting, nature of

Scripture frequently refers to individuals fasting and describes the different kinds of fast which may be undertaken.

Kinds of fasting**Abstaining from food and drink**

EZR 10:6 See also DAN 9:3; ACT 23:12

Abstaining from food only

1SA 1:7 See also DAN 6:18

The duration of fasting**One day: the normal fast period**

LEV 23:32; ; JDG 20:26; ; 2SA 1:12

Three days

EST 4:16; ; ACT 9:9

Seven days

1SA 31:13 parallel 1CH 10:12; ; 2SA 12:16–12:20

Forty days

These 40-day fasts are all in unique circumstances and are not prescribed: EXO 34:28; ; 1KI 19:8; ; MAT 4:2 parallel LUK 4:2

Regular observances of fasting**Those prescribed by the Law**

LEV 16:29–16:31 NIV footnote at verse 29. See also LEV 23:26–23:32; NUM 29:7; ACT 27:9

Those observed in Jewish tradition

ZEC 8:19 See also EST 9:30–9:31; ZEC 7:2–7:5

Those observed by the Pharisees

LUK 18:11–18:12

Involuntary fasts**Those imposed by decree**

2CH 20:3 See also 1SA 14:24 1KI 13:8–13:9, 1KI 13:16 1KI 21:9; JER 36:9

Those imposed by circumstances

ACT 27:33; ; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:27

Voluntary fasts

NEH 1:4 See also LUK 2:37

8431: fasting, reasons for

Scripture identifies a number of situations in which fasting is appropriate.

Situations in which fasting is appropriate**Bereavement**

1CH 10:11–10:12 parallel 1SA 31:11–31:13 See also 2SA 1:11–1:12, 2SA 3:31–3:35

Distress

EST 4:3 See also 1SA 1:7, 1SA 20:34; 1KI 21:4–21:6; PSA 109:24; DAN 6:18; ACT 27:33

Penitence

1SA 7:5–7:6 See also NEH 9:1–9:3; DAN 9:3–9:6 Daniel identifies himself with the sin of the people; DAN 9:20; JOL 1:13–1:14, JOL 2:12–2:15; JON 3:5–3:9

Seeking God's intervention

2SA 12:15–12:17 See also 2CH 20:2–20:4; EZR 8:21; EST 4:15–4:16; PSA 35:13–35:14

Seeking guidance

JDG 20:26–20:28 See also DEU 9:9 Moses fasts before the revelation of the Law; DAN 9:1–9:3, DAN 9:20–9:23, DAN 10:1–10:2, DAN 10:12; ACT 13:1–13:3 The church receives direction through the Holy Spirit while fasting.

Indicating earnestness

ACT 23:12–23:13

8432: fasting, practice of

Although fasting is a negative practice, it is not an end in itself but is to be undertaken for a positive purpose.

Fasting is not an end in itself**Fasting as empty ritual is condemned**

JER 14:11–14:12 See also ISA 58:1–58:7; ZEC 7:4–7:7

Fasting as mere show is condemned

MAT 6:16–6:18 See also MAT 9:14–9:15 parallels MRK 2:18–2:20, LUK 5:33–5:35 Jesus Christ repudiated fast-

ing for its own sake whilst granting that there is a time and a place for it.

Fasting imposed for false motives

1SA 14:24–14:30

Attitudes appropriate to fasting

Humility

PSA 35:13 See also 1KI 21:27–21:29; EZR 8:21; PSA 69:10

Repentance

ISA 7:6 See also NEH 9:1–9:3; JOL 1:13–1:14, JOL 2:12–2:15

Fasting and prayer

NEH 1:4 See also EZR 8:21–8:23; PSA 35:13; DAN 9:3; MAT 17:20 parallel MRK 9:29; LUK 2:37, LUK 5:33; ACT 13:3, ACT 14:23; 1CO 7:3–7:5 The motivation here is similar to that in abstaining from food.

Fasting and worship

ACT 13:2 See also LUK 2:37

8434: giving

Dedicating or offering something or oneself to others or to God. Scripture stresses the importance of giving. The generosity and love of God in giving his only Son to die for his people is understood to lead to an obligation, on their part, to love God and others in return.

8435: giving, of oneself

The submission of the self to the will of God, in thanksgiving and service.

Jesus Christ's self-giving as an example to believers

1JN 3:16 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; MRK 10:45; JHN 15:13; ROM 15:3; GAL 1:4; EPH 5:1–5:2, EPH 5:25; PHP 2:5–2:8; TIT 2:14

Why self-giving is reasonable service to God

God's people belong to him by creation

DEU 32:6 See also PSA 100:3; REV 4:11

God's people belong to him by redemption

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also REV 5:9

All good things are given by God

1CH 29:14 See also DEU 8:18; ACT 17:25; 1CO 4:7; 1TI 6:17

God's people giving themselves

To God

ROM 12:1 See also 2CO 8:5

To one another

2CO 8:5 See also 1CO 16:15

To holy living

ROM 6:19 See also PRO 23:26; ROM 12:1

To the service of God

1CO 15:58 See also JDG 5:2; 1CH 29:5; 2CH 17:16; PSA 40:7–40:8; ISA 6:8; ACT 6:4; ROM 1:9; 1TI 4:15

To a life of self-denial

LUK 14:33 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; LUK 14:26; ROM 15:2; 1CO 8:13, 1CO 10:33; 2CO 12:15; PHP 3:8

To martyrdom

DAN 3:28 See also ACT 20:24, ACT 21:13; REV 12:11

Rewards of self-giving

MAT 10:39 See also MAT 19:27–19:29 parallels MRK 10:28–10:30, LUK 18:28–18:30; MRK 8:35 parallel LUK 17:33

The giving of thanks

PSA 50:23 See also 1CH 16:8; EPH 5:4; PHP 4:4–4:7; COL 2:7, COL 3:15; HEB 12:28

8436: giving, of possessions

Making one's possession available for God's service in the way in which he directs, as a practical recognition that all possessions come from him.

Ministries that require the giving of material possessions

The relief of the poor

PRO 28:27 See also LEV 25:25; DEU 15:7–15:8; ISA 58:7; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 12:33; ROM 12:13; GAL 2:10

The support of God's servants

1TI 5:17–5:18 See also NUM 3:48, NUM 5:9; 2KI 4:8–4:10; MAT 10:10; GAL 6:6; PHP 4:15–4:18

The care of widows and orphans

JAS 1:27 See also DEU 26:12; RUT 2:5–2:12; 1TI 5:3–5:4

Motives for the giving of material possessions

Obedience to God

2CO 9:7 See also EXO 30:11–30:16; LEV 12:6–12:8; DEU 14:28; MAL 3:8–3:10; MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; ROM 13:6–13:7

Gratitude for God's generosity

1CH 29:14 See also GEN 28:20–28:22; DEU 26:9–26:10; 1SA 1:27–1:28

Love for others

1JN 3:17 See also 2CH 28:15; MAT 7:9–7:11; LUK 10:33–10:35

The manner of giving material possessions

Willingly and cheerfully

MAT 10:8 See also EXO 25:2, EXO 35:5, EXO 35:22; 2KI 12:4; 1CH 29:6, 1CH 29:9, 1CH 29:17; 2CH 24:10, 2CH 35:7–35:9; EZR 8:28; 2CO 8:11–8:12

Unostentatiously

MAT 6:1–6:4

Regularly

1CO 16:2

Generously

EXO 36:5; ; NUM 7:13; ; 1CH 29:3–29:4; ; LUK 6:38; ; 2CO 8:2–8:3; ; 1TI 6:18

God measures his people's giving

With a reckoning different from the world's

2CH 6:8; ; MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4

With regard for people's capacity to give

LEV 14:30, LEV 27:8; ; DEU 16:17; ; EZR 2:69; ; ACT 11:29; ; 2CO 8:12

God rewards the giver appropriately

PHP 4:18–4:19 See also 2CH 31:10; PRO 11:25, PRO 22:9, PRO 28:27; ECC 11:1 encouragement to be enterprising in giving; ISA 58:10; MAT 10:42, MAT 25:34–25:36; LUK 16:9; ACT 20:35; 2CO 9:6

God's reward overwhelming the giver

PRO 3:9–3:10 See also MAL 3:10; LUK 6:38

God's giving: the model for his people's giving

MAT 10:8 See also 2CO 8:8–8:9, 2CO 9:15

8437: giving, of talents

All human abilities and skills derive from God and are to be dedicated to his glory and the good of others.

Talents are given and sustained by God

1CO 4:7 EXO 28:3, EXO 31:3–31:6, EXO 35:31–35:35, EXO 36:1–36:2; DEU 8:18; ; 2SA 22:34–22:35; ; PSA 18:33–18:34; ; MAT 25:15 parallel LUK 19:13; ; ACT 7:10; ; ROM 12:6; ; 1CO 12:7–12:8; ; 2CO 3:5; ; EPH 3:7, EPH 4:7

Talents differ

MAT 25:15 See also 2CH 2:13–2:14; ROM 12:6; 1CO 7:7, 1CO 12:4–12:6; EPH 4:11

Talents need to be developed

2TI 1:6 See also MAT 25:16–25:30 parallel LUK 19:12–19:26; 1TI 4:14

Talents are to be devoted to God

For his own glory

1PE 4:11 See also EXO 35:10, EXO 35:25; 1KI 7:40; 1CH 9:13; PSA 33:2–33:3, PSA 137:4–137:5; 1CO 10:31

For the good of others

1PE 4:10 See also 1CO 12:7, 1CO 14:12; EPH 4:12

Talents are to be accounted for

MAT 25:19 parallel LUK 19:15 See also MAT 21:34 parallels MRK 12:2, LUK 20:10; LUK 12:48

Rewards according to use or misuse of talents

MAT 25:21 See also MAT 25:23–25:30 parallel LUK 19:17–19:26

8438: giving, of time

People are stewards of a deposit of time given by God, and will be held responsible for the way in which they use it.

Time is governed by God

God determines every lifespan

JOB 14:5 See also PSA 31:15, PSA 74:16–74:17, PSA 139:16; ACT 17:26

God will demand an account of how time has been spent

ECC 3:17 See also MAT 12:36; 1PE 4:3–4:5

Time may be squandered

In ungodly living

1PE 4:3 See also JOL 2:25; EPH 2:2–2:3; COL 3:5–3:7

By neglecting God-given opportunities

JER 8:20 See also PRO 20:4; MAT 25:11–25:12; LUK 13:25, LUK 19:44; ACT 24:25; REV 2:21

Time may be saved

By understanding its brevity

PSA 90:12 See also JHN 12:35; 1CO 7:29–7:31

By remembering its uncertainty

JHN 9:4 See also ECC 8:5–8:7; JAS 4:13–4:15

By making the most of present opportunities

EPH 5:16 See also PSA 32:6; ECC 12:1; EST 4:14; MAT 4:17; MRK 1:15; 2CO 6:1–6:2; GAL 6:10; COL 4:5; HEB 3:7–3:13

By allocating it wisely

1CH 12:32 See also EXO 18:13–18:26; ACT 6:1–6:4

Time is to be spent wisely

In worship and meditation

PSA 119:164 See also PSA 4:4, PSA 55:17; LAM 3:40; DAN 6:10, DAN 6:13; MRK 1:35; 1CO 11:28

In work

PSA 104:23 See also EXO 20:9 parallel DEU 5:13; ROM 13:6

In rest

EXO 20:8–20:10 See also LEV 16:29; MRK 6:31

With one's family

DEU 24:5 See also DEU 6:7; ECC 9:9; 1TI 3:4

In fellowship

1CO 16:7 See also ACT 2:42, ACT 20:7; HEB 10:25

Time is to be allocated according to priorities

LUK 10:41–10:42 See also PSA 1:1–1:3; HAG 1:2–1:4; MAT 6:33; ACT 13:46–13:47, ACT 17:16–17:17

8440: glorifying God

The giving of glory to God through acts of praise and obedience. Believers are to glorify God in their lives, as Jesus Christ glorified him in his life.

Believers are to glorify God

PSA 96:1–96:9 parallel 1CH 16:23–16:29 **ISA 42:12** See also ISA 43:5–43:7, ISA 66:18–66:19; HAB 2:14

God is entitled to be glorified

PSA 96:4–96:9 parallel 1CH 16:25–16:29 See also PSA 29:1–29:2, PSA 115:1; ISA 24:14–24:15

Glorifying God is the believer's natural response to him

PSA 118:28 See also PSA 34:3, PSA 69:30, PSA 86:12

God is glorified in Jesus Christ

JHN 13:31 See also JHN 14:13, JHN 17:4

Reasons for glorifying God

His holiness

PSA 99:9 See also REV 15:4

His great deeds

PSA 86:8–86:10 See also ISA 25:1; 2CO 4:13–4:15

His loving mercy

PSA 63:3 See also PSA 115:1; ROM 15:8–15:9

His righteous judgments

REV 14:7 See also EZK 28:22–28:23; ROM 11:33–11:36; REV 11:13

Means of glorifying God

By praising God

REV 4:11, REV 7:12 See also LUK 2:13; ROM 11:33–11:36, ROM 16:27; HEB 13:20–13:21; 1PE 4:11; 2PE 3:18; JUD 1:25

By living for God

1CO 10:31 See also ROM 4:20; 1CO 6:20; 2TH 1:11–1:12; 1PE 4:10–4:13

By doing good works and bearing fruit

JHN 15:8; PHP 1:9–1:11 See also MAT 5:16; GAL 5:22–5:26; HEB 13:20–13:21; 1PE 2:12

Examples of glorifying God

1CH 29:10–29:13 David; ; DAN 4:34–4:37 Nebuchadnezzar; ; LUK 1:46 Mary, the mother of Jesus Christ; ; LUK 2:13 the angels; ; LUK 2:20 the shepherds; JHN 13:31–13:32, JHN 17:1–17:4; REV 4:11, REV 7:12

8441: goals

Jesus Christ's basic aim was to do his Father's will. Believers have the same objective, which Jesus Christ and the Holy Spirit enable them to achieve.

God's goals

To live with his people

LEV 26:11–26:12 See also PSA 23:6; ZEC 2:10; JHN 14:23; REV 21:3

To build his church in Christ

MAT 16:18 See also EPH 2:19–2:22; REV 21:2

To perfect his church in Christ

EPH 5:26–5:27 See also PSA 138:8; PHP 1:6; COL 2:10

Jesus Christ's goals

To do his Father's will

JHN 6:38 See also MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; JHN 4:34, JHN 5:30; HEB 10:7, HEB 10:9

To preach the gospel

LUK 4:43 parallel MRK 1:38 See also LUK 4:18–4:19; ISA 61:1–61:2

To save the lost

LUK 19:10 See also MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; LUK 15:7 parallel MAT 18:14; LUK 15:10

Jesus Christ achieved his goals

JHN 17:4 See also LUK 13:32; JHN 12:31, JHN 19:28, JHN 19:30

Believers' goals

To please God

2CO 5:9 See also ROM 14:18; EPH 5:10, EPH 5:17; COL 1:9–1:10

To know God**PHP 3:8** See also JHN 17:3; PHP 3:10; 2PE 3:18**To be faithful to Jesus Christ****JHN 15:4** See also MAT 10:22 parallel MRK 13:13; MAT 24:13; PHP 3:14; 2TI 4:7; HEB 12:2; REV 2:26**To love one another****JHN 13:34** See also MAT 22:34–22:40 parallels MRK 12:28–12:31, LUK 10:25–10:28; JHN 15:12; 1CO 13:13, 1CO 16:14; 1TI 1:5; 1JN 4:11–4:12**To live at peace****ROM 12:18** See also MRK 9:50; 2CO 13:11; 1TH 4:11**To spread the gospel****MAT 28:19–28:20** See also ACT 20:24; ROM 11:14, ROM 15:20; 1CO 9:16; 2TI 4:2**To grow to maturity****EPH 4:13** See also MAT 5:48; ROM 8:29; 2CO 3:18, 2CO 7:1, 2CO 13:11**Believers' final goal is heaven****REV 7:9–7:10** See also JHN 6:40; 1CO 15:51–15:52; 2CO 5:4–5:5; 1TH 4:17; 1JN 3:2**God guarantees that believers will reach their goal****JHN 14:2–14:3** See also JHN 6:39; ROM 8:38–8:39; EPH 1:13–1:14; PHP 1:6; 2TI 1:12, 2TI 2:11–2:13; REV 3:5, REV 3:21**8442: good works**

Acts designed specifically to benefit others, which are characteristic of God. He requires and enables his people to do good, although such is contrary to their sinful human nature. Salvation does not depend on good works, but leads to them.

Good works are characteristic of God**JER 32:36–32:40** See also PSA 119:17, PSA 119:65, PSA 125:1–125:4; JER 32:41; MIC 2:7; ZEC 8:14–8:15; ACT 10:37–10:38**Good works are unnatural for sinful human beings****JER 13:23** See also PSA 5:9, PSA 10:7, PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3; PSA 36:1–36:4, PSA 140:3; ECC 7:20; ISA 59:7–59:8; JER 4:22; ROM 3:9–3:18, ROM 7:13–7:23**God's people are encouraged to do good works****GAL 6:9–6:10** See also PSA 37:3; ECC 3:12; MAT 5:38–5:48 parallel LUK 6:27–6:36; 1PE 3:8–3:13; PSA 34:12–34:16; 1PE 4:19**God is pleased with the good works of his people****HEB 13:16** See also 1PE 2:20, 1PE 2:15, 1PE 3:17**Good works will be rewarded****JHN 5:28–5:29** See also LUK 6:35; ROM 2:5–2:11; GAL 6:9–6:10; 1TI 6:17–6:19**Good works as evidence of repentance****PSA 34:14** See also PSA 37:27; 2TI 2:20–2:21; JAS 2:14–2:21, JAS 2:26, JAS 3:13; 1PE 3:10–3:12**Good works as evidence of God's grace in the lives of believers****2CO 9:8** See also ACT 9:36; PHP 2:12–2:13; COL 1:10–1:12**Good works are the purpose of the new creation****EPH 2:10** See also 2TI 2:21, 2TI 3:16–3:17; 1PE 2:13–2:15**Jesus Christ criticised for doing good works on the Sabbath****MAT 12:9–12:14** parallels MRK 3:1–3:6, LUK 6:6–6:11 See also LUK 13:10–13:17; JHN 9:1–9:41**8443: growth**

The process of development and maturing, used to refer to the progress of the kingdom of God and the spiritual development of believers. Scripture uses images of growth (such as seeds, plants and infants) to stress the dynamic nature of personal faith and the kingdom of God.

Images of growth**Infancy to maturity****EPH 4:13–4:15** See also 1CO 3:1–3:2, 1CO 13:11, 1CO 14:20; HEB 5:12–5:14; 1PE 2:2**Seeds and plants****LUK 8:14–8:15** parallels MAT 13:22–13:23, MRK 4:19–4:20 See also 2CO 9:10**The apostles worked and prayed for growth in believers****2CO 13:9** See also COL 1:28, COL 4:12**Dimensions of spiritual growth****In faith****2CO 10:15–10:16** See also 2TH 1:3**In knowledge****2PE 3:18** See also EPH 1:17–1:18, EPH 3:16–3:19; COL 1:10; 2PE 1:3, 2PE 1:6**In love****1TH 4:10** See also PHP 1:9; 1TH 3:12; 2PE 1:7–1:8**Growth comes from God****COL 2:19** See also 1CO 3:6–3:7; 2CO 9:10; PHP 1:6

Growth comes through discipleship

Putting away the sinful self

1PE 2:1 See also ROM 8:13–8:14; 2CO 7:1; GAL 5:24; EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:5–3:10

Moving on from basic teaching

HEB 6:1–6:2 See also HEB 5:11–5:14

Maturing in thinking

1CO 14:20 See also ROM 12:1

Persevering in faith

JAS 1:4 See also PHP 2:12, PHP 3:12; 2PE 1:5–1:8

Contributing to growth in the church by exercising gifts

EPH 4:11–4:12 See also 1CO 14:1–14:5; EPH 4:13–4:16

Examples of spiritual growth in some of God's servants

ISA 2:26; LUK 2:52 See also LUK 1:80; ACT 9:22

The growth of the kingdom of God

God promises that his kingdom will grow

COL 1:6 See also MAT 13:31–13:33 parallels MRK 4:30–4:32, LUK 13:18–13:21; MRK 4:26–4:29

The early church experienced rapid numerical growth

ACT 4:4 See also ACT 2:41, ACT 2:47, ACT 5:14, ACT 6:7, ACT 9:31, ACT 11:21, ACT 14:1, ACT 16:5

8444: honouring God

Giving the reverence and respect to God which is his due. All God's people have a duty to honour him in every aspect of their lives, while unbelievers and even animals can also honour him.

God's people must honour him

PSA 22:23 See also MAL 1:6, MAL 2:1–2:2; JHN 5:22–5:23

Ways of honouring God

By worshipping him

DAN 4:34 See also ISA 43:22–43:24; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15–6:16; REV 4:8–4:11, REV 5:6–5:14, REV 7:9–7:12

By holy living

1CO 6:18–6:20 See also ROM 12:1–12:2; 2CO 8:23; EPH 5:1–5:3; 1TH 4:7–4:8; 1PE 1:15–1:16

By keeping the Sabbath and religious feasts

LEV 19:30 See also EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15; EXO 12:42, EXO 31:12–31:17; LEV 26:2; ISA 58:13–58:14

By showing kindness to others

PRO 14:31 See also DEU 26:12–26:15; MAT 10:40–10:42

By honouring his name and his word

ACT 19:13–19:17 See also JDG 13:17; ISA 26:13; MAL 3:16; ACT 13:48; 2TH 3:1

By acknowledging him as God

DAN 3:28–3:29 See also ISA 6:4–6:5; ISA 43:20; REV 14:7

By giving tithes and offerings to him

PRO 3:9–3:10 See also DEU 26:1–26:11; MAL 3:6–3:12; 2CO 8:19–8:21

By proclaiming his deeds

ISA 63:7 See also 1CH 16:23–16:26; PSA 145:3–145:7; ISA 12:4–12:6; DAN 4:1–4:3

By obeying him

NUM 27:12–27:14 See also NUM 20:7–20:12

God honours those who honour him

ISA 2:27–2:30 See also LEV 10:1–10:3; 2CH 26:18; JHN 12:26

God requires sincerity from those who honour him

MRK 7:5–7:13 parallel MAT 15:1–15:9 See also ISA 29:13; ACT 5:1–5:11

All people will ultimately honour God

JER 3:17 See also ISA 60:9; ROM 14:9–14:12; ISA 45:23–45:24; PHP 2:9–2:11

Jesus Christ is to be honoured as God

MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35 **JHN 5:22–5:23** See also REV 5:12–5:13

8445: hospitality

Acts of generosity and friendship towards strangers. God's people are called to be hospitable as part of their duty to others and in gratitude for the salvation they have received from God. Showing hospitality includes the responsibility to protect those received as guests.

8446: hospitality, a duty of God's people

Hospitality is commanded by God

HEB 13:2 See also ISA 58:6–58:7; JHN 13:12–13:15; ROM 12:13; 1PE 4:9

Hospitality is a responsibility of leaders

1TI 3:2 See also 1TI 5:9–5:10; TIT 1:8

Hospitality indicates true discipleship

JOB 31:32 See also MAT 25:35

Hospitality crosses social barriers

Of race

LEV 19:33–19:34 See also EXO 22:21, EXO 23:9

Of class and status

LUK 14:12–14:14 See also JAS 2:2–2:4

Hospitality is to be offered to Christian ministers

ROM 16:1–16:2 See also COL 4:10; 3JN 1:5–1:10

Hospitality is to be refused to false teachers

2JN 1:10–1:11

Hospitality as a picture of salvation

PSA 23:5–23:6; REV 3:20 Jesus Christ comes as a willing guest to the repentant, as a sign of renewed fellowship. See also ISA 25:6; MAT 22:1–22:14; LUK 14:15–14:24, LUK 19:1–19:10; JHN 14:2–14:3

Warnings against inhospitable behaviour

DEU 23:3–23:4 See also MAT 10:14 parallels MRK 6:11, LUK 9:5; MAT 25:41–25:45

8447: hospitality, examples of

Scripture provides many examples of friendship and generosity towards strangers, and encourages believers to be hospitable in turn.

Examples of hospitality in the OT

GEN 18:2–18:5 See also GEN 19:1–19:3 Lot entertains visitors from God; GEN 24:22–24:25 Abraham's servant is welcomed in Rebekah's home; EXO 2:20 Moses is welcomed by a priest of Midian; JDG 13:15 Manoah receives the angel of the LORD. JDG 19:1–19:4, JDG 19:20–19:21 2SA 17:27–17:29 hospitality shown to David and his people; 1KI 17:7–17:16 The widow of Zarephath cares for Elijah despite her poverty; 2KI 4:8–4:10 a Shunammite provides for Elisha; NEH 5:17 Nehemiah shows hospitality to fellow Jews.

Hospitality shown to Jesus Christ

MAT 9:10 parallels MRK 2:15, LUK 5:29 Jesus Christ received hospitality from people of all social backgrounds. See also MAT 8:14–8:15 parallels MRK 1:29–1:31, LUK 4:38–4:39 at Peter's house MAT 26:6–26:7 parallel MRK 14:3; JHN 12:1–12:3 LUK 7:36 at the house of Simon the Pharisee; LUK 10:38 at the home of Mary and Martha; LUK 14:1 at the house of a prominent Pharisee; LUK 19:5–19:7 at Zacchaeus' house; LUK 24:29 with disciples in Emmaus; JHN 2:2 at the wedding at Cana

Hospitality assisted the mission of the apostles

Hospitality shown to the disciples

MAT 10:11–10:12 parallels MRK 6:10, LUK 9:4 Jesus Christ sends out the Twelve. See also LUK 10:5–10:7

Hospitality shown to Peter

ACT 10:32 at the home of Simon the tanner; ; ACT 10:48 with Cornelius and his family

Hospitality shown to Paul and his companions

ACT 16:15 at the home of Lydia; ; ACT 16:34 at the house of the Philippian jailer; ; ACT 18:2–18:3 with Aquila and Priscilla in Corinth; ; ACT 21:8 at the house of Philip; ; ACT 21:16 at the home of Mnason in Jerusalem; ; ACT 28:2 on Malta; ; ACT 28:7 at the home of Publius; ; ROM 16:23 with Gaius; ; PHM 1:22 as a guest of Philemon

Christians opened their homes for gatherings of believers

1CO 16:19 See also ACT 2:46; ROM 16:3–16:5; COL 4:15; PHM 1:2

Examples of inhospitable behaviour

1SA 25:10–25:11 See also NUM 20:18 Edom; NUM 21:21–21:23 Sihon; DEU 23:3–23:4 Ammonites and Moabites; JDG 19:15 Gibeah; LUK 9:52–9:53 a Samaritan village

8449: imitating

Following the example or copying the actions of another person. Christians are called upon to become Christlike. Becoming like Jesus Christ is, however, the result, not the condition, of conversion.

The people of God are to imitate God

LEV 11:44–11:45 See also LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7, LEV 20:26, LEV 21:8; 1PE 1:16; EPH 5:1

The people of God are to imitate Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ is the example for believers

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 **JHN 13:15** See also MAT 11:29; JHN 13:34; ROM 13:14; 1CO 11:1; EPH 5:2; PHP 2:5; COL 3:13; 1PE 2:21, 1PE 4:1

God works in believers making them like Jesus Christ

ROM 8:29 See also 2CO 4:10–4:12; COL 3:9–3:10

Good examples to imitate

Paul's example

1CO 4:16 See also 1CO 11:1; PHP 3:17, PHP 4:9; 1TH 1:6; 2TH 3:7–3:9

Christians are to imitate the good example of other believers

2CO 9:2; ; 1TH 2:14; ; HEB 6:12

Christian leaders are to set examples which can be imitated

1TI 4:12 See also TIT 2:7–2:8; HEB 13:7; 1PE 5:3

Believers are to imitate the good example of those who have gone before

HEB 12:1; ; JAS 5:10–5:11

God's people are not to imitate bad examples

Israel must not imitate other nations

LEV 20:23; ; DEU 18:9; ; 2KI 17:15

God's people must not imitate the ungodly

EXO 23:2; ; PSA 1:1; ; PRO 1:10–1:15; ; MAT 23:2–23:3; ; 1CO 15:33; ; 2PE 3:17; ; 1JN 3:11–3:12; ; REV 2:14

No-one can obtain salvation by imitating Jesus Christ

JHN 3:16–3:18 Jesus Christ teaches that salvation (eternal life) is a consequence of faith in him. He never links salvation with imitating him or any other act or acts. See also EPH 2:8–2:9; 2TI 1:8–1:9

8450: martyrdom

The term “martyr” comes from the Greek word for “witness”, reminding believers that the supreme act of witness for the gospel is to give up one's life for its sake.

Jesus Christ as martyr

Jesus Christ had to suffer and die

MRK 8:31 In that Jesus Christ gives up his life, he may be thought of as a martyr. But the NT stresses that he is far more than this. Through his death alone come all the benefits of salvation, in which all believers can share. See also ISA 53:10

Jesus Christ's life is given as a ransom for believers

MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45 See also LUK 9:22; JHN 10:11; ACT 2:23

Other examples of martyrdom

Abel

GEN 4:8; ; MAT 23:35 parallel LUK 11:51; ; HEB 11:4, HEB 12:24; ; 1JN 3:12

Zechariah

2CH 24:20–24:21; ; LUK 11:51

John the Baptist

MAT 14:10–14:12 parallel MRK 6:27–6:29

Stephen

ACT 7:58, ACT 22:20 Stephen is the first martyr of the Christian church.

James

ACT 12:2

Peter

JHN 21:18–21:19

Antipas

REV 2:13

Unnamed martyrs

1KI 19:10; ; ROM 11:3; ; NEH 9:26; ; MAT 23:30–23:34; ; LUK 11:47–11:49; ; ACT 7:52; ; ROM 8:35–8:36; ; HEB 11:35, HEB 11:37; ; JAS 5:6; ; REV 11:7, REV 13:15, REV 16:6, REV 17:6

Noble qualities of martyrs

Courage

DAN 3:16–3:18

Prayerfulness

ACT 7:59–7:60

Self-denial

REV 12:11 See also MAT 16:24 parallel MRK 8:34; LUK 9:24

Serenity

ACT 7:55–7:56

Steadfastness

REV 2:10 See also HEB 11:35 **ACT 21:13** See also DAN 3:16–3:18

Martyrdom must be recognised as a possibility for all believers

LUK 21:16 See also MAT 10:21 parallel MRK 13:12; MAT 24:9; JHN 16:2, JHN 21:18–21:19

Reasons for martyrdom

Refusal to engage in false worship

DAN 3:6 See also DAN 3:16–3:18, DAN 6:7, DAN 11:30–11:33; REV 13:15

Courageous confrontation

NEH 9:26 See also MAT 14:2–14:12 parallel MRK 6:17–6:29; ACT 7:51–7:58; REV 11:7–11:10

Public confession of Jesus Christ

MAT 24:9 See also MRK 13:12–13:13; LUK 21:16–21:17

A holy life

1JN 3:12

Methods of martyrdom

Beheading

See also MAT 14:10; MRK 6:16; LUK 9:9; REV 20:4

Burning

DAN 3:11; ; 1CO 13:3

Mutilation

HEB 11:37

Stoning

ACT 7:58; ; HEB 11:37

The sword

ACT 12:2; ; HEB 11:37

Torture

HEB 11:35

Retribution for instigators of martyrdom**REV 6:9–6:10** See also MAT 23:35; ACT 12:1–12:2, ACT 12:23**Rewards of martyrdom****REV 2:10** See also MAT 10:39; REV 20:4**8451: mortification**

The act of self-denial or the “putting to death” of sinful instincts in order to have freedom from sin and to live in the power of the Holy Spirit. The NT stresses that this act of humiliation comes about through the grace of God. It is the result of, not the condition for, conversion.

Examples of mortification through humility**2SA 10:1–10:5** See also MAT 27:3–27:5**Examples of mortification through self-denial****LEV 16:29–16:31** See also EXO 19:15; LEV 23:27–23:32; NUM 29:7**Mortification as the basis for discipleship****Self-denial is essential****MRK 8:34–8:35** parallels MAT 16:24–16:25, LUK 9:23–9:24 See also 1JN 3:16**The necessity of putting to death sinful human nature and the world’s values****ROM 8:13; COL 3:5** See also MAT 5:29–5:30; GAL 5:24, GAL 6:14; 1PE 2:11**Dying to self is a means of knowing freedom from sin****ROM 6:6–6:7** See also EPH 4:22–4:23**The importance of sharing in the death of Christ****GAL 2:20** See also ROM 6:3, ROM 7:4; 2CO 4:11–4:12; PHP 3:10; COL 2:20; 2TI 2:11**The example of Paul****1CO 9:27** See also 2CO 11:23–11:33; GAL 6:17**Mortification is not the same as self-infliction****COL 2:23** See also PHP 3:2–3:3; COL 2:20–2:22; 1TI 4:1–4:5**8452: neighbours, duty to**

Scripture defines the identity of neighbours in various ways, and indicates the nature and extent of believers’ obligations to them.

Neighbours defined**Those who live nearby****PRO 3:29** See also EXO 3:22, EXO 12:4; DEU 19:14; 2KI 4:3; PRO 27:10; LUK 15:4–15:6**Those of the same race****LEV 19:18** See also 1SA 15:27–15:28, 1SA 28:17; 1CH 12:38–12:40**Peoples of surrounding nations****DEU 1:7** See also JOS 9:16; 1SA 7:14; EZR 9:1; NEH 9:30, NEH 10:28, NEH 10:31; PSA 76:11; EZK 16:26**Those who show mercy to people in need****LUK 10:29–10:37****Fellow Christians****EPH 4:25** See also ROM 15:1–15:2; GAL 5:13–5:16; JAS 4:11–4:12**Duties to neighbours****Love****MAT 22:34–22:39** parallels MRK 12:28–12:34, LUK 10:25–10:28 See also LEV 19:18; DEU 6:5; MAT 19:19; ROM 13:8–13:10; GAL 5:14; JAS 2:8–2:9**Assistance****EXO 23:4–23:5** See also DEU 22:1–22:4; PRO 14:21; MAT 25:34–25:40**Fair treatment****EXO 22:14** See also EXO 20:17; LEV 6:2–6:5, LEV 19:15; DEU 5:21**Honest dealings****LEV 19:13** See also ZEC 8:16–8:17; EPH 4:25**Forgiveness****EPH 4:32** See also MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 17:3–17:4; ROM 15:1–15:2; COL 3:13**Reproof****LEV 19:17** See also LUK 17:3; GAL 6:1–6:2**Prohibition of negative actions towards neighbours****False witness****EXO 20:16** parallel DEU 5:20 See also LEV 19:16; PRO 24:28**Oppression****JER 22:13** See also PRO 3:28

Judgment

JAS 4:12 See also MAT 7:1–7:2; LUK 6:41–6:42; ROM 14:13

8453: obedience

A willingness to submit to the authority of someone else and to actually do what one is asked or told to do. Scripture lays particular emphasis upon the need for believers to obey God, stressing his trustworthiness. This obedience is especially clear in the life and death of Jesus Christ.

8454: obedience, to God

A willingness to submit oneself to the will of God and to put it into effect. Scripture emphasises the necessity for God's laws to be followed, gives examples and reasons, and describes the rewards.

Obedience is demanded of God's people

LEV 25:18; 1SA 15:22 See also DEU 26:16, DEU 32:46; ROM 6:16–6:18; 1PE 1:14–1:16

Examples of obedience in the OT

JOS 11:15 See also GEN 6:22, GEN 12:1–12:4, GEN 22:2–22:3; EXO 40:16; JON 3:3

The example of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 **JHN 14:31** See also JHN 17:4; ROM 5:19; PHP 2:8; HEB 5:8

Jesus Christ is obeyed**By the wind and the waves**

MAT 8:26–8:27 parallels MRK 4:39–4:41, LUK 8:24–8:25

By evil spirits

MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36

Obedience and love

JHN 14:15; 1JN 5:3 See also PSA 119:167; 1JN 2:5, 1JN 3:10; 2JN 1:6

Obedience and faith

HEB 11:8; MAT 7:21 Obedience to the will of God demonstrates the reality of a person's faith in Jesus Christ. See also ROM 1:5; JAS 2:14–2:26

God rewards those who obey him

EXO 19:5; JHN 15:10 See also DEU 5:29; 1KI 3:14; 2KI 18:5–18:7; MAT 7:21, MAT 7:24–7:25 parallel LUK 6:47–6:48; MAT 12:50 parallels MRK 3:35, LUK 8:21; JHN 12:26, JHN 14:21, JHN 14:23, JHN 21:4–21:6; 1JN 2:17

Obedience to the word of God

MAT 7:24–7:27; JAS 1:22 See also PSA 119:9–119:11; JON 3:3; LUK 11:28; JHN 17:6; JAS 2:14–2:20

Examples of people who obeyed God

GEN 6:9 Noah; GEN 12:1–12:4, GEN 17:23; PSA 119:30, PSA 119:100–119:106; ACT 4:19–4:20, ACT 5:29; PHP 3:7–3:14 Paul

8455: obedience, of Jesus Christ

See [2057: Jesus Christ, obedience of](#)

8456: obedience, to human authorities

Scripture teaches that all people, Christians included, should submit not only to God himself but also to divinely instituted secular authorities.

Obedience is owed to rulers

ROM 13:1–13:7 See also 1TI 2:1–2:3; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:14, 1PE 2:17

Jesus Christ expounds this principle

MRK 12:17 parallels MAT 22:21, LUK 20:25

Obedience is owed to church leaders

HEB 13:17 See also 1PE 5:5

Obedience is owed within the household

EPH 6:1–6:3 See also PRO 15:5; COL 3:20

Jesus Christ sets the example

LUK 2:51

Obedience to secular authority is limited by obedience to God

ACT 5:29 See also ACT 4:19

8458: peacemakers**The commendation of peacemakers**

MAT 5:9 See also PRO 12:20; ROM 14:19

The importance of pursuing peace

ECC 10:4; ; ROM 12:18; ; TIT 1:6; ; HEB 12:14; ; JAS 3:17

Examples of peacemakers

GEN 13:8–13:9 Abraham; ; 1SA 25:14–25:31 Abigail; ; EST 10:3 Mordecai; ; ISA 53:5 the suffering servant

8459: perseverance

Enduring in a course of action or belief. In its negative sense, it can mean being stubborn; in its positive sense, it means continuing commitment to the gospel of Jesus Christ.

Human perseverance in sin

2KI 17:41; ISA 1:5; ROM 1:32 See also EXO 9:1–9:3; DEU 29:19; JDG 14:17; 2KI 13:11; DAN 12:10

God's perseverance in calling Israel to obedience
NEH 9:30–9:31 See also EXO 32:14; 1KI 3:6; ISA 40:28; JER 26:13; JON 3:10

Jesus Christ's perseverance with those who would not believe

HEB 12:1–12:3 See also MAT 17:17 parallel MRK 9:19; 2TH 3:5

Christians' perseverance in faith

COL 2:6–2:7, COL 1:10–1:12 See also MAT 24:12–24:13, MAT 10:22; JHN 15:4–15:10; ROM 11:22; 1CO 1:8; 2CO 10:15; PHP 2:12; COL 1:23; 2TH 3:4; HEB 6:1, HEB 10:36–10:38; 2PE 3:18

Perseverance in prayer

LUK 18:1–18:8 See also LUK 11:5–11:13; ROM 12:12; EPH 6:18; 1TH 5:17

Perseverance arises from suffering

ROM 5:3 See also ROM 12:12; 2CO 1:6; 2TH 1:4; 2TI 3:10–3:11; JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 4:19; REV 2:2–2:3, REV 2:19

Perseverance builds and demonstrates Christian character

ROM 5:4 See also 1CO 13:7; 2CO 1:21–1:22, 2CO 12:12; JAS 1:4; 2PE 1:5–1:8

Encouragements for Christians to persevere

ACT 11:23, ACT 13:43; ; 1CO 15:58, 1CO 16:13; ; PHP 1:27; ; 2TI 1:13; ; HEB 2:1, HEB 4:14; ; REV 3:11

8460: pleasing God

An essential aspect of the life of believers that is more than a matter of external observance, but a total and heartfelt commitment to God.

Pleasing God is commanded

ROM 12:1; EPH 5:8–5:10 See also 2CO 5:9; GAL 6:8; COL 1:10, COL 3:20; 1TH 4:1; 1TI 2:1–2:3, 1TI 5:4

It is more important to please God than to please people

GAL 1:10, GAL 1:15–1:16; ; 1TH 2:4

Pleasing God involves inward attitudes, not simply external observance

1CH 29:17; PSA 51:16–51:17; ROM 14:17–14:18 See also PSA 5:4, PSA 69:30–69:31, PSA 147:10–147:11, PSA 149:4; PRO 11:20, PRO 12:22, PRO 15:8; ECC 5:4; ISA 1:11–1:13; EZK 18:23, EZK 33:11; HAG 1:7; MAL 2:13–2:14; ROM 8:8; GAL 1:10; 1TH 2:4; HEB 11:6

Sacrifices and duties please God when carried out with the right attitude

EXO 29:18; PHP 4:18 See also EXO 29:25, EXO 29:41; LEV 1:9, LEV 3:5; NUM 15:3, NUM 29:2; EZR 6:10; HEB 13:16

Results of pleasing God

PSA 37:23 See also 1KI 10:9; JOB 33:26; PRO 16:7; ECC 2:26, ECC 7:26

Examples of actions that please God

Prayer

PRO 15:8

Doing God's will

HEB 13:20–13:21 See also MAT 7:21; EPH 6:6; 1JN 2:17

Examples of those concerned to please God by their actions

NEH 5:19; PSA 19:14 See also EXO 32:11; NEH 13:31; PSA 90:17, PSA 104:34; DAN 9:17

Examples of people who pleased God

The example of Jesus Christ

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22 See also MAT 17:5; JHN 5:30, JHN 8:29; COL 1:19; 2PE 1:17

Other examples

GEN 6:8 Noah; EXO 33:12–33:13, EXO 33:17; DEU 33:23 Naphtali; ; ISA 2:26 Samuel; ; 1KI 3:10 Solomon; ; LUK 1:30 Mary; ; HEB 11:5 Enoch

8461: priorities

Scripture stresses that God must be allowed to rule at the heart of a person's life.

8462: priority, of God

Scripture provides examples of individuals who have allowed God to take priority in their lives, and also of those who have allowed something or someone else to take priority.

God's glory made a priority

MAT 6:9

Commands to put God first

MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8 See also DEU 6:13; 1CH 16:29

Examples of putting God first

GEN 5:22, GEN 5:24 Enoch; ; GEN 6:9 Noah; ; GEN 12:4 Abraham; ; JOS 24:15 Joshua; ; 2KI 20:3 Hezekiah; ; DAN 3:16–3:18 Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; DAN 6:10 Daniel; ; JHN 3:29–3:30 John the Baptist

Disapproval of not putting God first

EXO 20:3 See also LUK 16:13

Examples of not putting God first

ACT 12:22–12:23 See also 1KI 11:4 Solomon; 1KI 15:3 Abijah; 2CH 25:2 Amaziah; JER 3:10 Judah; ACT 5:1–5:5 Ananias and Sapphira; ROM 16:17–16:18

Worship commended as the highest human activity

PSA 95:6 See also PSA 96:9, PSA 99:5; ZEC 14:17; JHN 4:24

Outstanding examples of worship

2SA 6:14–6:15 David was prepared to be despised by his wife rather than inhibit his worship. See also EXO 3:6; ISA 6:3; EZK 1:28; DAN 6:10; JHN 9:38; REV 1:17

God's kingdom made a priority

MAT 6:10

Commands to participate in the kingdom

MAT 6:33 See also LUK 19:11–19:27

Examples of wholehearted participation

ACT 26:19 See also HEB 6:12, HEB 12:1–12:2

Warning against half-hearted participation

REV 2:4–2:5

Sacrifices for the kingdom advocated

REV 2:10 See also MAT 5:29 parallel MRK 9:47; MAT 18:8

Examples of sacrifices for the kingdom

HEB 11:26 See also 2CO 11:23–11:30; PHP 2:21–2:22, PHP 2:30; REV 2:13

God's will made a priority

MAT 6:10

Conformity to God's will commanded

EPH 5:17 See also 1TH 4:3, 1TH 5:18; HEB 13:20–13:21; JAS 4:15

Outstanding examples of conformity to God's will

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 See also JHN 4:34, JHN 6:38; ACT 20:22–20:24

8463: priority, of faith, hope and love

Putting God first—living according to his word—serves the glory of God and also the best interests of believers, by giving them true wisdom for daily living.

The wisdom of making faith a priority

HEB 11:6

Putting the fear of God before other considerations

PSA 31:19 See also EXO 1:17; NEH 5:15; PRO 1:7

Preferring God's way to sinful advice

PSA 1:1–1:2 PRO 3:13–3:14, PRO 8:19, PRO 8:32; NUM 31:16; ; 1KI 12:28

Choosing imaginative action rather than laziness or fearfulness

NUM 13:30 See also 1SA 25:33; EPH 5:16 MAT 25:10, MAT 25:26–25:27, MAT 25:44–25:45, MAT 26:40

Patient waiting rather than impetuous action

PSA 40:1 See also PSA 27:14, PSA 37:5–37:6, PSA 62:5, PSA 123:2; PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 40:31; HOS 12:6; JHN 2:4–2:5; REV 2:10

The wisdom of making hope a priority

HEB 6:19 See also PSA 147:10–147:11

Putting true riches above earthly wealth

LUK 16:9 See also DEU 15:8; MAT 6:24, MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30; HEB 11:26

Putting eternal joy before temporal hardship

2CO 4:17–4:18 See also ACT 14:22, ACT 16:25; ROM 8:18; 2TI 2:10; HEB 10:34

The wisdom of making love a priority

1CO 13:13 Paul's concern that love, rather than competition over spiritual gifts, should be made a priority.

Loyalty rather than opportunism

PRO 18:24 See also RUT 1:16; 2TI 4:10 Demas' love for this world rather than loyalty

Following the Spirit rather than sinful human nature

GAL 5:16 Merely "human" activity betrays a failure of love for God. See also PSA 147:10–147:11; ISA 31:1–31:3; ROM 8:5

Inner sincerity rather than outward appearance

ROM 12:9 See also 1SA 16:7; EPH 6:5; COL 3:22

Actions rather than mere words

JAS 2:18 See also MAT 7:21–7:22; 1JN 3:18

Peace rather than disharmony

ROM 12:18 See also ROM 14:19; HEB 12:14

Truth rather than falsehood

PRO 12:19 See also ACT 5:4; COL 3:9

8465: progress

The process of development and growth, of special importance in the life of believers. Scripture stresses the importance of progress, both of the individual believer and of the church, and the need to work towards that goal.

Progress in the Christian life should be expected

2CO 3:18; EPH 4:15 See also JOB 17:9; PSA 84:5, PSA 84:7, PSA 92:12; PRO 4:18; ROM 8:29–8:30

Believers are to strive for progress in their Christian lives

PHP 2:12 See also PSA 18:29; 1CO 9:24–9:27; PHP 3:12–3:14; 1TH 3:12; 2TH 1:3; 1TI 4:15; HEB 6:1; 1PE 2:2; 2PE 1:5–1:8, 2PE 3:18

Progress in the Christian life brings assurance

HEB 3:14 See also MAT 10:22 parallel MRK 13:13; MAT 24:13; HEB 6:9–6:11

The church is expected to progress

MAT 16:18, MAT 13:31–13:32 parallels MRK 4:30–4:32, LUK 13:18–13:19 **EPH 4:16** See also ACT 2:47, ACT 4:4, ACT 5:14, ACT 6:7, ACT 11:21

8466: reformation

The process of bringing religious practices and beliefs back into line with the word of God. The OT portrays Israel as requiring reformation at several points in her history. God's people continue to need to review their beliefs and practices in the light of God's word.

The continual need to turn from idolatry

1SA 7:3 Idolatry was the besetting sin of Israel and the point at which all reforms had to begin. See also GEN 35:2; JOS 24:14–24:24; JDG 6:25–6:27; 2KI 10:18–10:27, 2KI 11:17–11:18 parallel 2CH 23:16–23:17; 2CH 19:3, 2CH 33:15; 1CO 10:14; 1JN 5:21

The reform of Asa

He removed idols

1KI 15:12–15:13

He repaired the altar of the temple

2CH 15:8, 2CH 15:18

As a result the people sought and found God

2CH 15:9–15:15

The reform of Hezekiah

He removed idols and even local shrines dedicated to God

2KI 18:4 parallel 2CH 31:1

He established worship in the renovated and consecrated temple

2CH 29:3–29:7, 2CH 29:15–29:28

The covenant between God and his people was renewed

2CH 29:10–29:11, 2CH 29:29–29:31, 2CH 30:1–30:27, 2CH 31:2–31:19

The reform of Josiah

He repaired the temple

2KI 22:3–22:7 parallel 2CH 34:8–34:13

He ended false worship

2KI 23:4–23:24 parallel 2CH 34:3–34:7; ; 2CH 34:33

The results of Josiah's reform

2KI 22:11–22:20 parallel 2CH 34:19–34:28 The prevailing attitude was that God would ensure that no disaster would befall his chosen people. Now the need to turn from sin and complacency was reiterated and repentance ensued; ; 2KI 23:1–23:3 parallel 2CH 34:29–34:32; ; 2KI 23:3 parallel 2CH 34:31–34:32; ; 2KI 23:21–23:23 parallel 2CH 35:1–35:19

The reforms of Ezra and Nehemiah

The problem of intermarriage was dealt with

EZR 10:2–10:3 The objection to intermarriage was based on religious not racial grounds. It led to a corruption of the faith. See also EZR 9:1–9:15, EZR 10:5–10:17; NEH 13:23–13:27

The temple was purified

NEH 13:4–13:13

The Sabbath-rest was reaffirmed

NEH 13:15 See also NEH 13:16–13:22

Incomplete reforms

2KI 10:28–10:29 See also 1KI 15:14 parallel 2CH 15:17; 2KI 3:2–3:3, 2KI 12:2–12:3

The call to reform

To Israel

JER 7:3 See also 2CH 7:14; ISA 1:16–1:17, ISA 55:6–55:7; JER 18:11, JER 26:13, JER 35:15; ZEC 1:3; ACT 3:19–3:26

To the church

REV 3:2–3:3 See also 1CO 5:1–5:13; REV 2:5, REV 3:15–3:20

To individuals

JAS 1:21 See also ROM 12:2; 2CO 6:14–7:1; EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:5–3:10; JAS 1:22–1:25, JAS 4:7–4:10

8467: reminders

The means of calling to mind important matters or events. Scripture stresses the importance of being reminded of God's dealings with his people in the past.

The importance of being reminded of God's words and deeds

1CO 15:1; 2PE 1:12 See also 2PE 3:1

Reminders of God's covenant and faithfulness**GEN 9:12–9:16** See also GEN 17:9–17:14**Reminders of God's intervention in history****JUD 1:5** See also EXO 12:14–12:20 parallel DEU 16:1–16:8; EXO 13:3–13:10, EXO 17:14; 1CO 11:23–11:26; 2PE 1:12–1:16**Reminders to people of their sin or shortcomings****HEB 10:3–10:4** See also GEN 41:9; EXO 30:16; NUM 5:11–5:15; EZK 29:16**Reminders to people to be faithful to God****NUM 15:38–15:40** See also ROM 11:22; HEB 12:1–12:3; 2PE 3:1–3:2**Reminders to people of their potential and gifts from God****2TI 1:6** See also 1TI 4:14**Reminders to God's people on matters of faith and conduct****ROM 15:15** See also DEU 31:9–31:13; 1CO 4:17, 1CO 15:1–15:2; TIT 3:1–3:2**8468: renunciation**

The deliberate rejection or disavowal, especially of a person or object.

Renunciation of the LORD**JDG 2:12; ISA 1:28; ACT 3:13** See also EXO 32:8; JOS 22:16; 2KI 22:17; 1CH 28:9; JER 5:19; MAT 24:10; 2TI 2:12**Renunciation of evil****In repentance****PSA 37:27** See also JER 35:15; EZK 14:6; DAN 4:27; 2CO 4:2; 1TI 6:20**To find God's mercy****2CH 7:14** See also PRO 28:13; EZK 18:21; JON 3:10**Self-renunciation and the Christian life****An integral part of discipleship****MAT 16:24** parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 See also MRK 10:28; LUK 5:28, LUK 14:33; PHP 3:8**The example of Jesus Christ****MRK 10:45** See also JHN 10:17; PHP 2:7–2:8**8469: respect**

An attitude of reverence and deference, reflecting an appreciation of the significance of the person or thing that is esteemed.

8470: respect, for God's character

God's revelation of himself calls for deference, honour and a response of right living.

Respect for God's name**PSA 29:2** See also EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11; EXO 23:20–23:21; LEV 18:21, LEV 19:12, LEV 22:31–22:33, LEV 24:10–24:16; PSA 86:9–86:11; JER 3:16–3:17; MAL 2:1–2:2**Respect for God's presence****EXO 3:5–3:6** See also EXO 33:19–33:23; PSA 89:7; ISA 6:1–6:5; ZEP 1:7; ZEC 2:13**Respect for God's word****DEU 4:2** See also DEU 12:32; JOS 1:7–1:8; PRO 30:5–30:6; 2PE 1:19–1:21; REV 22:18–22:19**Respect for God's ark and sanctuary****LEV 19:30** See also 1SA 6:19–6:20; 2SA 6:1–6:7; ECC 5:1–5:2; HAB 2:20; MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46, JHN 2:13–2:17; JER 7:11**Respect for God's servants****1TH 5:12–5:13** See also ACT 23:1–23:5; EXO 22:28; ACT 28:7–28:10; PHP 2:29–2:30; 1TI 5:17–5:18; HEB 13:7, HEB 13:17**Respect for God leads to godly living****EXO 20:20** See also 2CH 6:30–6:31; PRO 16:6; HEB 11:7; 1PE 1:14–1:17**8471: respect, for human beings**

Each individual, created in the image of God, should be honoured and esteemed, and this should be worked out in every area of life.

Human beings are to be respected**They are made in the image of God****GEN 9:5–9:6** See also PRO 14:31, PRO 17:5; COL 3:9–3:11; JAS 3:9–3:10**The bounds of life belong to God****EXO 20:13** parallel DEU 5:17 See also EXO 21:22–21:25 NIV footnote at verse 22; 2SA 1:14–1:15, 2SA 4:9–4:12; 1KI 2:31–2:33; PSA 139:13–139:16**The equality and dignity of human beings is commanded****DEU 1:16–1:17** See also EXO 23:2–23:3; LEV 19:15; DEU 16:18–16:19; PRO 24:23–24:25, PRO 28:21; ACT 10:24–10:28, ACT 10:34–10:35; JAS 2:1–2:9; 1PE 2:17

Respect in the family

Respect for parents is commanded

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 See also LEV 19:3; PRO 1:8; MAL 1:6; MAT 15:4-15:6 parallel MRK 7:10-7:13; MAT 19:19 parallel LUK 18:20; EPH 6:1-6:3; COL 3:20; HEB 12:9

Disrespect for parents is condemned

DEU 27:16 See also EXO 21:17; LEV 20:9; PRO 30:17; ISA 45:10; 2TI 3:1-3:2

Examples of those who respected their parents

GEN 9:20-9:23 Shem and Japheth; ; GEN 47:11-47:12 Joseph; ; 1SA 22:3 David; ; 1KI 2:19 Solomon; ; 1KI 19:20 Elisha; LUK 2:51; ; JHN 19:25-19:27

Respect in marriage

EPH 5:33 See also EPH 5:21-5:25; COL 3:18-3:19; 1PE 3:6-3:7

Respect for children

MAT 18:10 See also LEV 20:1-20:5; MAT 18:5-18:6 parallels MRK 9:36-9:37, LUK 9:47-9:48; MAT 19:13-19:15 parallels MRK 10:13-10:16, LUK 18:15-18:17; EPH 6:4; COL 3:20-3:21

Respect for leaders

Leaders must have gained respect

DEU 1:13-1:15 See also 1SA 9:6; PRO 31:23; 1TI 3:2-3:11

Leaders must be given respect

1SA 26:9-26:11 See also 1SA 24:1-24:7; 2KI 3:14; ROM 13:1-13:7; 1TH 5:12; HEB 13:17

Respect for old age

LEV 19:32 See also JOB 32:4-32:7; LAM 5:12; 1TI 5:1-5:2; TIT 2:2; 1PE 5:5

Respect at the place of work

DEU 24:14-24:15 See also LEV 19:13; EPH 6:5-6:9; COL 3:22-4:1; 1TI 6:1-6:2; 1PE 2:18

8472: respect, for environment

Although God created the universe and retains ultimate ownership of it, he has delegated responsibility for the well-being of the earth to the human race. This stewardship includes the care of the animal kingdom and the earth's natural resources.

God's creation is to be respected

The earth belongs to God

PSA 24:1-24:2 See also EXO 19:5-19:6; LEV 25:23; 1CH 29:14; PSA 50:9-50:12, PSA 89:11; HAG 2:8

Responsibility to rule and care for the earth has been delegated to the human race

GEN 1:26-1:28 See also GEN 9:1-9:3; PSA 8:6-8:8, PSA 115:16; HEB 2:8; JAS 3:7

God himself maintains a caring supervision of his creation

MAT 6:26-6:30 parallel LUK 12:24-12:28 See also DEU 11:10-11:15; PSA 65:9-65:13; MAT 5:45

Respect for all nature and animals

DEU 20:19 NIV footnote. See also EXO 23:4-23:5, EXO 23:10-23:11; DEU 22:4, DEU 22:6-22:7, DEU 25:4; PRO 12:10

Respect and care for the earth's natural resources

EXO 23:10-23:11 See also LEV 25:1-25:7; NEH 10:31

8474: seeing God

Perceiving God in all his fulness. Scripture stresses that God, as spirit, is invisible to sinful human beings. He has, however, been revealed in Jesus Christ, who is his perfect likeness, and he will be seen in all his glory at the end of history when he comes in judgment.

No human can see the face of God in all his fulness

1TI 6:15-6:16 See also DEU 4:10-4:12; JHN 6:46; 1TI 1:17; 1JN 4:12

Privileged individuals may catch a glimpse of God

EXO 33:21-33:23 See also GEN 16:13-16:14 Hagar; NUM 12:5-12:8 Moses; JDG 6:11-6:24 Gideon; JDG 13:2-13:23 Manoah and his wife

Threat of death on seeing the face of God

EXO 33:20 See also GEN 32:24-32:30; EXO 19:21, EXO 24:9-24:11

Seeing God in a vision

ISA 6:1 See also 1KI 22:19 parallel 2CH 18:18 Micaiah; EZK 1:1-1:28 Ezekiel; ACT 7:55-7:56 Stephen

God may be seen in Jesus Christ

JHN 14:8-14:9; COL 1:15 See also JHN 1:1-1:18; 1JN 5:20

The hope of seeing God at the resurrection

1CO 13:12 See also JOB 19:26-19:27; PSA 17:15; MAT 5:8; 1CO 13:12; HEB 12:14; REV 1:7

8475: self-denial

The willingness to deny oneself possessions or status, in order to grow in holiness and commitment to God. This practice is commended and illustrated by Jesus

Christ himself, and underlies Christian fellowship within the church.

The wisdom of self-denial

PRO 23:20–23:21 See also PRO 25:16

Examples of self-denial in order to put God first

DAN 1:8; HEB 11:25 See also LEV 23:29; JER 35:6; DAN 10:3; LUK 1:15, LUK 7:33 parallel MAT 11:18

Self-denial is a requirement of following Jesus Christ

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 **ACT 21:13; PHP 3:7; 1PE 2:11** See also MAT 5:29, MAT 6:10, MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:13–2:14, LUK 5:27–5:28 the calling of Matthew; MAT 10:37–10:38 parallel LUK 14:26–14:27 the cost of being a disciple; MAT 18:8 parallel MRK 9:43; MAT 19:21 parallel LUK 18:22 the rich young man; MAT 19:27 parallels MRK 10:28, LUK 18:28 Peter left everything to follow Jesus Christ; MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30 the rewards of self-denial for the sake of the gospel; LUK 5:11, LUK 14:33, LUK 21:34; ACT 20:24; ROM 6:2, ROM 6:6, ROM 6:11, ROM 8:13, ROM 12:1, ROM 13:14; 1CO 6:12, 1CO 9:25–9:27; 2CO 8:5 the example of the Macedonian churches; GAL 2:20, GAL 5:16, GAL 5:23; COL 3:3, COL 3:5; 2TI 2:21; TIT 2:12–2:13; JAS 4:7; 1PE 4:2

Self-denial for the sake of others

RUT 2:11; PHP 2:4 Esther put her own life at risk for the sake of her people See also EXO 32:32; EST 4:16 ROM 14:21, ROM 15:1; 1CO 8:13, 1CO 9:23 1CO 10:24, 1CO 10:33, 1CO 12:15; EPH 4:2, EPH 5:21; PHP 2:17, PHP 2:20–2:21 the example of Timothy; COL 1:24; 2TI 2:10; TIT 3:2; 1PE 3:8, 1PE 5:5

Self-denial and the example of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 **2CO 8:9** See also PSA 40:7; ISA 53:7; MAT 11:29; JHN 13:1–13:17; ROM 15:3; EPH 5:1–5:2; PHP 2:5–2:8

8476: self-discipline

The dedicated training, through the study of Scripture, prayer and self-control, which enables Christians to be more effective witnesses to the gospel, to lead lives more pleasing to God, and to win the crown that awaits those who are victorious over sin.

Self-discipline is training oneself to be godly

1TI 4:7 See also ROM 13:14; 1CO 9:24–9:27; EPH 4:23–4:24; PHP 3:12–3:14; COL 3:12; 2TI 1:7; HEB 5:14, HEB 12:1

Self-discipline and the study of Scripture

PSA 119:9–119:11; 2TI 3:16–3:17 See also DEU 29:29

Self-discipline involves learning through experience

TIT 2:12 See also ROM 5:3–5:5

Self-discipline should transform the whole person

A Christian's thoughts should be disciplined

2CO 10:5 See also ROM 12:3 ROM 12:2; EPH 4:23 1PE 4:7

A Christian's speech should be disciplined

PSA 141:3 See also JAS 3:2–3:12

A Christian's behaviour should be disciplined

ROM 14:20–14:21

A Christian's body should be disciplined

1CO 9:27 See also ROM 6:12–6:13, ROM 8:13; EPH 4:22; COL 3:5; JAS 3:2

Self-discipline prevents God's discipline

1CO 11:31–11:32

Physical self-discipline is of some value, but only in this life

1TI 4:8 See also 1CO 9:25

An elder should be self-disciplined

TIT 1:8

Examples of those who exercised self-discipline

See also GEN 22:9–22:14 Abraham; GEN 39:8–39:12 Joseph; 2SA 11:11–11:13 Uriah **DAN 1:8, DAN 1:11–1:13** MAT 4:4 Jesus Christ; 1CO 8:13 Paul

Self-discipline strengthens believers when faced with temptation

MAT 5:29 parallel MRK 9:47; ; ROM 8:13; ; GAL 5:24

The reward for self-discipline is a crown and a prize

1CO 9:25 See also 1CO 9:24, 1CO 9:27; PHP 3:14; COL 2:18; 1TH 2:19; 2TI 4:8; JAS 1:12; 1PE 5:4; REV 2:10, REV 3:11

8477: self-examination

Reflection on one's own character, motives and actions, in order to judge whether they are truly in accordance with Christian values.

8478: self-examination, teaching on

Self-examination should take place on the basis of God's revelation of himself and the example he sets believers in Jesus Christ. It is especially important before confessing one's sins.

The importance of self-examination

HAG 1:5 See also PSA 4:4, PSA 77:6; HAG 1:7, HAG 2:15, HAG 2:18; 1CO 11:28; 2CO 13:5; HEB 3:12

A lack of self-examination leads to pride and self-delusion

1CO 11:28–11:29 See also MAT 7:5; JHN 8:7; ROM 2:1–2:4

Self-examination is not easy because of humanity's fallen nature

PSA 19:12–19:14 See also JER 17:9

God helps believers in their self-examination

PSA 26:2 See also JOB 7:17–7:18, JOB 13:9, JOB 13:23; PSA 11:4–11:5, PSA 139:23–139:24; PRO 5:21; JER 17:10, JER 20:12

The purpose of self-examination is to lead people to God and amendment of life

LAM 3:40–3:42 See also PSA 42:5, PSA 42:11, PSA 43:5; JAS 1:23–1:25

Self-examination is especially important when ministering to others

GAL 6:1 See also ROM 14:4; GAL 6:3–6:4; 1TI 4:16; JAS 3:1

8479: self-examination, examples of

Scripture provides numerous examples of self-examination, and its results. In particular, self-examination is often portrayed as leading to repentance.

Self-examination in the experience of Israel

Self-examination at the entry into the promised land
JOS 7:1–7:26, JOS 24:14

Self-examination during the war with the Philistines
1SA 14:24–14:47

Self-examination at the time of the exile
JER 31:18–31:20

Self-examination after returning from exile in Babylon
NEH 8:9; ; HAG 1:5–1:12, HAG 2:15–2:19

Self-examination by other nations

JON 3:1–3:10

Self-examination in the experience of individuals

King David

PSA 51:3–51:6 See also 2SA 12:1–12:13; PSA 32:3–32:5

Job

JOB 42:1–42:6

The psalmists

PSA 119:59 See also PSA 42:5, PSA 42:11, PSA 43:5

The lost son

LUK 15:17–15:20

The disciples

MAT 26:22 parallel MRK 14:19

Judas

See also MAT 26:25, MAT 27:3–27:5

8481: self-sacrifice

The willingness to leave one's possessions or to give them to others; to deny oneself to the point of death or to give oneself in the service of God or other people.

Self-sacrifice as forfeiting one's present comfort for the sake of others

RUT 2:11 See also GEN 44:33–44:34; HEB 10:34, HEB 11:24–11:27

Self-sacrifice as giving one's possessions to others

Jesus Christ commends the willingness to give away one's possessions

MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22 See also LUK 12:33

God rewards those who give their possessions away
LUK 18:28–18:30 parallels MAT 19:27–19:29, MRK 10:28–10:30

Sacrificing one's possessions as demonstrated in the life of the church

See also ACT 2:44–2:45, ACT 4:32–4:37; 2CO 8:1–8:5

Self-sacrifice as leaving all and following Jesus Christ

Such sacrifice is a condition of discipleship

LUK 14:33 See also MAT 10:37 parallel LUK 14:26 This means loving Jesus Christ over and above one's immediate family.

Those willing to leave everything to follow Jesus Christ

LUK 5:27–5:28; ; PHP 3:8

Self-sacrifice as the metaphorical laying down of one's life for others

Followers of Jesus Christ are required to give themselves in the service of others

JHN 12:24–12:25 See also MAT 10:38 parallel LUK 14:27; MAT 16:24–16:25 parallels MRK 8:34–8:35, LUK 9:23–9:24; LUK 17:33; 1JN 3:16–3:18

Examples of those who demonstrated such self-sacrifice

2CO 4:10–4:11 See also 1CO 9:19–9:23, 1CO 15:30–15:31; 2CO 11:23–11:29, 2CO 12:15

Self-sacrifice as the literal laying down of one's life

Jesus Christ warns his disciples to be prepared to give their lives

MAT 10:21–10:22 parallels MRK 13:12–13:13, LUK 21:16–21:17

Sacrificing one's life is of no value without love

See also 1CO 13:3

Examples of those willing to give their lives for the sake of God and others

ACT 20:23–20:24 See also EXO 32:32; 1CH 11:15–11:19; EST 4:14–4:16; MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35–14:36, LUK 22:42; PHP 2:17

Examples of those who gave their lives in God's service

ACT 7:59–7:60 See also JDG 11:36–11:38; PHP 2:5–2:8; HEB 11:36–11:38; REV 20:4

8482: spiritual warfare

The struggle against the forces of evil, which is a constant feature of the life of faith. Scripture locates the origins of spiritual warfare in the rebellion of Satan and his angels against God and affirms the hope of God's final victory over such forces through Jesus Christ's death and resurrection.

8483: spiritual warfare, causes of

Spiritual warfare has its origin in a rebellion of many angels against God. Satan is seen as the prince of this world, leading an array of forces opposed to God. Although disarmed by Jesus Christ on the cross, they remain a powerful threat to the church and to individual believers.

Satan and his angels fall

2PE 2:4 See also ISA 14:12–14:15; EZK 28:12–28:19 Some believe the kings of Babylon and Tyre to be types of Satan; 1TI 3:6; JUD 1:6

Satan and his angels comprise a well-organised army

EPH 6:12 See also COL 1:13

Satan and his angels will ultimately be fully disarmed by Jesus Christ

COL 2:15; REV 12:7–12:9 See also MRK 3:27 parallel MAT 12:29; LUK 10:18; JHN 12:31; HEB 2:14; 1JN 3:8

Satan persecutes the church

REV 12:13 The woman is here thought to be symbolic of the church. See also REV 2:10, REV 13:7 The dragon is here thought to be symbolic of the world's persecution (empowered by Satan) of the church.

Satan opposes the gospel

2CO 4:4 See also MAT 13:19 parallels MRK 4:15, LUK 8:12; MAT 13:38–13:39; 1TH 2:2, 1TH 2:18

Examples of opposition to the first Christians

ACT 6:8–6:14, ACT 7:54–7:58 Stephen stoned to death; ; ACT 8:1–8:3 Saul causes havoc in Jerusalem.; ACT 13:6–13:12, ACT 13:44–13:45, ACT 17:13, ACT 18:6, ACT 18:12; ACT 9:23, ACT 14:5, ACT 14:19, ACT 16:16–16:24, ACT 17:5–17:6, ACT 19:23–19:29, ACT 20:3, ACT 21:27–21:36; ACT 23:12–23:15, ACT 25:3

Satan attacks individual believers

REV 12:17 See also JOB 2:7; LUK 22:31–22:32; 2TI 3:12; 1PE 5:8

8484: spiritual warfare, enemies in

Christians are at war with the world, the flesh and the devil. Satan empowers the world to attack believers externally, persecuting, deceiving and seducing them. Internally, sinfulness frustrates the efforts of believers to serve God fully.

The world is an enemy

JAS 4:4 "world" here refers to the sinful human race, hostile to the truth and to the people of God. See also ROM 12:2; 1JN 2:15–2:17, 1JN 5:4

The world hates Christians

JHN 15:19–15:20 See also MAT 5:10–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22; JHN 16:2, JHN 17:14; 1PE 4:12–4:16; 1JN 3:13; REV 13:7 The beast may represent the world's antichristian persecution.

The world has its own false teaching and religion

COL 2:8 See also 1TI 4:1; 2TI 4:3–4:4; 1JN 4:1; 2JN 1:7–1:11; JUD 1:3–1:4; REV 13:11, REV 19:20 This beast is thought to represent antichristian religion.

The world seeks to seduce Christians

1JN 2:16 See also LUK 12:15, LUK 12:19; 2TI 4:10; TIT 2:12; HEB 11:24–11:25; REV 17:1–17:5 Babylon may represent the world's seduction.

Sinful human nature is an enemy

GAL 5:17; 1PE 2:11 See also ROM 6:12, ROM 7:14–7:23, ROM 8:13; GAL 5:24; COL 3:5; HEB 12:4; JAS 4:1

The devil is an enemy

1PE 5:8 See also MAT 13:39 parallels MRK 4:15, LUK 8:12; JHN 17:15; 2TH 3:3; REV 2:10, REV 12:17

He seeks to tempt Christians

1TH 3:5 See also GEN 3:1-3:6; HEB 2:18, HEB 4:15

He seeks to deceive

2CO 11:3; REV 12:9 See also GEN 3:13; 2CO 2:11, 2CO 4:4, 2CO 11:4; REV 20:3

He constantly seeks to accuse believers

REV 12:10 See also JOB 1:9-1:11; ZEC 3:1

8485: spiritual warfare, as conflict

The warfare believers must fight is spiritual, personal, intense and continual. It calls for courage, determination and prayer, and therefore believers must stand in God's strength and use the armour he has provided.

General descriptions of spiritual conflict**It is spiritual**

EPH 6:12 See also ZEC 4:6; 2CO 10:3-10:4; GAL 5:17; 1PE 2:11

It is personal

LUK 22:31-22:32 See also ROM 7:23; 2TI 3:12, 2TI 4:18

It is strenuous

HEB 12:4 See also JHN 16:33; PHP 1:27-1:30; 1PE 4:12-4:13

It is continual

EPH 6:13 See also 2TI 2:3; HEB 3:13; REV 12:10

How believers are to fight**With courage**

1CO 16:13 See also JOS 1:9, JOS 10:25; 2CH 32:6-32:8

With determination

1TI 6:12 See also 2TH 1:4; HEB 10:23; 1PE 5:9-5:10

With watchfulness

1PE 5:8 See also 1CO 16:13; GAL 6:1; EPH 6:18

With prayer

EPH 6:18 See also EXO 17:11; MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4; MAT 26:41 parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:46; ACT 12:5; 2TH 3:2

Standing in God's strength

EPH 6:10 See also 1SA 17:45; 2SA 22:40; PSA 18:32-18:36, PSA 118:8; EPH 3:16; PHP 4:13; 2TI 2:1

Using the armour of God

EPH 6:11 See also ROM 13:12-13:14; 2CO 10:4; EPH 6:13-6:17

8486: spiritual warfare, armour

The armour of God refers to the resources that Christians possess for defending themselves against the attacks of the world, the flesh and the devil.

God is the believer's strength and shield

PSA 28:7-28:8 See also GEN 15:1; DEU 33:29; PSA 3:3, PSA 7:10, PSA 119:114

Believers should be rightly clothed for battle

ROM 13:12-13:14 See also EPH 4:22-4:24; COL 3:9, COL 3:12-3:14; 1PE 4:1

Believers should put on the full armour of God**The belt of truth**

EPH 6:14 PSA 119:95, PSA 119:116; ; EPH 4:14-4:15; ; COL 2:8; ; 2TI 1:13-1:14; ; 1PE 1:13

The breastplate of righteousness

EPH 6:14 PRO 4:23, PRO 13:6; ; ISA 61:10; ; ZEC 3:1-3:4

The gospel of peace

EPH 6:15 JHN 14:27, JHN 16:33; ; PHP 4:6-4:7

The shield of faith

EPH 6:16 ROM 1:17; ; HAB 2:4; ; 1PE 5:9; ; 1JN 5:4

The helmet of salvation

EPH 6:17 1TH 5:8-5:9; ; TIT 2:11-2:14; ; 1JN 3:3

The Christian's spiritual weapons

2CO 10:4

The sword of the Spirit

EPH 6:17 PSA 119:11; ; 2TI 3:16-3:17; ; HEB 4:12

The armour of God is worn with prayer

EPH 6:18 PSA 55:16-55:18; ; HEB 4:16; ; JAS 5:16

8488: tithing

The practice of offering to God a tenth of the harvest of the land and of livestock, as holy to the LORD. The idea is also used in a more general sense, meaning offering one-tenth of one's income to the Lord.

Tithing was practised before the giving of the OT law

GEN 14:18-14:20 Abraham offered a tenth of the goods taken in battle, apparently in thankfulness to God for victory. See also GEN 28:22; HEB 7:1-7:3

Tithing under the law**Tithing extends to all kinds of produce and livestock**

LEV 27:30-27:32 Cereal and fruit offerings could be commuted to money. See also 2CH 31:5-31:6; NEH 10:35-10:38, NEH 13:12

All tithes were paid to the Levites

NUM 18:21–18:24; ; NEH 10:37–10:38; ; HEB 7:5

Tithes were to be paid in a designated place

DEU 12:5–12:6, DEU 14:22–14:29, DEU 26:2 Tithes were paid in Jerusalem, or every three years in towns where the tithe feast was eaten.

Levites offered a tenth to the LORD

NUM 18:25–18:29; ; NEH 10:39

Uses of the tithe**Support of the Levites**

NUM 18:21 See also 2CH 31:4

The tithe meal

DEU 14:23

A three-yearly gift to the poor

DEU 14:28–14:29

Tithing of minor items must not lead to neglect of major matters

MAT 23:23 See also LUK 11:42, LUK 18:9–18:14

Freewill offerings were made in addition to the tithe**They were given freely**

EXO 36:3 See also LEV 7:12–7:18; NUM 15:3; EZR 1:4; PSA 54:6; EZK 46:12

They were given according to ability

DEU 16:10 See also DEU 16:17; ACT 11:29; 1CO 16:2; 2CO 8:12 There is no specific command in the NT for the church to tithe, but many commands to give generously and to support the Lord's work.

Blessing promised to those who tithe

MAL 3:10 See also PRO 3:9–3:10

Failure to tithe and abuses of the tithe

MAL 3:8–3:10 See also LEV 27:33; 1SA 8:15, 1SA 8:17; NEH 13:10

8489: urgency**The urgency of the call to repent****In the preaching of John the Baptist**

MAT 3:2 parallels MRK 1:4, LUK 3:3

In the preaching of Jesus Christ

MRK 1:15 See also MAT 4:17; LUK 13:3

In the preaching of Peter

ACT 2:38 See also ACT 3:19

In the preaching of Paul

ACT 20:21, ACT 26:20

The urgency of the need to proclaim the gospel

2TI 4:1–4:2 See also JHN 4:35–4:37; 2CO 6:2; 1TH 5:2 in the light of the coming day of the Lord

Examples of urgent summons by officials

NUM 22:37; ; 1SA 21:8; ; DAN 3:22

8490: watchfulness

The state of being alert and expectant; watching over someone in one's care or waiting for the arrival of someone important or for some significant event. Scripture lays particular emphasis on the need to watch for the second coming of Jesus Christ.

8491: watchfulness, divine

The Lord's alertness to the needs of his people, his constant care for them and his awareness of the power and evil intent of their enemies.

The Lord's watchfulness over his people in danger or trouble

PSA 121:1–121:8 See also EXO 3:16; DEU 32:9–32:10; EZR 5:5; PSA 1:6, PSA 11:4–11:5, PSA 17:8, PSA 32:6, PSA 33:16–33:18, PSA 34:7, PSA 127:1, PSA 145:20; ZEC 9:8, ZEC 12:4; MAT 10:29–10:31; JHN 10:1–10:9; 2TI 1:12

The Lord's watchfulness means that his people's needs are met

PSA 146:9 See also GEN 28:15, GEN 48:15; DEU 2:7, DEU 11:12; 2CH 16:9; JOB 10:12, JOB 29:2; JER 24:6, JER 31:28; DAN 9:18

The watchfulness of a shepherd

PSA 23:1, PSA 28:9; ; ISA 40:11; ; MAT 2:6; ; JHN 10:1–10:9

The Lord's watchfulness means that he hears his people's prayers

PSA 34:15 See also 1KI 8:28–8:30 parallel 2CH 6:20; 1KI 9:3 parallel 2CH 7:16; NEH 1:6; 1PE 3:12

The Lord's watchfulness with a view to correction

JER 7:25–7:26 See also JER 7:13, JER 11:7, JER 25:4, JER 32:33; 2SA 22:28; JOB 33:11; JER 16:16–16:17

The Lord's watchfulness in seeking out those who have gone astray

EZK 34:16 See also MAT 18:12 parallel LUK 15:4; 1PE 2:25

People are vulnerable without the Lord's watchfulness

MAT 9:36 See also 1KI 22:17 parallel 2CH 18:16; ISA 13:14; EZK 34:11–34:12

8492: watchfulness, of leaders

Leaders must be alert to the needs of those they serve and also to the dangers that surround believers in the world. The OT teaching on watchmen provides an indication of the importance of watchfulness and the responsibility of those called to be watchful.

Leaders are required to be watchful

EZK 3:17 See also EZK 33:7–33:9; JHN 21:16

They are accountable to God

EZK 3:18 See also MRK 13:34–13:35; HEB 13:17

They must warn against false teachers

ACT 20:31 Elders are called overseers in Acts 20:28; 1Ti 3:2; Tit 1:7; 1Pe 5:2. See also JHN 10:1–10:3; ACT 20:29; 2Ti 4:2–4:5; TIT 1:9–1:11

Examples of leaders' warnings to churches

1CO 4:14 See also ROM 16:17; GAL 5:21; 1TH 4:1; TIT 3:10; REV 22:18

Leaders' watchfulness in prayer

ISA 62:6–62:7 See also 1SA 12:23; ROM 1:9–1:10; EPH 1:16; PHP 1:4; 2TH 1:11

Leaders need to watch over their own lives

ACT 20:28 See also MRK 14:29–14:30; 1Ti 3:2–3:7, 1Ti 4:15–4:16; TIT 1:6–1:8; JAS 3:1; 3JN 1:9–1:10

Watchmen sometimes fail to be watchful

ISA 56:9–56:12; ; EZK 34:1–34:10; ; ZEC 10:2–10:3

8493: watchfulness, of believers

Alertness to dangers and blessings in the Christian life, and also to opportunities to do good.

Watchfulness for dangers

1PE 5:8 See also PRO 4:23

The danger of false teaching

MAT 7:15 See also PSA 94:8; PRO 8:33–8:34; MAT 24:4–24:5; MRK 8:15; ROM 16:17; 1CO 16:13

The danger of temptation

MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38 See also DEU 4:15; 1KI 2:4; LUK 12:15, LUK 17:1–17:3; 1CO 10:12; GAL 6:1; 2JN 1:8

The danger of neglecting the word of God

DEU 4:9 See also JOS 22:5; 1KI 2:3; HEB 2:1, HEB 12:25; 2PE 1:19

The danger of damage to the Lord's work

NEH 4:9, NEH 7:3

The danger of speaking sinfully

PSA 39:1, PSA 141:3; ; PRO 13:3, PRO 21:23; ; JAS 1:26, JAS 3:5–3:8; ; 1PE 3:10

Watchfulness for blessings

PSA 25:15, PSA 59:9, PSA 123:1–123:2, PSA 130:5–130:6; ; ISA 40:9; ; MIC 7:7; ; LUK 2:25, LUK 2:36–2:38

Watchfulness and prayer

COL 4:2–4:3 See also MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38; MRK 13:33; LUK 21:36; EPH 6:18; 1PE 4:7

Watchfulness for the return of Jesus Christ

MAT 24:42–24:44 See also MAT 25:1–25:13; MRK 13:32–13:37; LUK 12:35–12:40, LUK 21:32–21:36; 1TH 5:4–5:8; REV 16:15

Watchfulness for opportunities to serve the Lord

1PE 3:15 See also EPH 5:15–5:16; COL 4:5–4:6

Meeting the needs of others

EPH 6:18 See also MAT 26:36–26:40; GAL 6:10; TIT 3:1

Contrast with the watchfulness of unbelievers with evil intent

PSA 37:32 See also 1SA 18:9, 1SA 19:11; PSA 10:8; JER 20:10; MAT 26:16; MRK 3:2; ACT 9:24

Warning against neglect of watchfulness

REV 3:2–3:3

8495: witnessing

The task of declaring what has happened, especially in relation to the life, death and resurrection of Jesus Christ. Believers are given the responsibility of proclaiming the good news of Jesus Christ to the world at all times and in all places.

8496: witnessing, importance of

Sharing the good news about God and Jesus Christ with others is a work to which some believers have a special calling, but in which all believers are to take part.

Witnessing is sharing the truth of God

PSA 145:10–145:12; LUK 24:46–24:48 See also 1CH 16:7–16:9; PSA 71:15; MAT 27:54 parallels MRK 15:39, LUK 23:47; JHN 1:35–1:36, JHN 4:29

Believers are commanded to witness

MAT 28:18–28:19 See also ISA 12:4–12:5; MAT 24:14 parallel MRK 13:10; ACT 1:8, ACT 9:15–9:16

Special ministries of witnessing

By the prophets

JHN 1:6–1:8 See also JER 1:4–1:9; EZK 33:7–33:9; JON 1:2, JON 1:9; JHN 1:15, JHN 1:29, JHN 1:36; ACT 10:43

By Jesus Christ**JHN 18:37** See also JHN 3:31–3:34; REV 1:5, REV 3:14**By the apostles****ACT 4:33** See also ACT 2:32, ACT 10:39–10:42, ACT 13:30–13:31; 1JN 1:1–1:3**By Christian leaders****2TI 1:8** Paul, in prison for his faith, encourages the young leader, Timothy. See also ACT 8:5; EPH 4:11**Witnessing is a task for all God's people****1PE 2:9, 1PE 3:15** See also PSA 26:6–26:7, PSA 107:1–107:2; ISA 43:10, ISA 43:12, ISA 44:8, ISA 52:7; ACT 8:4**Witnessing is a major aspect of Christian living****ROM 10:9–10:10** See also MAT 10:32–10:33 parallels MRK 8:38, LUK 12:8–12:9; 2CO 4:13; 1JN 2:23, 1JN 4:15**Examples of witnessing to Jesus Christ**

MAT 16:16 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20 Simon Peter; ; LUK 2:16–2:17 shepherds; ; JHN 1:40–1:42 Andrew; ; JHN 1:49 Nathanael; ; JHN 11:27 Martha; ; JHN 20:28 Thomas; ; ACT 8:37 the Ethiopian eunuch

Witnessing recounts personal experience**ISA 63:7** See also PSA 66:16; JER 51:10; DAN 4:2; MAT 9:27–9:31; MRK 1:40–1:45; JHN 9:25; ACT 4:20**Witnessing to the resurrection of Jesus Christ****ACT 2:32** See also LUK 24:33–24:35; ACT 5:30–5:32; 1CO 15:3–15:7**8497: witnessing, approaches to**

Scripture provides teaching, supported by examples, concerning when believers should witness, the methods they are to use, and the manner of doing it.

When and where to witness**In the home and family****MRK 5:18–5:19** parallel LUK 8:38–8:39 See also 2KI 5:1–5:3; JHN 1:41**To individuals****JHN 1:40–1:42** See also JHN 4:7–4:26; ACT 8:30–8:35**To assembled groups****ACT 17:17** See also ACT 5:42, ACT 16:13, ACT 19:8–19:9**Methods of witnessing****Sharing personal testimony****JHN 4:29** See also ACT 22:3–22:8 Paul uses the account of his conversion in witnessing.**Explaining the Scriptures****ACT 8:30–8:35** See also ISA 53:7–53:8; PSA 119:172; ACT 17:1–17:3, ACT 17:10–17:12**Using prophetic gifts****1CO 14:24–14:25****Answering questions****COL 4:6** See also JHN 9:8–9:11, JHN 9:15–9:17, JHN 9:24–9:25; 1PE 3:15**Through writing****JHN 20:31** See also LUK 1:1–1:4**Through holy living****MAT 5:16** See also 1PE 3:1–3:2**Through acts of devotion****MAT 26:6–26:7** parallel MRK 14:3 See also LUK 7:36–7:38; JHN 12:1–12:3**The manner of witnessing****With love****MRK 10:21** See also PHP 1:15–1:17**With urgency****2CO 5:20** See also EZK 33:7–33:9**Fearlessly****EPH 6:19–6:20** See also ACT 4:29**Clearly and courteously****1PE 3:15** See also ACT 26:1–26:3; COL 4:4–4:6**8498: witnessing, and Holy Spirit**

Christian witnessing is made effective through the empowering, strengthening and guiding of the Holy Spirit. Witnessing is an aspect of spiritual warfare, and believers need supernatural aid to face Satan's opposition.

The Holy Spirit supports believers in witnessing**ACT 5:31–5:32** See also JHN 15:26–15:27**The Holy Spirit empowers effective witness****ACT 1:8, 1CO 2:1–2:5** See also LUK 4:14–4:19, LUK 24:48–24:49**He confirms the testimony of believers**

1TH 1:5; ; HEB 2:3–2:4

He convinces people of their need

JHN 16:7–16:11

He brings people to new birth

JHN 3:5–3:8

The Holy Spirit guides believers in witnessing**ACT 8:39–8:40** See also ACT 8:29–8:35, ACT 16:6–16:7

Witnessing and spiritual warfare**REV 12:11** See also EPH 6:15–6:17**Witnessing and persecution****Witnessing results in persecution****REV 1:9** See also ACT 4:17, ACT 5:40, ACT 7:54–7:60 Stephen's witnessing leads him to become the first Christian martyr. The English word "martyr" comes from the Greek word for "witness"; ACT 22:22–22:25; EPH 6:19–6:20; COL 4:3–4:4; 2TI 1:8; REV 2:12–2:13, REV 6:9, REV 17:6**Supernatural help to face persecution****MAT 10:18–10:20** parallels MRK 13:9–13:11, LUK 21:12–21:15 **ACT 7:55** See also ACT 5:18–5:19, ACT 18:9–18:10**Witness is promoted by persecution**

ACT 8:1–8:5; ; PHP 1:12–1:14

8600: Prayer and worship of the believer

- 8602: prayer
- 8622: worship
- 8632: adoration
- 8634: amen
- 8636: asking
- 8638: benedictions
- 8640: calling upon God
- 8642: celebration
- 8644: commemoration
- 8646: doxology
- 8648: enquiring of God
- 8650: hands, lifting up of
- 8652: importunity
- 8656: longing for God
- 8658: Lord's Prayer, the
- 8660: magnifying God
- 8662: meditation
- 8664: praise
- 8670: remembering
- 8672: striving with God
- 8674: study
- 8676: thanksgiving
- 8678: waiting on God

8602: prayer

Fellowship with God through Jesus Christ, expressed in adoration, thanksgiving and intercession, through which believers draw near to God and learn more of his will for their lives. Scripture stresses the vital role of the Holy Spirit in stimulating and guiding prayer.

8603: prayer, as a relationship with God

Prayer is based on God's love for believers. Through his grace, he gives them things which they do not deserve,

while through his mercy he shields them from those things which they do deserve.

God's children can turn to their Father in prayer**Under the old covenant****ISA 64:8–64:9** See also PSA 103:13–103:14; ISA 63:16**Under the new covenant****MAT 6:9–6:13** parallel LUK 11:2–11:4 See also MAT 6:6, MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; ROM 8:15; GAL 4:6**Jesus Christ's prayer life with his Father****MRK 14:36** parallels MAT 26:39, MAT 26:42, LUK 22:42 See also JHN 17:1–17:26**It is possible to approach God in prayer because of Jesus Christ's sacrifice****HEB 10:19–10:22** See also EPH 3:12; HEB 7:15–7:19**Prayer reflects a longing after God****PSA 42:1–42:2; JER 29:12–29:13** See also PSA 130:5–130:6, PSA 145:18–145:19; PRO 8:17; ISA 26:9, ISA 33:2; LAM 3:25**8604: prayer, as a response to God**

Prayer offers believers a means of acknowledging the character and purposes of God and the opportunity to seek guidance concerning his will for them.

The direction of prayer is upwards towards God**PSA 123:1–123:2** See also PSA 25:1, PSA 86:4, PSA 121:1–121:2, PSA 143:8, PSA 145:15**Fellowship with God through prayer****PSA 73:23–73:26** See also EXO 33:11; 1KI 8:57–8:59; PSA 16:2, PSA 145:17–145:20; MAT 18:20**The habit of prayer****LUK 5:16** See also NEH 2:4 Nehemiah felt so close to God that it was automatic for him to speak to God and the king almost simultaneously; DAN 6:10–6:11, DAN 6:13**Contemplative prayer as a response to God's presence****PSA 27:4** See also 1CH 16:10–16:11 parallel PSA 105:3–105:4; PSA 27:8; ISA 55:6; JER 29:13; ACT 17:27–17:28; HEB 11:6**Prayer of acceptance in response to God's call****ISA 3:10** See also ISA 6:8; REV 3:20**Prayer of confession****In response to God's holiness****1JN 1:5–1:9** See also ISA 6:3–6:7, ISA 55:7–55:9

In response to sin being exposed**PSA 51:1–51:2** See also PSA 51:3–51:12**Prayer of co-operation in response to God's purposes****JHN 15:7–15:8** See also PSA 119:105–119:106; LUK 1:38; JHN 15:16**Prayer of confidence in response to God's mercy and grace****HEB 4:16** See also NEH 1:4–1:7; PSA 123:1–123:2; JAS 1:5–1:8**8605: prayer, and God's will**

Prayer is concerned not only with the well-being of the one who prays. A vital aspect of its purpose is to allow the will of God to be done, and to bring glory and honour to his name.

True motives for prayer**The desire that God's name be honoured****MAT 6:9–6:13** parallel LUK 11:2–11:4 See also NUM 14:13–14:16; JOS 7:7–7:9; 2SA 7:25–7:26; 1KI 18:36–18:37; PSA 115:1; JHN 17:1**The desire that God's will be fulfilled****MAT 6:9–6:13** parallel LUK 11:2–11:4 See also MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; MAT 26:42; HEB 10:7 Submission to God's will characterised Jesus Christ's prayer life.**God answers prayer that accords with his will****1JN 5:14–5:15****Petitioners may enquire of God to discover his will****PSA 143:10** See also GEN 25:22–25:23; JDG 1:1–1:2; 2SA 2:1; 1CH 14:14–14:15**The Holy Spirit helps believers to pray in God's will****ROM 8:26–8:27****God's response to prayers allows believers to discern his will****2CO 12:7–12:9** See also EXO 33:18–33:20; 2SA 12:15–12:18; JOB 19:7–19:8; PSA 35:13–35:14**God does not respond to the prayers of the wicked****JHN 9:31** See also PSA 66:18; PRO 15:8; ISA 1:15, ISA 59:1–59:2; LAM 3:44; 1PE 3:12**8606: prayer, and Holy Spirit**See [3221: Holy Spirit, and prayer](#)**8607: prayer, God's promises concerning**

God promises to hear and respond to the prayers of his people, when they pray in the name of his Son and according to his will.

God expects his people to make requests of him in prayer**MAT 7:7–7:11** parallel LUK 11:9–11:13 See also MAT 21:22**God promises to answer prayer in the name of Jesus Christ****JHN 14:13–14:14, JHN 15:7** See also JHN 15:16, JHN 16:23–16:24**God promises to respond to the prayers of his people in times of need****PSA 91:14–91:16** See also PSA 50:14–50:15**God promises to hear the prayers of the oppressed****PSA 10:17** See also EXO 22:22–22:23, EXO 22:26–22:27; PSA 102:19–102:20; ISA 41:17**God promises to hear the prayers of the truly penitent****2CH 7:14** See also EZK 36:37; ZEC 10:6, ZEC 13:8–13:9**God promises to hear the prayers of his obedient people****1JN 3:22****The need in prayer to have confidence in God's promises****MRK 11:24; 1JN 5:14** See also MAT 18:19**8608: prayer, and worship**

Worship is turning to God in awe, praise and joy, as his people realise how wonderful he is. Prayer is a natural part of worship: to know God is to want to worship him and pray to him.

Worship is a fundamental requirement of life**All nations are exhorted to worship God****1CH 16:28–16:29** See also PSA 29:1–29:2, PSA 96:9**Israel is commanded to worship God****2KI 17:36** See also PSA 95:6–95:7, PSA 99:4–99:5**Right attitudes in worship are imperative****Reverence and humility characterise acceptable worship****HEB 12:28–12:29** See also PSA 5:7, PSA 95:6, PSA 138:2; ECC 5:1

Honesty, without hypocrisy, characterises acceptable worship

AMO 5:21–5:24 See also MAT 15:7–15:9 parallel MRK 7:6–7:7; ISA 29:13; LUK 18:9–18:14; JHN 4:24

Prayer can focus on different aspects of God's character

Prayer can focus on God's holiness

EXO 15:11 See also PSA 77:13, PSA 96:9, PSA 99:5

Prayer can focus on God's glory

PSA 19:1–19:6 See also PSA 29:1–29:2, PSA 138:5; ROM 16:27; PHP 4:20; JUD 1:25

Prayer can focus on God's majesty

PSA 104:1–104:4 See also PSA 8:1, PSA 76:4, PSA 96:4–96:6

Prayer can focus on God's kingship

PSA 97:1 See also PSA 9:7, PSA 22:3, PSA 93:1, PSA 95:3, PSA 102:12

Prayer can focus on God's love and compassion

PSA 103:1–103:18 See also PSA 111:4, PSA 118:1–118:4, PSA 145:17–145:20

Prayer can focus on God's justice and righteousness

PSA 97:2 See also PSA 7:17, PSA 9:8, PSA 97:6, PSA 111:3

Prayer can focus on God's creative activity

NEH 9:6 See also PSA 90:2, PSA 95:3–95:7, PSA 102:25–102:27, PSA 104:5–104:9, PSA 104:24–104:26

8609: prayer, as praise and thanksgiving

Prayer embraces praising God for who he is, thanking him for what he has already done, and looking forward with joy to what he has promised to do in the future.

Scripture exhorts God's people to praise and thank him

PHP 4:6 See also PSA 66:1, PSA 68:4, PSA 95:1–95:2, PSA 105:1–105:3; EPH 5:19–5:20; COL 4:2; 1TH 5:16–5:18; HEB 13:15

Praise and thanksgiving in prayer for God's goodness towards his people

Praise and thanksgiving for deliverance and salvation

PSA 65:1–65:5 See also PSA 66:5–66:6, PSA 81:1–81:7, PSA 124:1–124:8; JON 2:1–2:9

Praise and thanksgiving for provision of material needs

MRK 8:6 parallel MAT 15:36 See also PSA 65:9–65:13; MAT 26:26–26:27 parallels MRK 14:22–14:23, LUK 22:19–22:20

Praise and thanksgiving for help in time of trouble

PSA 34:1–34:4 See also PSA 30:1–30:12, PSA 40:1–40:5, PSA 103:1–103:5, PSA 116:1–116:19

Praise and thanksgiving for the encouragement of other believers

PHP 1:3–1:6 See also ROM 1:8; 2CO 8:1; EPH 1:16; 2TH 1:3

Notable songs of praise and thanksgiving

EXO 15:1–15:18 Moses, on crossing the Red Sea; 2SA 22:2–22:51; ; PSA 18:1–18:50; 1CH 16:8–16:36 David, on bringing the ark to Jerusalem; ; LUK 1:46–1:55 Mary, on learning that she was to be the mother of Jesus Christ

8610: prayer, as asking God

God wants his people to turn to him in prayer, individually and corporately, in times of need or crisis, and to bring requests to him as a Father.

God's people are commanded to bring their requests to him

PHP 4:6 See also 1CH 16:11; MAT 7:7 parallel LUK 11:9; JHN 16:24; EPH 6:18–6:20; 1TH 5:17; JAS 5:13

Prayer for deliverance from difficulty

PSA 4:1, PSA 107:6 See also PSA 40:2–40:3; JON 2:1–2:3; ACT 12:5

Prayer for deliverance from enemies

PSA 17:8–17:9, PSA 35:4 See also 2KI 19:9–19:11; 2CH 14:11

Prayers of individuals in time of crisis

Jacob's prayer

GEN 32:9–32:12

David's prayers

PSA 28:1–28:9 See also PSA 4:1, PSA 5:1–5:3, PSA 30:8–30:10, PSA 142:1–142:7

Elijah's prayer

1KI 19:4

Jeremiah's prayer

See also JER 15:15–15:18

Jesus Christ's prayers

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35–14:36, LUK 22:42–22:44

Individual petition to God in prayer

Individual prayer for guidance

GEN 24:12–24:14 See also JDG 1:1–1:2, JDG 6:36–6:40; 1SA 14:41; 2SA 2:1; 1CH 14:14–14:15

Individual prayer for healing

2KI 20:1–20:11 parallel ISA 38:1–38:10

Individual prayer for the birth of a child**ISA 1:10–1:11** See also GEN 25:21, GEN 30:17**Corporate petition to God****Corporate prayer for deliverance****EXO 2:23** See also NUM 20:15–20:16; DEU 26:6–26:8; JDG 3:9, JDG 4:3, JDG 6:7–6:10; 1SA 12:8**Corporate prayer for restoration**

PSA 44:23–44:26, PSA 79:8–79:9, PSA 80:4–80:7, PSA 85:4–85:7

Corporate prayer for protection, especially at times of crisis**EZR 8:21–8:23** See also 2CH 20:12–20:13; EZR 10:1; EST 4:16; PSA 74:18–74:23; DAN 2:17–2:18**The first Christians prayed together when they met****ACT 1:13–1:14** See also ACT 2:42, ACT 2:46–2:47, ACT 16:13, ACT 16:16, ACT 20:36, ACT 21:5**The first Christians prayed together at times of crisis or important decisions****When threatened with punishment****ACT 4:24–4:31** See also ACT 12:5, ACT 12:12**When Barnabas and Saul were sent off by the church at Antioch**

ACT 13:3

When Paul and Silas experienced persecution

ACT 16:25

Prayers for mercy and grace**PSA 143:1; HEB 4:16** See also 2CH 6:18–6:19; PSA 130:1–130:2; MAT 20:30–20:31**8611: prayer, for others**

Believers should pray, not only for their own needs, but for those of others. Scripture provides many examples of intercession, and commends it as pleasing to God.

Believers must value others**PHP 2:3–2:4****Examples of praying for others****Moses prays for the Israelites****DEU 9:18–9:19** See also EXO 32:9–32:14, EXO 34:9; NUM 14:11–14:19; DEU 9:25–9:29**Samuel prays for Israel****1SA 7:5–7:9** See also 1SA 12:19–12:23**Job prays for his friends****JOB 42:10****Jeremiah prays for Judah****JER 7:16** God forbade the prophet Jeremiah to pray for his people because they were unrepentant sinners. See also JER 11:14, JER 14:11**Jesus Christ intercedes for believers****ROM 8:34** See also ISA 53:12; HEB 7:25; 1JN 2:1**The Holy Spirit intercedes for believers****ROM 8:26–8:27****Christians are to intercede for others****Christians are to pray for their enemies****MAT 5:44** See also LUK 6:28, LUK 23:34; ACT 7:60**Christians are to pray for one another****EPH 6:18** See also 1TH 5:25; PHM 1:22; HEB 13:18–13:19; JAS 5:14–5:16; 1JN 5:16**Christians are to pray for rulers****1TI 2:1–2:2****Examples of pleas made to Jesus Christ on behalf of others**

See also MAT 8:5–8:13 parallel LUK 7:1–7:10; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; MAT 17:14–17:20 parallels MRK 9:14–9:29, LUK 9:37–9:42

Examples of notable prayers of intercession

2KI 19:14–19:19 parallel ISA 37:14–37:20 Hezekiah for deliverance; ; EZR 8:21–8:23 Ezra for a safe journey; ; DAN 9:1–9:19 Daniel for Jerusalem; ; JHN 17:6–17:26 Jesus Christ for his disciples; EPH 1:15–1:21, EPH 3:14–3:21; COL 1:9–1:13 Paul for the believers in Colosse

8612: prayer, and faith

Effective prayer depends on faith, especially on a willingness to trust in God's faithfulness to his promises to his people.

Faith is necessary in order to approach God**HEB 11:6****Faith is necessary to receive benefits from God****MRK 6:5–6:6; JAS 5:16–5:18** See also EPH 3:12; HEB 10:22**Faith is necessary for effective prayer****MAT 21:21–21:22** parallel MRK 11:22–11:24 **JAS 1:5–1:8** See also JAS 5:14–5:15**Jesus Christ responded to people's need on the basis of faith****MAT 9:27–9:30** See also MAT 8:5–8:13 parallel LUK 7:1–7:10; MAT 9:20–9:22 parallels MRK 5:25–5:34, LUK 8:43–8:48; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30

Examples of notable prayers of faith

1KI 18:36–18:37 Elijah, in contest with the prophets of Baal; ; JAS 5:17–5:18 Elijah, praying about rain; ; 1KI 17:19–17:22 Elijah and the widow's son; ; 2KI 4:32–4:35 Elisha and the Shunammite's son

8613: prayer, persistence in

An answer to prayer may not come immediately. Petitioners are to continue praying earnestly. This requires patience, determination and, at times, a willingness to wrestle with God for the desired outcome.

The principle of persistence in prayer

Prayer should be made with patience and perseverance

PSA 40:1, PSA 88:1 See also 1CH 16:11; PSA 116:2

Jesus Christ taught his disciples to persist in prayer
LUK 18:1–18:8 See also LUK 11:5–11:10

Persistence in prayer was exemplified in the early church

ACT 1:14 See also ACT 2:42

Paul exhorted the churches to practise persistent prayer

EPH 6:18 See also ROM 12:12; 1TH 5:17

Examples of persistence in prayer

Abraham pleads persistently for Sodom
GEN 18:23–18:33

Jacob persists in wrestling with God
GEN 32:24–32:32

Moses persists in interceding for Israel
DEU 9:25–9:29 See also EXO 32:31–32:32

Hannah persistently asks for a son
1SA 1:10–1:11

Elijah persists in prayer about the rain
JAS 5:17–5:18 See also 1KI 18:36–18:44

The psalmists persist in calling out to God
PSA 88:1–88:18, PSA 119:147–119:149, PSA 130:1–130:6

Jesus Christ persisted in pursuing the Father's will
LUK 22:42–22:44 parallels MAT 26:36–26:43, MRK 14:32–14:40

Persistence in prayer is exemplified in waiting for God

MIC 7:7 See also PSA 27:14, PSA 33:20, PSA 37:7, PSA 38:15, PSA 40:1; ISA 26:8

8614: prayer, answers to

God has promised to answer prayer for personal or corporate needs and for the needs of others.

God answers the prayers of individuals

God answers the psalmists' prayers

PSA 145:18–145:19 See also PSA 3:4, PSA 6:8–6:9, PSA 30:2–30:3, PSA 66:19–66:20, PSA 116:1–116:2, PSA 118:5, PSA 138:3

God answers Moses' prayers

EXO 15:23–15:25, EXO 17:4–17:7; ; NUM 11:10–11:17

God answers Hannah's prayer for a son

1SA 1:27 See also 1SA 1:10–1:20

God answers the prayers of the prophets

PSA 99:6 See also 1SA 7:9; LAM 3:55–3:57; JON 2:1–2:2; JAS 5:17–5:18

God answers the prayers of the kings of Israel

1KI 9:3; ; 2CH 18:31

God answers corporate petition

Answered prayer for deliverance from hardship

DEU 26:7–26:8 See also EXO 2:23–2:25, EXO 3:7–3:9; NUM 20:16; 1SA 12:8; PSA 81:7

Answered prayer for deliverance from enemies

1SA 12:10–12:11 See also JDG 3:9, JDG 3:15; 2KI 19:19–19:20; 1CH 5:20

God answers the prayer of the oppressed

JAS 5:4 See also EXO 22:22–22:23; JOB 34:28

God answers prayer for healing

JAS 5:14–5:16 See also NUM 12:10–12:15; 1KI 17:21–17:22; 2KI 4:32–4:35, 2KI 20:1–20:6 parallels 2CH 32:24, ISA 38:1–38:6; MAT 8:2–8:3 parallels MRK 1:40–1:42, LUK 5:12–5:13; ACT 9:40

God answers prayer for others

DEU 9:18–9:19 See also 1SA 7:8–7:9; ACT 12:5–12:8

8615: prayer, doubts about

Sometimes God does not seem to answer prayer, causing his people to doubt him. Scripture affirms God's faithfulness to those who pray according to his will, and points out that the human understanding of a situation is limited.

Examples of God's servants questioning his promises

EXO 5:22–5:23 See also GEN 15:2–15:3; JOS 7:7–7:9

Examples of God's servants questioning the tasks he has given them

NUM 11:11–11:15 See also 1KI 19:4; JER 15:15–15:18, JER 20:7–20:9, JER 20:14–20:18; JON 4:1–4:3; MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; PSA 22:1

Examples of God's servants expressing their anger and confusion in prayer

JOB 10:2–10:22 See also JOB 13:20–13:27, JOB 14:1–14:22; PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 42:9–42:10, PSA 44:22–44:26, PSA 77:7–77:9, PSA 80:4–80:6, PSA 88:6–88:9; HAB 1:2–1:3

God's response to prayers of questioning or complaint

God reiterates his promises to those who question him

GEN 15:2–15:5 See also EXO 6:1–6:8

God provides help for those who question him
1KI 19:1–19:8

God rebukes those who question him

JOB 40:1–40:9 See also JER 15:19–15:21

God explains events to those who question him
HAB 1:5–1:11

8616: prayerlessness

Without prayer any relationship with God is impoverished because vital communication is lost.

Reasons for prayerlessness

Unbelief

PSA 14:1–14:4 parallel PSA 53:1–53:4 See also JOB 21:15; ROM 3:11

Self-reliance

JER 17:5 See also ZEP 3:2

Worship of other gods

DEU 32:17–32:18 See also JER 2:5–2:6, JER 2:8

Guilt as a result of disobedience

GEN 3:9–3:12 Adam and Eve did not respond to their sin by praying. On the contrary they sought to hide from God; ; JON 1:1–1:6 Jonah tried to run away from God.

Tiredness

LUK 22:45 See also MAT 26:40 parallel MRK 14:37; MAT 26:43–26:45 parallel MRK 14:40–14:41

Discord in relationship

1PE 3:7

Examples of prayerlessness

Joshua, after a great victory

JOS 7:2–7:5 Joshua devised his own plan in attacking Ai and did not seek the LORD until after he suffered a disastrous defeat.

King Ahaziah, turning to idols

2KI 1:16 See also 2KI 1:1–1:6

The nominal religion of Israel

ISA 43:22 This verse implies that prayer involves effort—the people only paid lip service to God. See also ISA 1:14, ISA 64:7

Israel trusts in other people rather than God

ISA 30:1–30:2, ISA 31:1

Israel's failure to repent of their sins

DAN 9:13 See also ISA 9:13; JER 5:3

The lack of an intercessor among God's people

EZK 22:30

Consequences of prayerlessness

Alienation from God

JHN 15:6 See also PSA 73:27

God's judgment

ZEP 1:4–1:6 See also JER 10:21

Disloyalty to Jesus Christ

MAT 26:74 parallels MRK 14:71, LUK 22:60, JHN 18:27 Peter had previously failed to pray in Gethsemane.

Spiritual poverty

JAS 4:2 See also 2KI 17:15; JER 2:5

Ineffective ministry

1SA 2:12 This literally means they had no fellowship with the LORD; ; 1SA 12:23; ; JHN 15:4–15:5

Conflicts with others because of unfulfilled desires

JAS 4:1–4:4

8617: prayer, advice for effective

Scripture provides guidance concerning what attitudes and actions are appropriate for effective prayer. It also identifies a number of motives which are likely to lead to prayers being unanswered.

Hindrances to prayer

Sin

ISA 59:2 See also PSA 66:18; JER 14:10–14:12; LAM 3:42–3:44; MIC 3:4

Disobedience

ZEC 7:13 See also DEU 1:43–1:45; PRO 1:28–1:31

Selfishness**JAS 4:3****Injustice****ISA 1:15–1:17** See also PRO 21:13; ISA 58:1–58:7**Lack of faith****JAS 1:6–1:7****Qualities that lead to effective prayer****Humility****LUK 18:9–18:14** See also 2SA 7:18; 2CH 7:14; PSA 51:16–51:17; ISA 57:15; MAT 8:8 parallel LUK 7:6**Obedience****1JN 3:21–3:22** See also 1SA 15:22; JER 7:22–7:23**Righteousness****PRO 15:29** See also 1KI 3:11–3:12; PSA 34:15**Single-mindedness****JER 29:13** See also DEU 4:29; 1CH 28:9**Faith****MAT 21:21–21:22** parallel MRK 11:22–11:24 See also MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; MAT 8:5–8:13 parallel LUK 7:1–7:10; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; JHN 14:12–14:14**8618: prayerfulness**

An attitude by which a constant relationship between God and believers is developed.

Prayerfulness is a way of life**LUK 2:37** See also PSA 5:3; PSA 55:17; PSA 109:4; DAN 6:10–6:11; DAN 6:13**Prayerfulness arises from a desire to be with God****PSA 130:5–130:6** See also PSA 42:1–42:4; PSA 84:1–84:2**Prayerfulness arises from an awareness of need that can only be met by God****1TI 5:5** See also PSA 86:1; PSA 105:4**Prayerfulness demonstrates a continuing trust in God****JHN 15:5–15:8** See also PSA 63:1–63:8**Prayerfulness involves a heart that is right with God****ISA 1:15–1:17** See also MAT 6:7; MRK 12:40 parallel LUK 20:47**Prayerfulness involves the need to be alert****MAT 26:41** parallels MRK 14:38; LUK 22:40 See also MIC 7:7; LUK 21:36; COL 4:2**Prayerfulness needs to be maintained especially in difficult circumstances****LUK 18:1** See also HAB 3:16–3:19; ACT 16:25; 1TH 5:17; 1PE 4:7**Examples of people whose prayerfulness proved effective****Hannah, who prayed for a child****1SA 1:20** See also ISA 1:10–1:18**Elijah, an ordinary man who prayed****JAS 5:17–5:18** See also 1KI 17:1; 1KI 18:41–18:46**Nehemiah, a man who discovered God's plan through prayer****NEH 1:4** See also NEH 1:5–1:11; NEH 2:4–2:5**David, sustained through trials****1SA 30:6** See also 2SA 22:1–22:4 parallel PSA 18:1–18:3; PSA 3:1–3:8**Daniel, whose patience in prayer was rewarded****DAN 10:12** See also DAN 9:1–9:19**Jesus Christ, who perfectly trusted his Father****HEB 5:7** See also LUK 5:16; JHN 11:41–11:42**The early church, which was founded upon prayer****ACT 1:14** See also ACT 2:42; ACT 4:23–4:31; ACT 6:4; ACT 12:5**Paul, who prayed for all the churches which he founded or visited****COL 1:9** See also ROM 1:9–1:10; EPH 1:16; PHP 1:4; 1TH 3:10; 2TH 1:11; 2TI 1:3; PHM 1:4**8619: prayer, in the church**

The prayer life of the NT provides a pattern from which the modern church can learn, both in terms of the importance of prayer, and also matters for prayer.

Prayer was at the centre of the life of the early church**They prayed when they met together****ACT 1:14** See also ACT 2:42; ACT 4:23–4:31; ACT 12:12; ACT 20:36; ACT 21:5**They prayed about the selection and ordination of Christian leaders****ACT 13:2–13:3** See also ACT 1:24–1:25; ACT 6:6; ACT 14:23**They prayed during persecution****ACT 12:5** See also ACT 7:59–7:60; ACT 12:12; ACT 16:22–16:25**They prayed for healing****ACT 9:40** See also ACT 28:7–28:8

The apostles' teaching on prayer in church life

The importance of prayer

COL 4:2 See also ROM 12:12; EPH 6:18; 1TH 5:17; 1TI 2:1; 1PE 4:7

Prayer for the spread of the gospel

COL 4:3–4:4 See also EPH 6:19–6:20; 2TH 3:1

Prayer for the sick

JAS 5:14

Prayer for sinners

1JN 5:16–5:17 See also JAS 5:16

Prayer for God's servants

ROM 15:30 See also 2CO 1:11

Orderly conduct of public prayer

1CO 11:4–11:5 See also 1CO 11:13–11:15

The practice of the apostles

Prayer was central to their ministry

ACT 6:3–6:4

They prayed for the church

COL 1:9–1:10 See also EPH 1:16–1:21, EPH 3:16–3:19; PHP 1:9–1:11; COL 1:3; 1TH 1:2; 2TH 1:11–1:12

8620: prayer, practicalities of

Scripture commends a life of prayer, characterised by simplicity of expression, sincerity of heart and trust in the promises of God. It gives guidance on how, when and where to pray.

Scripture stresses the importance of prayer

1TH 5:16–5:18 See also ACT 6:3–6:4; ROM 12:12

Judgment comes on those who do not pray

PSA 79:6 See also PSA 53:4; JER 10:21; ZEP 1:4–1:6; JAS 4:2

Prayers should be expressed simply

MAT 6:7–6:8 See also ECC 5:1–5:3; LUK 18:9–18:14

Prayer should not be ostentatious

MAT 6:5–6:6 See also MAT 14:23 parallel MRK 6:46; LUK 5:16

Physical positions for prayer

Sitting while praying

2SA 7:18 See also JDG 20:26; NEH 1:4

Kneeling while praying

LUK 22:41 See also 1KI 8:54; 2CH 6:13; EZR 9:5; ACT 9:40, ACT 21:5; EPH 3:14

Standing while praying

1KI 8:22 See also 1SA 1:26; MRK 11:25

Lying prostrate while praying

2CH 20:18 See also GEN 24:52; NUM 20:6

Praying with arms outstretched

EXO 9:29; ISA 1:15 See also 1KI 8:54; 2CH 6:13

Praying with hands raised

1TI 2:8 See also EXO 9:29; 1KI 8:22, 1KI 8:54; PSA 63:4, PSA 77:1–77:2

Prayer can be offered at any time

Praying several times a day

DAN 6:10 See also PSA 55:17, PSA 88:1

Praying early in the morning

MRK 1:35 See also PSA 5:3, PSA 119:147

Praying all night

LUK 6:12 See also 1SA 15:11; LUK 2:37

Prayer is not confined to any single place

JHN 4:21–4:24

Praying inside a building

DAN 6:10; MAT 6:6 See also 1KI 8:28–8:30

Praying outside a building

MRK 1:35; LUK 5:16 See also ACT 10:9, ACT 21:5

Prayer may be accompanied by fasting

ACT 13:2–13:3 See also EZR 8:23; NEH 1:4; PSA 35:13; DAN 9:3; LUK 2:37, LUK 5:33; ACT 14:23; MAT 17:21 parallel MRK 9:29

8622: worship

The praise, adoration and reverence of God, both in public and private. It is a celebration of the worthiness of God, by which honour is given to his name.

8623: worship, of God alone

God alone is worthy of worship; the worship of other gods is forbidden. In the NT worship is offered to the Son of God.

God alone is to be worshipped

He alone is worthy of worship

1CH 16:25 The English word “worship” means literally “worth-ship”. See also PSA 48:1, PSA 96:4–96:5, PSA 145:3; 2SA 22:4

The worship of God the Father

JHN 4:23 See also PHP 2:11

The worship of God the Son

MAT 2:11, MAT 14:33; JHN 20:28 See also MAT 28:16–28:17; JHN 9:35–9:38; PHP 2:9–2:11; HEB 1:6; REV 5:8–5:14

Angels worship God

PSA 103:20, PSA 148:1–148:2 See also PSA 29:1–29:2; ISA 6:1–6:4; EZK 10:1–10:18; REV 4:8–4:9

The worship of other gods forbidden

EXO 20:3 parallel DEU 5:7 **2KI 17:35–17:36** See also EXO 34:14; DEU 6:13–6:14; NEH 9:6; PSA 86:9–86:10; PSA 97:7; ACT 10:25–10:26; ACT 14:13–14:18

The worship of angels forbidden

COL 2:18 See also REV 19:9–19:10; REV 22:8–22:9

8624: worship, reasons for

The supreme reason for human existence is to worship God for his love, greatness and saving deeds.

To worship is a divine command

MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8 See also DEU 6:13; EXO 23:25; 2KI 17:36; 1CH 16:29; PSA 22:23; PSA 29:2; PSA 68:26; PSA 113:1; PSA 117:1; PSA 148:11–148:13; PSA 150:6; 1TI 2:8; REV 14:7

God's people are to be a worshipping people

1PE 2:9 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; PSA 105:1–105:6; ISA 43:21; REV 1:5–1:6

Worship is the response of God's people**To God's love**

EXO 4:31 See also DEU 6:5; DEU 12:7; DEU 26:10–26:11; 2CH 7:3; PSA 95:6–95:7; PSA 117:1–117:2; PSA 138:2

To God's holy presence

1CH 16:29 parallel PSA 96:8–96:9 See also EXO 33:10; LEV 10:3; JOS 5:13–5:15; PSA 29:2; PSA 99:5; REV 4:8; REV 15:4

To God's greatness

PSA 95:1–95:3 See also EXO 3:12; PSA 22:27–22:28; PSA 66:1–66:4; PSA 96:1–96:3; REV 15:3–15:4

To the deeds of God

GEN 8:20 Noah's response to God's deliverance from the flood. See also GEN 12:7 God's promise of an inheritance to Abraham **EXO 4:29–4:31, EXO 12:27, EXO 15:1, EXO 15:20 EZR 3:10–3:11; ISA 19:21; DAN 3:28** God's deliverance of Daniel in Babylon; **MAT 9:7–9:8** parallels **MRK 2:12, LUK 5:25–5:26** the healing of the paralytic; **ACT 3:8** the healing of the crippled beggar

To the fear of God

PSA 22:23; HEB 12:28 See also PSA 2:11; ACT 10:2

8625: worship, acceptable attitudes in

True worship is not the mechanical repetition of rituals, but should be wholehearted and reverent. It should be based upon trustful and obedient lives, in that obedience is itself to be seen as an act of worship.

Worship should be in accordance with God's commands

GEN 22:2 See also GEN 12:1; GEN 12:7–12:8; DEU 30:16–30:20; 1SA 15:22; PSA 40:6–40:8; JER 7:2; DAN 3:28; ACT 13:2; ROM 12:1

Worship should not be mechanical

JHN 4:23–4:24 See also HEB 10:1

Worship should give God the honour due to him

1CH 16:29 parallel PSA 96:8–96:9

Worship of mere human devising is unacceptable

ISA 29:13 See also LEV 10:1; MAT 15:7–15:9 parallel **MRK 7:6–7:7; PHP 3:3; COL 2:23**

Worship should be orderly and reverent

1CO 14:40 See also 1CH 16:37–16:42; 1KI 18:30–18:39; 1CO 14:26

Worship should be grounded in godly and obedient living

MIC 6:6–6:8; ROM 12:1 See also PSA 15:1–15:5; PSA 24:3–24:4; 1TI 2:10

The proper attitude of worshippers**Preparation for worship**

1CO 11:28 See also LEV 16:3–16:4; 2SA 12:20; 2CH 7:1; MAT 2:11

Wholeheartedness

DEU 6:5 See also EXO 34:14; DEU 10:12; JOS 22:5; 1SA 12:24; PSA 27:4; MAT 22:37 parallel **MRK 12:30; LUK 10:27**

Confidence in approaching God

HEB 10:22–10:23 See also GEN 4:4; JAS 4:8; HEB 7:19; HEB 11:4

8626: worship, places of

Under the old covenant, there were rules governing the places where worship might be offered but under the new covenant the earthly location is of no importance.

Worship at places commemorating some act of God

GEN 12:7 See also GEN 8:20; GEN 26:23–26:25; GEN 35:1

Worship at a place chosen by God

DEU 12:13–12:14 See also GEN 22:2; DEU 14:23–14:25; 1CH 21:18–21:19; 2CH 7:15–7:16

Worship in certain sacred places

DEU 12:5 See also EXO 3:12; DEU 26:2; ISA 1:3, ISA 1:28; ISA 27:13; JHN 4:20

Worship at the Tent of Meeting

EXO 25:8–25:9 See also EXO 29:42–29:43, EXO 33:10; LEV 17:1–17:5

Worship at the temple in Jerusalem

1CH 22:1 See also 2CH 7:15–7:16, 2CH 29:27–29:30; NEH 8:6; LUK 1:8–1:10, LUK 2:37; ACT 8:27

Worship in a synagogue

LUK 4:16 See also ACT 13:15, ACT 15:21, ACT 17:2

Worship in the home

DAN 6:10 See also MAT 6:6; ROM 16:5; 1CO 16:19; COL 4:15; PHM 1:2

The earthly location for worship is unimportant

JHN 4:21–4:24 See also GEN 24:26, GEN 47:31; JDG 7:15; JOB 1:20

In heaven worship is perfect

LUK 2:13; ; HEB 12:22; ; REV 4:9–4:11, REV 5:13–5:14, REV 7:9–7:12, REV 19:4–19:7

8627: worship, elements of

Praise and thankfulness are important elements of worship, which also includes confession of sin, the reading of Scripture and music.

Worship with awe

DEU 10:12 See also LEV 10:1–10:3; 2CH 7:3; PSA 2:11, PSA 68:35, PSA 96:9; ECC 5:1

Worship includes trust

PSA 4:5 See also PSA 37:7; HEB 11:6

Worship includes praise

PSA 22:22, PSA 107:32; HEB 13:15 See also 2CH 31:2; NEH 9:5–9:6; PSA 150:1–150:6; HEB 2:12; REV 7:11–7:12

Worship includes thanksgiving

PSA 100:4; REV 11:16–11:17 See also 2CH 7:3; PSA 50:14, PSA 50:23; EPH 5:19–5:20; PHP 4:6; REV 7:11–7:12

Worship with joy

PSA 95:1 See also PSA 27:6, PSA 43:4, PSA 100:2; LUK 24:52–24:53; ACT 2:46–2:47

Worship includes the confession of Jesus Christ as Lord

HEB 13:15

Worship includes confession of sin

HOS 14:2 See also LEV 16:21; NEH 9:2; PSA 66:18

Worship includes the reading of God's word

COL 3:16; 1TI 4:13 See also NEH 8:5–8:6, NEH 9:3

Worship includes music and song

PSA 95:2–95:3 See also 2SA 6:5; PSA 100:2; EPH 5:19–5:20

Worship includes dance

PSA 149:3 See also EXO 15:20; PSA 30:11

8628: worship, hindrances to

True worship goes beyond mere form and can therefore be hindered by a wrong relationship to God or to others.

Worship that is merely formal is unacceptable

1SA 15:22 See also ISA 1:13; EZK 33:31; HOS 6:6; MAT 6:5; 2TI 3:5

Worship is hindered by wrong relationships**To God**

PSA 66:18; MAT 15:7–15:9 parallel MRK 7:6–7:7 See also ISA 29:13; PSA 32:5–32:6; ISA 59:2, ISA 64:7; JAS 4:3

To others

ISA 1:11–1:17; MAT 5:23–5:24 See also AMO 5:21–5:24

8629: worship, times for

Scripture stresses the importance of regular worship, while at the same time recognising that believers may worship God spontaneously.

Examples of regular worship**On a daily basis**

ACT 2:46–2:47 See also EXO 29:38–29:43; PSA 141:2; EZK 46:13–46:15

Several times a day

DAN 6:10 See also 1CH 16:37; PSA 119:164; ACT 3:1; HEB 10:25

On holy days

2CH 8:12–8:13 See also EZK 46:3

At the three annual pilgrim festivals

DEU 16:16 EXO 12:1–12:20; ; LUK 2:41; EXO 34:22; ; ACT 2:1; EXO 23:16; ; LEV 23:33–23:36; ; NUM 29:12–29:39; ; DEU 16:13–16:15

On the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:34 See also EXO 30:10; LEV 16:3–16:33, LEV 23:26–23:32

On Sabbath days

LUK 4:16 See also LEV 24:5–24:8; NUM 28:9–28:10

Examples of spontaneous worship**In response to an awareness of the closeness of God**

EXO 34:8; ; JDG 7:15

In response to the experience of God's mercy

EXO 4:29–4:31 See also ISA 1:19–1:28

In response to the presence and power of Jesus Christ

MAT 28:8–28:9 See also MAT 14:33; LUK 24:52

Worship should not be dependent on circumstances

PHP 4:6 See also JOB 1:20–1:21; DAN 6:10; ACT 16:25; 1TH 5:16–5:18

The continuous worship of God in heaven

REV 4:10–4:11, REV 5:14, REV 7:11, REV 11:1, REV 19:4

8630: worship, results of

Worship not only gives God what is due to him but also results in many benefits for his people.

True worship brings benefits for God's people**Blessing**

EXO 23:25–23:26 See also DEU 11:13–11:15

Guidance

ACT 13:2–13:3 See also ISA 58:6–58:11; NUM 7:89

Deliverance

ACT 16:25–16:26 See also PSA 50:14–50:15

Joy

1CH 29:21–29:22 See also 2CH 29:30; PSA 43:4; ISA 56:7; LUK 24:52

A sense of God's presence

2CH 5:13–5:14 parallel 1KI 8:10–8:11 See also EXO 40:35

A deeper sense of Jesus Christ's lordship

PHP 2:9–2:11 See also REV 1:10–1:18

Boldness to witness

ACT 4:31 See also PSA 57:9; ACT 18:9–18:10

True worship convicts sinners

1CO 14:24–14:25

8632: adoration

An attitude of worship characterised by love and reverence towards God. It can also describe the love between man and woman.

Adoration of God by his people

DEU 10:12

Adoration and love for God

PSA 31:23, PSA 116:1 See also DEU 6:5, DEU 11:1; JOS 22:5; PSA 18:1, PSA 26:8

Adoration and reverence for God

PSA 5:7 See also EXO 3:5; DEU 13:4; JOS 5:15; 1CH 16:29; PSA 29:2, PSA 33:8, PSA 95:6, PSA 99:5; DAN 6:26; JON 1:16; HAB 2:20

Examples of adoration in worship

Moses and the Israelites: EXO 15:1–15:2, EXO 15:6–15:7, EXO 15:11–15:12; 1SA 2:1–2:2 Hannah; ; 2SA 22:47–22:51 David; ; 1KI 8:23–8:24 Solomon; PSA 27:4, PSA 63:2–63:5, PSA 73:25–73:26, PSA 84:1–84:2, PSA 103:1–103:5, PSA 103:20–103:22; LUK 1:46–1:49 Mary; REV 4:8–4:11, REV 5:8–5:14, REV 7:9–7:12, REV 15:3–15:4, REV 19:6–19:8

Adoration also describes the love between man and woman

PRO 5:18–5:19; ; SNG 1:2–1:4

8634: amen

A Hebrew term expressing the ideas of truth and reliability, often used in prayer and adoration.

Amen as an expression of worship

1CH 16:36; EPH 3:21; REV 7:11–7:12 See also NEH 5:13, NEH 8:6 The repetition of “Amen” here conveys Ezra's intensity of feeling as he read the Book of the Law. The response of the people represents a solemn, formal acceptance of God's commandments; PSA 72:19, PSA 106:48; ROM 9:5 “Amen” can mean either “Yes indeed, it is so” or “So be it”; ROM 11:36, ROM 16:25–16:27; 1CO 14:16; GAL 1:3–1:5; PHP 4:20; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15–6:16; 2TI 4:18; HEB 13:20–13:21; 1PE 4:11, 1PE 5:10–5:11; 2PE 3:17–3:18; JUD 1:24–1:25; REV 1:4–1:7, REV 19:4 the worship of heaven

Amen confirms a grace or blessing

GAL 6:18 See also ROM 15:33; 1CO 16:24; PHP 4:23; REV 22:20–22:21

Amen confirms a vow or action

JER 28:5–28:6 See also NUM 5:20–5:22; DEU 27:15; 1KI 1:32–1:36; JER 11:1–11:5

Amen as a title of Jesus Christ

REV 3:14 See also 2CO 1:18–1:20 The implication is that all God's promises find their fulfilment in Jesus Christ.

8636: asking

The act of making requests of another, as an expression of dependence. Scripture encourages believers to ask things of God in prayer, and gives guidance concerning the motivation in doing so.

Asking as an aspect of human relationships

Examples of everyday requests

JOS 4:20–4:22; ECC 7:10; 1PE 3:15 See also EXO 3:22; DEU 32:7; 1SA 12:19 The people asked for a king; 2KI 2:3; NEH 2:1–2:2; DAN 2:10–2:11; MAT 2:1–2:2 the Magi seek the king of the Jews; LUK 2:46 Jesus Christ asks questions in the temple; JHN 4:9; ROM 16:1–16:2; GAL 2:9–2:10; PHM 1:21

Examples of stronger appeals

PHP 4:2–4:3 See also GEN 50:17; EXO 5:15; LUK 23:20; ACT 25:3; 1TH 4:1

Asking as an aspect of prayer

General petitions

MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13 **PHP 4:6** See also DEU 18:16; JDG 6:39; 1SA 1:20; 1CH 16:4; 2CH 6:32–6:33; JOB 6:8–6:9; PSA 5:3; PRO 30:7–30:8; MAT 9:37–9:38; 1TI 2:1

Frequent requests for guidance or insight

2SA 2:1; EPH 1:17 See also GEN 25:21–25:22; EXO 33:7; JOS 9:14; 1SA 23:1–23:2; 2KI 8:7–8:8; 1CH 21:29–21:30; 2CH 20:3; ISA 58:2; JER 10:21; COL 1:9; JAS 1:5

The grounds for asking

According to God's will

1JN 5:14–5:15

Trusting in God's great mercy

See also DAN 9:18

In the name of Jesus Christ

JHN 14:13 See also JHN 16:23–16:27

In faith

MAT 21:22 parallel MRK 11:24 **JAS 1:6**

8638: benedictions

Prayers invoking God's blessing upon others. They are often spoken at a time of impending separation, although they may sometimes constitute greetings.

Benedictions pronounced by priests

NUM 6:23–6:27 See also DEU 21:5; 1SA 2:20; 2CH 30:27

Benedictions pronounced by kings

1KI 8:54–8:61 See also GEN 14:18–14:20; 2SA 6:20; 2CH 6:3–6:11

Benedictions pronounced by other leaders of the nation of Israel

JOS 22:6–22:8 See also DEU 33:1–33:29

Benedictions pronounced by family members

RUT 1:8–1:9 See also GEN 24:60; GEN 27:27–27:29; GEN 48:9–48:22; GEN 49:1–49:28

Apostolic benedictions on the church

The blessing of grace and peace

ROM 1:7 See also ROM 16:20; 1CO 1:3; 1CO 16:23; GAL 1:2–1:5; GAL 6:16; EPH 1:2; EPH 6:23; 1TI 1:2; REV 22:21

The blessing of spiritual growth

HEB 13:20–13:21 See also 1PE 5:10

The blessing of God in all his fulness

2CO 13:14

8640: calling upon God

Asking God to act, in dependence upon him and out of a sense of sometimes desperate need.

Calling upon God as an act of worship

By those who depend upon him and proclaim his name

GEN 4:26 See also GEN 12:8; GEN 26:25; 1CH 16:8 parallel PSA 105:1; PSA 86:5; PSA 116:2; PSA 116:17; JOB 27:10; 2TI 2:22

Those who do not acknowledge God or call upon his name

PSA 14:4 parallel PSA 53:4; ; PSA 79:6; ; ISA 65:1; ; JER 10:25; ; ZEP 3:9

Calling upon God in time of need

PSA 50:15; LAM 3:55 See also 1SA 12:17–12:18; 2SA 22:4 parallel PSA 18:3; 1KI 18:24; 2KI 5:11; JOB 19:7; PSA 4:1; PSA 17:6–17:9; PSA 18:6; PSA 27:7–27:12; PSA 28:1–28:2; PSA 55:16; PSA 86:3; PSA 86:7; PSA 91:15; PSA 120:1; PRO 1:28; ISA 58:9; ISA 65:24; JER 11:14; JER 33:3; JOL 1:19; HAB 1:2; ZEC 13:9

Calling upon God for his salvation

ACT 2:21 See also JOL 2:32; ROM 10:12–10:14

Calling upon God was part of the priestly function of intercession

PSA 99:6 See also EXO 17:11; EXO 32:31–32:32; NUM 21:7; 1SA 12:19; 1SA 12:23; JER 15:1

Examples of those who called upon God

Abraham

GEN 13:4

Moses

EXO 17:10–17:13, EXO 17:15, EXO 32:11–32:13, EXO 32:30; ;
NUM 14:13–14:19; ; DEU 9:26–9:29

Samuel

1SA 7:5–7:9

Elijah

1KI 18:36–18:37

Jonah

JON 2:2, JON 2:7

Stephen

ACT 7:59–7:60

8642: celebration

Although there are examples of private celebrations in Scripture, most celebration is associated with the acts of God. The enemies of God's people also celebrate, but in the end it is the triumph of God's purpose that is celebrated.

Celebrations in everyday life

Wedding: JDG 14:10; ; MAT 22:2–22:3; MAT 14:6 parallel
MRK 6:21–6:22 birthday; ; LUK 5:29 for an honoured
guest; ; LUK 15:22–15:24 family reunion

The Israelites celebrated God's acts

Celebrating God's gifts of harvest: Pentecost and Tabernacles

EXO 23:16, EXO 34:22; ; LEV 23:15–23:21, LEV 23:33–23:36,
LEV 23:39–23:43; ; NUM 28:26, NUM 29:12; ; DEU 16:9–
16:10

Celebrating their deliverance from slavery in Egypt: Passover

EXO 13:3 See also EXO 12:14, EXO 23:15, EXO 34:18; NUM
9:2; DEU 16:1

Celebrating the deliverance of the nation through Esther: Purim

EST 9:18–9:19

Religious celebrations

The bringing of the ark of the covenant to Jerusalem

2SA 6:12–6:15 parallel 1CH 15:27–15:28

The bringing of the ark of the covenant to the temple

See also 1KI 8:3–8:6 parallel 2CH 5:4–5:6; 2CH 5:12–5:13

The completion and dedication of the first temple

1KI 8:63, 1KI 8:65–8:66 parallel 2CH 7:8–7:10

The dedication of the second temple

EZR 6:16

The reading of the law after the building of the walls of Jerusalem

NEH 8:9–8:12

Christians celebrate the death of Christ and his return

1CO 11:26

The enemies of God's people celebrate

JDG 16:23 capture of Samson; ; DAN 5:1 Belshazzar's
feast; REV 11:3, REV 11:7–11:10

Celebration in heaven

Creation

JOB 38:4–38:7

The repentance of sinners

LUK 15:7, LUK 15:10

Divine deliverance through Jesus Christ

REV 5:9–5:10

The downfall of evil

REV 19:1–19:5

The final triumph of Jesus Christ

REV 19:9 See also REV 11:16–11:18, REV 15:2–15:4

8644: commemoration

The act of remembering particular people, places or events in order to reflect on and be thankful for God's faithfulness.

Commemoration of people

2CH 35:25–35:27 See also JDG 11:28–11:40; 1KI 11:41
parallel 2CH 9:29

Commemoration of Jesus Christ

LUK 22:19; 1CO 11:23–11:26

Commemoration of places

GEN 35:1 See also JOS 4:19–4:24; JDG 6:24; 2SA 24:18

Commemoration of events

Commemoration of God's creation of the world

EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15 See also EXO
31:12–31:17

Commemoration of God's acts in history

EXO 12:14–12:17 See also EXO 13:1–13:10; PSA 9:1–9:6,
PSA 126:1–126:3

Commemoration of God's provision of food

LEV 23:9–23:14 See also LEV 23:15–23:22 parallels NUM 28:26–28:31, DEU 16:9–16:12; LEV 23:33–23:43 parallels NUM 29:12–29:39, DEU 16:13–16:17

8646: doxology

A form of words that offers praise to God, especially for his work of creation and redemption. Scripture records a number of these forms of praise which were used in both public and private worship.

Doxologies used in the formal worship of Israel

1CH 29:10–29:13 See also PSA 41:13, PSA 72:18–72:19, PSA 106:48, PSA 150:1–150:6

Doxologies used in the spontaneous praise of God's people

ROM 11:33–11:36 See also PSA 57:5, PSA 57:11; MAT 21:9 parallels MRK 11:9–11:10, LUK 19:38; GAL 1:5; EPH 3:21; PHP 4:20; 1TI 1:17

Doxologies used as a benediction

JUD 1:24–1:25 See also EPH 3:20–3:21; ROM 16:25–16:27; HEB 13:20–13:21; 2PE 3:18

Doxologies used in heavenly worship

REV 5:12–5:13 See also ISA 6:3; LUK 2:13–2:14; REV 4:8, REV 4:11, REV 5:9–5:14, REV 7:12, REV 19:1

8648: enquiring of God

Requesting from God a definite direct response to a particular question. In the OT, people are frequently said to enquire of God for knowledge or guidance, often through the intermediacy of a priest or prophet.

Enquiring of God for knowledge

GEN 25:22–25:23 See also JDG 13:17, JDG 18:5–18:6; 1SA 10:22

Enquiring of God for guidance

2SA 2:1 See also JDG 20:18, JDG 20:23, JDG 20:27–20:28; 1SA 23:2, 1SA 23:4, 1SA 30:8; 2SA 5:19 parallel 1CH 14:10; 2SA 5:23 parallel 1CH 14:14

Enquiring of God through intermediaries**Priests**

JDG 18:5–18:6 See also NUM 27:18–27:21; 1SA 22:10, 1SA 22:13–22:15

Prophets

1KI 22:6–22:9 parallel 2CH 18:5–18:8 See also 1SA 9:6–9:10, 1SA 28:6; 2KI 3:11, 2KI 22:11–22:20 parallel 2CH 34:19–34:28; JER 21:1–21:7, JER 37:6–37:8; EZK 14:7

Enquiring of God by casting lots

ACT 1:24–1:26 See also NUM 27:21 The Urim and Thummim were sacred lots carried in the breastpiece of the High Priest's ephod; 1SA 10:20–10:22, 1SA 14:36–14:42

Enquiring of God in prayer

2CH 20:1–20:17

Enquiring of God at the tabernacle

EXO 33:7 See also JDG 20:26–20:28; 1CH 13:3; 2CH 1:5

Devotion to God as a necessary prerequisite for enquiring of him

EZK 20:30–20:31 See also EZK 14:1–14:11, EZK 20:1–20:3

Failure to enquire of God displeases him and heralds disaster

1CH 10:13–10:14 See also 1CH 15:13; JER 10:21; ZEP 1:4–1:6

The Holy Spirit and enquiring of God

JHN 16:23–16:24 See also JHN 16:13–16:15

8650: hands, lifting up of

A human gesture which can be a sign of worship and adoration or indicate the swearing of a solemn oath. God is portrayed as raising his hands as a sign of authority over his creation.

God's uplifted hand**God's uplifted hand signifies his power**

PSA 118:16 See also EXO 24:11; PSA 89:13; ISA 9:12, ISA 9:17, ISA 9:21, ISA 26:11

God's uplifted hand signifies his judgment

ISA 5:25 See also 1SA 6:3, 1SA 6:5; ISA 19:16; MIC 5:9; ZEC 2:9

Hands uplifted for swearing oaths**Oaths taken by God**

EZK 20:5 See also EXO 6:8; DEU 32:40–32:41; NEH 9:15; EZK 20:15, EZK 36:7, EZK 47:14

Oaths taken by people and angels

GEN 14:22–14:23; ; DAN 12:7; ; REV 10:5

Hands uplifted in worship**Hands lifted up in prayer**

PSA 28:2 See also EXO 17:11–17:13; PSA 141:2; LAM 2:19, LAM 3:41; 1TI 2:8

Hands lifted up in praise

PSA 63:4 See also NEH 8:6; PSA 119:48, PSA 134:2

Hands lifted up for blessing

LEV 9:22; ; LUK 24:50

Hands lifted up as a threat**1SA 24:6** See also 1SA 18:17, 1SA 22:17, 1SA 24:10; 2SA 18:12, 2SA 18:28, 2SA 20:21; JOB 31:21**Uplifted hands as a sign of minimal effort**

GEN 41:44; ; DEU 28:32; ; EZR 6:12; ; PSA 76:5

Uplifted hands as a sign of support**PSA 91:12** See also MAT 4:6 parallel LUK 4:11**8652: importunity**

Persistence and boldness in making requests to God in prayer and to other people, and persevering until a favourable response is received.

8653: importunity, towards God

Earnestness and perseverance in presenting requests to God on behalf of oneself and others; seen in persistent pleading, faithful intercession and bold appeal.

Perseverance in prayer**Persistence in prayer****PSA 55:17** See also PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 86:3, PSA 88:1, PSA 88:9; 1TH 5:17; 1TI 5:5 **MAT 7:7–7:8** parallel LUK 11:9–11:10 **LUK 18:1** See also LUK 18:2–18:8**Faithfulness in prayer****EPH 6:18** See also ROM 1:9–1:10; COL 4:12; 1TH 1:2–1:3; 2TI 1:3**Earnestness in prayer****PSA 119:58, PSA 130:1–130:2** See also PSA 55:1–55:2, PSA 61:1–61:2; JON 3:8 **LUK 22:44** See also HEB 5:7**Boldness in prayer****GEN 18:27; LUK 11:8** See also EXO 33:12–33:16 **EPH 3:12; HEB 4:16****Further examples of importunity in prayer****Repeated requests in prayer**

GEN 18:22–18:32 Abraham prays for Sodom; ; JDG 6:36–6:40 Gideon asks for assurance; ; MAT 15:22–15:28 parallel MRK 7:25–7:30 a Canaanite woman begs for Jesus Christ's help; ; MAT 20:30–20:31 parallels MRK 10:47–10:48, LUK 18:38–18:39 Blind men call out to Jesus Christ; ; MAT 26:44 Jesus Christ prays in Gethsemane; ; MRK 5:10 parallel LUK 8:31 Legion begs for mercy; ; 2CO 12:8 Paul pleads with God to take away his "thorn".

Further examples of perseverance in prayer

GEN 32:26 Jacob wrestles with God; ; DEU 9:18 Moses fasts and prays because of Israel's sin; ; 2SA 12:16 David pleads for his sick child; ; 1KI 18:28–18:29 The prophets of Baal appeal unsuccessfully to their god; ; NEH 1:4–1:6 Nehemiah prays for God's people; ; DAN 10:2–10:3 Daniel waits for the interpretation of his vision; ; LUK 2:37 Anna looks for God to redeem his people.

Further examples of earnestness in prayer

1SA 1:12–1:16 Hannah prays for a child; ; 1KI 8:22 parallel 2CH 6:12 Solomon prays at the dedication of the Temple; ; JAS 5:17–5:18 Elijah prays for rain to cease; ; EZR 9:5 Ezra prays about the people's sin; ; ISA 38:2–38:3 Hezekiah prays for healing; ; DAN 9:3 Daniel prays for Jerusalem; ; MRK 5:22–5:23 parallel LUK 8:41–8:42 Jairus asks Jesus Christ to heal his daughter; ; JHN 4:47 A nobleman begs Jesus Christ to heal his son; ; ACT 12:5 The early church prays for Peter's release from prison.

8654: importunity, towards people

Boldness, urgency and persistence in appealing to others; seen in making requests of all kinds, presenting the gospel and giving Christian instruction; seen too in God's patient and persistent pleading with people.

Making requests of others

GEN 19:3 Lot prevails on his angelic visitors to stay with him; ; GEN 39:10 Potiphar's wife propositions Joseph; ; NUM 22:37 Balak summons Balaam; ; JDG 14:16–14:17 Samson's wife presses for the answer to his riddle; ; JDG 16:6–16:16 Delilah nags Samson to know the secret of his strength; ; 2KI 2:16–2:17 Elisha is requested to authorise a search for Elijah; ; EST 3:3–3:4 Royal officials plead with Mordecai; ; EST 8:3 Esther pleads with the king; ; PRO 19:7 A poor man pleads in vain with fair-weather friends; ; JER 38:26 Jeremiah pleads with King Zedekiah; ; LUK 23:23 The crowds call for Jesus Christ to be crucified; ; ACT 12:16 Peter knocks on the door after his release from prison; ; ACT 25:3 The chief priests urge that Paul be taken to Jerusalem; ; 2CO 8:4 The Macedonian churches ask to share in the giving to God's people; ; PHP 4:2 Paul pleads with Euodia and Syntyche to agree.

Importunity in preaching the gospel**2CO 5:20****Persistence****ACT 5:42****Urgent appeal****ACT 2:40**

Boldness

ACT 19:8 See also ACT 4:29, ACT 4:31, ACT 9:27, ACT 14:3, ACT 18:26, ACT 28:31; PHP 1:14

Persuasion

2CO 5:11 See also ACT 18:4, ACT 19:8, ACT 26:28

Importunity in giving instruction

2CO 10:1; 1TH 4:1 See also ROM 15:15; ACT 13:43; 2CO 6:1; GAL 4:12; EPH 4:1, EPH 4:17; 1TH 4:10

God's persistent appeal**God's repeated call to individuals**

ISA 3:8; JHN 21:17

God's appeal to his wayward people

2CH 36:15; JER 7:13; MAT 21:35–21:37 Finally, God sends his Son. See also JER 7:25, JER 11:7, JER 25:3–25:4, JER 26:5, JER 29:19, JER 32:33, JER 35:14–35:15, JER 44:4

8656: longing for God

A deep desire for God, which Scripture often compares to hunger or thirst. Only Jesus Christ can truly satisfy this longing for God.

The individual's longing for God

PSA 119:20; ISA 26:9 See also PSA 73:25, PSA 119:81, PSA 119:131

The longing for God compared to hunger and thirst

PSA 42:2, PSA 63:1 See also PSA 143:6; AMO 8:11

The longing for God is satisfied through Jesus Christ

JHN 4:13–4:14, JHN 6:35 See also PSA 42:2; ISA 55:1; JHN 6:27, JHN 6:50–6:51, JHN 7:37; REV 21:6, REV 22:17

8658: Lord's Prayer, the

The name given to the prayer Jesus Christ taught his disciples, probably as a model prayer for regular use.

Aspects of the Lord's Prayer**A recognition of God as Father and Lord**

MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2 See also MAT 7:21, MAT 16:17; LUK 10:21; EPH 3:14–3:15

A desire for God's perfect will to be done

MAT 6:10 parallel LUK 11:2 See also MAT 12:50, MAT 26:39, MAT 26:42; ACT 21:14; COL 1:9; HEB 10:9

Asking for physical provision

MAT 6:11 parallel LUK 11:3 See also MAT 6:31–6:32, MAT 7:9–7:11

Asking for forgiveness

MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4 See also MAT 6:14–6:15, MAT 18:23–18:35; MRK 11:25; LUK 23:34; COL 3:13; 1JN 1:9

Asking for spiritual protection

MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4 See also 2CO 1:10–1:11; JUD 1:24; REV 3:10

The doxology

MAT 6:13 NIV footnote.

8660: magnifying God

Giving glory to God through worship and through up-right living. God's people are exhorted to praise him and to bring honour to his name.

Ways of magnifying God**Through praise**

PSA 103:19–103:22 See also PSA 33:1–33:5, PSA 68:26, PSA 104:1, PSA 106:1–106:2, PSA 111:1–111:10, PSA 117:1–117:2, PSA 135:1–135:3, PSA 135:19–135:21, PSA 150:1–150:2; LUK 1:46, LUK 19:37–19:38

In worship

1CH 16:28–16:29 parallel PSA 96:7–96:9 See also PSA 29:1–29:2, PSA 100:1–100:2

Through reverence

PSA 5:7 See also DAN 6:25–6:27; MAL 2:4–2:7; HEB 12:28–12:29

By glorifying him

PSA 34:1–34:3 See also PSA 63:3–63:4, PSA 69:30–69:31, PSA 86:12–86:13, PSA 96:3–96:9; 2TH 1:11–1:12; 1PE 2:11–2:12; REV 4:6–4:11, REV 15:2–15:4

By honouring him

1TI 6:15–6:16 See also ISA 26:13; MAL 2:1–2:2; JHN 5:22–5:23; 1CO 6:19–6:20; 1TI 1:17; REV 7:9–7:12

8662: meditation

Spending time in quietness and usually alone, drawing close to God and listening to him, pondering on his word, his creation, his mighty works or other aspects of his self-revelation.

The importance of meditation

PSA 1:1–1:3 See also 1SA 12:24; JOB 37:14; PSA 19:14, PSA 48:9, PSA 77:11–77:12, PSA 104:34, PSA 107:43; PHP 4:8; 2TI 2:7

Meditation on the person of God

PSA 16:8, PSA 63:6 See also PSA 104:34

Meditation on God's word

PSA 119:15–119:16 See also JOS 1:8; PSA 1:1–1:3, PSA 119:23, PSA 119:48, PSA 119:78, PSA 119:95, PSA 119:97, PSA 119:99

Meditation on the works of God

PSA 77:12 See also PSA 111:2, PSA 143:5, PSA 145:5

Meditation on the creation

PSA 8:1–8:9 See also PSA 104:1–104:34; PRO 6:6; MAT 6:26–6:30 parallel LUK 12:24–12:27

Meditation at night

PSA 119:148 See also PSA 16:7, PSA 42:8, PSA 63:6

Examples of people meditating

JOS 1:8; PSA 19:14 See also JOB 22:22 Eliphaz' advice to Job; PSA 39:3, PSA 119:78, PSA 119:148; LUK 2:19 Mary; ACT 8:27–8:35 the Ethiopian eunuch

The results of meditation**Obedience**

PSA 119:11 See also JOS 1:8; PSA 119:55

Understanding and wisdom

PSA 119:97–119:98 See also PSA 119:27

Praise and worship

PSA 48:9–48:10, PSA 63:5–63:6, PSA 104:33–104:35, PSA 119:97

Prosperity and success

JOS 1:8

Delight in the LORD

PSA 1:2 See also PSA 119:15–119:16, PSA 119:23–119:24, PSA 119:77–119:78

Confidence and faith

PSA 16:8

8664: praise

The celebration, honouring and adoration of God, in the power of the Holy Spirit, whether by individual believers or communities of believers.

8665: praise, reasons for

Scripture treats praise as the natural response of believers to God's person and actions.

Praise is commanded of God's people

PSA 68:32; 1PE 2:9; REV 19:5 See also PSA 30:4, PSA 150:6; ISA 42:10; PHP 2:9–2:11

Praise is due to God alone

DEU 10:21; 1CH 16:25; ISA 42:8 See also PSA 66:4, PSA 118:15–118:21, PSA 148:13; REV 4:11

Praise is pleasing to God

PSA 69:30–69:31 See also PSA 135:3, PSA 147:1; ISA 43:20–43:21, ISA 61:10–61:11; JER 13:11

Praise as an act of witness

PSA 9:11 See also 2SA 22:50; PSA 34:1–34:3; ISA 42:12; 2CO 9:13

Praise in response to God's nature**For his greatness**

DEU 32:3; PSA 150:2 See also 1CH 16:25; NEH 8:6; PSA 104:1; MAT 9:8

For his righteousness

PSA 98:8–98:9 See also DAN 4:37

For his faithfulness

PSA 57:9–57:10, PSA 138:2 See also 1KI 8:15–8:20, 1KI 8:56; PSA 89:1

For his strength

PSA 59:16 See also PSA 28:7, PSA 81:1

Praise in response to God's deeds**For deliverance from enemies**

EXO 18:10; PSA 18:46–18:48 See also GEN 14:20; JDG 16:24; PSA 43:1–43:4, PSA 124:1–124:7

For answered prayer

PSA 28:6 See also PSA 66:19–66:20

For sending his Son, Jesus Christ

LUK 1:68–1:69; EPH 1:3 See also LUK 2:10–2:14, LUK 2:25–2:28, LUK 24:53; 1PE 1:3–1:6

8666: praise, manner and methods of

Praise is the natural response of believers to God at all times and in all places, involving adoration in music and song. God himself assists believers to praise him through his Spirit.

The manner of praise**God is praised in faith**

PSA 28:7, PSA 106:12

God is praised through Jesus Christ

HEB 13:15 See also PHP 2:9–2:11

God can be praised at any time and in any place

PSA 104:33, PSA 145:2 See also PSA 146:2

God helps believers to praise him

PSA 51:15 See also PSA 40:3; ISA 61:3

The Holy Spirit moves believers to praise

LUK 1:67; EPH 5:18–5:20 See also LUK 10:21; ACT 2:11, ACT 10:44–10:46; COL 3:16–3:17

The methods of praise**In singing**

EPH 5:19 See also NEH 12:46; PSA 149:1; ISA 42:10; LUK 1:46–1:47, LUK 1:68; ACT 16:25; COL 3:16

With musical instruments

PSA 150:3–150:5 See also 1CH 25:3; 2CH 7:6; PSA 33:2, PSA 92:1–92:3; ISA 38:20

In dancing

PSA 149:3 See also EXO 15:19–15:20; 2SA 6:14; PSA 150:4

With thanksgiving

PSA 42:4, PSA 100:4 See also 2CH 5:13

Hallelujah as a frequent expression of praise to God

PSA 106:48 “Hallelujah” translates “praise the LORD”. See also PSA 111:1, PSA 113:1, PSA 135:1, PSA 149:1, PSA 150:1; REV 19:3–19:4

Praise for his patient love

PSA 106:1 See also PSA 117:2

Praise for his election of Israel

PSA 135:3–135:4 See also 1CH 16:36; PSA 148:14

Praise for his sovereign rule

PSA 146:10; REV 19:6 See also REV 19:1

Hosanna as an acclamation of praise**At Jerusalem**

MAT 21:9 parallels MRK 11:9–11:10, JHN 12:13 “Hosanna” is the Greek form of the Hebrew term seeking God’s salvation. See also MAT 21:5

The OT background

PSA 118:25–118:26 See also 1CH 16:35–16:36; PSA 79:9, PSA 106:47

“Selah” in the context of praise**Following the assurance of answered prayer**

PSA 3:4 There are a number of possible ways of understanding this obscure term: pausing or lifting up, perhaps indicating that the singers or musicians should sing or play “forte”. See also PSA 21:2, PSA 24:6, PSA 32:5, PSA 81:7, PSA 84:8

Following an expression of deliverance

PSA 3:8 See also PSA 32:7, PSA 49:15, PSA 57:3, PSA 68:19, PSA 76:9; HAB 3:13

After a statement comparing God’s greatness with human insignificance

PSA 9:20 See also PSA 39:5, PSA 39:11, PSA 47:4, PSA 52:5, PSA 55:19, PSA 59:5, PSA 67:4, PSA 75:3, PSA 89:37; HAB 3:3

After an affirmation of security in God

PSA 46:7 See also PSA 46:11, PSA 48:8, PSA 61:4

On reflection of evil opposition

PSA 54:3 See also PSA 62:4, PSA 140:3, PSA 140:5

8667: praise, examples of

Scripture provides many examples of individuals who praised God. These examples illustrate the variety of ways and methods in which God can be praised, as well as the motivation for that praise.

OT examples of those who praised God**Melchizedek**

GEN 14:18–14:20

Moses

EXO 15:1–15:2

Jethro

EXO 18:9–18:10

David

1CH 29:10–29:13

Ezra

NEH 8:6

NT examples of those who praised God**Jesus Christ**

LUK 10:21

Zechariah

LUK 1:67–1:68

The shepherds

LUK 2:20

Simeon

LUK 2:28

The disciples

LUK 19:37; ACT 2:46–2:47 See also LUK 24:50–24:53; ACT 16:25

Those who were healed by Jesus Christ

LUK 18:35–18:43; ; ACT 3:1–3:10

The citizens of heaven

REV 15:2–15:3

8668: praise, and Holy Spirit

See [3218: Holy Spirit, and praise](#)

8670: remembering

The process of recalling the past, especially the presence and activity of God in the history of his people. Remembering God's work in the past can lead to praise and rejoicing, and to hope for the future. God himself remembers.

Divine remembering

God always remembers his covenant

1CH 16:15 parallel PSA 105:8 See also GEN 9:14–9:16; EXO 2:23–2:25; PSA 111:5; LUK 1:69–1:73

God always remembers his promises

PSA 105:42 See also DEU 6:20–6:23; JOS 1:3; 2PE 3:9

God always remembers his people

ISA 49:15–49:16 See also GEN 7:24–8:1, GEN 19:29, GEN 30:22; 1SA 1:19–1:20; LUK 1:54–1:55

Situations in which God will not remember

HEB 8:10–8:12 See also JER 31:33–31:34; ISA 65:16–65:17; EZK 18:21–18:24

The Holy Spirit helps believers to remember Jesus Christ and his words

JHN 14:26 See also JHN 2:22, JHN 12:16, JHN 16:4

Human remembering

Believers are to remember God's person

DEU 8:18; PSA 119:55 See also PSA 42:5–42:6; JER 51:50; JON 2:7

Believers are to remember God's acts in the past

ISA 46:9 See also DEU 5:15, DEU 7:17–7:18, DEU 8:10–8:18; 1CH 16:12; MAT 16:9–16:10

Believers are to remember God's wrath

DEU 9:7–9:8 See also 2PE 3:1–3:10

Believers are to remember God's commands

NUM 15:38–15:40 See also DEU 8:1–8:2; PSA 103:17–103:18

Believers are to remember their responsibilities towards one another

ACT 20:35 See also GAL 2:10; HEB 13:2–13:3

Believers are to remember the death of Jesus Christ

1CO 11:24–11:28; LUK 22:17–22:20

The importance of remembering

Remembering should lead to rejoicing

PSA 13:5–13:6 See also DEU 26:4–26:11; PSA 66:5–66:6

Remembering should lead to repentance

REV 3:3 See also EZK 16:59–16:63; MAT 5:23–5:24, MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:61–22:62; REV 2:5

Remembering should lead to understanding

LUK 24:6–24:8 See also JHN 15:20, JHN 16:1–16:4; ACT 11:15–11:18

Remembering should produce hope for the future

LAM 3:21–3:24 See also PSA 42:4–42:11, PSA 103:1–103:2; HEB 10:32–10:36

8672: striving with God

Striving with God can refer both to the fruitless opposition of the ungodly to God's will and purposes, and to the struggle of the righteous with God, as they seek to find his will and obey it.

The striving of the wicked with God

It is the result of a guilty conscience

ACT 26:14

Striving against God cannot succeed

2CH 13:12 See also PRO 21:30; ISA 8:10; ACT 11:17

It leads to the destruction of those who attempt it

PSA 2:2–2:5 See also JOB 15:20–15:26, JOB 15:30

Ways in which the wicked strive with God

By resisting the Holy Spirit

ACT 7:51

By arguing with God

ROM 9:20 See also JOB 40:2; ISA 45:9–45:11

Through unbelief

NUM 14:1–14:4, NUM 14:10–14:11, NUM 20:13; ; PSA 95:8–95:9

By attacking God's people

ACT 5:39 To attack God's people is to attempt to attack God himself. See also 1SA 17:45; ISA 37:22–37:25; ACT 9:4–9:5

Jacob strives with God

GEN 32:24–32:28 Jacob's struggle with God represents the conflict within himself between self-will and dependence on God. As "Jacob", the supplanter, he had overcome Esau and Laban, but God demonstrates his superior power in the wrestling match so that as "Israel" he will be submissive to the divine will. See also HOS 12:2–12:5

The striving of the righteous with God

The struggle for righteousness

ACT 24:16 See also LUK 13:24; ROM 7:14–7:25; 1CO 9:25–9:27; PHP 3:10–3:14; 1TI 4:10; HEB 12:4

The discipline of prayer

COL 4:12 See also ISA 64:7; LUK 22:44

The struggle to understand God's purposes

EXO 5:22–5:23 See also JOB 10:18; PSA 73:16, PSA 88:14–88:18; HAB 1:2–1:4, HAB 1:13

8674: study

The application of the mind with a view to acquiring knowledge, particularly of the Scriptures. God promises his help to those who give themselves to this work.

The study of the works of the LORD

PSA 111:2 The works mentioned are his acts of providence and grace.

God's people are to study in order to gain wisdom

PRO 2:1–2:5, PRO 4:5 See also JOB 28:12, JOB 28:20; PSA 90:12; PRO 3:13, PRO 15:14, PRO 23:23

The study of human activity, achievement and wisdom

ECC 1:13–1:14 See also ECC 1:17, ECC 2:12, ECC 7:25, ECC 8:9, ECC 8:16, ECC 9:1, ECC 12:9–12:11 The Teacher turned from human wisdom to searching out and setting forth proverbs; ECC 12:12 He concluded that all human study was wearisome.

The study of the word of God

The study of the word of God is commended

2TI 2:15 See also ISA 8:20; JER 15:16; MAT 22:29; ROM 15:4; 1PE 2:2

Ezra studied the law of the LORD

EZR 7:10

The Bereans studied the Scriptures

ACT 17:11

Some Jews studied the Scriptures without finding Jesus Christ

JHN 5:39

God promises his help in the study of the Scriptures

JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13

8676: thanksgiving

The offering of thanks, especially for gifts received. Scripture emphasises the importance of giving thanks to God for all his gifts and works, both as an expression of our dependence upon him and gratitude to him.

Thanksgiving is sometimes linked with praise to God

PSA 69:30 See also 1CH 16:4; PSA 42:4, PSA 100:4

The duty of thanksgiving to God

1TI 4:3–4:4 See also PSA 107:8–107:9, PSA 147:7–147:9; LUK 17:17–17:18; ROM 1:20–1:21, ROM 14:6

The expression of thanksgiving to God

Through OT offerings

PSA 50:14 See also LEV 7:12–7:15; JON 2:9

In Christian gatherings

1CO 10:16 See also 1CO 10:30, 1CO 14:16–14:17

Through song

PSA 95:2 See also 1CH 16:7–16:9; EZR 3:11; NEH 12:8, NEH 12:24, NEH 12:27, NEH 12:46; PSA 147:7; ISA 51:3; JER 30:19; EPH 5:19–5:20

Through prayer

1TI 2:1 See also NEH 11:17; DAN 6:10

Through giving

2CO 9:11–9:12

In conversation

See also EPH 5:4

Believers are to give thanks in all circumstances

1TH 5:18 See also PHP 4:6; COL 3:17

Thanksgiving for the blessings of salvation

1CO 15:57 See also ROM 7:24–7:25; 2CO 2:14 for victory through Christ; 2CO 4:15 for God's grace; 2CO 9:15 for Jesus Christ himself; COL 1:12, COL 2:6–2:7 for union with Christ

Examples of those who gave thanks to God

Jesus Christ

MAT 14:19 parallel LUK 9:16; ; MRK 8:6; ; LUK 24:30; ; 1CO 11:24

Paul

ACT 28:15; ; ROM 6:17; ; EPH 1:16; ; 1TI 1:12

Heavenly beings

REV 4:9, REV 7:12, REV 11:17

8678: waiting on God

Being prepared to patiently look towards God for his guidance and accepting the timing he proposes. Waiting on God can lead to an atmosphere of expectation and confidence in God and a realisation of the unreliability of one's own judgment.

Waiting on God is something that is commanded

HOS 12:6 See also PSA 27:14, PSA 37:7, PSA 37:34, PSA 123:2; ISA 30:18

Reasons for waiting on God

JER 14:22 for his providence; ; PSA 25:5 for his salvation; ; PSA 145:15–145:16 for his blessings

Waiting on Christ

JAS 5:7–5:8 “Waiting on Christ” is often seen in terms of waiting patiently for God to bring about the end of all things through the promised second coming of Jesus Christ. See also LUK 12:35–12:40; 1CO 1:7, 1CO 4:5; TIT 2:13; HEB 9:28; JUD 1:21

The benefits of waiting on God

It leads to expectancy

PSA 5:3 See also ROM 8:23; 1CO 4:5; GAL 5:5; TIT 2:13

It leads to hope

PSA 33:20 See also PSA 130:5; ISA 51:5; MIC 7:7

It leads to trust

ISA 8:17

It leads to patience

ROM 8:23–8:25 See also LAM 3:24–3:26; REV 6:9–6:11

Examples of people who waited on God

GEN 49:18 Jacob; ; PSA 39:7 David; ; ISA 8:17 Isaiah; ; MIC 7:7 Micah; ; MRK 15:43 Joseph of Arimathea; ; LUK 2:25 Simeon

8700: Threats to the life of faith

- 8701: affluence
- 8702: agnosticism
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- 8711: covenant breakers
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- 8721: doubt
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- 8742: faithlessness
- 8746: false Christs
- 8747: false gods
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- 8749: false teachers
- 8750: false teachings

- 8751: false witness
- 8752: false worship
- 8753: favouritism
- 8754: fear
- 8755: folly
- 8759: fools
- 8763: forgetting
- 8764: forgetting God
- 8765: grudge
- 8766: heresies
- 8767: hypocrisy

8701: affluence

Literally, “flowing” with prosperity. Wealth is not condemned in Scripture but is seen as a good gift of God. However, affluence has its dangers.

Godly affluence

EXO 3:8 See also DEU 28:1–28:6, DEU 28:11; PSA 1:3, PSA 112:3; PRO 8:18–8:21, PRO 22:4; ISA 60:5, ISA 61:6, ISA 66:12; MIC 4:4

Examples of affluence

GEN 2:8–2:12 Eden; ; GEN 13:2 Abraham; ; GEN 26:12–26:13 Isaac; ; GEN 33:11 Jacob; ; JOB 42:10–42:12 Job; 1KI 3:13, 1KI 10:23–10:29; 2CH 32:27–32:29 Hezekiah; ; MAT 27:57 Joseph of Arimathea

The dangers of affluence

Pride

DEU 8:17–8:18; 1TI 6:17 See also PSA 10:4–10:6, PSA 73:3–73:6

Reliance upon riches

PRO 11:28; 1TI 6:17 See also PSA 62:10; PRO 23:5; ECC 10:19; MRK 10:24; LUK 12:16–12:21

Over-attachment to riches

MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23

Greed for more riches

ECC 5:10

Temptation

1TI 6:9–6:10

Cares and anxieties

MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14

Spiritual complacency

REV 3:17

Contempt for God

See also PRO 30:8–30:9

Contempt for the poor or unfortunate

JOB 12:5; ; PRO 22:16; ; AMO 2:6–2:8, AMO 4:1, AMO 5:11; ; LUK 16:24–16:31; ; JAS 5:1–5:6

Affluence is temporary

It is for this life only

1TI 6:7 See also JOB 1:21; PSA 37:35–37:36, PSA 49:10–49:12, PSA 49:16–49:20; ECC 5:15

It is often lost

JOB 1:13–1:15; ; ECC 5:13–5:14

Spiritual affluence

The riches of God

PHP 4:19 See also PSA 36:7–36:9; 2CO 9:9; EPH 3:8

Spiritual wealth

EPH 1:3; ; 1PE 1:4; ; REV 2:9

The shared wealth of the church

MRK 10:29–10:30; ; ACT 4:34–4:35; ; PHP 4:18

The wealth of heaven

MAT 6:20; ; LUK 12:33; ; REV 7:16–7:17

8702: agnosticism

The inability to decide whether or not God exists. It is characterised by indecision and compromise when faced with the challenge to wholehearted commitment, and is condemned as sinful, inexcusable and unnecessary in the light of God's clear self-revelation.

Agnosticism is inexcusable in the light of God's self-revelation

In the creation

ROM 1:19–1:20 See also PSA 19:1–19:2; ACT 14:17

In the person of Jesus Christ

JHN 1:18 See also JHN 14:9; HEB 1:1–1:3

Agnosticism is sinful

Because God calls for wholehearted commitment

JOS 24:14–24:15 See also EXO 32:26; DEU 6:13–6:14, DEU 30:15–30:19; ACT 14:15

Because God's call demands total obedience

MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:14, LUK 5:27–5:28 See also MAT 4:18–4:22 parallel MRK 1:16–1:20

Agnosticism results in compromise

In worship

1KI 18:21; 2KI 17:41 See also 2KI 17:29–17:33; 1CO 10:21

In commitment

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 in the attitude to money; ; MAT 8:19–8:22 parallel LUK 9:57–9:62 in service; ; 2CO 6:14 in relationships with unbelievers; ; EPH 4:14 in accommodating false teaching

Agnosticism as a result of ignorance

Ignorance through being uninformed

ACT 17:23–17:30 See also ACT 3:17–3:18

Foolish ignorance of God's existence

PSA 14:1 parallel PSA 53:1 See also PSA 92:5–92:7; JER 5:4

Ignorance of God's presence

PSA 115:2 See also PSA 42:3; JOL 2:17; MIC 7:10

Ignorance as a result of rejecting God's truth

PSA 10:4 See also PSA 36:1; JER 5:21–5:24; ZEC 7:11–7:12; ACT 2:22–2:23

Ignorance as a result of sin

EPH 4:17–4:19 See also ISA 1:3–1:4; JER 4:22

Ignorance is no defence against God's judgment

ROM 1:18 See also JDG 2:10–2:14; ISA 44:9–44:11

8703: antinomianism

A form of spiritual anarchy, which rejects the law as having any place in the Christian life, whether as instructor or as assessor. Paul's teaching that Christians are free from the law is sometimes misunderstood as antinomian. But Paul reveres God's law, and teaches believers, who are free from the law as a system of salvation, to keep it out of gratitude for salvation freely given, and because holiness as defined by the law is the Christian calling.

Antinomianism as a rejection of God's laws

JER 2:20 See also PRO 29:18; JER 5:5; HOS 8:12; 2PE 2:10

Various people described as antinomian

Israel described as antinomian

EZK 20:13 See also EXO 32:25; JER 2:23–2:25; HOS 8:1; ZEC 7:11–7:12

The ungodly described as antinomian

JUD 1:4 See also 2TI 3:1–3:5; 2PE 2:13–2:15; JUD 1:8

The antichrist described as antinomian

2TH 2:3–2:10 See also DAN 7:25, DAN 8:9–8:12, DAN 8:23–8:25 The object of these prophecies, Antiochus Epiphanes, foreshadowed the antichrist in his behaviour.

Jesus Christ and his followers accused of antinomianism

MAT 11:19 See also MAT 12:2; JHN 9:16; ACT 6:11–6:14

Jesus Christ came to fulfil the law, not abolish it

MAT 5:17–5:19

Paul rejects antinomianism**ROM 6:1–6:2** See also ROM 3:31, ROM 7:7**Misunderstandings, by opponents and converts alike, about Paul's teaching on freedom from the law****Paul accused of antinomianism****ACT 21:28** See also ROM 3:8, ROM 6:15**Paul corrects the Corinthians' interpretation of his teaching as a licence for antinomianism****1CO 10:23** The phrase "Everything is permissible" is probably the Corinthians' misinterpretation of Paul's teaching. See also 1CO 5:1–5:8, 1CO 6:12–6:13**Punishment of antinomians****JER 6:19** See also EZR 7:26; AMO 2:4–2:5; REV 22:15**8704: apostasy**

A general falling away from religion or a denial of the faith by those who once held it or professed to hold it. It is frequently described in terms of spiritual adultery and thus provokes the jealous anger of God.

8705: apostasy, in OT

Israel was in danger of abandoning God from her earliest days. The OT frequently warns against apostasy and identifies its likely consequences.

Apostasy in Egypt and in the desert

PSA 78:9–78:41 See also EXO 32:25–32:29 the death of 3,000 after Aaron made the golden calf; LEV 17:7, LEV 20:1–20:6; NUM 14:9–14:12 The people rebel against Moses and Aaron after the return of the spies; NUM 14:31–14:35, NUM 25:1–25:4, NUM 32:10–32:11; DEU 31:16–31:18, DEU 32:15–32:21; PSA 95:7–95:8, PSA 106:13–106:33; HEB 3:15–3:19

Apostasy in the time of the judges

PSA 78:55–78:64 See also JDG 2:6–2:23, JDG 8:27, JDG 8:33–8:34; NEH 9:26–9:31; PSA 106:34–106:39

Apostasy in the kingdom of Israel

HOS 5:3–5:4 See also 2KI 17:7–17:20; HOS 1:2, HOS 4:10–4:19, HOS 7:4

Apostasy in the kingdom of Judah

JER 3:1–3:25 See also 2KI 23:26–23:27; 2CH 29:6–29:9 Hezekiah's reforms to purify the temple; 2CH 30:7–30:9; ISA 1:1–1:6, ISA 30:1–30:5 Judah's alliance with Egypt; JER 2:7–2:13, JER 2:19–2:25, JER 5:5–5:7, JER 7:9–7:15, JER 9:2, JER 13:23–13:27, JER 17:5–17:6, JER 17:13, JER 23:10–23:15 lying prophets denounced; JER 31:22; EZK 6:9, EZK 16:15–16:42, EZK 23:1–23:35; DAN 9:5–9:14

8706: apostasy, warnings against personal

It is possible for individuals to fall away from faith or turn against Jesus Christ. Scripture identifies this danger and warns against its negative consequences.

Personal apostasy described

HEB 6:4–6:8 See also MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13; MAT 24:10–24:12; GAL 1:6, GAL 5:4; 2TH 2:3; 2TI 4:3–4:4; 1TI 4:1; 1JN 2:19, 1JN 5:16

Warnings against personal apostasy

HEB 10:26–10:31 See also MAT 10:33 parallels MRK 8:38, LUK 12:9; JHN 15:6; 2TI 2:12; HEB 3:12; 2PE 3:17

OT examples of personal apostasy

DEU 13:1–13:11 an unfruitful prophet or relative; 1SA 15:11, 1SA 15:28, 1SA 16:14; ; 2SA 7:15; 2CH 26:16–26:21 King Uzziah; ; 2CH 28:19–28:27 King Ahaz

NT examples of personal apostasy

MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:3–22:6 Judas; ; LUK 13:26–13:27; ; JHN 6:66; ; ACT 5:1–5:11 Ananias and Sapphira; ; 1TI 1:19–1:20 Hymenaeus and Alexander; ; TIT 1:16; ; 2TI 4:10 Demas; ; 2PE 2:1–2:3, 2PE 2:10–2:15, 2PE 2:20–2:22; ; JUD 1:4, JUD 1:8–1:16; ; REV 2:20–2:22 Jezebel

8707: apostasy, dealing with personal

Individual believers can fall away from faith and be restored. Scripture gives examples of such falling away, and offers advice on how such people should be dealt with pastorally.

Warnings of the dangers of personal apostasy

2CO 11:2–11:3 See also PSA 125:4–125:5; LUK 9:59–9:62; GAL 3:1–3:3, GAL 4:8–4:10 Those who return to strict observance of Jewish days and festivals have not understood the gospel.

Warnings against leading others into apostasy

MAT 18:6 See also PRO 28:10; GAL 5:7–5:10

Encouragements to guard against personal apostasy

1CO 10:12–10:13; HEB 3:12–3:14 See also PSA 85:8; MAT 24:10–24:13, MAT 24:24–24:25 parallel MRK 13:22–13:23; COL 1:21–1:23; 1TI 6:20–6:21; HEB 10:35–10:39, HEB 12:1–12:8; 2PE 3:17–3:18; REV 13:5–13:10

Dealing with apostate believers

GAL 6:1 See also 1CO 5:4–5:5; JAS 5:19–5:20; 1JN 5:16–5:17

Examples of those who were restored from apostasy

Samson: JDG 16:20, JDG 16:28–16:30; PSA 51:1–51:17
David; MAT 26:74 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:61–22:62, JHN 18:27 for the account of Peter's reinstatement see Jn 21:15–17; ACT 15:37–15:38 for evidence of John Mark's recovery see 2Ti 4:11

The punishment of apostates

ISA 65:12–65:15; ; EZK 3:20, EZK 18:24–18:26; ; 2TH 2:11–2:12; ; 2PE 2:17

Punishment through misfortune

DEU 28:63; ; AMO 2:4–2:6

Punishment through defeat

NUM 14:43; ; JDG 2:12–2:15

Punishment through rejection

2CH 24:20; ; HOS 4:6

8709: astrology

The study of the stars and planets, based on the pagan assumption that they exercise a decisive influence over human destinies. Scripture rejects such beliefs, insisting upon the total sovereignty of God over his entire creation.

Astrology is to be rejected

The worship of heavenly bodies is forbidden

DEU 4:19; 2KI 17:16 See also 2KI 21:3–21:5 parallel 2CH 33:3–33:5; 2KI 23:4, 2KI 23:11; JOB 31:26–31:28; EZK 8:16–8:18; ZEP 1:5

The consultation of stars is condemned

ISA 47:13 See also JER 8:2

Astrology at the time of Daniel

DAN 2:1–2:13, DAN 4:1–4:7, DAN 5:1–5:8

Astrologers came to worship the newborn Jesus

MAT 2:1–2:10

8710: atheism

The denial of God's existence and thus also the denial of his word, truth and authority. It is seen in the worship of created things, in human boasting and in the decision to live a life without God which results in godlessness and brings God's judgment.

Characteristics of atheism

Denying God's existence

PSA 14:1 parallel PSA 53:1

Worshipping created things

ROM 1:25 See also DAN 5:23; REV 9:20

Denying God's truth

ISA 32:6; ROM 1:18 See also JER 5:12, JER 5:31, JER 11:21, JER 14:14, JER 27:15

Denying God's ability to fulfil his word

JER 17:15 See also ISA 5:19; ACT 17:18; 1TH 4:8; 2PE 3:3–3:4; REV 11:7–11:10

Showing contempt for God's name

LEV 19:12; ; JER 5:2; ; EZK 36:20, EZK 43:8

Boasting against God

PSA 10:3–10:5 See also JOB 15:25; PSA 12:3–12:4, PSA 36:1–36:2, PSA 73:11; PRO 30:9; EZK 35:13; REV 13:6

Not turning to God in trouble

JOB 35:10 See also JOB 36:13; JER 2:8, JER 17:5

Living in ignorance of God

JER 5:4 See also EPH 2:12

Denying Jesus Christ

JUD 1:4 See also 1JN 2:22, 1JN 4:3; 2JN 1:7

Atheism results in godless living

ROM 1:28–1:31 See also GEN 6:5; ISA 2:12; PRO 11:9; ISA 9:17, ISA 26:10; JER 5:5, JER 23:11; MAL 3:14, MAL 3:18; 1TI 1:9–1:10; JUD 1:18

Atheism brings condemnation

It cannot be excused

JOB 12:7–12:8; ; ACT 14:17; ; ROM 1:19–1:20

It results in lack of hope

JOB 8:13, JOB 15:34, JOB 20:5, JOB 27:8; ; PSA 9:17

It results in God's judgment

ISA 10:6, ISA 33:14; ; JER 5:5–5:6, JER 5:9–5:11, JER 5:29; ; ROM 1:18; ; 1PE 4:17; ; 2PE 3:7; ; JUD 1:14–1:15

God desires to save the atheist

ACT 17:27 See also ISA 55:7; JER 3:12; EZK 18:23, EZK 33:11; ROM 5:6–5:8

8711: covenant breakers

Covenants were central to OT life, with the result that those who broke covenants, and especially those who violated the covenant between God and Israel, were regarded as a serious threat to social stability.

The importance of covenants

The covenant between God and his people

GEN 9:16 See also 2SA 23:5; ISA 24:5, ISA 55:3

God will remain faithful to his covenant

JDG 2:1 See also PSA 105:8; ISA 54:10

Covenants between people

Covenants made in the sight of God were permanently binding

NUM 30:2; 1SA 23:16–23:18 See also DEU 23:21; ECC 5:4

Condemnation of those who break covenants

HOS 6:7 See also PRO 2:17

Examples of covenants between people

GEN 21:27; ; JOS 24:24; ; 2SA 5:3; ; 1KI 5:12, 1KI 20:34; ; JER 34:8

Examples of breaking the covenant with God

Coveting the possessions of others

ECC 4:4 See also EXO 20:17

Stealing

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also DEU 23:24

Using dishonest weights or scales

LEV 19:35–19:36; PRO 20:23 See also DEU 25:13–25:16; HOS 12:7–12:8; AMO 8:5

Moving boundary stones

PRO 23:10 See also DEU 19:14, DEU 27:17

Extortion

HAB 2:6 See also ISA 10:1–10:2; EZK 22:12; AMO 5:11

Breach of trust

LEV 6:2; ; EZK 16:17

Not repaying loans

PSA 37:21

Not paying fair wages

See also GEN 31:6–31:9

Failing to care for aliens

Aliens living in Israel were regarded as having privileged status amongst Gentiles, and were treated as covenant people in some respects: EXO 23:9; ; DEU 29:9–29:15, DEU 31:12; ; JOS 8:33–8:35

8712: denial of Jesus Christ

The making of a conscious, informed decision not to accept Jesus Christ or his claims and teaching.

Jesus Christ was denied by the Jewish people

JHN 1:11 See also MAT 11:16–11:19 parallel LUK 7:31–7:35; MAT 13:54–13:58 parallel MRK 6:1–6:6; MAT 26:63–26:68 parallels MRK 14:61–14:65, LUK 22:66–22:71; LUK 4:16–4:30; JHN 5:37–5:43; ACT 4:8–4:12; PSA 118:22

The consequences of denying Jesus Christ

Denying Jesus Christ results in judgment

JHN 12:48 See also MAT 12:38–12:42 parallel LUK 11:29–11:32

Denying Jesus Christ means replacement by others

ACT 13:46 See also MAT 21:40–21:41 parallels MRK 12:9, LUK 20:15–20:16; ACT 18:5–18:6

To deny Christ is to be denied by Christ

2TI 2:12 See also MAT 10:32; MRK 8:38

Warnings against those who deny Jesus Christ

2PE 2:1 See also 1JN 2:22–2:23; 2JN 1:7; JUD 1:4

Denial, repentance and restoration: the example of Peter

Peter's denial predicted by Jesus Christ

MRK 14:29–14:30 parallels MAT 26:31–26:34, LUK 22:31–22:34

Peter declares he will never deny Jesus Christ

MRK 14:31 parallel MAT 26:35

Peter denied that he knew Jesus Christ

MAT 26:69–26:75 parallels MRK 14:66–14:72, LUK 22:55–22:62, JHN 18:15–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27

Peter's restoration to Christ

See also JHN 21:15–21:19; ACT 1:15–1:22, ACT 2:14–2:41

8713: discouragement

A sense of unhappiness arising from a loss of confidence in one's own abilities, in the reliability of God or in the power of the gospel. Discouragement can occur in the Christian life, especially when there is resistance to the gospel or in instances of personal failure. Scripture provides reassurance for those who experience discouragement.

The experience of discouragement

JOB 3:20–3:26 See also NUM 21:4–21:5 the Israelites in the desert; JOS 2:8–2:11 the Canaanites and Rahab; 1SA 17:10–17:11 the Israelites and Goliath; 2KI 19:26 God's judgment on Sennacherib; JOB 5:6–5:7; PSA 38:1–38:14; PRO 1:26–1:27 Wisdom speaks to the sinner; ECC 2:17–2:20 the Teacher's disillusion; ISA 21:2–21:4; JER 45:3 to Baruch; EZK 21:7 God's judgment on Israel; ZEC 10:2; 2CO 1:8–1:9 Paul

Prayer in discouragement

PSA 42:5–42:11 See also DEU 26:6–26:7; 2SA 22:7 David; 2CH 20:9 Jehoshaphat; NEH 9:32; PSA 31:9–31:12; ISA 38:14 Hezekiah; JER 8:18–8:19; JON 2:1–2:2

Endurance in discouragement

ISA 42:3–42:4 See also 2CO 6:4–6:10 Paul; 2TH 1:4; HEB 10:32, HEB 12:3; REV 2:3 concerning the church at Ephesus

Discouragement through disobedience

JER 8:9 See also ISA 28:15–28:18; JOB 15:24–15:25 Eliphaz to Job; ZEP 1:17

Discouragement and discipline

HEB 12:5–12:7 See also JDG 2:14–2:15; ISA 26:16

Effects of discouragement

PRO 17:22 See also EXO 6:9 the Israelites in Egypt; 2SA 4:1; EZR 4:4 the rebuilding of the temple; JOB 4:5; PRO 15:13, PRO 18:14

Resisting discouragement

DEU 1:21 See also JOS 1:9, JOS 8:1; ISA 17:32 David reassuring Saul about Goliath; 1CH 22:13 David to Solomon; 2CH 32:7 Hezekiah; JER 51:46; LUK 18:1; JHN 14:1; GAL 6:9; EPH 3:13; 2TI 4:5

God's help in discouragement

ROM 8:35–8:39 See also DEU 31:6, DEU 31:8, DEU 31:23; JOS 1:9; 1CH 28:20; 2CH 20:15, 2CH 20:17; PSA 34:18; ISA 40:29–40:31, ISA 61:1; LUK 4:18; JER 30:10; JHN 16:33; 2CO 7:6 Paul

Warnings not to discourage others

The Israelites discouraged when on the point of entering the promised land

OBA 1:12 See also DEU 1:28 by the spies; NUM 32:7 by the Gadites and Reubenites

General warnings not to discourage others

PSA 109:16; ; ZEC 10:2; ; ACT 15:19 James advises against discouraging the Gentiles; ; COL 3:21

The need to stand with the discouraged

HEB 13:3 See also JOB 6:14; JER 8:21; ROM 12:15; JAS 1:27

8714: dishonesty

A way of speaking or acting which leads to people being deceived, misled or cheated.

8715: dishonesty, and God's nature

Dishonesty is contrary to the will and nature of God, and so should not be found among the people of God.

Dishonesty is contrary to the will and nature of God

NUM 23:19 See also ISA 15:29; ROM 3:4; TIT 1:2

Dishonesty, like sin, is of satanic origin

JHN 8:44 See also GEN 3:1–3:5

God's hatred of dishonesty

PRO 12:22 See also PSA 5:4–5:6; PRO 6:16–6:17; ISA 59:1–59:4, ISA 59:12–59:15

Kinds of dishonesty

In business deals

HOS 12:7 See also DEU 25:13–25:16; PRO 20:14; AMO 8:5; MIC 6:10

In not paying debts

PSA 37:21 See also JAS 5:4

In exploiting the poor

EZK 22:29 See also JOB 24:2–24:11; ISA 32:7; JER 22:13

God's judgment on dishonesty

God's denunciation of dishonesty in general

HOS 4:1–4:2 See also LEV 19:15; JER 7:8–7:10; 1TH 4:6

The dishonesty of liars and false witnesses

PRO 19:9; ACT 5:1–5:10 See also DEU 19:16–19:19; JOS 7:10–7:12 regarding Achan's sin; 2KI 5:19–5:27; PSA 5:6; ISA 29:20–29:21; JER 9:4–9:9; REV 21:8

The dishonesty of false prophets and teachers

JER 14:14–14:15; ; 2PE 2:1–2:3; ; ISA 9:14–9:15; ; JER 28:15–28:16; ; EZK 13:1–13:23; ; ZEC 10:2–10:3; ; 1TI 4:1–4:2

God's demands for making amends for dishonesty

LEV 6:1–6:7; ; LUK 3:12–3:14 This demonstrated that their repentance was genuine; ; LUK 19:8 the result of encountering Jesus Christ; ; LUK 16:1–16:12 Jesus Christ was not commending the steward's dishonesty but his shrewdness.

8716: dishonesty, examples of

Examples of the dishonest behaviour condemned by God.

Dishonest words condemned

Lying

EPH 4:25 See also LEV 19:11; PSA 34:13; COL 3:9–3:10

False witness

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20 See also MAT 19:17–19:18; MRK 10:19; LUK 18:20; EXO 23:1, EXO 23:7; MAT 26:59–26:60; ACT 6:12–6:14

Swearing falsely

LEV 19:12 See also EXO 20:7; MAT 5:33–5:37

Dishonest actions condemned

Stealing

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also MAT 19:18 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20; ROM 13:9

Dishonest dealing

PRO 11:1 See also LEV 19:13; DEU 25:13–25:16; PSA 62:10; ISA 33:15–33:16; TIT 2:9–2:10

Israel condemned for dishonest gain

Bribery and extortion

EZK 22:12–22:13 See also JER 22:13, JER 22:17–22:19; EZK 22:27–22:31; HAB 2:6–2:9

Cheating and dishonest scales

AMO 8:4–8:8 See also LEV 19:35–19:36; MIC 6:10–6:13; MAL 1:14 In this case, they were cheating the LORD.

Examples of dishonesty

GEN 26:15–26:22 Abimelech's servants; GEN 25:29–25:33, GEN 27:6–27:29, GEN 30:31–30:43; GEN 29:21–29:30, GEN 31:19 Rachel; ; GEN 31:36–31:42 Laban; ; JOS 7:11–7:26 Achan; ; 1KI 21:2–21:16 Ahab and Naboth's vineyard

8718: disobedience

The refusal to obey someone, especially someone in a position of authority. Scripture insists on the need to obey God at all times.

Disobedience enters people's hearts for various reasons

Disobedience comes through greed and lust

GEN 3:6 See also GEN 3:11–3:12; EXO 16:19–16:20; JOS 7:20–7:21; 2SA 11:2–11:4

Disobedience arises from impatience

EXO 32:23 See also NUM 20:10–20:11; 1SA 13:8–13:14

Disobedience comes through fear

JER 43:2–43:7; ; JHN 7:13, JHN 12:42; ; GAL 2:12

Disobedience results from pride and arrogance

LEV 10:1 See also EXO 5:2; 2CH 26:16

Unbelief is disobedience

HEB 3:12 See also JER 7:23–7:28; ROM 11:30–11:32 Ro 11:20 makes it clear that the disobedience spoken of here was unbelief; HEB 3:18–3:19, HEB 4:2, HEB 4:6

Lack of love is disobedience

JHN 14:24 See also 1JN 2:9, 1JN 3:15

Disobedience to God leads to punishment

Punishment is applied to individuals

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 3:23–3:24; LEV 10:1–10:2; NUM 20:12; 1SA 28:18; 2SA 12:14; JON 1:10–1:12; EPH 5:5–5:6

Punishment for the disobedience of unbelief

2TH 1:8–1:9 See also HEB 2:2–2:3

Nations are also punished

GEN 15:14 See also ACT 7:7**DEU 11:26–11:28; 1SA 12:15** See also EXO 32:35; DEU 28:15; ISA 13:11

Disobedience, like all sin, can be forgiven

ROM 5:19 See also EPH 2:1–2:5

8719: distrust

Failure to trust another, or a tendency to be suspicious of others' abilities or intentions. Though sometimes justifiable towards other human beings, such an attitude is never acceptable towards God.

Distrust between human beings

GEN 50:15–50:17 Joseph's brothers distrusted him because they could not believe he had forgiven them. See also GEN 32:6–32:8 Jacob distrusted Esau because he thought he was seeking revenge; JDG 11:19–11:20 Sihon distrusted Israel because he suspected a trick; ACT 15:37–15:38 Paul distrusted John Mark, having been let down by him.

Distrust of God

Israel distrusted God

ZEP 3:2 See also DEU 1:32–1:33, DEU 9:23–9:24 Because that generation distrusted God, they failed to enter the promised land; PSA 78:7, PSA 78:22 Israel distrusted God in spite of the miracles he had done for her.2KI 17:14–17:15; JER 13:25

Other examples

Distrust in God involves failure to trust God's promises and placing trust in other things: JER 13:25; ; EZK 33:13; ; MAL 3:6–3:10; ; MAT 19:22 parallel MRK 10:22

Distrust by God

JOB 4:18 See also JOB 15:15; JHN 2:24

Distrust is sometimes justified

PSA 118:8 See also JOB 39:12; PSA 5:9, PSA 44:6, PSA 146:3; JER 7:4, JER 9:4, JER 12:6; MIC 7:5; HAB 2:18

8720: double-mindedness

Indicative of insincerity and hypocrisy. God requires wholeheartedness and sincerity from all people, both in their dealings with others and in their worship of him.

Double-mindedness is characteristic of sinners

JAS 4:8 See also PSA 119:113–119:115

Double-mindedness in dealings with other people

GEN 34:1–34:29; ; JOS 9:3–9:15; ; 1SA 18:17–18:25; ; 2SA 3:22–3:27, 2SA 20:8–20:10; ; NEH 6:1–6:4, NEH 6:10–6:13; ; MAT 26:47–26:50 parallels MRK 14:43–14:46, LUK 22:47–22:48; ; ACT 23:12–23:24

Double-mindedness in daily life

MAT 23:25–23:28 See also MAT 15:10–15:19 parallel MRK 7:14–7:23; LUK 11:39–11:40

Double-mindedness in worship

Idolatry

1KI 18:21 See also 2KI 17:27–17:34, 2KI 17:40–17:41; HOS 10:1–10:2

Insincerity

MAT 15:1–15:9 parallel MRK 7:1–7:13 See also ISA 29:13

Lack of faith in prayer is equated with double-mindedness

JAS 1:5–1:8

God requires wholeheartedness and sincerity

Towards himself

1CH 28:9 See also NUM 14:20–14:24; JOS 14:14; 2CH 31:21; ROM 12:9; 1CO 5:8; 2CO 1:12; 1TI 3:8; JAS 3:13–3:17

Towards other people

COL 3:22 See also 2CH 19:8–19:11; EPH 6:5–6:9

8721: doubt

Uncertainty about the truth and reality of spiritual things, as seen especially in a lack of faith in and commitment to God.

8722: doubt, nature of

Doubt leads to insecurity and lack of trust concerning God's willingness and ability to deliver his people. It also leads to a fear of people and situations.

Doubting God's truth

Doubt as a questioning of God's words

GEN 3:1 See also GEN 3:4; ISA 5:19; JER 17:15; 2PE 3:4

Doubt as lack of faith

MAT 21:21–21:22 parallel MRK 11:23–11:24 See also MAT 17:20; MRK 6:6, MRK 16:14; LUK 17:6

Doubt as wavering

JAS 1:6 See also 1KI 18:21; ROM 4:20; EPH 4:13–4:14

Doubt as double-mindedness

JAS 1:8 See also 2KI 17:40–17:41; LUK 16:13; 1CO 10:21; JAS 4:8

Doubt as insecurity about relationship with God

Doubting God's compassion

PSA 77:7–77:9 See also PSA 90:13; HEB 12:5–12:6

Doubting God's concern

JOB 30:20; ISA 49:14 See also PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 35:17; ISA 40:27; JER 8:18–8:22; LAM 3:8; HAB 1:2

Doubting God's desire to deliver

JER 45:3 See also EXO 5:22–5:23; LAM 2:1–2:9, LAM 3:13–3:20

Doubting God's ability to deliver

PSA 78:18–78:22 See also EXO 14:10–14:12; PSA 78:41–78:43; MAT 8:26 parallels MRK 4:39–4:40, LUK 8:24–8:25

Doubting God's justice

JER 12:1 See also JOB 9:23; PSA 73:13–73:16, PSA 82:2; JER 15:16–15:18; HAB 1:13

Doubt as fear of people and situations

MAT 14:30–14:31 See also GEN 12:12–12:13, GEN 19:30, GEN 26:7; JOS 7:5; 1SA 17:11; ISA 51:12–51:13

8723: doubt, results of

Doubt results in uncertainty and ineffectiveness in the spiritual life of individual believers and of the believing community. God appeals to those who waver to make a clear choice.

Doubt results in spiritual uncertainty

Uncertainty about commitment

LUK 9:57–9:62 parallel MAT 8:19–8:22 See also GEN 19:17, GEN 19:26; EXO 16:2–16:3; MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; HEB 11:15

Uncertainty about God's power

NUM 13:31 See also DEU 1:29–1:33

Uncertainty about God's love

ISA 40:27 See also DEU 1:27; JOB 9:16–9:18, JOB 30:21

Uncertainty about the meaning of life

JOB 3:16 See also 1KI 19:3–19:4; PSA 42:3–42:4; JER 20:14–20:18; JON 4:3

Uncertainty about teaching

EPH 4:14 See also 1TI 6:20–6:21

Uncertainty about the will of God

JDG 6:17 See also JDG 6:36–6:40; JHN 20:25; 2CO 13:3

Doubt may result in a spiritual decline

Doubt may result in drifting from faith

HEB 2:1 See also 2CH 36:12–36:13; NEH 9:16–9:17; PSA 95:8–95:9; LAM 5:20; HEB 3:12–3:13, HEB 6:4–6:6; 2PE 2:20–2:21

Doubt may result in faithless action

ISA 31:1; ROM 14:23 See also GEN 12:13, GEN 16:2–16:3; EXO 32:1; NUM 20:11–20:12; ACT 7:40; ROM 14:14

Doubt brings the risk of God's judgment**NUM 20:12** See also NUM 11:1, NUM 14:37; HEB 6:7–6:8**Doubt leads to ineffectiveness in prayer****JAS 1:6–1:7** See also MAT 17:20, MAT 21:21 parallel MRK 11:23**Doubt spreads****DEU 1:28** See also NUM 13:32; 2KI 17:14**God's appeal for a clear decision****1KI 18:21** See also DEU 30:15–30:17; JOS 24:15; JHN 20:27; JAS 4:8**8724: doubt, dealing with**

Uncertainty may be remedied by gaining assurance from God's word, remembering God's past goodness, reflecting on his power and appealing to his unfailing love. Believers should help the weak with the patience and encouragement that reflects God's own compassion.

Doubt dealt with by holding on to God's truth**Gaining assurance from God's word****PSA 119:147; 1JN 5:13** See also PSA 119:116; JHN 20:31; ROM 15:4; 2PE 1:19**Receiving correction and understanding through God's word****2TI 3:14–3:17** See also PSA 119:130; PRO 6:23; 1CO 10:11**Avoiding idle speculation**

EPH 4:14; ; 1TI 6:20–6:21; ; 2TI 2:16, 2TI 2:23; ; TIT 3:9

Doubt dealt with by meditating on God's works**Remembering God's past deeds****PSA 77:10–77:20** See also DEU 7:17–7:19; 1CH 16:8–16:12 parallel PSA 105:1–105:6; PSA 22:4–22:5, PSA 74:12–74:17, PSA 143:5; ISA 46:9; MAT 16:9–16:10**Commemorating God's deeds****EXO 12:14** Religious festivals such as Passover provided a permanent reminder of God's past goodness to his people. See also DEU 16:1; LUK 22:19; 1CO 11:24–11:25**Reflecting on divine power**

MAT 11:4–11:6; ; JHN 10:38, JHN 14:11

Doubt dealt with by trusting**Trusting in God's unfailing love****PSA 6:2–6:4** See also PSA 42:8; ISA 49:15–49:16, ISA 54:10; JER 31:3–31:4**Trusting in God's presence****GEN 28:15** See also EXO 3:12; DEU 20:1; 2CH 20:15–20:17; PSA 42:11, PSA 73:23–73:26**Trusting in God's strength****ISA 41:10** See also 1KI 19:6–19:8; ISA 40:28–40:31, ISA 43:2**Remembering God's concern for the weak****God's compassion for the weak****EZK 34:16** See also ISA 42:3**God's grace to those with doubts****EXO 5:22–6:1** God responds to Moses' uncertainty by promising a demonstration of his power. See also NUM 11:21–11:23; JDG 6:39–6:40; JHN 20:27**Pastoral concern for those who doubt****Being patient with doubters****JUD 1:22** See also ROM 14:1–14:4, ROM 14:15–14:17, ROM 15:1**Encouraging those with doubts****JDG 20:22; JOB 4:3–4:4** See also 2CH 32:6–32:8; ISA 35:3–35:4, ISA 40:1; 1TH 3:2; HEB 10:23–10:25, HEB 12:12**8726: doubters**

Scripture provides examples of believers who express temporary doubts—in particular about the willingness and power of God to deliver his people, the nature of his purpose, and their own place within the divine plan.

Examples of those doubting their effectiveness to serve God**Moses****EXO 3:11** See also EXO 4:1, EXO 4:10–4:13, EXO 6:12, EXO 6:30; NUM 11:13–11:15**Gideon****JDG 6:15** See also JDG 6:17, JDG 6:36–6:40**Elijah****1KI 19:3–19:4** See also 1KI 19:10, 1KI 19:14**Jeremiah****JER 1:6** See also JER 15:10**Those temporarily doubting God's promises****GEN 15:8** See also GEN 17:17–17:18, GEN 18:12–18:15; LUK 1:18**Those doubting God's power****Abraham and Isaac doubt God's protection****GEN 12:12–12:13** Fearing for his safety, Abraham resorts to deception. See also GEN 20:2, GEN 26:7**Moses and Israel in the desert****EXO 5:22–5:23** See also EXO 14:10–14:11 The Israelites doubt God's protection at the Red Sea; NUM 11:21–11:22

Moses doubts God's provision of food; NUM 13:31–13:33
The ten spies doubt God's power to give victory in Canaan; NUM 20:7–20:12 Moses strikes the rock twice.

Others doubting God's deliverance

1SA 17:11 The people of Israel are dismayed by the challenge from Goliath; ; ISA 7:2 King Ahaz, afraid of the coalition of Syria and Israel turns to Assyria for help; ; MAT 14:29–14:31 Peter, walking on water, is afraid and begins to sink; ; ACT 12:14–12:15 The early church does not believe that God has released Peter from prison.

Believers questioning God

Questioning God's actions

JDG 6:13 See also NUM 11:10–11:12, NUM 14:3; JOS 7:7–7:8

Questioning God's commands

1SA 16:2 Samuel; ; 2KI 4:42–4:43 Elisha's servant; ; ISA 7:12 Ahaz; MRK 6:37 parallels MAT 14:16–14:17, LUK 9:13; JHN 11:39 Martha; ; ACT 9:13–9:14 Ananias

Believers with doubts about Jesus Christ

MAT 11:2–11:3 parallel LUK 7:18–7:19 **JHN 20:25** See also MAT 28:17; MRK 16:11–16:14; LUK 24:25

8727: enemies

Opponents or hostile forces which pose a threat to people or nations. Scripture identifies Satan as being the particular enemy of God and notes many enemies of the people of God. Scripture urges caution and courage in dealing with such enemies. Jesus Christ had enemies, and he provides an example of Christian conduct in the face of enemies' threats.

8728: enemies, of Israel and Judah

Throughout their history, Israel and Judah contended with enemies committed to their destruction, finding refuge only in their covenant-keeping God.

Enemies of Israel

The Egyptians

EXO 1:8–1:11, EXO 14:9; ; 1KI 14:25 parallel 2CH 12:2; ; 2CH 36:3

The Amalekites

EXO 17:8; ; JDG 3:13

The Edomites

NUM 20:18; ; 1KI 11:14

Sihon, king of the Amorites

NUM 21:23

Og, king of Bashan

NUM 21:33

The Canaanites and the surrounding nations

JOS 11:1–11:5

The Syrians (Arameans)

JDG 3:8; ; 1KI 11:25, 1KI 20:1; ; 2KI 6:8, 2KI 6:24, 2KI 24:2; ; 2CH 28:5

The Moabites

JDG 3:12; ; 2KI 1:1, 2KI 24:2

The Ammonites

JDG 3:13, JDG 10:9; ; 2SA 10:6 parallel 1CH 19:6; ; 2KI 24:2

The Midianites

JDG 6:1

The Philistines

JDG 10:7–10:8; ; 1SA 4:1–4:2, 1SA 17:1–17:2, 1SA 31:1; ; 2SA 5:17, 2SA 8:1, 2SA 21:15, 2SA 21:18 parallel 1CH 20:4

The Assyrians

2KI 15:19, 2KI 15:29, 2KI 17:3–17:6, 2KI 18:13

The Babylonians

2KI 24:1, 2KI 25:1; ; 2CH 36:5–36:7, 2CH 36:15–36:20

Those opposed to the rebuilding under Ezra and Nehemiah

EZR 4:4–4:6, EZR 5:3; ; NEH 2:10

Haman the Persian

EST 3:5–3:6

The Greeks

ZEC 9:13

The Romans

JHN 11:48

Characteristics of Israel's enemies

They were often more numerous than Israel

1SA 13:5 See also NAM 1:12

They were often better equipped

JOS 17:16 See also 1SA 13:19–13:22

They were cruel and oppressive

JER 6:23 See also EXO 6:5–6:9; DEU 28:33; JDG 6:2–6:6; JER 50:42; HAB 1:6

They were cunning

PSA 83:3

They were determined to destroy Israel

PSA 83:4

They were often in league with each other

See also PSA 83:5–83:8

God helped Israel against her enemies

He opposed Israel's enemies

GEN 12:3 See also EXO 23:22

He protected Israel

DEU 23:14; ; NEH 4:15, NEH 6:16; ; PSA 125:2; ; ISA 51:22, ISA 59:19

He delivered Israel

NUM 10:9; ; 1SA 12:11; ; 2KI 17:39; ; LUK 1:71

He gave Israel victory

EXO 23:27 See also LEV 26:7-26:8; NUM 10:35; DEU 6:19, DEU 33:27; PSA 60:12 parallel PSA 108:13; PSA 68:1; ISA 54:15

He destroyed Israel's enemies

EXO 15:6 See also DEU 20:17, DEU 30:7; JOS 10:19; 2CH 20:29; PSA 44:5

He gave Israel rest

DEU 12:10 See also DEU 25:19; 1KI 5:3-5:4; 1CH 22:9

Israel's attitude towards her enemies**Israel was not to fear them**

DEU 20:1-20:4 See also 1SA 17:45-17:47

Israel was to pray for deliverance

1KI 8:33-8:34 parallel 2CH 6:24-6:25; ; 1KI 8:37-8:40 parallel 2CH 6:28-6:31; ; EZR 8:22-8:23; ; PSA 74:3, PSA 74:10, PSA 74:18, PSA 74:22-74:23

Kindness was to be shown to Israel's enemies

EXO 23:4-23:5; ; 2KI 6:21-6:23; ; PRO 25:21-25:22; ; ROM 12:20

Thanksgiving for victory over Israel's enemies**Giving thanks to God was the proper response to victory**

EXO 15:1 See also 2SA 8:11-8:12 parallel 1CH 18:11; PSA 136:24

Israel often forgot to give thanks to God

JDG 8:33-8:34

God used enemies to chastise Israel

DEU 28:47-28:48 See also LEV 26:44 Because of his covenant, the LORD was unwilling to destroy Israel completely at the hand of her enemies; DEU 28:53; JDG 2:10-2:23, JDG 6:1; ISA 8:5-8:8

8729: enemies, of Jesus Christ

Throughout his life Jesus Christ was opposed by both spiritual and human enemies. He overcame every enemy so that his people might be set free by his victory.

The enemies of the infant Jesus

MAT 2:13-2:20 See also MAT 2:14-2:20; REV 12:1-12:5

Satan as the enemy of Jesus Christ**In the temptation in the wilderness**

MRK 1:12-1:13 parallels MAT 4:1-4:11, LUK 4:1-4:13 See also GEN 3:15

Operating through Jesus Christ's friends

MAT 16:22-16:23 See also LUK 22:3; JHN 13:21-13:27

The Jewish leaders as enemies of Jesus Christ**They plotted to kill Jesus Christ**

MAT 12:14 parallels MRK 3:6, LUK 6:11 See also PSA 2:2; ISA 53:3; MAT 27:1; JHN 5:18, JHN 7:1, JHN 7:19, JHN 11:53; 1PE 2:21-2:24

They had no real reason for hating him

JHN 15:25 See also PSA 35:19, PSA 69:4

Judas as the enemy of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:14-26:16 See also MAT 10:4, MAT 10:36; MIC 7:6; MAT 26:21-26:25, MAT 26:47-26:50; JHN 13:25-13:27

The enemies of Jesus Christ succeeded in killing him in accordance with God's will**Jesus Christ was crucified**

ACT 2:23 See also MAT 27:22; MRK 15:1; JHN 18:28-18:32; ACT 3:13

Jesus Christ did not retaliate but prayed for his enemies

LUK 23:34

Jesus Christ can change an enemy into a friend

GAL 1:23 See also ACT 9:1-9:6, ACT 22:4-22:5, ACT 26:9-26:11; ROM 5:10; PHP 3:18; COL 1:24

Jesus Christ will ultimately conquer all his enemies

1CO 15:25-15:26 See also PSA 2:9; MAL 3:2; MAT 22:44; PSA 110:1; ACT 2:34; PHP 2:9-2:11; 2TH 1:6-1:10, 2TH 2:3-2:8; HEB 1:13, HEB 10:13

8730: enemies, of believers

Christians must expect to face many enemies on account of their faith. Jesus Christ made it clear that such opposition was the inevitable result of commitment to him. Nevertheless, Christians are called upon to love their enemies.

Christians are enemies of the world because they belong to Jesus Christ

JHN 15:18-15:19 See also PSA 86:14; JHN 17:14; 2TI 3:12; 1PE 4:15-4:16; 1JN 3:13

Opposition to Christians is opposition to Jesus Christ

MAT 25:34–25:40 See also MRK 9:42; LUK 17:1; ACT 9:4–9:5

Particular enemies of Christians

All kinds of people

MRK 13:13 parallel MAT 10:22 See also JHN 15:21

Family members

MAT 10:34–10:36 parallel LUK 12:51–12:53 See also GEN 37:1–37:11; MIC 7:6; MAT 10:21 parallel MRK 13:12

Religious zealots

ACT 4:18, ACT 5:28, ACT 8:3, ACT 9:1–9:2; ; 2PE 2:1; ; 3JN 1:9–1:10

Christians may be killed by their enemies

JHN 16:2 See also ACT 7:56–7:60, ACT 12:1–12:2, ACT 26:9–26:10; REV 6:9

Christian attitudes towards enemies

To love, do good, bless and pray for them

MAT 5:44–5:45 See also JOB 31:29–31:30; LUK 6:27–6:29, LUK 6:35, LUK 23:34; ACT 7:59–7:60; ROM 12:14; 1PE 3:9

To forgive them

MAT 6:12–6:15; ; LUK 11:4, LUK 23:33–23:34; ; ACT 7:59–7:60

To help and show kindness to them

ROM 12:20 See also PRO 25:21–25:22; LUK 10:25–10:37

To show kindness to their beasts of burden

EXO 23:4–23:5

Not to rejoice in their misfortunes

PRO 24:17–24:18

To win them with kindness

ROM 12:21 See also 1SA 26:21

Christians have a spiritual enemy

Satan opposes Christians

1PE 5:8 See also JOB 1:7–1:9; LUK 22:31; 2TI 4:17–4:18

The need to engage in spiritual warfare

1PE 5:9 See also 2CO 10:4; EPH 6:10–6:18; 1TI 5:14–5:15; 2TI 4:7; JAS 4:7

God supports his people against their enemies

PSA 23:5; JHN 17:15 See also DEU 33:27; 1SA 12:11; 2SA 22:1–22:3; PSA 18:2, PSA 43:1, PSA 46:1, PSA 59:1–59:2, PSA 71:1–71:4, PSA 91:1–91:4, PSA 119:134, PSA 140:1–140:2, PSA 143:9, PSA 144:11; MAT 10:28–10:31; LUK 1:69, LUK 1:71, LUK 22:32; 2TI 4:8

Death as the last enemy to be destroyed by Jesus Christ

1CO 15:26 See also PSA 116:8; 2TI 1:10; REV 20:14, REV 21:4

8731: enemy, Satan as the enemy of God

See [4121: Satan, as the enemy of God](#)

8733: envy

A desire for another's gifts, possessions, position or achievements, closely associated with jealousy.

Causes of envy

Envy is the result of human sin

GAL 5:19–5:21 See also PRO 23:17; MAT 15:19–15:20 parallel MRK 7:21–7:23; ROM 1:29; 1CO 3:3; 1TI 6:4; TIT 3:3; 1PE 2:1–2:2

Envy arises from the good fortune of others

GEN 26:12–26:14; ; 1SA 18:6–18:8; ; PSA 73:3; ; MAT 20:12–20:15

Love does not envy others

1CO 13:4

Envy arises from the spiritual abilities of others

PSA 106:16–106:18; ACT 13:44–13:45 See also NUM 11:28–11:30, NUM 12:2, NUM 16:1–16:3; MAT 27:18 parallel MRK 15:10; ACT 17:5; PHP 1:15

Examples of envy

Cain envies Abel

GEN 4:3–4:5

Esau envies Jacob

GEN 27:41

Rachel envies Leah

GEN 30:1

The brothers envy Joseph

GEN 37:4

Results of envy

JOB 5:2 See also PRO 14:30; ECC 4:4; JAS 3:14–3:16

In some cases, envy can be used by God

ROM 10:19, ROM 11:11, ROM 11:13–11:14 Paul hopes that the Gentiles' response to the gospel might make Israel want its blessings as well. See also DEU 32:21

Envy forbidden

PSA 37:1 See also PRO 3:31, PRO 24:1; GAL 5:26

8734: evil

The presence of corruption, malevolence and depravity in the world, opposed to God's nature and will. Scripture stresses that evil is a force in its own right, rather than the mere absence of good, and describes its origins and the manner in which God deals with its continuing presence and power in his world.

8735: evil, origins of

Although Scripture does not reveal the ultimate origin of evil, it identifies a number of intermediate sources.

Satan as a source of evil

GEN 3:1 Identified later (Rev 12:9) with Satan; **MAT 4:1** parallels MRK 1:13, LUK 4:2 **JHN 8:44; 1JN 3:8; REV 12:9** See also 1CH 21:1 Satan incites David to take a census of Israel; JOB 1:11, JOB 2:5; MAT 5:37, MAT 6:13, MAT 13:38–13:39 the parable of the weeds; LUK 13:16 Satan is responsible for a woman's crippling disease; JHN 13:2 The devil prompts Judas to betray Jesus Christ; JHN 17:15; ACT 5:3 Ananias lies to the Holy Spirit at Satan's instigation; 2CO 4:4, 2CO 12:7 Paul's thorn in the flesh from Satan; EPH 2:2, EPH 6:11; 1TH 2:18; 1PE 5:8; 1JN 3:12, 1JN 5:19; REV 2:10, REV 20:2

Other evil powers

LUK 9:39 parallel MRK 9:17–9:18 **EPH 6:12; 1TI 4:1** See also JDG 9:23; ISA 16:14, ISA 18:10–18:11, ISA 19:9–19:10; MAT 12:45 parallel LUK 11:26; REV 12:7, REV 16:13–16:14

Fallen human nature as a source of evil

GEN 6:5; MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21–7:22 **JAS 1:13–1:14** See also GEN 8:21; PRO 6:18; ECC 8:11, ECC 9:3; ISA 59:7; JER 4:14, JER 17:9, JER 18:12 **MAT 23:25** parallel LUK 11:39; MAT 23:27–23:28 ROM 1:24, ROM 7:14–7:23; 1TI 6:10 the love of money a root of evil; JAS 3:6 The tongue is a source of evil; JAS 4:1

Physical evil is a consequence of moral evil

GEN 3:17; ROM 5:12 See also DEU 28:20–28:24, DEU 28:58–28:59; PSA 90:8–90:9; PRO 14:30; MAL 4:6; ROM 6:23, ROM 8:19–8:21; REV 16:1, REV 16:5–16:6

8736: evil, warnings against

Scripture repeatedly warns against evil. It exposes it and reveals its consequences.

God opposes evil

PSA 34:16 See also PRO 6:16–6:19; ISA 31:2; MIC 2:1

Warnings against specific dangers

LEV 20:23; 2CO 6:14 See also EZK 20:18; LUK 12:1, LUK 12:15; ACT 13:40; 1CO 10:21; 2PE 3:17

God's law given to counter evil

By exposing evil

ROM 7:7 See also ROM 3:20, ROM 5:20, ROM 7:13; GAL 3:19

By leading believers away from evil

GAL 3:24 See also 1TI 1:9–1:11

The state is ordained to restrain evil

ROM 13:1–13:4 See also DEU 17:7, DEU 17:12–17:13, DEU 21:21; 1TI 2:1–2:2; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Evil rebounds on evildoers

PRO 22:8; GAL 6:7–6:8 See also DEU 19:18–19:19; EST 9:25; PRO 1:29–1:31, PRO 14:22, PRO 17:13; HOS 8:7

Evil ends in judgment

ISA 65:12; ROM 2:9 See also PSA 37:9; PRO 6:12–6:15, PRO 12:7; MAL 4:1; ROM 2:5, ROM 6:23

8737: evil, believers' responses to

Scripture outlines several ways in which believers should respond to evil.

Evil is to be avoided

PSA 1:1; PRO 4:14; 1TH 5:22 See also JOB 28:28; PSA 119:115; PRO 4:27, PRO 14:16; ISA 52:11; ACT 2:40 Peter's appeal to the crowd; ROM 12:9, ROM 13:14 **1CO 5:6–5:7; GAL 5:9** 2CO 6:14–6:18; EPH 4:27, EPH 5:3, EPH 5:6–5:7; 2TH 3:6; 1PE 3:11; PSA 34:14

Evil is to be hated

PRO 8:13 See also PSA 97:10; AMO 5:15; JHN 3:20; ROM 12:9

Evil is to be rebuked

MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33 **2TI 4:2** See also 1SA 2:29, 1SA 13:13, 1SA 15:22; 2SA 12:9 Nathan rebukes David; 1KI 18:18 Elijah rebukes Ahab; 2CH 16:9, 2CH 24:20, 2CH 26:18; EZR 10:10; PSA 141:5; DAN 4:27, DAN 5:22; MAT 14:4 parallel MRK 6:18 John the Baptist rebukes Herod; LUK 23:40; ACT 5:3–5:4 Peter rebukes Ananias; ACT 5:9 Peter rebukes Sapphira; 1TI 1:3, 1TI 5:20; TIT 1:13, TIT 2:15

Evil is to be resisted

PRO 1:10; GAL 2:11; EPH 6:11; JAS 4:7 See also 1CO 5:13; EPH 5:11; HEB 12:1; 1PE 2:1, 1PE 5:9

Evil is to be repaid with good

LUK 6:35; ROM 12:20–12:21 See also PRO 25:21–25:22; EXO 23:5; LEV 19:18; MAT 5:44 parallel LUK 6:27; 1TH 5:15; 1PE 3:9

Believers should pray in response to evil

MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4 **ACT 4:29; HEB 4:16** See also EXO 17:4; 1KI 18:36; 2KI 19:19; 2CH 20:12; EZR 8:23; NEH 1:4; MAT 26:41 parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:46; ACT 12:5; JAS 5:13

Believers should trust God in the face of evil

PSA 23:4; MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 See also PSA 4:8, PSA 20:7, PSA 27:1; ISA 12:2; DAN 3:17–3:18; HAB 3:17–3:18; 2TI 1:12; HEB 13:6; PSA 118:6–118:7

8738: evil, victory over

Although evil continues to be present and active in the world, Scripture gives an assurance that God will finally triumph over evil in all its forms.

Satan's power is already limited by God

JOB 1:12 See also GEN 3:14–3:15; JOB 2:6; ZEC 3:2; REV 12:9

Evil spirits are subject to God's control

ISA 16:14 See also JDG 9:23; ISA 18:10, ISA 19:9; 1KI 22:23; COL 2:13–2:15; JUD 1:6

Jesus Christ's triumph over evil powers

1JN 3:8 See also MAT 12:25–12:29 parallels MRK 3:23–3:27, LUK 11:17–11:22; MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36; LUK 4:13, LUK 10:18; JHN 12:31, JHN 14:30; HEB 2:14–2:15; 1JN 4:4; REV 3:21

God's transforming power reverses the effects of evil in human lives

2CO 3:18; 1JN 3:2 See also JON 3:10; MRK 5:15 parallel LUK 8:35; LUK 19:8; ACT 26:17–26:18; ROM 6:14, ROM 12:2; 1CO 15:10; 2CO 12:9; COL 3:10

God brings good out of evil

GEN 50:20; ROM 8:28 See also GEN 45:8; JOB 23:10; JHN 9:3, JHN 12:24; ACT 2:36, ACT 3:13–3:16, ACT 5:30–5:31; PHP 1:12–1:14, PHP 1:17–1:18; JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 1:6–1:7

The removal of the curse on creation

ROM 8:20–8:21 See also MAT 19:28; ACT 3:21; REV 21:1, REV 21:5, REV 22:3

Jesus Christ's victory over evil is expressed in his thousand-year reign with believers, during which Satan is bound

REV 20:4 See also REV 20:2 Interpreters differ over whether the “thousand years” refers to a future period or to Jesus Christ's present rule in the world.

The final defeat of all evil powers

REV 20:4; ROM 16:20; REV 20:10 See also MAL 4:1; MAT 13:41–13:42, MAT 25:41; 1CO 15:25; 2TH 2:8; REV 19:20, REV 21:8

Evil will be excluded from the new heaven and earth

2PE 3:13 See also ISA 65:17; REV 21:4, REV 21:27, REV 22:15

8739: evil, examples of

Biblical examples of evil are many and varied.

Evil disasters sent by God in judgment

GEN 7:20, GEN 19:24; EXO 7:20, EXO 8:6, EXO 8:17, EXO 8:24, EXO 9:6, EXO 9:10, EXO 9:23, EXO 10:13, EXO 10:22, EXO 12:29; NUM 16:21–16:22; ; ISA 5:6; ; 2SA 24:15; ; 1KI 17:1

Other disasters

GEN 12:10, GEN 26:1, GEN 41:54; ; AMO 1:1; ; LUK 13:4; ; ACT 11:28

National evil**Israel guilty of evil**

EXO 32:7; ; NUM 14:11; ; DEU 32:5; ; JDG 2:11–2:15, JDG 3:7, JDG 4:1, JDG 6:1, JDG 10:6, JDG 13:1; ; NEH 9:28; ; ISA 65:12; ; AMO 2:4–2:8

Threats to Israel from other nations

JDG 6:1; ; ISA 7:7; ; 2CH 20:10–20:11

Judgment on other nations

ISA 15:2; ; ISA 14:29–14:30, ISA 15:1, ISA 17:1, ISA 19:1; ; JER 46:10, JER 46:25–46:26, JER 47:4, JER 48:1, JER 49:1–49:2, JER 49:7–49:8, JER 49:35–49:38, JER 50:1–50:2; ; AMO 1:11, AMO 1:13, AMO 2:1

Evil rulers**Of Israel**

1KI 12:31, 1KI 15:25–15:26, 1KI 15:33–15:34, 1KI 16:12–16:13, 1KI 16:18–16:19, 1KI 16:30, 1KI 21:25, 1KI 22:51–22:52; ; 2KI 10:31, 2KI 13:1–13:2, 2KI 13:10–13:11, 2KI 14:23–14:24, 2KI 15:8–15:9, 2KI 15:17–15:18, 2KI 15:24, 2KI 15:27–15:28, 2KI 17:1–17:2

Of Judah

1KI 11:4, 1KI 15:1–15:3; ; 2KI 8:16–8:18, 2KI 8:26–8:27, 2KI 11:1, 2KI 16:2, 2KI 21:1–21:2, 2KI 21:9, 2KI 21:19–21:20, 2KI 23:31–23:32, 2KI 23:36–23:37, 2KI 24:8–24:9, 2KI 24:18–24:19; ; 2CH 12:13–12:14

Of other nations

EXO 5:2; ; NUM 21:23; ; JDG 4:1–4:3; ; 2KI 18:13; ; ISA 14:3–14:6, ISA 14:13–14:14; ; DAN 4:31, DAN 5:22

Evil religious leaders

ISA 2:12; ; 1KI 18:19; ; JER 23:11; ; EZK 13:4, EZK 34:2; ; HOS 5:1; ; MIC 2:6; ; ZEP 3:4; ; MAT 23:15; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20

Opponents of Jesus Christ

MAT 2:16, MAT 12:14 parallel MRK 3:6; ; LUK 4:28; ; JHN 5:18, JHN 7:12, JHN 7:32, JHN 8:59, JHN 10:20, JHN 10:31, JHN 19:6

Opponents of the church

ACT 4:3, ACT 5:18, ACT 6:9, ACT 8:1–8:3, ACT 12:1, ACT 13:8, ACT 13:50, ACT 14:5, ACT 14:19, ACT 16:19, ACT 17:5, ACT 17:13, ACT 18:12, ACT 19:29, ACT 20:3, ACT 21:27, ACT 23:12

Evil influences

NUM 25:1, NUM 31:16; ; DEU 18:9; ; HOS 7:9; ; 1CO 5:6, 1CO 8:10; ; 1TI 4:1; ; 2PE 2:18; ; 1JN 2:26

8741: failure

Scripture indicates various ways in which believers may fail God, while emphasising that God will never fail his people.

God will never fail his people

1CH 28:20 See also JOS 1:8–1:9; PSA 89:28

God's righteousness will not fail

ISA 51:6

God's compassion will not fail

LAM 3:22–3:23

God's word will not fail

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also ROM 9:6

Examples of failing God

Failing to abide in him

PSA 14:3 See also PSA 58:3, PSA 78:57; JER 2:19, JER 3:22, JER 15:6; JHN 15:6; 2PE 3:17

Failing to believe in him

JHN 20:27 See also NUM 14:11–14:12; PSA 78:21–78:33; HEB 3:12

Failing to fear him

GEN 20:11 See also EXO 9:30; DEU 25:18; JOB 6:14; LUK 23:40

Failing to honour him

MAL 2:2 See also NUM 20:12; ISA 2:29–2:30; DAN 5:22–5:23; ROM 2:23

Failing to love him

1CO 16:22 See also JOS 23:10–23:13; MAT 10:37; REV 2:4

Failing to obey him

2KI 17:14–17:20; ; MAT 7:26

Failing to remember him

DEU 8:11, DEU 32:18 See also JDG 3:7, JDG 8:33–8:34; 1SA 12:9; PSA 78:11, PSA 106:21; ISA 17:10

Failing to seek him

2CH 12:14 See also PSA 14:2–14:3, PSA 119:155; ISA 9:13; ZEP 1:6

Failing to serve him

DEU 28:47–28:48 See also JOB 21:14–21:15; JER 2:20; MAL 3:14; ROM 1:25

Failing to trust him

MAT 6:30 parallel LUK 12:28 See also MAT 14:31, MAT 16:8, MAT 17:17–17:20

Peter's failure of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:33–26:35 parallel MRK 14:29–14:31; ; LUK 22:31–22:34; ; JHN 18:25–18:27

8742: faithlessness

The lack or absence of faith, or the turning away from a professed commitment to God.

8743: faithlessness, nature and causes of

The abandoning of a commitment to the Lord, seen in disowning him, wandering from the truth and becoming entangled with the world, and resulting in judgment.

Warnings against faithlessness

2TI 2:12–2:13 See also MAT 10:33 parallel LUK 12:9; LUK 9:62; HEB 10:35–10:39; HAB 2:3–2:4

Ways in which faithlessness is seen

Turning away from the Lord

HEB 3:12

Abandoning the gospel of grace

GAL 1:6

Becoming entangled in the world

2PE 2:20–2:22 See also PRO 26:11; 2TI 4:10

Causes of faithlessness

False teaching

2TI 2:17–2:18 See also GAL 1:7, GAL 4:8–4:11; 1TI 4:1–4:3; 2TI 4:3–4:4; 2PE 3:17

Persecution and trials

MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13 See also MAT 24:9–24:13

Concern for money and possessions

1TI 6:10 See also PRO 30:8–30:9; MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14

Love growing cold**MAT 24:12** See also REV 2:4**Sexual desire**

1TI 5:11–5:15

Faithlessness brings punishment**Church discipline**

1TI 1:18–1:20 These men had been excluded from the church, a sanctuary from Satan's power.

God's judgment**MAT 10:33** parallel LUK 12:9 See also HEB 6:4–6:6, HEB 10:26–10:27**The faithlessness of those who fall away****The absence of true faith****1JN 2:19****True faith is proved by perseverance**

See also JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 1:5–1:7

Israel's faithlessness in the OT**Israel's unfaithfulness led to God's rejection**

PSA 78:56–78:59

Warnings not to repeat Israel's unfaithfulness

PSA 95:7–95:11; ; HEB 3:7–3:12, HEB 4:1–4:2

8744: faithlessness, as disobedience

A lack of faith and obedience to God, which is seen especially in the lives of unbelievers. However, Scripture makes clear that believers can occasionally lapse into faithlessness towards God.

Faithlessness among the ungodly**In their character and lifestyle****PSA 101:3–101:5, PSA 119:158** See also PSA 10:4, PSA 14:1; JHN 16:8–16:9; 2TH 3:2; TIT 1:15–1:16**Examples of faithless men**

1SA 25:2–25:3 Nabal; ; EST 3:5–3:6 Haman; ; MAT 2:16 Herod the Great; ; ACT 19:23–19:27 Demetrius

The faithless appear to prosper**JER 12:1** See also JOB 21:7; PSA 73:3–73:5, PSA 73:12; MAL 3:15**Faithlessness results in judgment****PRO 14:14; JHN 3:36** See also PSA 73:17–73:18, PSA 73:27; MAL 4:1; MRK 16:16; JHN 8:24; 2TH 2:12; REV 21:8**Faithlessness among the Jews****Their failure to trust God for deliverance****ISA 31:1** See also ISA 22:8–22:11, ISA 30:1–30:2, ISA 30:12–30:13**Their rejection of the gospel****JHN 12:37–12:38** See also ISA 53:1; JHN 3:11–3:12, JHN 5:37–5:40, JHN 8:45, JHN 10:25–10:26**Specific examples**

MAT 13:58 parallel MRK 6:5–6:6 the people of Nazareth; ; MAT 19:21–19:22 parallels MRK 10:21–10:22, LUK 18:22–18:23 the rich young ruler; ; ACT 28:24 Many Jews reject Paul's ministry in Rome; ; 1TI 1:13 Paul's own persecution of the church arose from unbelief in Jesus Christ.

Israel's estrangement from God**MAT 21:43** See also PSA 118:22; MAT 21:41 parallel MRK 12:9; ROM 9:32–9:33**The acceptance of the Gentiles**

ROM 11:17–11:21 The Jews' rejection of the gospel opens the way for Gentiles to be incorporated into the people of God, represented here as branches grafted onto a cultivated olive tree.

Israel's faithlessness is partial and temporary

ROM 11:5 Though the people as a whole have rejected Jesus Christ, a faithful remnant remains; ; ROM 11:11–11:12, ROM 11:23–11:27 God's purpose for the faithful of Israel is their ultimate salvation.

Faithlessness among believers**Lack of faith is rebuked****MAT 14:30–14:31** See also MAT 6:30–6:32 parallel LUK 12:28–12:30 worrying about food and clothing; MAT 8:24–8:26 parallels MRK 4:38–4:40, LUK 8:23–8:25 Fear during a storm at sea; MAT 17:17–17:20 parallels MRK 9:17–9:19, LUK 9:40–9:42 inability to cast out a demon**Causes of faithlessness**

MAT 16:8–16:10 failure to learn from the lessons of the past; ; LUK 24:25 failure to accept teaching that has been given

8746: false Christs

Mistaken and deceptive people claiming to be Jesus Christ. Jesus Christ warns his followers to be on their guard against the appearance of such people.

Jesus Christ warns that false Christs will appear**MAT 24:5** parallels MRK 13:6, LUK 21:8 See also MAT 24:23 parallel MRK 13:21**False Christs will perform signs and miracles in order to deceive****MAT 24:24** parallel MRK 13:22

False Christs can be recognised because the return of Jesus Christ will be obvious to everyone

MAT 24:27–24:31 parallels MRK 13:24–13:27, LUK 21:25–21:28 The personal return of the Lord Jesus Christ is not described in terms of an appearance to a select group, but to the whole world. The attempt of anyone to convince others that he is Christ therefore is a sure sign of deception.

8747: false gods

Any gods other than the LORD himself. Some of these divinities took the form of images, others were mythical. Some Israelites became involved in idolatrous worship of such gods. The book of Acts records attempts to deify human beings.

False gods associated with foreign nations in the OT

Amon, the chief god of Egypt

See also JER 46:25

Asherah, a Canaanite goddess

EXO 34:13–34:14 Asherah was the consort of El, the chief Canaanite god. Wooden poles, perhaps carved in her image, were often set up in her honour and placed near other pagan objects of worship. See also DEU 7:5; JDG 6:25–6:30 Gideon destroys an Asherah pole; 1KI 14:15, 1KI 14:23, 1KI 15:13, 1KI 16:33, 1KI 18:19 Elijah summons 400 prophets of Asherah to Mount Carmel. 2KI 23:4–23:7, 2KI 23:13–23:16 ISA 27:9; JER 17:2; MIC 5:14

Ashtoreth, a goddess of war and fertility

JDG 2:12–2:13 Ashtoreth, the consort of Baal, was associated with the evening star and was worshipped as Ishtar in Babylon and as Attart in Aram. To the Greeks she was Astarte or Aphrodite and to the Romans, Venus. See also JDG 10:6; 1SA 7:3–7:4, 1SA 12:10, 1SA 31:10; 1KI 11:5, 1KI 11:33

Baal, a Canaanite and Phoenician god of fertility and rain

JDG 2:10–2:13 Baal, meaning “lord”, was pictured standing on a bull, a popular symbol of fertility and strength. Baal was associated with Asherah and Ashtoreth, goddesses of fertility.

Baal-Zebub, a popular deity of the Philistines

MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15 Beelzebub is the Greek form of the Hebrew name “Baal-Zebub”, meaning “lord of the flies”. See also 2KI 1:1–1:6, 2KI 1:16–1:17

Bel, the chief deity of Babylon

ISA 46:1 Bel was another name for the sun god, Marduk. Nebo, the god of learning and writing was the son of Marduk. See also JER 50:2, JER 51:44

Chemosh, the chief god of Moab

1KI 11:7 See also NUM 21:29; 1KI 11:33; 2KI 23:13; JER 48:7, JER 48:13, JER 48:46

Dagon, worshipped in Babylonia and Philistia

JDG 16:23 See also 1SA 5:2–5:7; 1CH 10:10

Molech, the chief deity of Ammon

1KI 11:4–11:5 See also LEV 18:21 The practice of sacrificing children to Molech was common in Phoenicia and the region; LEV 20:2–20:5; 1KI 11:7, 1KI 11:33; 2KI 23:10 Josiah destroyed the area where the altars for child sacrifice were located; 2KI 23:13; ISA 57:9; JER 32:35, JER 49:1, JER 49:3; ZEP 1:5; ACT 7:43

Tammuz, a Babylonian fertility god

EZK 8:14

The worship of false gods was a snare to God’s people

Their worship included disgusting rites

1KI 14:23–14:24, 1KI 19:18; ; JER 7:31; ; HOS 13:2

Numerous attempts were made to stop the worship of Baal and other false gods

JDG 6:28–6:32; 1KI 18:17–18:40 See also 2KI 10:18–10:28, 2KI 11:18, 2KI 23:4–23:5, 2KI 23:13

Attempts to stop false worship proved unsuccessful

2KI 21:3 The word “Baal” was not originally a proper name but came to be used as such. See also 2CH 28:1–28:4; HOS 13:1–13:2

Warnings against and condemnation of, the worship of false gods

PSA 40:4; DAN 3:29 Nebuchadnezzar came to realise the foolishness of worshipping false gods See also PSA 4:2; JER 13:25, JER 16:19; AMO 2:4; ZEP 1:4

The first Christians were confronted with the worship of Greek and Roman deities

Zeus and Hermes

ACT 14:12 Zeus was the patron god of the city of Lystra and his temple was there. Paul was identified as the god Hermes (the Roman Mercury), Zeus’ attendant and spokesman.

Artemis

ACT 19:24–19:28 Artemis was the Greek name for the Roman goddess, Diana.

Castor and Pollux

See also ACT 28:11 the two “sons of Zeus”, regarded as the guardian deities of sailors

Attempts to deify human beings

ACT 12:21–12:22, ACT 14:12–14:15, ACT 28:6

8748: false religion

The worship of anything that is not God, including any form of religion that fails to do justice to the glory and majesty of God. Scripture criticises both the practices and the beliefs of false religions.

The nature of false religion**Man-made images are worshipped**

ACT 17:29 See also DEU 4:28; PSA 115:4–115:7, PSA 135:15–135:17; ISA 44:10–44:20; JER 10:3–10:5, JER 16:20; DAN 3:4–3:7; ACT 19:26

Created things are worshipped

ROM 1:25 See also 2KI 21:3 parallel 2CH 33:5; JER 8:2, JER 19:13; EZK 8:16

Secular authorities are worshipped

REV 13:4 The dragon in Revelation may be understood as the devil and the beast as the antichrist: the forces at work behind the human authorities that defy the rule of God. See also ACT 12:21–12:23; REV 13:8, REV 13:12

Demons are worshipped

DEU 32:17 See also LEV 17:7; PSA 106:37–106:38; 1CO 10:20; REV 9:20

False religion is based on man-made traditions, myths and philosophies

COL 2:8, COL 2:20–2:23; ; 1TI 1:4, 1TI 6:20

False religious practices**Immorality**

1KI 14:23–14:24 See also EZK 16:16–16:17; HOS 4:13–4:14

Human sacrifice

2KI 17:17 See also LEV 18:21; PSA 106:37–106:38

False religion ensnares its adherents**It offers no help in time of need**

ISA 12:21 See also JDG 10:14; 1KI 18:29; 2KI 19:12 parallel ISA 37:12; ISA 16:12, ISA 44:17–44:20, ISA 45:20, ISA 46:7, ISA 57:13; JER 11:12

It prevents people from finding the truth

JON 2:8 See also MAT 23:13; LUK 11:52; 2CO 4:4

It devalues, degrades and defiles

2KI 17:15 See also PSA 106:39, PSA 115:8, PSA 135:18; ISA 44:9; JER 2:5; EZK 20:18

It leads to immorality

NUM 25:1–25:2 See also NUM 25:3, NUM 25:6–25:8; ROM 1:23–1:31; REV 9:20–9:21

It enslaves

GAL 4:8 See also DEU 12:30; GAL 4:3, GAL 4:9–4:10; COL 2:8

False religion receives the full force of God's anger

JER 16:18 See also 1KI 13:1–13:3, 1KI 13:33–13:34; 2KI 17:18–17:23; JER 22:8–22:9; MIC 5:13–5:15; NAM 1:14; ZEP 1:4–1:5

8749: false teachers

Those who teach error and in so doing lead others astray. They are to be distinguished from false prophets who are equally condemned in Scripture.

The OT prophets warned God's people against being led astray by false teachers

ISA 9:16; EZK 34:2 See also ISA 3:12, ISA 8:20; JER 2:8, JER 10:21, JER 23:1; EZK 22:26; MAL 2:7–2:8

Jesus Christ condemned false teachers**He opposed legalism and hypocrisy**

MAT 5:19

He identified the teachers of the law and Pharisees as false teachers

MAT 23:1–23:33 parallel LUK 11:42–11:52 See also MAT 15:14

He warned his followers against them

MAT 16:6, MAT 16:12 parallels MRK 8:15, LUK 12:1

The condemnation of false teachers in the early church**Paul urges his readers to avoid false teachers**

1TI 6:3–6:6 See also ACT 20:29–20:31; ROM 16:17–16:18; 2CO 11:3–11:4 The Corinthian church had been undiscerningly tolerant of Jewish deceivers in their midst; EPH 4:14COL 2:4, COL 2:81TI 1:3–1:4, 1TI 1:7 1TI 4:1–4:3, 1TI 6:20–6:21; TIT 1:10–1:11; HEB 13:9; 2JN 1:9–1:10REV 2:6, REV 2:15 REV 2:14 the followers of Balaam; REV 2:20

Hymenaeus and Philetus are cited as examples of false teachers

2TI 2:17–2:18

Those who teach will be judged particularly strictly

JAS 3:1 See also 2CO 11:13–11:15; GAL 1:6–1:9, GAL 5:10

8750: false teachings

Scripture repeatedly warns against false teachings, which deny or distort some aspect of the gospel. The origin of such teachings is attributed either to human error or to demonic inspiration.

Examples of false teachings

REV 2:14–2:15 See also MAT 5:19; 2TH 2:1–2:2; 1TI 4:1–4:3; REV 2:20

Qualities of false teachings

They are valueless

MAT 15:9 parallel MRK 7:7 See also ISA 29:13; EPH 5:6; COL 2:20–2:23; 1TI 1:3–1:7

They are destructive in their nature

2PE 2:1 See also MAT 7:15; ACT 20:29–20:30; TIT 1:10–1:11

They have the capacity to lead people astray

ACT 20:30 See also EPH 4:14; 1TI 6:20–6:21; HEB 13:9; 2PE 2:14–2:15; 1JN 2:26

They may be popular

2PE 2:2 See also MAT 24:4–24:5 parallel MRK 13:5–13:6; 2TI 4:3; 2PE 2:18–2:19; 1JN 4:1–4:5

They may be accompanied by miraculous signs

MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22 See also 2TH 2:9–2:10; REV 13:11–13:15

The origin of false teachings

Demonic inspiration

1TI 4:1–4:2 See also 2CO 11:3–11:4; 1JN 4:1–4:3; REV 16:13–16:14

Human error

2PE 2:3 See also COL 2:8; 1TI 6:20–6:21

Discerning false teachings

By their content

1JN 4:2–4:3 See also 1CO 12:3; 1JN 2:20–2:23; 2JN 1:7–1:11

By the teacher's lifestyle

MAT 7:15–7:20 See also 2CO 11:20; 1JN 3:7–3:10; JUD 1:4

By their effects

1TI 6:3–6:5 See also 1TI 1:3–1:4; 2TI 2:16–2:18; REV 2:20

The antidote to false teachings

Holding fast to the true gospel

1JN 2:24 See also GAL 1:6–1:9; 1TI 1:18–1:20; 2TI 1:13–1:14

Shunning false teachers

ROM 16:17–16:18 See also 2TI 3:1–3:9; TIT 3:9–3:11; 2JN 1:9–1:11

8751: false witness

The telling of lies about another so as to make them appear guilty when they are innocent. Condemned in Scripture, false witness was experienced by Jesus Christ and is to be expected by those who follow him.

False witness is condemned in Scripture

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20 See also EXO 23:1; DEU 19:15–19:19; PSA 101:5–101:7; MAT 19:18 parallels MRK 10:19; LUK 18:20

False witness arises from an evil heart

MAT 15:19–15:20 parallel MRK 7:21–7:23

False witness will be subject to judgment

PSA 101:5–101:8; PRO 21:28 See also PRO 19:9; DAN 6:24; MAT 12:35–12:37

Examples of those who were the victims of false witness

Jesus Christ

MAT 26:59–26:61 parallel MRK 14:55–14:59 See also MAT 11:18–11:19 parallel LUK 7:33–7:34

Other examples

1KI 21:8–21:14 Naboth; ; PSA 27:12 David; ; DAN 6:24 Daniel; ; ACT 6:11–6:13 Stephen; ACT 17:5–17:7, ACT 24:5–24:9, ACT 25:7; ; ROM 3:8

False witness against believers is to be expected by them

MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23 See also MAT 24:9–24:10; ACT 19:9

8752: false worship

Forms of worship that are not worthy of God, especially worship offered without sincerity and obedience or that is contrary to the commands of God.

Examples of false worship

Worship conducted in disobedience to God

LEV 10:1–10:2 See also NUM 3:2–3:4; 1SA 15:1–15:23; 2KI 17:33

Worship and sacrifices offered by those who were not priests

1SA 13:11–13:14 See also 2CH 26:19–26:20

Insincere worship

ISA 29:13 See also MAT 15:8–15:9; MRK 7:6–7:7; COL 2:23

Worship lacking in due humility and reverence

MAT 6:5 See also LUK 18:10–18:14

Worship conducted in ignorance of God

JHN 4:22 See also ACT 17:22–17:23

Scripture vividly contrasts false worship with true worship

True worship involves the worshipper's heart, soul and mind

DEU 6:5 parallels MAT 22:37, MRK 12:30, LUK 10:27

True worship is costly

2SA 24:24; ; MRK 12:41–12:44; ; ROM 12:1 True worship involves the whole of a person's life and not just formal acts of worship.

True worship is in the spirit

JHN 4:23–4:24 See also ISA 29:23; PHP 3:3; 1TI 2:9; HEB 12:28

8753: favouritism

The unfair treatment of a person or group in preference to another. Favouritism is shown in Scripture as causing division both in the family and in the church. It is warned against in the administration of justice. The human tendency to partiality is contrasted with God's impartial dealings.

Favouritism in family life

Isaac's preference for Esau

GEN 25:23, GEN 25:28

Rebekah's preference for Jacob

GEN 27:6–27:10

Jacob's preference for Joseph

GEN 37:3–37:4

Elkanah's preference for Hannah

1SA 1:5–1:6

The child of a favourite wife must not receive preferential treatment

DEU 21:15–21:16

Favouritism in church relationships

In the treatment of widows

ACT 6:1

James warned against favouring rich Christians

JAS 2:1–2:4, JAS 2:8–2:9

Paul warned Timothy against showing favouritism

1TI 5:21

Justice must be impartial

LEV 19:15 See also EXO 23:3; DEU 16:19; JOB 13:10; PSA 82:2; PRO 24:23, PRO 28:21; MAL 2:9

God has no favourites

ROM 2:11 See also JOB 34:19; MAT 5:45

God has no favourite nation

ACT 10:34–10:35 See also ROM 2:10; EPH 6:8–6:9

God does not differentiate between Jewish and Gentile Christians

ACT 15:7–15:9; ; ROM 10:12–10:13

God judges all without favouritism

DEU 10:17; ; 2CH 19:7; ; ROM 2:9; ; COL 3:25; ; 1PE 1:17

8754: fear

An attitude of anxiety or distress, caused by concern over a threat to one's future. Scripture provides numerous examples of situations in which fear is experienced. It declares, however, that God alone is to be feared, and moments of human fear can be opportunities for deepening faith in him.

Reverent fear of God commended

PRO 1:7 See also DEU 6:13, DEU 31:12–31:13; JOS 4:24, JOS 24:14; 1SA 12:24; PSA 2:11, PSA 34:7–34:9; PRO 15:33; ECC 12:13; ISA 33:6; REV 14:7

Fear of natural phenomena

PSA 91:5; JON 1:4–1:5 See also GEN 19:30; JOB 5:22; ECC 12:5; ISA 7:25; MAT 8:26; REV 11:13

Fear of the unnatural

Fear of thoughts and visions

DAN 4:5; ACT 10:4 See also 1SA 3:15; JOB 4:13–4:15; ISA 21:4; DAN 8:17, DAN 10:11–10:12; MAT 1:20, MAT 28:4; LUK 1:12–1:13, LUK 1:29–1:30, LUK 2:9–2:10

Fear of the unknown or the abnormal

MAT 14:26–14:27 parallels MRK 6:50, JHN 6:19–6:20 **ACT 5:5** See also EXO 20:18, EXO 34:30 The radiance of Moses' face reflected God's glory and made the Israelites afraid; DEU 5:5; 1SA 4:7; NEH 6:16; JER 10:2; DAN 5:9 Belshazzar's fear at the writing on the wall; JON 1:10; MAT 17:6 the fear of the disciples at the transfiguration; MAT 27:54; MRK 5:33, MRK 9:32, MRK 16:8; LUK 5:10, LUK 8:37 Fear seized the people when the Gerasene demoniac was healed; LUK 9:34; JHN 19:8; ACT 19:17

Fear of embarrassment or shame

GEN 3:10 See also ISA 54:4; JHN 3:20; 2CO 12:20

Fear of the future

JER 51:46 See also ISA 41:23; MRK 10:32; LUK 12:32; ACT 27:24

Fear of persecution

EZR 4:4; JHN 12:42–12:43 See also 1KI 19:3; JHN 7:13, JHN 9:22, JHN 20:19; 1PE 3:14; REV 2:10

Fear of death

HEB 2:14–2:15 See also PSA 55:4–55:5; MRK 5:36 parallel LUK 8:50; ACT 23:10

Fear of people

Of enemies

EXO 14:10; ISA 7:7 See also NUM 22:3; JDG 7:3; ISA 17:24, ISA 17:11; 2SA 10:19; 2CH 12:5; PSA 27:1–27:3, PSA 56:1–56:4; ISA 20:5, ISA 41:5; JER 22:25, JER 41:18; OBA 1:9

Of one's own family

GEN 32:11, GEN 45:3; JDG 9:21 See also GEN 31:31, GEN 32:7, GEN 42:4, GEN 50:19; JDG 6:27

Of particular people

ISA 15:24; 1CO 2:3 See also GEN 26:7; EXO 2:14; DEU 2:4; ISA 18:15 Saul's fear of David; 2SA 3:11; NEH 2:2 Nehemiah's fear before the king; EST 7:6; JER 26:21, JER 38:19; MAT 2:22; MRK 12:12; LUK 19:21; ACT 9:26 the disciples fear of Paul, not believing his conversion; 1CO 16:10; 2CO 7:15; GAL 2:12

Of human beings in general

PRO 29:25 See also DEU 1:17; ISA 51:7

Fear of judgment

EZK 11:8; ACT 24:25 See also ISA 28:20; 1CH 21:30; ISA 33:14; JER 17:18, JER 30:5, JER 42:15–42:16; EZK 12:18, EZK 27:35; ZEC 9:5; 1JN 4:18 Christians, assured of God's love, no longer fear judgment; REV 18:10, REV 18:15

Fear as a deterrent

ROM 13:4 See also DEU 13:11, DEU 17:13, DEU 19:20, DEU 21:21; JOB 19:28–19:29

Fear as an opportunity for faith

DEU 1:21; PSA 23:4; PRO 3:25–3:26; MAT 10:29–10:31 See also EXO 14:13; DEU 1:29, DEU 7:18–7:21, DEU 31:6; JOS 11:6; NEH 4:14; PSA 3:6, PSA 34:4, PSA 49:5, PSA 56:3; ISA 10:24, ISA 35:3–35:4, ISA 41:14, ISA 43:5, ISA 44:8, ISA 51:12; JER 1:8, JER 1:17, JER 30:10, JER 42:11, JER 46:27; EZK 2:6, EZK 3:9; DAN 10:19; MAT 8:26 parallels MRK 4:40, LUK 8:25; MRK 6:49–6:51; JHN 14:27

8755: folly

A human attitude of lack of wisdom or contempt for wisdom, which shows itself in a lack of understanding and obedience. Scripture contrasts human foolishness with divine wisdom, and indicates the serious consequences of a rejection of the wisdom of God.

8756: folly, examples of

Human folly is seen in rebellion against God, ignoring his way and will, a failure to understand him: and moral or spiritual irresponsibility.

Examples of human folly

The folly of God's people

JER 4:22 See also DEU 32:6 rejecting God; JER 10:8 worshipping idols; HOS 7:11 seeking foreign help rather than trusting God

The folly of Israel's leaders

JER 10:21 The shepherds are those entrusted with the task of guiding and caring for God's people; **EZK 13:3** See also MAT 23:16–23:17

Particular demonstrations of human folly

NUM 12:1–12:11 Aaron and Miriam; ISA 13:13, ISA 26:21; ISA 25:25 Nabal. In Hebrew this name means “fool”; 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; 2CH 16:7–16:9 Asa, king of Judah; ; ISA 19:11–19:13 Pharaoh's advisors; ; MAT 7:26 the foolish builder; ; MAT 25:1–25:3 the foolish virgins; ; LUK 12:16–12:21 the rich fool; ; GAL 3:13 the Galatian Christians

Paul's “foolishness”

2CO 11:16–11:21 Paul engages in what he admits is the foolish boasting of his accomplishments in order to challenge the claims of false “apostles”. See also 2CO 11:1, 2CO 12:6, 2CO 12:11

God's wisdom regarded as “foolishness”

1CO 1:18 See also HOS 9:7; ZEC 11:15; 1CO 1:20–1:25, 1CO 1:27, 1CO 4:10

Human wisdom is foolishness to God

1CO 3:19 See also JOB 12:17; ISA 29:14, ISA 44:25, ISA 55:8; JER 50:36; ROM 1:22

8757: folly, effects of

The attitude that leads to a closing of the mind towards God and his truth, and a false self-confidence, which results in being easily led astray, failure to see danger, unpreparedness and ultimate ruin.

Folly gives a false basis for confidence

Contempt for God's wisdom

PRO 1:7 See also JOB 28:28; PSA 14:1, PSA 85:8, PSA 111:10; PRO 1:20–1:27, PRO 12:1, PRO 18:2

Blindness to God's truth

EPH 5:17 See also PSA 92:6; ECC 5:1–5:4; JER 5:4; LUK 11:39–11:40 hypocrisy in worship; ROM 1:21; 1CO 15:36 failure to understand the nature of death and resurrection; 2TI 2:23; TIT 3:9 futile controversies

Rebellion against God's authority

PSA 107:17; ; JER 5:21–5:25

Self-reliance

PRO 28:26 See also PRO 11:28, PRO 12:15, PRO 14:12; LUK 12:20

Folly cannot be hidden

ECC 10:3 See also PSA 69:5; PRO 12:23, PRO 13:16, PRO 15:2; 2TI 3:9

Folly opens the way to deception

PRO 14:8

Being led astray

PRO 14:15 See also PRO 7:7–7:23, PRO 9:13–9:18; ECC 7:26; HOS 7:11; GAL 3:1

Failing to see danger

PRO 22:3 See also ECC 4:13

Being unprepared

MAT 25:10

The consequences of folly**Destruction and ruin**

PRO 1:32 See also PRO 5:23, PRO 10:8; ECC 7:17; 1TI 6:9

Shame

PRO 3:35 See also PRO 18:13; ISA 44:9; JER 8:9

Grief to parents

PRO 17:25 See also PRO 10:1, PRO 15:20, PRO 17:21

Punishment

PRO 16:22 See also PSA 38:5; PRO 18:6, PRO 26:3

Exclusion from God's way of salvation

ISA 35:8 See also MAT 25:10–25:12

Folly is persistent

PRO 27:22 See also PRO 15:14, PRO 26:11

Remedies for folly**The forgiveness of foolish actions**

NUM 12:11; ; JOB 42:8; ; PSA 85:8; ; TIT 3:3–3:5

Discipline

PRO 19:25, PRO 21:11, PRO 22:15, PRO 29:15

Wisdom and instruction

PRO 8:5, PRO 14:33; ; ISA 29:24; ; ROM 2:20

8759: fools

Those who lack wisdom and understanding, especially in relation to God.

8760: fools, characteristics of

Scripture portrays fools as those who have rejected God and his ways and are unable or unwilling to appreciate the wisdom of knowing and obeying him.

The world regards Christians as fools

1CO 4:10 See also 1CO 1:26–1:31

The world regards the gospel as foolish

1CO 1:18 See also 1CO 1:20–1:25

Fools do not believe in God

PSA 53:1 parallel PSA 14:1 See also ROM 1:21

Fools do not trust God

HOS 7:11 See also 2CH 16:7–16:9; ISA 19:11–19:13, ISA 30:1

Fools lack knowledge of God

JER 4:22 See also JER 5:4, JER 5:21; PSA 92:6; LUK 24:25; EPH 5:15–5:17

The behaviour of fools**Fools worship idols**

JER 10:8 See also JER 10:14 parallel JER 51:17; ROM 1:22–1:23

Fools act in a godless manner

ISA 32:6 See also PSA 94:5–94:8; PRO 10:23; ECC 7:25; JER 4:22

Fools are dishonest

JER 17:11

Fools give vent to their anger

PRO 29:11 See also ECC 7:9

Fools are disobedient

1SA 13:13 See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; PSA 107:17; PRO 10:8

Fools despise instruction and discipline

PRO 1:22 See also PRO 1:28–1:33, PRO 5:23, PRO 12:15; ISA 65:2; JER 18:12; EZK 3:7

The speech of fools**Fools speak unwisely**

PRO 18:6–18:7 See also ECC 10:12; EPH 5:4

Fools are slanderous

PRO 10:18 See also 2PE 2:15

Fools are mockers

PRO 14:9 See also PRO 1:22, PRO 14:6, PRO 23:9, PRO 24:9

Fools love quarrelling and dissension

PRO 20:3 See also PRO 19:1; 1TI 1:4, 1TI 6:4; 2TI 2:23; TIT 3:9

The words of fools are empty

PRO 15:2 See also PRO 14:7, PRO 26:7; ECC 9:17, ECC 10:14

Fools rely on themselves

PRO 12:15 See also PRO 14:12, PRO 28:26

Fools rely on words, not deeds

JAS 2:20 See also ECC 5:4; LUK 11:39–11:40

8761: fools, in teaching of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ speaks about those whose words and actions demonstrate opposition to, or disregard for, the wisdom of God revealed in his words and through the Scriptures, and in parables points to the serious consequences of folly.

The foolishness of the Pharisees

Their blindness

MAT 23:16–23:17 The Pharisees demonstrate foolishness by attaching undue significance to what is less important whilst neglecting what really matters. See also MAT 7:3 parallel LUK 6:41; MAT 15:14 parallel LUK 6:39; MAT 23:23–23:24

Their hypocrisy

LUK 11:39–11:40 The Pharisees were concerned with the externals of religion. Jesus Christ is concerned, also, with the inner life. See also MAT 12:35–12:36, MAT 23:25–23:28

The foolishness of the disciples

LUK 24:25 See also MAT 15:16–15:20 parallel MRK 7:20–7:23; MRK 8:17 parallel MAT 16:9; MRK 9:32, MRK 16:12–16:14

Fools in Jesus Christ's parables

The rich fool

LUK 12:16–12:21 The foolishness of trusting in wealth and not in God. See also JOB 27:16–27:19; DAN 4:30–4:31; MAT 6:19

The foolish builder

MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:49 See also PRO 1:28–1:33; ISA 65:2; JER 5:21–5:25, JER 13:10; EZK 3:7

The foolish virgins

MAT 25:1–25:13 The foolishness of being unprepared for the coming of God's kingdom. See also MRK 13:35–13:36; LUK 12:35–12:36

The seriousness of the term “fool”

MAT 5:22 See also PRO 1:32; ECC 7:17

8763: forgetting

The process of accidentally or deliberately failing to remember people, events or ideas. Scripture rebukes those who forget the past work of God in history or in their lives or who neglect their present responsibilities towards God in order to please themselves.

Causes of forgetting

Forgetting can be deliberate

2PE 3:5

Forgetting can be caused by idolatry

JER 23:25–23:27 See also DEU 32:15–32:18; JDG 3:7; JER 18:15; HOS 2:13

Forgetting can be caused by pride

HOS 13:4–13:6 See also 2CH 26:16; PSA 10:4

Forgetting can be caused by drinking

PRO 31:4–31:5 See also GEN 9:20–9:21; MAT 24:45–24:51 parallel LUK 12:42–12:46

Forgetting can be caused by affliction

PSA 102:4 See also GEN 41:28–41:31; LAM 3:17–3:20

Forgetting people

GEN 40:23 See also JOB 19:13–19:15; PSA 31:11–31:12

Forgetting God

DEU 32:18 See also JDG 2:10–2:13; 1SA 12:9–12:10

Forgetting God's acts in the past

PSA 78:11–78:20 See also JDG 8:33–8:34; NEH 9:16–9:17; PSA 106:7–106:13

Consequences of forgetting God

Forgetting God brings suffering on the individual

PSA 50:22 See also 1SA 12:9; ISA 17:10–17:11

Forgetting God brings suffering on others

2SA 12:9 David's forgetting of God in his adultery with Bathsheba led to her husband Uriah suffering death through David's manipulation of events. See also PSA 106:13–106:15; JER 3:21

Forgetting God brings destruction on the nation

DEU 8:19–8:20 See also ISA 65:11–65:12; HOS 8:14

Warnings not to forget God

DEU 6:12 See also DEU 4:9, DEU 8:10–8:14; 2KI 17:35–17:38

People may sometimes feel that God has forgotten them

PSA 13:1 See also PSA 42:9–42:10, PSA 44:23–44:24; ISA 49:14; MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; PSA 22:1

God promises never to forget his people

ISA 44:21 See also ISA 49:15–49:16; HEB 6:10

Things God urges believers to forget

ISA 43:18 See also PHP 3:13–3:15

8764: forgetting God

Scripture warns people how easy it is to forget God in the varying circumstances of life and to fail to give him his due place, and points out the consequences of so doing.

Warnings not to forget God

Forgetting God's past acts

DEU 4:9 See also DEU 9:7-9:8; ISA 51:12-51:13

Forgetting God's covenant

DEU 4:23 See also 2KI 17:38

Forgetting God's ways

ISA 55:6-55:8 See also DEU 18:9-18:13; 1KI 2:1-2:4

Reasons why people forget God

Easy circumstances

DEU 6:10-6:12 See also DEU 8:10-8:14

Idolatry

JDG 8:33-8:34 See also EXO 32:1-32:8; DEU 12:29-12:31; 1KI 11:4-11:6

Pride and stubbornness

NEH 9:16 See also DEU 9:12-9:13; 2KI 17:14-17:17; JER 7:22-7:26

Consequences of people forgetting God

Spiritual adultery

HOS 1:2 See also JER 3:6-3:10; HOS 4:10-4:13, HOS 5:4

Social decay

HOS 4:1-4:3

The destruction of the nation

DEU 8:19-8:20 See also DEU 6:14-6:15

The death of the sinner

PSA 9:17 See also JOB 8:11-8:13; PSA 50:22; ISA 65:11-65:12

Examples of people forgetting God

JDG 8:33-8:34; ; 2KI 17:7-17:20; ; PSA 78:40-78:43, PSA 106:19-106:22; ; ISA 1:2-1:3; ; JER 3:19-3:21

Exhortations and resolve not to forget God

PSA 103:2, PSA 119:61, PSA 119:109

God's provision to help people not to forget him

His word

PSA 78:5-78:7 See also DEU 31:24-31:27; JER 20:9

Covenantal meals and festivals

DEU 16:1-16:3, DEU 16:9-16:12; ; 1CO 11:23-11:26

External signs

GEN 9:12-9:17, GEN 17:9-17:13; ; NUM 15:37-15:39; ; DEU 11:18-11:20

God's challenge to those who forget him

HOS 4:1 See also ISA 57:11; JER 2:31-2:32; HOS 2:2-2:13

God's call to those who forget him

JER 3:19-3:22 See also REV 2:4-2:5, REV 3:20

God's grace even when his people do forget him

ISA 49:15-49:16 See also DEU 4:25-4:31; NEH 9:29-9:31

8765: grudge

A persistent feeling of ill will or resentment held by one person against another, often as the result of an injury or insult. Christians are not to bear grudges against others; instead they are to forgive those who have wronged them.

Examples of those who held grudges

Esau against Jacob

GEN 27:41

Joseph's brothers and Joseph

GEN 37:4 See also GEN 37:5, GEN 37:8, GEN 37:18-37:19, GEN 37:23-37:24, GEN 50:15

The Israelites against Moses and Aaron

NUM 11:1, NUM 14:1-14:4, NUM 14:27

Saul against David

1SA 18:7-18:9

Ahab against Elijah

1KI 18:16-18:17, 1KI 21:20, 1KI 22:8

Herodias against John the Baptist

MRK 6:18-6:19

The disciples against others

See also MAT 26:6-26:9 parallel MRK 14:3-14:5; JHN 12:3-12:6

The Sadducees against the apostles

ACT 5:17

The Jews against Stephen

ACT 7:54

Severe grudges that led to hatred and murder

That of Abel by Cain

GEN 4:4-4:8

That of Joseph by his brothers, averted by Reuben

GEN 37:18-37:20

That of Amnon, on the orders of Absalom

2SA 13:22, 2SA 13:28-13:32

That of John the Baptist by Herodias

MRK 6:22–6:24, MRK 6:27–6:28

Warnings against the holding of grudges**In the OT****LEV 19:18** See also DEU 15:10; JDG 8:1–8:3; JOB 5:2, JOB 36:13; PRO 3:11, PRO 20:22, PRO 23:17**In Jesus Christ's teaching****MRK 7:21–7:23** parallel MAT 15:19–15:20**In the apostles' teaching****ROM 12:17–12:21; 1TH 5:15** See also GAL 5:15, GAL 5:19–5:21; PHP 2:13–2:15; COL 3:8; 2TI 2:24; JAS 3:14–3:16; 1PE 2:1**Christians should not hold grudges****MAT 5:43–5:47** See also MAT 18:21–18:35; COL 3:13**8766: heresies**

Teachings held by a factional religious party which deny some aspect of established doctrine. NT writers give no toleration to heresies in the church.

Heresy as deviant teaching**HEB 13:9** See also GAL 1:6–1:7; 2TI 4:3–4:4**Heresies and the factional nature of Judaism****The party of the Pharisees****ACT 26:5** See also ACT 15:5; PHP 3:5–3:6**The party of the Sadducees****ACT 23:8** See also MAT 22:23 parallels MRK 12:18, LUK 20:27**Christianity was perceived as a heresy within Judaism****ACT 24:14** See also ACT 24:5, ACT 28:22**Heresies within the church****The imposition of Jewish regulations on Gentile converts****ACT 15:1** See also GAL 6:12–6:13; 1TI 1:3–1:7; TIT 1:10**Heresies concerning the person of Jesus Christ****2JN 1:7** See also 1JN 2:22–2:23, 1JN 4:1–4:3**Heresies concerning the return of Jesus Christ****2TH 2:1–2:2** See also MAT 24:4–24:5 parallels MRK 13:5–13:6, LUK 21:8; MAT 24:23–24:24 parallel MRK 13:21–13:22**The origins of heresy****Erroneous human teaching****COL 2:8** See also EPH 4:14; COL 2:20–2:22**Deceitful demonic power****1TI 4:1** See also 1JN 4:2–4:3, 1JN 4:6**Christian opposition to heresy****Heresy warned against****2PE 3:17** See also 1TI 4:7; TIT 1:10–1:14**Heresy condemned****2PE 2:3** See also GAL 1:8–1:9; 2PE 2:17–2:22**8767: hypocrisy**

An outward pretence masking an inner reality. Scripture condemns hypocrisy, especially in matters of faith. Believers should express their commitment to God in their words and their deeds, as well as in their inner motivation.

The origin of hypocrisy**JER 17:9** See also HOS 10:2 Israel; MRK 7:21–7:22 parallel MAT 15:19**The expression of hypocrisy****Insincere motives****MAT 6:2** See also MAT 6:5, MAT 6:16, MAT 15:7–15:9, MAT 22:18, MAT 23:5–23:7**When deeds do not match words****ISA 29:13** See also MAT 15:7–15:8 parallel MRK 7:6; PRO 26:24–26:26; JER 9:8, JER 12:2; EZK 33:31; MAT 23:28; ROM 2:17–2:24; JAS 2:14–2:26**A tendency to judge others****MAT 7:5** parallel LUK 6:41 See also ROM 2:1**The alternative to hypocrisy****HEB 10:22** See also PSA 24:3–24:4, PSA 26:4, PSA 32:2; JAS 3:17, JAS 4:8; 1PE 2:1–2:3**Hypocrisy is not to be found in leaders****1CH 28:8–28:9** See also MAL 2:6 the true priest; 1CO 4:1–4:5; 1TI 3:8; TIT 1:8; JAS 3:1**Examples of hypocrites****Israel's leaders****JER 6:13** See also JER 8:8**The Pharisees****MRK 12:38–12:40** See also MAT 23:1–23:32; LUK 12:1–12:2, LUK 12:56**Peter and Barnabas****GAL 2:12–2:13** By acting in this way, Peter was denying his own conviction that Gentiles could be saved by faith without having to submit to the law.**Many false teachers****ROM 16:17–16:18** See also PHP 1:17; 1TI 4:2; 2TI 3:5; JUD 1:16

Examples of those who did not practise hypocrisy

Jesus Christ

1PE 2:21–2:22 See also ISA 53:9; JHN 8:44–8:46

Paul and his companions

2CO 1:12 See also 2CO 2:17; 1TH 2:3–2:10

8768: idolatry

The worship or adoration of anyone or anything other than the LORD God. Idolatry includes the worship of other gods, such as those of the nations surrounding Israel, images or idols and the creation itself.

8769: idolatry, in OT

Scripture provides illustrations of idolatry from various periods in the history of the people of God. Idolatry is seen as a constant temptation for believers, especially in times of national or personal stress.

Idolatry among the Gentiles

JDG 11:24, JDG 16:23–16:24; ; 2KI 5:18; ; ISA 36:18–36:20, ISA 37:38, ISA 46:1; ; EZK 8:14; ; ACT 14:11–14:13; ; 1CO 8:5

Idolatry among God's people

In patriarchal times

JOS 24:2 See also GEN 31:30, GEN 31:34 these household gods may have been either masks or statuettes; GEN 35:2

In the Mosaic period

EXO 32:4

In the period of the judges

JDG 17:5 See also JDG 10:6

In the early monarchy

1KI 11:10 See also 1KI 12:28 The golden calves were perhaps pedestals on which the LORD was thought to sit.

In the middle monarchy

1KI 16:33 An Asherah pole was probably a crude carved wooden image of a Canaanite fertility goddess. See also 1KI 11:7–11:8, 1KI 16:32

In the late monarchy

2KI 21:2–21:6

After the fall of Jerusalem

EZK 8:10 See also EZK 8:3, EZK 8:14, EZK 8:16

Objects of false worship

The sun, moon and stars

DEU 4:19 See also DEU 17:3; JOB 31:26

Other objects of worship

DEU 4:28 See also DEU 16:22 sacred stones; 1KI 12:31 high places; ISA 1:29 oaks

Practices associated with idolatry

The burning of children

2KI 23:10

The superstitious use of religious symbols

2KI 18:4 See also JDG 8:27 The ephod was a priestly garment sometimes subject to excessive veneration.

Sexual deviance

DEU 23:17 See also 1KI 14:24; HOS 4:14

8770: idolatry, in NT

The NT world included many religions which promoted the worship of idols. Idolatry was thus of continuing importance to NT writers, especially Paul.

Idolatry in the Gentile world

ACT 17:16 See also ACT 14:11–14:13, ACT 17:22–17:23, ACT 19:24; 1CO 8:5; GAL 4:8

Criticism of idolatry

Idolatry leads to other sinful behaviour

ROM 1:24 Verses 22 and 24–25 show the link between idolatry and immoral conduct.

Idolatry is an offence against the doctrine of creation

ROM 1:20 See also ACT 17:24–17:29

Idols are futile and degrading

ROM 1:22–1:23 See also 1CO 8:4, 1CO 10:19, 1CO 12:2

Idolatrous worship of human beings

ACT 12:22 See also LUK 20:24–20:25 Jesus Christ opposes the hypocrisy which objected to Roman coinage as idolatrous on the grounds that the emperor's head infringed the Ten Commandments; ACT 28:6

Demonic powers are involved with idolatry

1CO 10:20 See also REV 9:20, REV 13:4

Food sacrificed to idols

ACT 15:20 See also ROM 14:2–14:3, ROM 14:6; 1CO 8:4–8:13, 1CO 10:14–10:31

Encounters with idolatrous practice

ACT 19:28 See also ACT 14:11–14:18, ACT 17:18–17:31

Spiritual idolatry

1JN 5:21 "idols" here may well refer to a wide range of God-substitutes.

The temptations of Jesus Christ present three main kinds of spiritual idolatry

Possessions

MAT 4:3 parallel LUK 4:3 See also MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; LUK 18:23; PHP 3:19; COL 3:5; 1TI 6:10

Prestige and self-esteem

MAT 4:6 parallel LUK 4:9 See also LUK 3:8, LUK 10:29, LUK 18:11-18:12, LUK 18:21; ROM 2:19

Power

MAT 4:8-4:9 parallel LUK 4:6-4:7 See also LUK 9:54-9:55, LUK 23:39; JHN 18:10-18:11, JHN 19:10; PHP 2:6; JAS 4:6, JAS 4:10

8771: idolatry, objections to

Scripture presents idolatry as absurd and irrational, offensive to God and a source of spiritual and moral danger.

Idolatry is disparaged

The absurdity of making idols

HAB 2:18 See also DEU 4:28; ISA 40:18-40:20, ISA 41:6-41:7; JER 10:3-10:9; HOS 10:6; HAB 2:19

Idols represent falsehood and fraud

PSA 40:4 See also JER 2:5, JER 10:14, JER 16:19, JER 51:17-51:18; HOS 12:1; AMO 2:4

Bowing down to idols is inappropriate

PSA 135:17-135:18 parallel PSA 115:5-115:8 See also ISA 2:8, ISA 44:15-44:17, ISA 46:6; JER 1:16; MIC 5:13

Idols contrasted with the LORD

ISA 46:5 See also ISA 40:25-40:26; JER 5:24, JER 10:10; HOS 2:8; ACT 17:24-17:25

Idolatry is forbidden by God

EXO 20:3-20:4 parallel DEU 5:7-5:8

Idolatry incurs severe penalties

ZEP 1:4 See also DEU 13:1-13:9, DEU 13:12-13:15; ISA 66:4; AMO 5:27; NAM 1:14

God abominates idols

EZK 7:20 Two terms, that is “idols” and “vile images”, meaning “abomination” are found here in parallel. A third, punning on the word for “dung” is often used by Ezekiel for idols. See also DEU 7:25; 2KI 23:24; EZK 5:9, EZK 5:11, EZK 6:4

Pressure to worship idols must be resisted and idols abandoned

DAN 3:18 See also ISA 2:20, ISA 30:22, ISA 31:7

The dangers of idolatry

Blindness

ISA 44:18

Becoming like idols

PSA 115:8 See also JER 2:5; HOS 9:10

Spiritual adultery

DEU 31:16 See also JDG 8:33; ISA 1:21; JER 13:27; HOS 1:2, HOS 2:7, HOS 8:9

Injustice

AMO 5:7

8773: jealousy

A strong feeling of possessiveness, often caused by the possibility that something which belongs, or ought to belong, to one is about to be taken away. The word can be used in a positive sense (e.g., the jealousy of God), meaning a passionate commitment to something which rightly belongs to one. It can also be used in a negative sense (e.g., human jealousy), to mean a self-destructive human emotion similar to envy.

God's jealousy for his people

God's jealousy demands an exclusive response from his people

EXO 20:4-20:6 See also EXO 34:14; DEU 32:16, DEU 32:21

God pictured as a jealous husband with an unfaithful wife

EZK 16:1-16:63

God is jealously protective of his people

JOL 2:18 See also ISA 26:11; ZEC 1:14-1:15, ZEC 8:2

God possessiveness expresses itself in judgment on his people's unfaithfulness

DEU 4:24 See also DEU 6:15, DEU 29:20; JOS 24:19; 1KI 14:22; EZK 23:25, EZK 36:6; NAM 1:2; ZEP 1:18, ZEP 3:8

Human jealousy is potentially destructive

Human jealousy arises from sin

MRK 7:21-7:23 parallel MAT 15:19-15:20

Human jealousy can be destructive

PRO 14:30 See also JOB 5:2; PRO 27:4; ECC 9:5-9:6

Human jealousy is criticised by Scripture

GAL 5:19-5:21 See also PSA 37:1-37:2; PRO 23:17; ROM 13:13; 1CO 13:4-13:7; TIT 3:3-3:5; JAS 3:14-3:16

Examples of jealousy

In the OT

GEN 4:3–4:5 Cain and Abel; ; GEN 27:41 Esau and Jacob; ; GEN 30:1 Rachel and Leah; GEN 37:4; ; ACT 7:9; 1SA 18:6–18:9 Saul and David; ; ISA 11:13 Ephraim and Judah

In the early church

ACT 5:17, ACT 13:45, ACT 17:5; ; 1CO 3:3; ; 2CO 12:20

8774: legalism

The belief that salvation demands or depends upon total obedience to the letter of the law. Examples of legalism include an excessive concern for minute details of the law coupled with a neglect of its fundamental concerns, and a preoccupation with human legal traditions.

Legalism represents a fatal misunderstanding of the purpose of OT law

ROM 9:31–9:32 See also ROM 3:20; GAL 3:10–3:11

Legalism is contrary to the gospel

GAL 2:16 See also MAT 23:13, MAT 23:15; ROM 3:20–3:24; PHP 3:8–3:9

Paul: example of a Jewish legalist

PHP 3:4–3:6 See also GAL 1:14

The ugly effects of legalism

Lack of love

MAT 23:23 Legalism actually contradicts the spirit of OT law. See also HOS 6:6; MIC 6:7–6:8; MAT 23:14; LUK 10:31–10:32; JHN 7:49

Spiritual pride

LUK 18:11–18:12 See also MAT 6:1–6:2, MAT 6:5, MAT 6:16, MAT 23:5–23:7; LUK 16:15; ROM 10:3

Formalism

ISA 29:13 See also MRK 7:6

Degeneration into man-made rules

ISA 29:13 See also MRK 7:7–7:8

Hypocrisy

MAT 23:27–23:28 See also 1SA 15:19–15:22; MAT 15:3–15:9 parallel MRK 7:9–7:13; MAT 23:25–23:26; JHN 7:19

Spiritual blindness

JHN 9:16

Warnings against legalism

MAT 16:6 parallel MRK 8:15 See also MAT 16:12; GAL 4:10–4:11, GAL 5:2–5:4

The burden of legalism

ACT 15:10 See also PSA 130:3; JAS 2:10

The answer to legalism: the grace of Jesus Christ

ACT 15:11 See also MAT 5:17; GAL 3:13, GAL 4:21–4:31; EPH 2:8–2:9

8775: libertinism

A form of abuse of Christian freedom which refuses to acknowledge any obligation for Christians to obey the law or to restrain sin.

Grace must not lead to libertinism

ROM 6:1–6:2, ROM 6:15 See also ROM 3:5–3:8; GAL 2:17–2:21

Believers must resist sin

ROM 6:12, ROM 6:14 See also HEB 12:1–12:2; 1JN 5:16–5:18

The law remains valid for believers

MAT 5:17–5:18 See also JOS 23:6; 1CH 22:12; PRO 28:7; ROM 7:12; 1TI 1:8

The dangers of libertinism

Falling back into sin

ROM 6:1–6:2; ; HEB 12:1; ; 1JN 1:8–1:10

Disobedience towards God

1JN 2:3–2:4 See also 1JN 3:4; 2CO 10:6; EPH 5:6; 1PE 2:8

Selfishness

1JN 3:17 See also LUK 6:32–6:34; 2TI 2:1–2:4; 1JN 2:9–2:11

8776: lies

Statements or answers which are untrue. Lying, false witness, deceit and false dealings are all condemned in Scripture.

Lying is condemned

PSA 34:12–34:13; EPH 4:25; COL 3:9–3:10 See also EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; LEV 19:11–19:12; PRO 6:16–6:17, PRO 12:22; JER 17:9–17:10

Examples of lying

GEN 3:4–3:5 the serpent to Eve; ; GEN 4:9 Cain to the LORD; ; GEN 12:11–12:13 Abraham urges Sarah to lie to the Egyptians; ; GEN 18:15 Sarah to the LORD; ; GEN 20:1–20:2 Abraham to Abimelech; ; GEN 26:6–26:7 Isaac to the men of Gerar; GEN 27:18–27:19, GEN 27:24; GEN 39:14–39:18 Potiphar's wife to her household servants; ; 2KI 5:22–5:27 Gehazi to Naaman and then to Elisha; ; ACT 5:1–5:10 Ananias and Sapphira; ACT 6:11, ACT 6:13; ACT 25:7; ; ROM 3:8

Lying will not go unnoticed or unpunished

PRO 19:9 See also PSA 5:6, PSA 52:2–52:5, PSA 55:23, PSA 101:7; JER 6:13–6:15, JER 23:32; NAM 3:1; 1TI 1:9–1:10; REV 21:8, REV 21:27, REV 22:15

God's people should resist the temptation to lie

JOB 27:2–27:5; ; REV 2:2

Lying can be an act of malice

PRO 26:24–26:28

Lying can be the sign of a dead conscience

1TI 4:1–4:2

A lying spirit

See also 1KI 22:21–22:23 parallel 2CH 18:20–18:22

Lying is the hallmark of the devil and the antichrist

JHN 8:44 See also 1JN 2:22; REV 13:14, REV 20:7–20:10

8777: lust

An overpowering and compulsive desire or passion, especially of a sexual nature. Scripture condemns lust of all kinds, and urges believers to show self-control.

Lust has its origins in the heart and mind

PRO 6:25–6:29; MAT 5:28 See also GEN 3:6; JOB 31:1; JAS 1:13–1:15; 1JN 2:16

Lust is natural to unbelievers

ROM 1:21–1:27 See also ROM 7:5; 1CO 6:9–6:10; 1PE 4:3; 2PE 2:14–2:18

Believers can and must fight against lust by showing self-control

GAL 5:16–5:21; COL 3:5 See also 1CO 9:27; GAL 5:24; EPH 4:22; 1TH 4:4–4:5; 2TI 2:22; TIT 2:12; 1PE 2:11

Examples of lust**Lust expressed as sexual desire**

GEN 39:6–39:12 Potiphar's wife and Joseph; ; 2SA 11:2–11:5 David and Bathsheba

Lust for money

1TI 6:9–6:10 See also 1TI 3:3

The lustful desire of Israel and Judah for alliances

EZK 23:1–23:21 Both kingdoms sought security from such alliances, rather than trusting in God.

8778: materialism

The outlook on life which treats material possessions as being of supreme importance or which denies the spiritual aspects of life. Scripture notes the dangers

of material wealth and possessions. The accumulation of wealth can easily become a god in itself and lead people astray from the worship of the true God. Yet it is not money itself, but the love of money, which is seen by Scripture as a fundamental cause of evil.

8779: materialism, nature of

The attitude to life that places particular emphasis on immediate, physical values rather than on future, spiritual ones or that regards the material world as the only reality.

The basic features of materialism**An attitude of godlessness**

PSA 14:1–14:2 parallel PSA 53:1–53:2 See also JOB 35:9–35:10; PSA 10:4, PSA 10:11; ECC 1:1–1:11; LUK 12:13–12:19; ROM 1:20–1:22

A denial of the resurrection

MAT 22:23 See also ECC 4:1–4:3, ECC 9:3–9:6; ACT 4:1–4:2, ACT 23:6–23:8; 1CO 15:12–15:17; 2TI 2:17–2:19

Desire for wealth and physical gratification

1CO 15:32 See also ECC 2:4–2:9, ECC 9:7–9:10; MAT 6:19–6:24

Materialism condemned

PSA 52:7 See also JOB 22:4–22:11, JOB 31:25–31:28; PSA 49:10; PRO 18:11, PRO 23:5; ECC 5:10; MAT 16:26; LUK 12:23–12:25, LUK 21:34; JAS 5:1–5:3

8780: materialism, as an aspect of sin

The pursuit of possessions and wealth and a preoccupation with physical things is futile and dissatisfying.

Materialism as the result of human sin**At the fall**

GEN 3:6

Among pagans

ROM 1:22–1:23 See also PSA 115:2–115:8; ISA 44:9–44:11; DAN 3:1, DAN 3:4–3:7; HAB 2:18; ACT 17:16; 2TI 3:2

Within Israel itself

EXO 20:4–20:5 See also EXO 32:4; LEV 26:1; DEU 4:15–4:19, DEU 7:25; 1KI 11:1–11:6; PSA 106:19–106:20; ISA 42:8; JER 2:11–2:13; 1CO 10:14

Materialism and possessions**Possessions are to be seen as a gift from God**

1CH 29:12 See also GEN 13:2, GEN 26:12–26:13; DEU 8:18; 2CH 32:29; PSA 112:1–112:3; PRO 10:22; ECC 5:19; HOS 2:8

Material goods can turn the heart away from God

DEU 8:13–8:14; 1TI 6:9–6:10 See also JOB 31:24–31:28; EZK 28:5; MAT 19:21–19:22 parallel LUK 18:22–18:23; MAT 26:14–26:16; 1JN 3:17

Possessions and riches can make it difficult to enter the kingdom

MAT 19:23–19:24 parallels MRK 10:24–10:25, LUK 18:24–18:25 See also MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14; 1TI 6:17–6:19; JAS 2:2–2:5, JAS 5:1–5:6

The weaknesses of materialism**It is transitory**

PRO 27:24 See also JOB 22:20; PSA 49:10, PSA 49:17; PRO 22:1–22:2, PRO 23:5; ECC 2:18, ECC 2:21, ECC 2:26; JER 17:11; LUK 12:20–12:21; 1TI 6:7

It does not satisfy

ECC 5:10 See also ECC 4:8, ECC 5:12; HAG 1:5–1:6; MAT 6:19

It can encourage greed

1KI 21:2–21:4 See also EXO 20:17 parallel DEU 5:21; JOS 7:1, JOS 7:20–7:24; 1KI 10:23–10:27

It can lead to worldliness

MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:36–8:37, LUK 9:24–9:25 See also JER 17:11; LUK 16:15, LUK 16:25–16:26; JAS 1:9–1:11; REV 3:17

Jesus Christ's non-materialistic attitude

MAT 8:20 parallel LUK 9:58 See also PHP 2:5–2:6

Warnings to believers to guard against materialism

LUK 12:15 See also JER 9:23–9:24; MAT 6:25–6:32; 1TI 6:17–6:19; HEB 13:5; 1JN 2:15–2:17

Godly examples of a non-materialistic attitude

GEN 13:8–13:9, GEN 14:23; ; ACT 3:6, ACT 4:32–4:37; ; PHP 4:11–4:12

8782: mockery

A form of ridicule directed especially against individuals, with the purpose of humiliating them. Scripture condemns mockers as arrogant, unrighteous and foolish.

Targets of mockery**God**

ISA 52:5 See also PSA 74:10, PSA 74:18, PSA 74:22

Job

JOB 30:1 See also JOB 17:2, JOB 21:3, JOB 30:9

God's servants

2CH 36:16 See also NEH 2:19; PSA 22:7, PSA 35:15–35:16, PSA 69:12, PSA 80:6, PSA 89:50–89:51, PSA 119:51; JER 20:7; LAM 3:14, LAM 3:63 ACT 2:13, ACT 17:32, ACT 26:24

Jesus Christ

MAT 20:17–20:19 parallels MRK 10:32–10:34, LUK 18:31–18:33 See also MAT 26:67–26:68 parallels MRK 14:65, LUK 22:63–22:65; LUK 23:11; MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20; MAT 27:41–27:44 parallels MRK 15:31–15:32, LUK 23:35; LUK 23:36

Those who oppose God will become objects of mockery

PRO 3:34 See also 2KI 19:20–19:28 parallel ISA 37:22–37:29; JOB 22:17–22:20; JER 10:14–10:16 parallel JER 51:17–51:19; EZK 22:1–22:5

False accusations of mockery

JOB 11:1–11:3 See also JOB 9:21–9:24 Job accuses God of mocking the plight of innocent sufferers.

Mockery in metaphorical use

PRO 20:1

Characteristics of mockers**They are proud and arrogant**

PRO 21:24 See also PRO 3:34

They instigate strife

PRO 22:10 See also PRO 9:7, PRO 29:8

They do not respond to correction

PRO 15:12 See also PRO 1:22–1:26, PRO 13:1, PRO 19:25

Scripture condemns mockers as unrighteous

PSA 1:1 See also PRO 14:6 Resistance to correction accounts for the failure to find wisdom; PRO 14:9, PRO 24:9; ISA 57:4; HOS 7:5

Mockers will be punished

PRO 1:22–1:26 See also PRO 9:12, PRO 17:5, PRO 19:28–19:29, PRO 21:11, PRO 30:17; ISA 28:22, ISA 29:20; ZEP 2:10–2:11; GAL 6:7

8783: neglect

The shirking of one's duties or responsibilities, whether to God or to other people. The consequences of such neglect are often serious.

The Israelites sometimes neglected their religious duties**They neglected to support the Levites**

DEU 14:27 See also DEU 12:19; NEH 13:10

They neglected the temple**NEH 13:11** See also 2CH 24:5; MAL 1:6-1:14Such neglect earned them the judgment of God
2CH 29:6-29:9**The Israelites sometimes neglected their social obligations****They neglected to ensure justice for the poor****ISA 5:7** See also AMO 2:6-2:8; AMO 4:1-4:3; AMO 5:7-5:15**Their leaders neglected their responsibilities****ISA 56:10-56:12** See also EZK 34:1-34:6; AMO 6:1-6:7**God punished their neglect****ZEP 1:12-1:13** See also ISA 32:9-32:15**Neglect in the NT****Warnings against neglect****1TI 4:14** See also MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42; MAT 25:14-25:30 parallel LUK 19:12-19:26; LUK 12:35-12:48**Examples of neglect****The neglect of salvation****HEB 2:1-2:4****The neglect of public worship****HEB 10:25****Sodom's neglect of the poor****EZK 16:49****The neglect of widows****ACT 6:1-6:4****8784: nominal religion**

An outward show of piety which may appear to be very devout. However, the heart is far from God and this is confirmed by the person's attitudes and actions.

The nature of nominal religion

It has an appearance of devotion which masks an evil heart

JER 12:2 See also PRO 26:23; ISA 58:2; EZK 33:31-33:32; MAT 23:27-23:28

It is based on what human beings may think is right

MAT 15:7-15:9 parallel MRK 7:6-7:7 See also ISA 29:13

It becomes apparent by the actions of its adherents

TIT 1:16 See also MAT 7:15-7:23; 1TI 1:3-1:7; 1JN 2:4**The insufficiency of nominal religion****1SA 15:22** See also ISA 1:11-1:15; AMO 5:21-5:24; MAT 9:13; MAT 12:7; HOS 6:6**Those who practise nominal religion are condemned****PRO 15:8** See also ISA 66:3-66:4; 2TI 3:1-3:5**8785: opposition**

The act of resisting individuals and forces. Scripture stresses the reality of sin and evil in the world and calls upon believers to resist them. Scripture also points to the existence of evil forces that oppose God and identifies them so that believers may recognise and resist them. These forces were evident in the ministry of Jesus Christ.

8786: opposition, to sin and evil

Believers are called upon to oppose all that is hostile to God's purposes in the world.

God opposes evil**MAT 21:12-21:13** parallels MRK 11:15-11:16, LUK 19:45-19:46, JHN 2:14-2:17 See also EXO 4:24; LEV 20:3; LEV 26:14-26:17; NUM 22:22; MAL 3:2-3:5; JAS 4:6; 1PE 5:5; REV 2:16**God's people should oppose evil****Within themselves****COL 3:5** See also MAT 5:29-5:30; ROM 8:13**Among themselves****GAL 2:11** See also 1CO 5:12-5:13; EPH 5:3**Examples of failure to oppose evil****Within the church**

1CO 5:1-5:2; ; REV 2:20

Within the family

1SA 3:13; ; 1KI 1:6

Within the state**HAB 1:4** See also JDG 5:23; 1SA 15:9-15:11; JER 5:28**Examples of unwise opposition to evil**

MAT 26:51-26:52 parallels MRK 14:47, LUK 22:50-22:51; ; JHN 18:10-18:11; ; LUK 9:54-9:55; ; ACT 19:13-19:16

Opposing evil by doing good**Commanded by God****1PE 2:15** See also MAT 5:44; ROM 12:20-12:21; 1TH 5:15**Exemplified in Scripture**

NUM 12:13; ; 1SA 24:17, 1SA 26:11; ; 2KI 6:22; ; LUK 22:51, LUK 23:34

Motives for opposing evil

Concern for the honour and glory of God

NUM 25:6–25:13 See also 1KI 19:10; EZK 28:22; JHN 2:17

Concern for the good of others

GAL 2:4–2:5 See also DEU 17:12–17:13; 1TI 5:20

8787: opposition, to God's person and work

The forces of evil are antagonistic towards God, his people and his work, and believers must oppose them.

Targets of opposition from evil forces

The Lord himself

PSA 2:1–2:3; HEB 12:3 See also ISA 63:10; ACT 7:51; REV 17:14

God's people

ACT 8:1–8:3 See also NUM 16:1–16:3; 2SA 16:5–16:8; EST 3:6; JER 18:18; ACT 26:9–26:11; 2TI 4:14–4:15; REV 13:7

God's work

1TH 2:2 See also EZR 4:4–4:5; NEH 4:7–4:8; ACT 4:18, ACT 13:8; 1CO 16:9

Sources of opposition

The world

JHN 15:18–15:19 See also JHN 17:14; 1JN 3:13

The flesh

GAL 5:17 See also MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38; ROM 7:23

The devil

1PE 5:8 See also ZEC 3:1; MAT 13:38–13:39; REV 2:10, REV 12:4, REV 12:7, REV 12:9, REV 12:13, REV 12:17

Strategies used in opposition

Shows of strength

JDG 6:5; ; 1SA 17:10–17:11; ; 2KI 6:14

Discouraging propaganda

2KI 18:19–18:22 See also REV 13:4–13:6

Surprise

GEN 39:11–39:12; ; PSA 10:8–10:9, PSA 64:4

Seduction

MAT 4:9; ; 1JN 2:15–2:16; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20

Deceitfulness

JUD 1:4 See also NUM 31:16; 1SA 18:17; NEH 6:1–6:2; ROM 16:18; 2CO 11:13–11:15; 2JN 1:7, 2JN 1:8; REV 19:20

Sustained pressure

GEN 39:10; ; 1SA 1:6–1:7; ; 2KI 6:25; ; NEH 6:4

Motives for opposition

Jealousy

1SA 18:9 See also PSA 106:16–106:18; MAT 27:18 parallel MRK 15:10; ACT 5:17–5:18, ACT 13:45, ACT 17:5

Troubled conscience

JHN 7:7 See also ISA 30:10; ACT 26:14; 1JN 3:12; REV 11:10

Vested interests

ACT 16:19, ACT 19:24–19:27

No just cause

PSA 69:4; ; JHN 15:25

Dealing with opposition

Being prepared

2PE 3:17; 2CO 10:4 See also MRK 13:9; JHN 16:1–16:4; 1PE 4:12

Keeping a right perspective

2KI 6:15–6:17; ; NEH 4:14; ; ROM 8:31

Prayer

NEH 6:9 See also NEH 4:4; LUK 18:7; ACT 4:23–4:24

Patience

2TI 2:25

Prudence

JDG 8:1–8:3; ; PRO 15:1; ; ACT 22:25, ACT 23:6, ACT 25:11; ; 2CO 6:3

Perseverance

1CO 15:58; ; PHP 1:27–1:28; ; 1PE 5:9; ; REV 1:9, REV 13:10, REV 14:12

8788: opposition, to Jesus Christ

See [2545: Jesus Christ, opposition to](#)

8790: oppression

The unfair or cruel treatment of individuals or nations, which prevents them from having the same opportunities, freedom and rights as others.

8791: oppression, nature of

Oppression leads to the exploitation of the weak and vulnerable by the strong.

The victims

The weak

PSA 12:5 See also PSA 10:2; ECC 4:1; EZK 34:4

The poor

PRO 22:22–22:23 See also EXO 23:6; DEU 15:7; PRO 22:7, PRO 22:16, PRO 28:27; EZK 22:29; AMO 2:6–2:7, AMO 5:11–5:12, AMO 8:4, AMO 8:6; ZEC 7:10; JAS 2:6

Widows and orphans

EXO 22:22 See also DEU 24:17; JOB 24:3, JOB 24:9, JOB 31:21, JOB 31:22; PSA 94:5–94:6; PRO 23:10; ISA 1:23; JER 7:6; ZEC 7:10; MAL 3:5; MRK 12:40

The foreigner

EXO 22:21 See also GEN 15:13; EXO 23:9; LEV 19:33–19:34; DEU 23:7, DEU 24:17; PSA 94:6; JER 22:3; EZK 22:29; MAL 3:5

Servants

DEU 24:14–24:15 See also GEN 16:6; EXO 1:11, EXO 3:9; LEV 19:13; ISA 58:3; MAL 3:5; ACT 7:24; JAS 5:4

Examples of oppression

GEN 16:6 Sarah oppresses Hagar; ; GEN 31:39 Laban oppresses Jacob; ; EXO 1:8–1:22 the Egyptians oppress Israel; ; ISA 52:4 the Assyrians oppress Israel

The oppressors' motives**Greed**

JER 5:27–5:28 See also PRO 31:5; ECC 5:8–5:9; ISA 1:23, ISA 10:2; JER 22:17; AMO 4:1

Lust for power

EXO 1:10 See also 2CH 10:14, 2CH 16:10; PRO 28:15

God's attitude to the oppressor

EXO 22:22–22:24 See also DEU 27:19; PRO 21:13; ISA 14:5–14:6; JER 6:6, JER 22:3–22:5; AMO 1:3, AMO 1:6, AMO 1:9, AMO 1:11, AMO 2:1; ZEP 3:1; LUK 20:47

The experience of oppression**It brings grief and crying to God**

PSA 42:9 See also EXO 3:7; JDG 2:18; PSA 43:2, PSA 137:1; ECC 4:1

The example of Jesus Christ

ISA 53:7 See also MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20; ACT 8:32–8:35

Following Jesus Christ

1PE 2:21 See also JHN 16:33; ACT 14:22–14:23; 1TH 3:2–3:4; 2TI 2:3, 2TI 3:12

8792: oppression, God's attitude to

God is concerned for the victims of oppression; he hears, sustains and delivers them. Christians are to exhibit the same concern.

God forbids the oppression of the poor and vulnerable

ZEC 7:10 See also PRO 22:22–22:23

God warns the oppressor

JER 7:5–7:7 See also ISA 33:14–33:15

God condemns the oppressor

PSA 72:4; ISA 10:1–10:3 See also PRO 17:5; ISA 30:12–30:13; EZK 22:7, EZK 22:13, EZK 22:31; AMO 2:6, AMO 5:11; MIC 2:1–2:3; NAM 3:1, NAM 3:19; LUK 11:42

God's concern for the oppressed**Showing mercy to the oppressed**

PSA 103:6; DEU 10:18 See also ISA 2:8; PSA 146:7–146:9

Defending the oppressed

PSA 72:4 See also DEU 10:18; PSA 9:9, PSA 10:17–10:18, PSA 12:5, PSA 68:5, PSA 146:7–146:9; JER 50:33–50:34

Delivering the oppressed

JOB 5:15 See also EXO 3:7–3:9; DEU 6:21; PSA 35:10, PSA 107:6 parallels PSA 107:13, PSA 107:19; PRO 20:22; ISA 14:3–14:4, ISA 49:26; ACT 7:34

The oppressed turn to the LORD**In prayer**

PSA 10:12 See also JDG 4:3, JDG 10:9–10:10; 2CH 6:38–6:39; PSA 42:9, PSA 57:1, PSA 79:11, PSA 82:3–82:4, PSA 94:1–94:7; REV 6:10

In trust

ACT 16:25 See also JOB 19:25; PSA 42:1–42:3, PSA 138:7; 2CO 4:17, 2CO 6:4–6:5; 1PE 4:19

Christian attitudes towards the oppressed**Showing practical mercy**

MAT 5:7 See also LEV 19:10; DEU 24:19–24:21; PRO 31:8–31:9, PRO 31:20; ISA 58:9–58:10; JER 22:3; ZEC 7:9; MAT 6:3, MAT 25:34–25:39; ROM 12:13; PHP 4:10, PHP 4:15; JAS 1:27

Showing concern

HEB 13:3 See also ROM 12:15; GAL 6:2; COL 4:18; PHM 1:10

8794: persecution

Scripture indicates that believers can expect to face hardship, ridicule and oppression, from individuals and state authorities, on account of their faith. It encourages believers to remain faithful in the face of such persecution and to draw strength from the example of Jesus Christ himself.

8795: persecution, nature of

Persecution by the world and secular powers is a likely consequence of faith. Scripture identifies a number of potential sources of such persistent harassment.

Persecution is characteristic of this world

PSA 10:2 See also AMO 1:6, AMO 1:9, AMO 2:1; HAB 1:6–1:11; REV 6:8, REV 9:7–9:10

Satan is the arch-persecutor of the church

GEN 3:15 See also JOB 2:6–2:7; ZEC 3:1; LUK 22:3–22:4; 1PE 5:8; REV 2:10, REV 2:13

The agencies of persecution

The world

JHN 15:18; 1JN 3:13 See also MRK 12:7; JHN 5:18, JHN 15:19, JHN 17:14; ACT 14:22; 1TH 2:14–2:15; 1JN 3:1

Earthly governments

MRK 13:9 See also 1KI 19:2; NEH 6:1, NEH 6:9; EST 3:6; PSA 119:161; JER 38:6; DAN 3:13–3:17; MAT 10:17; ACT 12:1–12:3

Religious authorities

1TH 2:13–2:16 See also JER 26:8; AMO 7:12–7:13; MAT 23:34–23:37; ACT 4:27–4:29, ACT 5:17–5:18, ACT 22:4REV 13:7, REV 13:15, REV 17:6

Family and friends

MAT 10:36 See also MIC 7:6; GEN 4:8; MAT 10:21; MRK 3:21; GAL 4:29

The experience of persecution

2CO 12:10 See also 1SA 24:14; PSA 59:1–59:4, PSA 64:1–64:4; 2CO 4:8–4:12, 2CO 11:23–11:26; HEB 11:32–11:38

Believers must expect persecution

2TI 3:12 See also MAT 13:21; MRK 10:29–10:30; 1TH 3:4

Persecution is part of the tribulation of the church

MAT 24:7–24:10 See also 2TH 2:3–2:4; REV 6:11

Persecution is sometimes part of God's judgment on his people

LAM 4:16–4:19 See also JER 6:22–6:26, JER 32:26–32:29, JER 39:5–39:10

8796: persecution, forms of

Scripture identifies a number of reasons why individuals and governments may attempt to persecute believers and also the methods by which they may carry this out.

The motives for persecution

Envy

ACT 5:17–5:18 See also GEN 26:14–26:15, GEN 37:4, GEN 37:8; 1SA 18:8–18:9; PSA 106:16; DAN 6:1–6:5; MAT 27:18; ACT 13:45; JAS 3:16

Fear

LUK 22:2 See also EXO 1:10; 1SA 18:15, 1SA 18:29; MAT 2:3; ACT 19:23–19:27

Hatred

1JN 3:12 See also GEN 4:3–4:8; 1KI 22:8 parallel 2CH 18:7; JHN 7:7

The means of persecution

Deception

PSA 38:12 See also 1KI 21:10; EZR 4:12–4:13; PSA 35:11; JER 20:10; AMO 7:10; MAT 5:11; JHN 7:12; ACT 6:11, ACT 21:21, ACT 21:28, ACT 24:5

Threats

PSA 10:7 See also EZR 4:4; DAN 3:15; JHN 9:22; ACT 4:17

Ridicule

NEH 4:1–4:3 See also HOS 9:7; 1CO 4:13; HEB 13:13; REV 2:9

Ostracism

MAT 10:22 See also JHN 9:29, JHN 9:34, JHN 12:42, JHN 16:2

Violence

ROM 8:35 See also JER 38:6; MAT 10:17 parallel MRK 13:9; JHN 21:18–21:19; ACT 5:40, ACT 16:37; 2CO 11:25; GAL 6:17; HEB 11:36–11:39

How God deals with persecutors

1TI 1:13 See also DAN 4:34–4:35; ACT 12:1, ACT 12:21–12:23; GAL 1:23

8797: persecution, attitudes to

Scripture outlines the attitudes which believers should adopt in the face of persecution, laying particular emphasis upon the faithfulness of God, the example of Jesus Christ and the need for patience and hope by believers.

The call to endure in the face of persecution

Passively

PSA 119:87 See also MAT 10:22, MAT 10:28; 1CO 4:12; 2TH 1:4; JAS 5:8

Actively

HEB 12:1 See also EPH 6:10–6:20; 2TI 2:3; 1PE 5:9; REV 2:3

Attitudes believers are to adopt in facing persecution

Living holy and forgiving lives

1PE 2:12 See also MAT 5:44; ROM 12:19–12:20; 1PE 2:15, 1PE 2:23, 1PE 3:16

Rejoicing in suffering

ROM 5:3–5:5 See also PSA 30:5; MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23; ACT 5:41, ACT 16:22–16:25; ROM 12:15; COL 1:24; 1PE 1:6, 1PE 1:8, 1PE 4:12, 1PE 4:16

Relying on the promise of God's grace to endure

LAM 3:22–3:23 See also PSA 18:17–18:19; NAM 1:7–1:8; ROM 8:18, ROM 8:35–8:39; 2TI 3:10–3:11; HEB 13:6; REV 3:10

Trusting in the promise of God's presence

HEB 13:5 See also PSA 23:4; ISA 43:2, ISA 43:5; MAT 28:20; 2CO 4:9

Praying always

EPH 6:18 See also PSA 35:24, PSA 38:15–38:16, PSA 129:5, PSA 143:9; MIC 7:7–7:8; LUK 6:28, LUK 18:7–18:8; 1PE 4:7

The certain prospect of victory over persecution**The triumph of Jesus Christ**

1CO 15:25 See also OBA 1:21; PHP 3:20–3:21; 2TH 1:6–1:8; REV 11:15

The vindication of the saints

JUD 1:24 See also EZR 6:8; EST 6:11–6:13; PSA 126:1; DAN 6:26; HAG 2:22–2:23; 2TI 1:12; REV 2:10, REV 7:13–7:17, REV 12:11

Believers are to take heart from the example of Jesus Christ in facing persecution**The persecution of Jesus Christ was predicted in the OT**

PSA 22:1–22:18; ; ISA 50:6, ISA 53:7–53:12

The fulfilment of these predictions

MAT 27:26–27:31 parallel MRK 15:15–15:20

The relevance of Jesus Christ's innocent suffering to believers

1PE 2:20–2:23 See also 1PE 3:14–3:17 suffering for the sake of righteousness; 1PE 4:13–4:14 rejoicing at sharing in Christ's sufferings

8799: polytheism

Belief in, and worship of, more than one god. It is forbidden in Scripture because God has revealed himself as the one true God. Israel in the OT and the church in the NT lived amongst polytheistic peoples. The Israelites shared in this worship and so came under God's judgment.

The uniqueness of God**There is only one true God**

ISA 45:5–45:6 See also DEU 6:4, DEU 32:39; ISA 43:10, ISA 44:8

The contrast of the true God with idols

1TH 1:9 See also 1CH 16:26 parallel PSA 96:5; ISA 40:18–40:19, ISA 40:25–40:26; ACT 17:29; 1CO 8:4–8:6; GAL 4:8

Polytheism is expressly forbidden**Warnings against worshipping idols**

EXO 20:23 See also EXO 20:3–20:5 parallel DEU 5:7–5:9; EXO 23:13; LEV 17:7

Polytheism compromises relationship with God

2KI 17:35–17:38 See also DEU 31:16; JER 11:10; 1CO 10:18–10:22

The challenge to Israel to worship God only

JOS 24:15 See also GEN 35:2–35:4; DEU 12:2–12:4; 1KI 18:21

Polytheism brings God's judgment

EXO 22:20; ; DEU 31:17–31:18; ; JOS 23:16; ; JER 11:11–11:13

Polytheism among Israel's neighbours

JDG 10:6 See also JDG 16:23; 1KI 11:33; 2KI 1:2, 2KI 17:29–17:33; ISA 46:1; JER 50:2; EZK 8:14

Polytheism among the Israelites**They were called to destroy foreign gods**

NUM 33:51–33:52 See also EXO 23:24, EXO 34:12–34:13; DEU 12:2–12:3

They were seduced by foreign gods

2KI 17:15–17:18; JER 2:11 See also EXO 34:15–34:16; NUM 25:2; DEU 12:30, DEU 32:16–32:17; JDG 2:11–2:13; PSA 106:34–106:36; HOS 2:13, HOS 11:2

Polytheism among Israel's kings

1KI 11:5–11:7 Solomon; ; 1KI 12:28–12:29 Jeroboam, king of Israel; ; 1KI 16:30–16:33 Ahab, king of Israel; ; 2KI 16:3–16:4 Ahaz, king of Judah; ; 2KI 21:3–21:5 Manasseh, king of Judah

Examples of reforming kings

1KI 15:12–15:13 Asa, king of Judah; ; 2KI 18:4 Hezekiah, king of Judah; ; 2KI 23:12–23:15 Josiah, king of Judah

The character of polytheism in the OT**The physical representation of deities**

LEV 26:1; ; 1KI 14:23; ; ISA 48:5

Cult prostitution

DEU 23:17; ; 1KI 14:24

Human sacrifice

LEV 18:21 to Molech; ; DEU 12:31; ; 2KI 3:26–3:27 to Chemosh; ; JER 19:5 to Baal; ; EZK 16:20–16:21

Self-mutilation

1KI 18:28–18:29

Polytheism in the NT

It was widespread

ACT 17:23 The Athenians were fearful of offending a god by failing to give him attention. Any omissions were covered in the designation “UNKNOWN GOD”. See also ACT 14:11–14:13, ACT 19:35; 1CO 8:5–8:6

The worship of man-made idols

1CO 12:2 See also ACT 17:16, ACT 19:26; ROM 1:20–1:23; 1CO 10:19–10:20 Idols in themselves are nothing, but they represent a demonic presence which lies behind polytheistic worship.

8800: prejudice

Seen mainly in Scripture as a bias against places, peoples and ideas. It is sometimes so firmly rooted as to resist all contrary evidence.

Prejudice against places

JHN 1:46 See also JHN 7:41, JHN 7:52

Prejudice against people

Prejudice due to an attitude of superiority

JHN 7:49 See also 1SA 10:27, 1SA 25:10–25:11; JOB 30:1–30:10; ISA 65:5; LUK 18:11

Prejudice based on fear or jealousy

EXO 1:9–1:10, EXO 1:12–1:13; ; 1SA 18:8–18:9, 1SA 18:29

Prejudice against Jesus Christ

JHN 12:37 See also MAT 9:34; MRK 6:2–6:3; JHN 9:29, JHN 10:20

Prejudice may be based on false assumptions about people's behaviour

Hostility incorrectly assumed

GEN 12:11–12:12 See also GEN 20:1–20:2, GEN 26:1–26:11

Motives misunderstood

NUM 32:5–32:9 The leaders of Reuben and Gad chose to inhabit the fertile land in Transjordan but they were also prepared to cross the Jordan to help their brothers conquer the land. See also NUM 32:14, NUM 32:17; JOS 22:10–22:24; 2SA 10:3

Prejudice in terms of partiality

Favouritism

GEN 25:28, GEN 37:3, GEN 44:20, GEN 44:27–44:29

People are often prejudiced in favour of their own kind

MAT 5:46–5:47 parallel LUK 6:32–6:34 See also LUK 7:29, LUK 17:16; ACT 10:45; LUK 11:18

Prejudice on grounds of outward appearance or behaviour

JAS 2:3–2:4 See also 1SA 16:7; 2SA 14:25; ECC 9:16; JHN 8:15; ROM 14:1, ROM 14:3, ROM 14:10, ROM 14:13; 1CO 4:5; GAL 2:6

Prejudice due to race

EST 3:5–3:6 See also EZR 4:15–4:16; NEH 4:1–4:4; EST 3:8–3:14, EST 7:4; DAN 3:8–3:12, DAN 6:3–6:9, DAN 6:13

Partiality forbidden

EXO 23:3 See also LEV 19:15; JAS 2:9

God is not prejudiced

God is impartial

ACT 10:34 See also ROM 2:11; EPH 6:9; COL 3:25

Job falsely accuses God of partiality

JOB 9:16, JOB 9:20, JOB 9:30–9:31, JOB 10:15–10:17

Prejudice which no contrary evidence would change

LUK 16:31 See also 1SA 22:13–22:15; MAT 11:21–11:23, MAT 21:32; ACT 7:52, ACT 13:41

The Sadducees' prejudice against the resurrection

MAT 22:23 parallels MRK 12:18, LUK 20:27 See also ACT 4:1–4:3, ACT 23:8

8801: presumption

A form of self-confidence, which makes overconfident assumptions concerning one's importance and rights. It is criticised as a form of arrogance that is unacceptable among believers, whose lives should be characterised by humility.

Presumption is unacceptable

PSA 5:5; ISA 13:11 See also NUM 15:30; DEU 6:16, DEU 18:20; ISA 45:9; ROM 2:4, ROM 9:20; 1CO 10:9; JAS 4:13; 2PE 2:10

Examples of presumption

GEN 11:1–11:4 those preparing to build the tower of Babel in defiance of God; ; NUM 14:40–14:45 the Israelites, ignoring Moses' orders; ; LUK 12:16–12:21 the rich fool

Humility is commended in place of presumption

MIC 6:8 See also LUK 14:10, LUK 22:26; ROM 12:3; JAS 4:10; 1PE 5:5

8802: pride

Arrogance or delusions of greatness on account of one's achievements, status or possessions. Scripture frequently speaks of God humbling the proud.

8803: pride, evil of

Pride is viewed as a great evil because it involves pretending to a greatness and glory that belong rightly to God alone.

The sinfulness of pride

It is condemned as evil

1SA 15:23; PRO 21:4; JAS 4:16 See also MRK 7:22–7:23; ROM 1:29–1:30; 2CO 12:20; 2TI 3:1–3:2; 1JN 2:16

It is a characteristic of Satan

EZK 28:2; 1TI 3:6 See also 2TH 2:4 the antichrist

Warnings against pride

In the book of Proverbs

PRO 16:5, PRO 16:18 See also PRO 3:7, PRO 3:34, PRO 6:16–6:17, PRO 11:2, PRO 25:6–25:7, PRO 25:27, PRO 26:12, PRO 27:1, PRO 29:23

Elsewhere in Scripture

PSA 119:21 See also LEV 26:19; 1SA 2:3; PSA 12:2–12:3; JER 9:23–9:24; PSA 5:5, PSA 40:4, PSA 138:6; ISA 5:21; JER 13:15–13:17; MAT 23:12 parallel LUK 14:11 Jesus Christ's teaching on pride; ROM 12:16; 1CO 10:12; 1PE 5:5; JAS 4:6; PRO 3:34

The gospel excludes pride

ROM 3:27 See also LUK 18:9–18:14; ROM 4:2–4:3, ROM 11:17–11:20; 1CO 1:26–1:31; EPH 2:8–2:9

Godliness involves rejecting pride

PRO 8:13 See also PSA 101:5, PSA 131:1; ROM 12:3; 1CO 13:4; GAL 6:14

8804: pride, examples of

Scripture illustrates the many different ways in which pride manifests itself.

Pride in status

EXO 5:2 Pharaoh; ; 2KI 5:11 Naaman; 2KI 20:13; ; 2CH 32:25; EST 5:11–5:12 Haman; ISA 16:6; ; JER 48:29; ISA 47:8 Babylon; ; EZK 16:49–16:50 Sodom; ; EZK 28:2 the king of Tyre; EZK 31:3, EZK 31:10; DAN 5:23 Belshazzar; ; OBA 1:3 Edom; ; ZEP 2:15 Nineveh; MAT 23:6–23:7 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:46; ; LUK 11:43; ACT 8:9 Simon the sorcerer; ; REV 18:7 Babylon the Great

Pride in strength

1SA 17:42 Goliath; ; 2KI 14:9–14:10 Amaziah, king of Judah; ; 2KI 18:33–18:35 the Assyrian commander; ISA 9:9–9:10; ; HOS 10:13; ISA 10:13 the king of Assyria; DAN 3:15, DAN 4:30; MAT 26:33–26:35 parallels MRK 14:29–14:31, LUK 22:33; ; JHN 13:37

Pride in wisdom

ISA 10:13 the king of Assyria; ; ACT 17:21; ; ROM 1:22; ; 1CO 1:20, 1CO 3:18

Proud ambition

ISA 14:13–14:14 the king of Babylon; ; 2TH 2:3–2:4 the antichrist

Spiritual pride

2KI 10:16; ; JOB 32:1, JOB 33:9; ; ISA 65:5; ; MAT 6:2, MAT 6:3, MAT 6:16; MAT 23:5, MAT 23:30; ; MRK 12:40 parallel LUK 20:47; ; LUK 16:14–16:15, LUK 18:9, LUK 18:11–18:12; ; JHN 9:40–9:41; LUK 10:29 an expert in the law; JHN 8:33, JHN 9:34; ; ROM 2:17–2:20; 1CO 4:7, 1CO 4:18; ; REV 3:17 the church in Laodicea

8805: pride, results of

The real nature of pride can be seen in the fact that it leads to many other evils and ends in destruction.

Pride leads to other forms of evil

Self-deception

GAL 6:3 See also DEU 8:17–8:18; ISA 16:6, ISA 47:10; JER 49:16 parallel OBA 1:3; 1CO 8:2; 1TI 6:3–6:4

Spiritual blindness

JER 43:2 See also DEU 8:14; NEH 9:16, NEH 9:29

A hard heart

PSA 36:2 See also PSA 10:3, PSA 52:1; DAN 5:20

A malicious spirit

PSA 119:85 See also PSA 73:8, PSA 140:5

Contempt for others

PSA 123:4 See also PSA 119:51; PRO 21:24

Quarrelling

PRO 13:10

Violence

PSA 73:6 See also EST 3:5–3:6; PSA 86:14

Injustice

PSA 119:78 See also PSA 56:2

Oppression

PSA 10:2 See also PSA 119:122; HAB 2:4–2:5

Contempt for God

PSA 10:4 See also 2KI 19:22

Pride may be accompanied by temporary prosperity

PSA 73:3 See also PSA 10:5

Pride ends in disaster

PRO 16:5, PRO 16:18 See also 2SA 22:28 parallel PSA 18:27; JOB 40:11–40:12; PSA 31:23, PSA 101:5; PRO 11:2, PRO 15:25, PRO 26:12, PRO 29:23; ISA 2:11–2:12, ISA 2:17, ISA 13:11, ISA 26:5; ZEP 3:11; MAL 4:1; LUK 1:51–1:52; 1TI 3:6

Examples of the proud being humbled

Pharaoh: EXO 14:28; ; NEH 9:10; 2CH 26:16 Uzziah; 2CH 32:21; ; ISA 10:12, ISA 10:16; 2CH 32:25 Hezekiah; ; EST 7:10 Haman; ; ISA 3:16–3:17 the women of Zion; ISA 13:19, ISA 14:11–14:15; ISA 23:9, ISA 25:10–25:12 Moab; ; ISA 28:1–28:3 Samaria; ISA 47:10–47:11; ; JER 50:31–50:32; JER 13:9; ; EZK 7:24; EZK 16:49–16:50 Sodom; EZK 28:5–28:9, EZK 28:17; EZK 30:6, EZK 32:12; DAN 4:30–4:33 Nebuchadnezzar; ; DAN 5:30 Belshazzar; ; AMO 6:8; ; ZEP 2:15 Nineveh; ; ZEC 9:6, ZEC 10:11 Assyria; ; MAT 11:23 Capernaum; ; ACT 12:21–12:23 Herod; ; REV 18:7–18:8 Babylon the Great

8807: profanity

Behaviour which dishonours God's name or brings it into disrepute. It is often the result of idolatry, injustice or irreverence. Scripture strongly admonishes God's people to avoid it.

General warnings against profanity

LEV 22:31–22:33 See also LEV 21:5–21:6

God's name profaned through idolatry

Through child sacrifice

LEV 18:21 See also LEV 20:3; DEU 12:29–12:31, DEU 18:9–18:13; 2KI 16:1–16:4 parallel 2CH 28:1–28:4; 2KI 17:16–17:17, 2KI 21:1–21:6 parallel 2CH 33:1–33:6; PSA 106:36–106:39; ISA 57:3–57:5; JER 32:32–32:35; EZK 16:20–16:22

Through the worship of idols

EZK 20:39 See also JER 44:25–44:28; EZK 20:31, EZK 43:6–43:9

God's name profaned through injustice and evil

MAL 2:10 See also JER 34:12–34:16; AMO 2:6–2:8, AMO 5:7–5:15; MIC 6:6–6:8

God's name profaned through false swearing

LEV 19:12 See also JER 5:1–5:2; MAT 5:33–5:37; JAS 5:12

God's name profaned through blasphemy

ISA 52:5–52:6 See also EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11; LEV 24:10–24:16; ISA 37:23; 2PE 2:12

God's name profaned through irreverence

LEV 22:2 See also EZK 22:26; ZEP 3:1–3:4; MAL 1:6–1:14

God's name profaned in the sight of foreign nations

EZK 39:7 See also EZK 20:13–20:44, EZK 36:16–36:23; ROM 2:17–2:24; ISA 52:5

Penalties for profanity

LEV 20:1–20:5 See also JER 44:25–44:30; EZK 13:17–13:23, EZK 21:24–21:27, EZK 39:1–39:8; AMO 4:2–4:13, AMO 8:4–8:14; MAL 2:7–2:9

8808: riches

Material possessions and wealth. Scripture stresses that riches originate from God: used wisely, they can be a blessing; used foolishly, they can lead people away from God.

8809: riches, nature of

God has created an abundance of good things. Those who have material wealth should understand its true nature and acknowledge God.

God and riches

All riches belong to God the Creator

PSA 24:1–24:2 See also JOB 41:11; PSA 50:12; HAG 2:8

God gives of his riches

1SA 2:7 See also ECC 5:19; 1CH 29:12; 2CH 1:12

God gives the ability to produce wealth

DEU 8:17–8:18 See also GEN 26:12–26:13; DEU 26:9–26:10

Riches may be a sign of God's blessing

PRO 10:22 See also 2CH 25:9; JOB 1:9–1:10; PSA 112:1–112:3, PSA 128:1–128:2; PRO 8:17–8:18

Riches should be thankfully received

1TI 4:4–4:5 See also MAT 14:19; ROM 1:21; COL 3:17

The character of earthly riches

Riches provide great opportunity for doing good

EXO 35:29; ; 1CH 29:6–29:7; ; LUK 12:33, LUK 16:9, LUK 19:8; ; ACT 4:34–4:35

Riches do not satisfy

ECC 5:10 See also PRO 13:11, PRO 27:20, PRO 27:24; ECC 4:8, ECC 6:7; LUK 12:18

Riches are insecure and uncertain

1TI 6:17 See also JOB 1:13–1:19; PRO 23:5, PRO 27:24; JER 48:36; MAT 6:19; 1PE 1:18; REV 18:14–18:20

Riches are for this life only

1JN 2:17 See also LUK 12:13–12:21; 1TI 6:6–6:8

8810: riches, dangers of

Material wealth can be a source of both physical and spiritual danger, against which believers are clearly warned to be on their guard.

Riches are spiritually dangerous

Love of riches a root of many evils

1TI 6:10 See also JOS 7:11, JOS 7:20–7:21; 1TI 3:3

They may lead to divided loyalty

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 See also MAT 4:9–4:10; JAS 4:4

They may hinder people's response to the gospel

MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14; ; MAT 19:21–19:22 parallels MRK 10:21–10:22, LUK 18:22–18:23

They may create false security

1TI 6:17 See also JOB 31:24–31:28; PSA 52:6–52:7; PRO 11:28; JER 49:4

They may make people proud

EZK 28:5 See also PSA 62:10; PRO 18:23, PRO 28:11; HOS 12:8

They may cause unbelief and anxiety

ECC 5:12 See also JOB 20:17–20:20; PRO 15:6

They may lead people to forget God

PRO 30:8–30:9 See also DEU 8:10–8:14, DEU 32:15; NEH 9:25–9:26; HOS 13:6

Riches are physically dangerous

Working for them may cause excessive tiredness

PRO 23:4 See also JHN 6:26–6:27

Enjoying them may lead to self-indulgence

JAS 5:5 See also HAG 1:3–1:5; MAT 23:25; LUK 16:19–16:21; 1TI 6:8–6:9

Misusing them may foster oppression and injustice

LEV 19:13 See also DEU 24:12–24:15; PRO 22:16; ISA 1:23; JER 22:13; MIC 6:12; MAL 3:5; JAS 2:6, JAS 5:4

8811: riches, believers' attitudes towards

God entrusts some of his people with material wealth. If this is to be a blessing, it must be used in God-honouring ways.

Believers may be blessed with riches

Riches can be a blessing from God

1CH 29:16 See also 1CH 29:14–29:15; JOB 1:9–1:10; 2KI 4:1; MAT 8:20; LUK 6:20, LUK 16:20–16:22; ROM 15:26

The attitude of believers towards riches

They acknowledge that their riches come from God

1CH 29:12 See also ECC 5:19–5:20

They devote their riches to God's service

PRO 3:9–3:10 See also 1CH 29:1–29:9; ACT 4:32–4:37

They support gospel work and workers

LUK 8:1–8:3; ; ACT 16:15

They give to the poor

1JN 3:17 See also LUK 19:8; ACT 9:36–9:39; GAL 2:10

They are generous

1TI 6:18 See also DEU 15:10–15:11; 2CO 9:10–9:11

They remain humble

JAS 1:10–1:11

They do not trust in riches

1TI 6:17 See also JOB 31:24–31:28; PRO 11:28; JER 49:4

They do not set their heart on riches

PSA 62:10 See also LUK 12:29–12:30

Believers value heavenly riches most

MAT 6:20–6:21 See also LUK 12:33–12:34; 1TI 6:18–6:19

Examples of rich believers

Abraham

GEN 12:1–12:3, GEN 13:1–13:2

Solomon

2CH 1:11–1:12, 2CH 9:22

Hezekiah

2CH 32:27–32:29

Job

JOB 1:1–1:3

Joseph of Arimathea

ISA 53:9; ; MAT 27:57–27:60 parallels MRK 15:42–15:46, LUK 23:50–23:54, JHN 19:38–19:42

8812: riches, ungodly use of

Ungodly people often make the possession of wealth a priority. They do not understand the true nature of wealth, and they do not realise that they will have to face God in judgment.

The ungodly grow rich

PSA 73:12 See also LUK 19:21; JAS 2:6–2:7

The ungodly misuse riches

They often obtain their riches unjustly

PRO 10:2 See also 1KI 20:5; PRO 13:11, PRO 21:6, PRO 22:16; JER 17:11; MIC 2:1–2:5, MIC 6:10–6:12; HAB 2:6–2:11

They accumulate and hoard their riches

PRO 11:26 See also JOB 27:16–27:17; PRO 3:27; ECC 2:26, ECC 5:10–5:14; JAS 5:1–5:3

They trust in their riches

PSA 49:5–49:6 See also JOB 31:24; PSA 52:7; PRO 11:28; JER 9:23–9:24, JER 48:7

The ungodly suffer difficulties because of their riches

PRO 15:6 See also PRO 10:16, PRO 13:7–13:8, PRO 15:16–15:17

The ungodly, like all people, must leave their riches to others

PSA 49:10 See also PSA 39:6; ECC 2:18–2:21; LUK 12:20

Jesus Christ warned the rich of their danger

LUK 6:24 See also LUK 12:15, LUK 16:25

Examples of the ungodly rich**Nabal**

1SA 25:2–25:3

Rich young ruler

MRK 10:17–10:23 parallels MAT 19:16–19:24, LUK 18:18–18:25

8813: riches, spiritual

Out of his infinite abundance God gives his people spiritual treasure. This, much more valuable than material wealth, is to be held in the highest esteem and sought after eagerly.

The riches of God**His wisdom and knowledge**

ROM 11:33–11:36

His mercy, love and grace

EPH 2:4, EPH 3:8 See also ROM 2:4; EPH 2:7

His riches in Jesus Christ

COL 2:2–2:3 See also PHP 4:19; COL 1:27

God bestows spiritual riches on believers**His precious word**

JOB 23:12; ; PSA 19:9–19:10, PSA 119:72, PSA 119:111, PSA 119:127

A wealth of spiritual qualities

ISA 33:5–33:6 See also PRO 2:1–2:5, PRO 15:6; 2CO 9:10–9:11; EPH 1:7–1:8; COL 2:2–2:3; JAS 2:5

A glorious gospel

2CO 4:7

A costly kingdom

See also MAT 13:44–13:46

A rich reward

RUT 2:12 See also 1SA 26:23; PSA 18:20; PRO 25:21–25:22; COL 3:24; HEB 10:35

A heavenly inheritance

ACT 20:32 See also EPH 1:13–1:14, EPH 1:18; COL 1:12, COL 3:24; 1PE 1:4

Christians and spiritual riches**Christians need to appreciate their spiritual riches**

EPH 1:7–1:8 See also EPH 1:18; REV 2:9

Christians need to store up treasure in heaven

LUK 12:33 See also MAT 6:20; LUK 12:20–12:21; 1TI 6:19; HEB 11:26; REV 3:18

8815: ridicule

Laughing others to scorn, publicly humiliating or making fun of them in a demeaning manner.

8816: ridicule, nature of

Scripture declares that ridicule of the weak, the poor and the godly is unacceptable. Those who ridicule them invite judgment upon themselves.

Warnings against ridicule**Ridicule is foolish**

PRO 11:12 See also PRO 1:20–1:22, PRO 14:6, PRO 14:9

Ridicule creates trouble

PRO 9:12 See also PRO 19:29, PRO 22:10, PRO 29:8, PRO 30:17; MAT 5:22 “Raca” probably means “empty-head”, a term of derision.

Ridicule is a sign of the last days

2PE 3:3–3:4 See also JUD 1:18

Examples of ridicule

JDG 9:28–9:29, JDG 9:38; ; 1SA 17:41–17:44; ; 1KI 22:24; ; 2KI 2:23–2:24, 2KI 18:23–18:25; ; NEH 2:19, NEH 4:1–4:3

Ridicule associated with divine punishment

ISA 14:3–14:4 See also ISA 37:22–37:23; JER 49:17, JER 50:13; EZK 36:1–36:7; HAB 2:6; ZEP 2:15 **MIC 2:3–2:4** See also DEU 28:37; 1KI 9:6–9:9 parallel 2CH 7:19–7:22; JER 19:8, JER 24:9; EZK 5:14–5:15, EZK 23:32, EZK 22:3–22:5; HOS 7:16; MIC 6:16

Prophets ridicule idolatry

1KI 18:27 See also ISA 41:7, ISA 41:21–41:24, ISA 44:12–44:17, ISA 46:1–46:2; JER 10:3–10:5

8817: ridicule, objects of

Ridicule of God and of believers is to be expected, but it will bring divine retribution upon its perpetrators.

God ridiculed

PSA 74:10–74:18 See also 2KI 19:4 parallel ISA 37:4

Jesus Christ mocked

LUK 22:63–22:65 parallels MAT 26:67–26:68, MRK 14:65
See also LUK 23:11; MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20; JHN 19:1–19:3; MAT 27:39–27:44 parallels MRK 15:29–15:32, LUK 23:35–23:37

God's messengers scorned

2CH 36:15–36:16 See also 2CH 30:6–30:10; ACT 2:1–2:13, ACT 17:17–17:18, ACT 17:32; HEB 11:36

God's people may suffer ridicule for their faith

PSA 22:6–22:8 JOB 12:4, JOB 16:10, JOB 19:18, JOB 30:1, JOB 30:9; PSA 35:15–35:25, PSA 42:10, PSA 69:10–69:12, PSA 79:4, PSA 89:50–89:51, PSA 123:3–123:4; ; JER 20:7; ; LAM 2:15–2:16, LAM 3:14, LAM 3:63

Divine judgment because of ridicule

ZEP 2:8–2:11 See also PRO 3:34; ISA 28:22

God ridicules his enemies

PSA 2:4–2:5 See also PSA 59:8

8819: scoffing

Treating individuals, people, ideas or values with contempt or ridicule. Scripture indicates that God's word and his people can expect to be treated with contempt by the world.

Objects of scoffing**Nations punished by God**

JER 19:8 See also 1KI 9:6–9:9; JER 49:17, JER 50:13; LAM 2:15–2:17; ZEP 2:13–2:15

God's messengers

2CH 36:15–36:16

Reasons for scoffing**Unbelief**

2PE 3:3–3:4 See also ACT 13:41; HAB 1:5; JUD 1:17–1:19

Arrogance

HAB 1:10 See also PSA 73:3–73:8; ISA 28:14–28:15

Lack of wisdom

PRO 29:9

God scoffs at the nations

PSA 59:5–59:8 See also PSA 2:1–2:6

8820: self-confidence

A positive assessment of one's own abilities and resources. Scripture censures excessive self-confidence, in that such an attitude lacks humility and fails to recognise the role of God's grace in the Christian life.

Excessive self-confidence**In one's own abilities**

ISA 28:15; MAT 26:33–26:35 parallels MRK 14:29–14:31, LUK 23:33–23:34, JHN 13:37–13:38 See also LUK 22:33–22:34; JDG 16:20; 1KI 20:11; 2KI 19:23–19:24; JOB 8:13–8:14; PSA 49:5–49:6; JER 17:5; HOS 12:8

Excessive self-confidence leads to pride

ISA 9:9–9:10; OBA 1:3 See also GEN 11:4, GEN 37:5; EXO 15:9; 2CH 26:16; PRO 16:18; ISA 16:6; EZK 28:2; ACT 8:9; ROM 11:17–11:18; 1CO 5:2; 1JN 2:16

Challenges to excessive self-confidence

NEH 6:16; 1CO 4:7 See also PSA 49:12–49:13, PSA 52:7; PRO 3:5–3:7, PRO 11:28, PRO 28:26; ISA 5:21, ISA 14:13–14:15; JER 49:7, JER 49:4–49:5; JAS 4:13–4:16

Excessive self-confidence is a barrier to justification

LUK 18:9–18:14

Accurate self-confidence**Of one's natural advantages**

PHP 3:4–3:6 See also ACT 22:3, ACT 22:28

Of one's experience of God

2CO 12:2 See also ACT 22:4–22:21; 2CO 12:1, 2CO 13:5–13:6; GAL 1:13–1:17, GAL 6:4

Of one's calling to serve

2CO 10:8 See also 2CO 10:13–10:17; GAL 2:7

Of one's service

ACT 20:19; ROM 12:3 See also ACT 20:18, ACT 20:20–20:21; 1CO 9:15–9:18; 2CO 1:12; PHP 2:16; 1TH 2:1–2:12

Of one's own weakness

2CO 11:29–11:30 See also 2CO 11:21–11:28, 2CO 12:9

Accurate self-estimates lead to justification

LUK 18:9–18:14

Justified self-confidence may appear as pride

2CO 11:17–11:18

Jesus Christ's accurate assessment of himself

MAT 16:15–16:17 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20–9:21 See also MAT 26:62–26:64; JHN 13:13

The proper source of all confidence

JER 9:23–9:24 See also PSA 34:2, PSA 44:6–44:7; ISA 10:15; 1CO 1:27–1:31

8821: self-indulgence

Throwing off restraint and discipline and yielding to the desire to gratify selfish appetites and cravings. Scripture warns against such a characteristic and urges, instead, self-control, generosity and consideration for others.

The desire to satisfy selfish cravings

EPH 2:3 See also ROM 7:8, ROM 16:18; TIT 3:3; JAS 1:14; 2PE 2:18–2:19; 1JN 2:16

Examples of self-indulgent desires

Selfish ambition

JAS 3:14–3:16 See also PRO 18:1; GAL 5:20; PHP 1:17

The desire for one's own way

ISA 56:11–56:12 See also DEU 29:19; EST 1:10–1:12; JAS 4:1–4:3

The desire for sexual gratification

GAL 5:19 See also GEN 19:5 NUM 25:1; 1CO 10:8 2SA 11:2–11:4 David's adultery with Bathsheba; 2SA 13:11–13:14 Amnon's rape of Tamar; PRO 7:16–7:18 the lure of the adulteress; 2CO 12:21 sexual sin in the church at Corinth; 2PE 2:14 sexual desires of false teachers

The desire for wealth

JAS 5:3–5:5 See also JOS 7:21 Achan; 1SA 8:3 Samuel's sons; JER 22:17 Jehoiakim, king of Judah; HAG 1:4 the people of Judah; TIT 1:11 false teachers in Crete

Indulgence in food and drink

ISA 22:13 See also PRO 23:20; ECC 6:7

Abandoning restraint

EPH 4:19 See also ROM 1:26–1:31; 2TI 3:1–3:4; JUD 1:7

The consequences of self-indulgence

Self-indulgence proves futile

ECC 2:1–2:11 See also LUK 12:18–12:21

Self-indulgence leads to ruin

PRO 21:17 See also PRO 6:26, PRO 23:21, PRO 23:29–23:32; LUK 15:13–15:16; 1TI 5:6

Self-indulgence brings God's judgment

ROM 2:8 See also PRO 5:20–5:21; PHP 3:19; DAN 4:29–4:32 God's judgment on Nebuchadnezzar's selfish pride; AMO 4:1–4:2 God's judgment on Israel's pampered upper-class women; AMO 6:4–6:7 God's judgment on Israel's self-indulgent nobility; LUK 12:19–12:20

Dealing with self-indulgence

Receiving new life through Jesus Christ

MAT 23:25 Dealing with self-indulgence requires an inner transformation. See also ROM 12:2; COL 2:21–

2:23 **ROM 13:14** See also GAL 5:24; TIT 2:11–2:12 ROM 8:5; GAL 5:16

Seeking God's will

PSA 119:36; ; 1PE 1:14, 1PE 4:2

Self-control

1TH 4:3–4:5 See also PRO 23:4; 1CO 9:25–9:27; 1PE 4:7; 2PE 1:6

Ruthless self-denial

COL 3:5 See also DAN 1:8; MAT 5:28–5:29; 1PE 2:11

Consideration for others

GAL 5:13 See also 1CO 10:23–10:24; PHP 2:3–2:4

Generosity

DEU 15:7–15:8; ; LUK 19:8

8822: self-justification

A self-centred attitude by which people defend their actions and beliefs without reference to God. Scripture insists that the confidence and ultimate justification of believers lie with God, and condemns those who look elsewhere for these.

The impossibility of self-justification

Self-justification is impossible before a holy God

JOB 25:4 See also 1SA 6:20; MAL 3:2; REV 6:17

Justification is achieved by God, not by people

ROM 5:1–5:2 See also ROM 3:27–3:30; GAL 2:20–2:21

How self-justification occurs

Self-justification occurs through ignoring God and his ways

NEH 9:16 See also LUK 16:14–16:15

Self-justification occurs through pride

LUK 18:9–18:14 See also MAT 23:1–23:7 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:45–20:46; ROM 2:17–2:27

Self-justification occurs through legalism

LUK 10:25–10:29 See also GAL 3:1–3:5, GAL 5:4

Self-justification causes separation from God and Jesus Christ

GAL 5:4 See also MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 18:9–18:14

Examples of self-justification

GEN 3:8–3:12 Adam; ; EXO 32:19–32:24 Aaron; ; 1SA 13:7–13:14 Saul; ; MAT 19:16–19:22 parallels MRK 10:17–10:22, LUK 18:18–18:23 the rich young man; ; PHP 3:4–3:9 Paul as a Pharisee

God's attitude to self-justification

God's condemnation of self-justification
ROM 2:1–2:11

God's punishment of self-justification
PRO 29:1 See also GEN 3:8–3:19; JER 6:19–6:23

The true basis of justification

People are justified by God's grace alone
EPH 2:8–2:9 See also ROM 3:21–3:24; TIT 2:11, TIT 3:4–3:7

God accepts those who trust in his mercy without trying to justify themselves
PSA 130:3–130:4 See also PSA 143:2; LUK 18:9–18:14

8823: self-righteousness

A moral self-confidence and superiority arising from satisfaction in one's own achievements. True righteousness can only be found in a relationship with Jesus Christ.

8824: self-righteousness, nature of

Self-righteousness fosters the sinful human illusions of sinlessness, sufficiency and freedom.

The claim to self-righteousness

ROM 10:3 See also LUK 10:29, LUK 18:9; PHP 3:4–3:6

The illusion of self-righteousness

That people are sinless
1JN 1:8 See also PRO 20:9; HOS 12:8

That people are guiltless
PRO 16:2 See also JER 2:34–2:35

That people are deserving
DEU 9:4 See also EZK 28:2

The results of self-righteousness

Self-deception
1JN 1:5–1:6 See also PRO 30:12; JER 17:9; MAT 23:23–23:24, MAT 23:27–23:28; LUK 16:15; HEB 3:13

A sense of superiority
LUK 18:9–18:11 See also PHP 2:3; COL 2:16–2:18

Separation from God
1JN 1:10 See also ZEP 3:11; 2CO 10:18; GAL 5:4

Examples of self-righteousness

NUM 16:3 some Israelites opposed to Moses; ; 1SA 15:13–15:21 Saul; ; PSA 10:5 the wicked; LUK 16:14, LUK 18:9–18:14; ; JHN 9:39–9:41; REV 3:17–3:18 the church at Laodicea

8825: self-righteousness, and the gospel

Self-righteousness is an obstacle to the gospel, which insists that true righteousness can only be found in Jesus Christ.

The real issue of righteousness

JOB 9:2 See also 1SA 6:20; JOB 4:17, JOB 15:14, JOB 32:2 Although Elihu had misjudged Job, his main point, that only God was righteous, was correct; JOB 40:8; PSA 130:3

True righteousness is not the result of human effort

ROM 3:20 Even though God's law tells people what God requires, human beings cannot keep it because of the weakness of their sinful human natures. See also ROM 9:31; GAL 2:16, GAL 3:11; EPH 2:8–2:9; TIT 3:5; 1JN 2:16

Self-righteousness is a contradiction in terms

2CH 6:36; ISA 64:6 See also EZR 9:15; PSA 14:3; ECC 7:20; DAN 9:7; ROM 3:10, ROM 3:23

God calls people from their pretended self-righteousness

ISA 2:22 See also PSA 75:2–75:4; JER 17:5; MAT 5:20

True righteousness

It comes from God
ROM 10:3 See also PSA 98:2; ISA 46:13, ISA 51:5; JER 9:23–9:24; ROM 1:17

It is grounded in Jesus Christ
ACT 13:39 See also 1CO 1:30; 2CO 5:21

It comes about by faith
ROM 5:1 See also GAL 5:5; EPH 2:8

It is received in humility
LUK 18:13–18:14 See also ROM 3:27, ROM 4:2; 1CO 1:31, 1CO 4:7; 2CO 11:30, 2CO 12:9; GAL 6:13–6:14; EPH 2:9; PHP 3:7–3:9

8827: selfishness

A self-centred concern for oneself, without due regard to the needs of others. Scripture treats selfishness as an aspect of sin and urges believers to care for others as well as themselves.

Selfishness is a characteristic of the sinner

ROM 8:5; 2CO 5:15 See also PRO 18:1; ROM 2:8; EPH 2:3

Selfishness is a characteristic of sinful society

2TI 3:1–3:2 See also JDG 17:6, JDG 21:25

Expressions of selfishness

Greed

MAT 23:25 See also MRK 12:7; LUK 12:13–12:21; ACT 5:3

Ambition

PHP 2:3 See also JER 45:5; GAL 5:19–5:20; PHP 1:17; JAS 3:14–3:16

Boastfulness

DAN 4:30

Examples of selfishness

See also GEN 11:4 the builders of the tower of Babel; GEN 13:10–13:11 Lot in his choice of territory; EZK 28:2–28:5 the king of Tyre; EZK 34:8 Israel's leaders; MRK 10:35 James and John

Self-absorption as the result of pain or depression

JOB 14:22; 1KI 19:10

Antidotes to selfishness

God's word

PSA 119:36

The example of Jesus Christ

ROM 15:3 See also PHP 2:4–2:8

Dying to the old nature

ROM 6:6 See also EPH 4:22; COL 3:9

Serving one another

1PE 4:10 See also 1CO 10:24

Loving one another

JHN 13:34 See also MAT 22:39; ROM 13:8–13:10

8828: spite

The malicious desire to retaliate in words or action. It may be in response to good or evil. Believers are to rid themselves of any such vindictive spirit.

Examples of people acting out of spite

In response to good

1KI 19:1–19:2 Jezebel; ; 2CH 16:10 Asa, king of Judah; ; EST 3:6 Haman; ; MAT 14:3–14:12 parallel MRK 6:17–6:29 Herodias; ; JHN 12:10 the chief priests; ACT 7:54, ACT 7:57–7:58

In response to evil

PSA 140:3 See also GEN 27:41 Esau; GEN 37:4, GEN 37:8, GEN 37:11, GEN 37:18–37:27 EZK 25:15 the Philistines; ACT 23:12–23:15 some Jews

Spite has no place in the lives of believers

Believers are to rid themselves of all spitefulness

EPH 4:31 See also 1CO 5:8; COL 3:8; 1PE 2:1

As a result believers are enabled not to retaliate against others

LEV 19:18 See also PRO 20:22, PRO 24:29; MAT 5:38–5:40; ROM 12:17, ROM 12:19–12:21; 1TH 5:15; 1PE 2:21–2:23, 1PE 3:9

8829: superstition

Misplaced credulity concerning the supernatural, which leads to irrational fear, misdirected reverence, false religion and magic, and which brings God's judgment. Scripture warns against and condemns such things.

Superstition causing irrational fear

JER 10:2 See also JOB 15:20–15:24, JOB 18:11

Fear of Jesus Christ or his disciples

MAT 14:26–14:27 parallel MRK 6:49–6:50 See also MAT 14:2 parallel MRK 6:14; ACT 5:13

Fear of other gods

1KI 20:23 See also 1KI 18:28, 1KI 20:28; ACT 17:23

Misunderstanding God's work

ACT 8:18–8:19 See also LUK 24:36–24:37; ACT 12:15, ACT 19:13 invoking the name of Jesus Christ for exorcism as though it were a magic formula; ACT 28:3–28:4

Superstition leading to misdirected reverence

ACT 14:11–14:13 See also ACT 28:5–28:6; REV 22:8–22:9

False religion

JDG 10:6–10:7 See also 1SA 7:3–7:4; 1KI 13:33, 1KI 14:15–14:16, 1KI 14:22–14:24; 2CH 28:2–28:4 parallel 2KI 16:3–16:4; JER 9:14, JER 44:17–44:18; HOS 11:2

Unhelpful speculations

1TI 1:3–1:4 See also ISA 65:2–65:3, ISA 66:17–66:18; EZK 13:2, EZK 13:17; 1TI 6:3–6:4

The true demonic source of superstition

1TI 4:1 See also REV 9:20–9:21

8830: suspicion

The belief that people or things are not as they appear. It may be based on evidence, but it can also be ill-founded, occasioned by jealousy or malicious gossip.

Suspicion of sexual impurity

DEU 22:13–22:19 See also NUM 5:11–5:31

Suspicion of drunkenness**ISA 1:9–1:18** See also ACT 2:13–2:15**Suspicion of espionage****2SA 10:1–10:5****Suspicion of treachery****ISA 18:6–18:9** See also EXO 1:9–1:10; 1SA 20:24–20:31, 1SA 21:10–21:12, 1SA 29:1–29:11**Lack of suspicion****2SA 15:7–15:12** See also 1SA 27:1–27:12; 2SA 13:1–13:11, 2SA 13:23–13:29**Evil suspicions****1TI 6:3–6:5****8831: syncretism**

The incorporation into religious faith and practice of elements from other religions, resulting in a loss of integrity and assimilation to the surrounding culture.

Syncretism in Israel

God's claim to exclusive worship, the basis of the rejection of syncretism

EXO 20:3 parallel DEU 5:7 See also DEU 6:13–6:15; JOS 24:14–24:15; 1KI 18:21**Syncretism forbidden to Israel****EXO 34:15–34:16** See also DEU 7:1–7:6; JOS 23:16; 1SA 7:3**Israelite practice of syncretism****JER 19:4–19:5** See also 2KI 17:34–17:41, 2KI 21:1–21:7 parallel 2CH 33:1–33:7; EZK 8:9–8:16**The consequence of syncretism****JER 2:5** See also DEU 18:9–18:13; 2KI 17:15–17:17; ISA 2:6**Punishment for syncretism****ZEP 1:4–1:5** See also DEU 17:2–17:7; JER 19:10–19:13; HOS 2:2–2:13**Syncretism in NT times****Mediterranean society was syncretistic**

ACT 14:11–14:13, ACT 17:16–17:23, ACT 19:13–19:16

NT opposition to syncretism**HEB 13:9** See also 1CO 10:21; GAL 4:9–4:10; COL 2:18**Monotheism is incompatible with syncretism****ISA 44:6** See also DEU 6:4–6:5; ISA 43:10–43:12; 1CO 8:4–8:6**8832: testing**

God allows his people to pass through certain experiences, so that he may see, and prove to them, that

their faith in him is genuine. Believers sometimes doubt God and test him, to see if he is true to his word, but this is forbidden in Scripture.

God tests his people**JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 1:7** See also JOB 7:17–7:18, JOB 23:10; PSA 11:5; ISA 1:25; ZEC 13:9; MAL 3:3; JAS 1:12**Examples of God testing his people collectively****EXO 16:4; DEU 8:2–8:3** See also EXO 20:20 at the giving of the law; DEU 8:16 over the gathering of manna; DEU 13:3–13:4 by their attitude to a false prophet; JDG 2:20–3:4 by leaving nations in the promised land**Examples of God testing his people individually****GEN 22:1–22:2** See also JDG 7:4–7:7 Gideon; 2CH 32:31 Hezekiah; 2CO 12:7–12:9 Paul**Jesus Christ tested the faith of people when he was on earth****JHN 6:5–6:6** See also MAT 15:22–15:28 parallel MRK 7:25–7:30 a Canaanite woman; MRK 8:17–8:21 his disciples**Believers have a responsibility to test the quality of their lives****ROM 12:2** See also PSA 17:3PSA 26:2, PSA 139:23 LAM 3:40; 2CO 13:5; GAL 6:4; 1TH 5:21**God will make a final test of believers' lives and service****1CO 3:12–3:15****People may test God as an expression of faith and obedience****MAL 3:10** See also JDG 6:39**People must not test God as an expression of doubt and disobedience****EXO 17:2** See also EXO 17:7; NUM 14:22–14:23; DEU 6:16, DEU 33:8; PSA 78:18, PSA 78:41, PSA 78:56, PSA 95:8; MAT 4:7 parallel LUK 4:12; DEU 6:16; MAT 19:3 parallel MRK 10:2; ACT 5:9, ACT 15:10; HEB 3:8–3:9**The command to test the spirits****1JN 4:1****8833: threats**

Intimidating announcements of action to be taken unless conditions are met. God uses threats against tyrannical and disobedient earthly rulers as a means of restoring them to obedience and humility in his sight. God's people are not to threaten others and though the wicked will sometimes seek to intimidate them, they are to rely on God's protection.

God threatened Pharaoh

See also EXO 8:1–8:4, EXO 8:21, EXO 9:2–9:3, EXO 9:13–9:14, EXO 10:3–10:6

God threatened his own people

In general

JOS 23:15–23:16 See also LEV 26:14–26:20; DEU 11:26–11:28, DEU 28:15–28:20; 1SA 12:15, 1SA 12:25; 1KI 9:6–9:7

Regarding the Babylonian captivity

EZK 6:9–6:10 See also JER 6:8, JER 22:5–22:7, JER 44:28–44:29

Threats made by God may be averted

Through a faithful intercessor

EXO 32:11–32:14 See also NEH 1:8–1:9

Through turning from evil

JON 3:10

The result of threats inflicted by God may be alleviated

Through returning to the LORD

DEU 30:1–30:3

Through submission to God's will

See also JER 27:6–27:13

God's people may be threatened by others

ACT 9:1 See also 2KI 18:17–18:35 parallel ISA 36:1–36:20; NEH 4:7–4:8; PSA 55:9–55:11, PSA 73:8

God's people, when threatened, are to rely on him

PSA 64:1–64:10 See also 2KI 19:6–19:7 parallel ISA 37:6–37:7; NEH 6:11–6:14; ISA 30:17–30:18; ACT 4:17–4:21, ACT 4:29–4:30

God's people are not to threaten others

EPH 6:9 See also 1PE 2:20–2:23

The rich are more likely to be threatened than the poor

PRO 13:8

8834: unbelief

The lack of faith and trust in God that challenges his truthfulness and finds expression in disobedience and rebellion.

8835: unbelief, nature and effects of

Unbelief, or the failure to trust God, holds back his blessing and leads to condemnation and spiritual death.

The nature of unbelief

Not trusting God

PSA 78:22

Rebelling against God

HEB 3:12 See also PSA 78:40; HEB 3:16

Disobeying God

HEB 11:31 NIV footnote. See also EPH 2:2; HEB 3:18–3:19, HEB 4:11

Questioning God's truthfulness

1JN 5:10 See also PSA 106:24; 1JN 1:10

Unbelief as the result of the devil's work

Taking away God's word

LUK 8:12 parallels MAT 13:19, MRK 4:15

Causing spiritual blindness

2CO 4:4 See also ROM 1:21; 2CO 4:3; EPH 4:18

Unbelief as the result of not belonging to God

JHN 10:26 See also JHN 5:38, JHN 8:44–8:45, JHN 12:37–12:40; 1CO 2:14

Unbelief hinders Jesus Christ's miracles

MAT 13:58 parallel MRK 6:5–6:6

The consequences of persistent unbelief

Failure to receive God's reward

HEB 3:19 The "rest" that God's people enjoyed on entering the promised land is here taken to symbolise the final reward prepared by God for his people. See also HEB 4:1–4:2, HEB 4:6; JUD 1:5

Exclusion from the people of God

ROM 11:20 See also HEB 6:4–6:6

Death in sin

JHN 8:24 See also PSA 106:43; MRK 4:12; ACT 10:43

God's wrath

JHN 3:36 See also ROM 1:18, ROM 2:5, ROM 2:8

Condemnation by God

JHN 3:18 See also MRK 16:16; LUK 12:46; JHN 12:48; 2TH 2:12; REV 21:8

8836: unbelief, as response to God

The stubborn and sinful refusal to accept God's word and his messengers. Since the coming of Jesus Christ it is frequently expressed in the rejection of his person and teaching.

Unbelief expressed towards God

PSA 78:22

Rebellion against God

2KI 17:14–17:15 See also NEH 9:16; PSA 78:17–78:19, PSA 95:8–95:11; ISA 65:2; JER 7:26; ACT 7:51; HEB 3:12–3:19

Rejection of God's promises

PSA 106:24 See also ROM 4:20, ROM 10:16; HEB 4:2

Unbelief expressed towards Jesus Christ**Rejection by those close to him**

JHN 1:11 See also MAT 13:54–13:58 parallel MRK 6:1–6:6; LUK 4:14–4:30; JHN 7:5

Rejection of his miracles

MAT 12:22–12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:14–11:16

Rejection of his claims

See also LUK 22:67; JHN 5:37–5:38, JHN 6:36, JHN 6:64, JHN 10:24–10:26; 1PE 2:7

Rejection of his words

JHN 3:11–3:12 See also JHN 5:46–5:47, JHN 8:45

Demands for miraculous signs

JHN 4:48 See also MAT 12:38–12:39 parallel LUK 11:29; MAT 16:4 parallel MRK 8:12; LUK 11:16

Unbelief expressed towards God's messengers

GEN 19:16 Lot; ; EXO 4:1 Moses; ; 2KI 7:2 Elisha; ; 2CH 32:15 Sennacherib of Assyria urges the inhabitants of Jerusalem to disbelieve Hezekiah's words; ; ISA 53:1 Isaiah; ; MAT 21:32 John the Baptist; ACT 13:50, ACT 14:2; ACT 17:13 Paul and Silas; ACT 19:9, ACT 28:24

Unbelief expressed in unrighteousness

TIT 1:15 See also ROM 1:18; 2TH 2:12, 2TH 3:2; 1TI 1:13

Unbelief despite miraculous signs

NEH 9:16–9:17 See also EXO 4:8–4:9; PSA 78:32; JHN 9:18, JHN 10:31–10:33, JHN 12:37

Means of overcoming unbelief

JHN 10:37–10:38 the evidence of Jesus Christ's miracles; ; ROM 10:14–10:15 preaching the gospel; ; 1CO 14:22–14:24 prophecy in worship; ; 1PE 3:1 the behaviour of a believing spouse; ; 1TI 1:13 God's mercy

8837: unbelief, and life of faith

Believers may go through periods of doubt and indecision, especially on account of difficulties in trusting God or accepting certain aspects of his will for them.

General examples of unbelief in believers**Abraham**

GEN 17:17 See also GEN 15:8

Sarah

GEN 18:13–18:14

Moses

NUM 11:21–11:22

Gideon

JDG 6:12–6:13, JDG 6:17, JDG 6:36–6:40

Elisha's servant

2KI 4:42–4:44

Zechariah

LUK 1:20

John the Baptist

MAT 11:3

The unbelief of Jesus Christ's disciples**Unbelief concerning Jesus Christ's power over the natural world**

MAT 8:24–8:26 parallels MRK 4:38–4:40, LUK 8:23–8:25 **MAT 14:26** parallel MRK 6:49 **MAT 14:29–14:31**, **MAT 16:8–16:10** parallel MRK 8:17–8:21 See also MRK 6:37 parallel JHN 6:7; MRK 6:52; MAT 15:33 parallel MRK 8:4; JHN 11:39; ACT 12:15–12:17

Unbelief concerning Jesus Christ's resurrection

MRK 16:14; **LUK 24:25** See also MRK 16:9–16:13; LUK 24:11, LUK 24:37–24:41; JHN 20:25

Unbelief concerning Jesus Christ's power to heal

MAT 17:17 parallels MRK 9:19, LUK 9:41 See also MAT 17:19–17:20

Encouragements in overcoming unbelief

MRK 9:24; **JHN 14:11** See also MAT 11:4–11:6; JHN 10:37–10:38, JHN 20:30–20:31; ROM 4:20

8839: unfaithfulness

The failure to fulfil the obligations of a relationship, resulting in disloyalty to God and to others.

8840: unfaithfulness, to God

In the OT the terms of the covenant with God were constantly broken by Israel by acts of idolatry and disobedience. The consequence was God's judgment, which eventually included exile.

Warnings within the covenant

NEH 1:8; ; LEV 26:1, LEV 26:14–26:17, LEV 26:31–26:33; ; DEU 4:25–4:27, DEU 8:19–8:20; ; PRO 2:22; ; EZK 14:13, EZK 15:8

Unfaithfulness seen in idolatry**Idolatry as marital unfaithfulness**

JER 3:20 The covenant between God and Israel at Sinai viewed in terms of a marriage contract; **JER 3:6–3:9** See also JER 3:12–3:14, JER 9:2, JER 31:32; HOS 1:2

Idolatry as prostitution

1CH 5:25; ; HOS 4:10–4:12, HOS 9:1

Idolatry as abandoning God**JER 1:16** See also JDG 10:13; JER 5:19, JER 15:6**Unfaithfulness seen in other forms of disobedience****Trust in money and possessions****JOB 31:24–31:28** See also JER 49:4**Doing wrong to others****NUM 5:5–5:6** See also LEV 6:2; PRO 11:3, PRO 13:2; ISA 1:21–1:23; HOS 6:6–6:7**Marrying foreign wives****EZR 10:2** See also EZR 9:1–9:4; NEH 13:27**Withholding tithes and offerings**

JOS 7:1, JOS 22:20; ; MAL 3:8

Breaches in the ritual law

1SA 14:33; ; MAL 1:7–1:8

Unfaithfulness as a characteristic of God's people throughout the OT**JER 5:11** See also ACT 7:37–7:41; JDG 2:16–2:17; NEH 9:26; HAG 1:7–1:9**Unfaithfulness among Israel's leadership****The unfaithfulness of the priesthood****EZR 9:1–9:2** See also 2CH 36:14; EZK 22:26; MAL 2:7–2:8**Unfaithful kings**

Solomon's unfaithfulness leads to unfaithfulness among his subjects: 1KI 11:4–11:5, 1KI 11:33; 2CH 12:1–12:2 Rehoboam; ; 2CH 26:16–26:18 Uzziah's bad example; 2CH 28:19–28:23, 2CH 29:19; 2KI 21:9 parallel 2CH 33:9; ; 2KI 21:16; ; 2CH 33:19

Unfaithfulness leads to judgment

DEU 32:20; ; PSA 73:27, PSA 78:56–78:59; ; PRO 21:18

Individuals judged for unfaithfulness

JOS 7:1, JOS 7:25; ; 1CH 10:13

Wandering in the desert**NUM 14:33** See also NUM 14:34–14:35**The people taken into exile****EZK 39:23** See also 1CH 9:1; DAN 9:7**Restoration following repentance****EZK 39:25–39:26** God's purpose through the exile is to bring about the eventual repentance and restoration of his people. See also LEV 26:40–26:42; DEU 30:1–30:3; NEH 1:8–1:9**8841: unfaithfulness, to people**

A breach of the trust that is expected within specific relationships, and also a failure of mutual responsibility within a community life; the breaking of the last six of the Ten Commandments.

Unfaithfulness to one another breaks God's commandments**LEV 19:18** See also EXO 20:12–20:17; DEU 5:16–5:21; MAT 22:39 parallel MRK 12:31; ROM 1:29–1:31**Unfaithfulness to promises made****NUM 30:2** See also NUM 30:9; JOS 9:20; 1SA 20:42**Unfaithfulness in business**

MAT 25:24–25:26; ; LUK 16:3–16:12, LUK 19:8

Unfaithfulness to the marriage covenant**MAL 2:14–2:15****The seriousness of marital unfaithfulness**

Adultery in the OT punishable by death: LEV 20:10; ; DEU 22:22; ; JHN 8:3–8:5; MAT 5:32, MAT 19:9

Examples of marital unfaithfulness

JDG 19:1–19:2; HOS 1:2–1:3, HOS 2:2, HOS 2:5

Unfaithfulness among family and friends**MIC 7:5–7:6****God's people may face opposition from their families****JER 12:6** See also 2SA 15:10; MAT 10:21 parallels MRK 13:12, LUK 21:16**Unfaithful friends cause great sorrow****PSA 55:12–55:14** See also PSA 41:9, PSA 55:20–55:21 JOB 6:14–6:17; PSA 38:11; PRO 25:19**Unfaithfulness to Jesus Christ during his earthly ministry****Jesus Christ deserted by his followers****JHN 6:66, JHN 16:32** See also MAT 26:31 parallel MRK 14:27; ZEC 13:7; MAT 26:56 parallel MRK 14:50**Jesus Christ betrayed by Judas**

MAT 26:47–26:50 parallels MRK 14:43–14:46, LUK 22:47–22:48; ; JHN 18:2–18:5

Jesus Christ denied by Peter

MAT 26:74 parallels MRK 14:71–14:72, LUK 22:59–22:61; ; JHN 18:26–18:27

Unfaithfulness to God's appointed leaders**The Israelites challenge their leaders****EXO 16:3–16:8** See also 1SA 8:7–8:8

Paul's friends desert him**2TI 1:15** See also 2TI 4:9–4:11, 2TI 4:16**Examples of treachery and betrayal**

JDG 16:18–16:19 Samson betrayed by Delilah; ; 2SA 3:27 Joab murders Abner; ; 2SA 4:5–4:6 Ish-Bosheth assassinated by Recab and Baanah; ; 2SA 11:14–11:15 David has Uriah killed in battle; ; 2SA 20:9–20:10 Amasa killed by Joab; ; 1KI 21:8–21:10 Jezebel's treachery towards Naboth

8843: unforgivable sin

The wilful, outwardly expressed and impenitent slander against the Holy Spirit, when Jesus Christ's mighty works, clearly performed by the power of the Holy Spirit, are attributed to Satan, thus subjecting Christ to public disgrace.

The unforgivable sin is slandering the Holy Spirit**MAT 12:31–12:32** parallel MRK 3:28–3:29 See also LUK 12:10; HEB 10:26–10:29**The unforgivable sin is attributing Jesus Christ's miracles to Satan****MRK 3:30** See also MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15**8844: unforgiveness**

God remains unforgiving to those described as unrepentant, who blaspheme against the Holy Spirit and who are themselves unforgiving. Being unforgiving and demonstrating true love are mutually exclusive.

The unforgiveness of God**Towards the unrepentant****DEU 29:18–29:21** See also EXO 23:21, EXO 34:7; NUM 14:18; JOS 24:19; 2KI 24:4; ISA 30:12–30:14; JER 5:7; LAM 3:42; HOS 1:6; LUK 18:10–18:14; HEB 10:28–10:31**Towards those whose hearts are hardened**

JOS 11:20; ; MAT 13:13–13:15 parallels MRK 4:11–4:12, LUK 8:9–8:10; ; ISA 6:9–6:10; ; JHN 9:39–9:41, JHN 20:23

Towards those who blaspheme against the Holy Spirit**MAT 12:31–12:32** parallels MRK 3:28–3:29, LUK 12:10 Blasphemy against the Spirit probably involves attributing the authenticating miracles of Jesus Christ to the work of Satan rather than to the power of the Holy Spirit. See also 1JN 5:16**Towards those who are not forgiving****MAT 6:14–6:15; JAS 2:12–2:13** See also MAT 5:23–5:24, MAT 7:1–7:2 parallel LUK 6:37–6:38; MAT 18:32–18:35, MAT

23:23; MRK 11:25–11:26 NIV footnote at verse 26; ROM 14:9–14:13

God's people call upon him not to forgive the wicked**JER 18:23** See also NEH 4:5; ISA 2:9**True love is forgiving****ROM 5:8; 1CO 13:4–13:5** See also PSA 86:5, PSA 130:3–130:4; DAN 9:9; MIC 7:18; ACT 13:38; ROM 15:7; 2CO 2:5–2:11; EPH 4:32; COL 3:13**8845: unfruitfulness**

A lack of fruitfulness, whether material or spiritual, which is often seen as a sign of God's disfavour or anger.

Unfruitfulness as a moral or spiritual condition**MAT 21:19** parallel MRK 11:14 See also JOB 15:32–15:33; EZK 17:9, EZK 19:10–19:12; MAT 21:43; HEB 6:7–6:8**Reasons for unfruitfulness****Disobedience****LEV 26:18–26:20** See also DEU 11:17, DEU 28:15–28:16; PSA 78:46, PSA 107:33–107:34; ISA 5:10, ISA 32:10; HOS 8:7; HAG 2:19**A continuing preoccupation with the world****MAT 13:22** parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14**A broken relationship with Jesus Christ****JHN 15:4** See also JHN 15:6**Some results of unfruitfulness****Unfruitfulness condemned**

ISA 5:1–5:7

Unfruitfulness leads to rejection

MAT 3:8–3:10 parallel LUK 3:9; ; MAT 7:19

Unfruitfulness retrieved**LUK 13:6–13:9** The parable holds out the possibility of restoration.**Discipline with a view to renewed fruitfulness****JHN 15:2****8846: ungodliness**

The state of believing in God, while adopting a lifestyle which seems to deny this. Believers are warned to guard against ungodliness.

Expressions of ungodliness

A defiant spirit towards God

MAT 7:6 Jesus Christ is teaching his disciples not to share the riches of spiritual truth with persons who are persistently unappreciative, vicious and defiant. See also JOB 36:8–36:13; PSA 73:8–73:11

Mocking God and/or his people

2PE 3:3–3:4 See also PSA 35:15–35:16; ACT 13:40–13:41; HAB 1:5

Evil behaviour

ISA 32:6–32:7 See also PRO 11:9; JON 1:1–1:2; 1TI 1:9–1:11

Examples of ungodliness

2CH 36:15–36:16 the southern kingdom of Judah; ; PSA 52:1–52:3 Doeg the Edomite; ; ISA 9:13–9:17 the northern kingdom of Israel; JER 23:11–23:12, JER 23:15–23:17; 1CO 6:9–6:11; ; EPH 2:1–2:3; 2TI 3:1–3:5 people in general during the last days (the time between the first and second comings of Jesus Christ); ; HEB 12:16 Esau

God will judge the ungodly

In this life

PRO 11:31 See also PRO 1:28–1:33, PRO 3:33–3:34; ISA 10:5–10:7, ISA 33:14; ROM 1:18

At the final judgment

2PE 3:7 See also JOB 27:8; PRO 3:34; 1PE 4:18; 2PE 2:4–2:10; JUD 1:14–1:15

Jesus Christ died for the ungodly

ROM 5:6–5:8, ROM 11:26; ; ISA 59:20

God's people must guard against ungodliness

By relying upon God's grace

TIT 2:11–2:12

By putting no confidence in ungodly people

1CO 6:1 See also PSA 1:1; JUD 1:3–1:4, JUD 1:17–1:19

By avoiding ungodly teaching and behaviour

2TI 2:16 See also 1TI 4:7, 1TI 6:20–6:21

8847: vulgarity

Believers are to avoid vulgar intentions

The men of Sodom had vulgar intentions

GEN 19:5

They were judged by God

GEN 19:24–19:25; ; 2PE 2:6–2:7; ; JUD 1:7

The men of Gibeah had vulgar intentions

JDG 19:22, JDG 19:25

They were punished by the Israelites

JDG 20:4–20:7, JDG 20:33–20:36, JDG 20:48

Such vulgarity is condemned by God

LEV 18:22; ; ROM 1:24–1:28

Paul warns against vulgar speech

EPH 4:29, EPH 5:4; ; COL 3:8

Believers are to avoid vulgar actions

Noah got drunk and exposed himself

GEN 9:21–9:22

Lot's daughters became pregnant by their father

GEN 19:31–19:36

Some converts led vulgar and depraved lives before conversion

1CO 6:9–6:11

The Cretans had a reputation for vulgarity

TIT 1:12, TIT 1:15–1:16

8848: worldliness

The sinful tendency to conform to the world, to be contrasted with the biblical command to maintain contact with the world while avoiding becoming like the world. Believers are called to live in the world, while not being of the world. This attitude is supremely exemplified in the ministry of Jesus Christ.

The paradox of God's love for a sinful world

JHN 3:16; ; 1JN 2:15–2:16

God's people are called to be separate from the world, yet a source of blessing to it

The example of Abraham

GEN 12:1–12:3 The life of Abraham illustrates the important biblical balance, called to separation from his native environment to be a blessing to the nations. See also GEN 15:7, GEN 18:18; GAL 3:8

The example of others

GEN 41:56–41:57 Joseph; ; DAN 2:48–2:49 Daniel and his friends

Conformity to the pagan standards of the OT world disparaged

LEV 18:28 with respect to sexual perversion; 1SA 8:5; ; 1KI 21:7; 1KI 11:7–11:8 with respect to idolatry; ; ISA 13:19 with respect to pride; ISA 31:1; ; ZEC 4:6

God's concern for the nations of the world

ISA 49:6 See also JON 4:11; REV 22:2

Jesus Christ is a model of the required balance of being in the world but not of it

He was in the world

JHN 3:16–3:17 See also JHN 9:5, JHN 16:28

He was not of the world

JHN 8:23 See also LUK 4:5–4:8 parallel MAT 4:8–4:10; JHN 17:14, JHN 18:36; 1JN 3:1

He was a friend of the disreputable

MAT 11:19 See also MRK 2:16; LUK 7:44–7:48

He was concerned for outsiders

JHN 10:16 See also MAT 28:19; MRK 7:24–7:30 parallel MAT 15:21–15:28; ACT 1:8

Believers are called to live in the world, while not being of it

They have been chosen out of the world

JHN 15:19 See also JHN 17:14, JHN 17:16; 2CO 6:17

They must avoid conformity with the world

ROM 12:2 See also 1TH 4:3–4:5; 2TI 4:10; TIT 2:12; JAS 1:27; 1PE 1:14–1:16, 1PE 4:3–4:4; 1JN 2:15, 1JN 5:4

They must maintain contact with the world

1CO 5:9–5:10 See also JHN 17:11

They must do good in the world

GAL 6:10 See also TIT 2:14

8849: worry

A sense of uneasiness and anxiety about the future. Scripture indicates that such anxiety is ultimately grounded in a lack of trust in God and his purposes.

The causes of worry

Being world-centred

MAT 6:25 parallel LUK 12:22 See also MAT 6:34, MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14; LUK 12:29, LUK 21:34; 1CO 7:33

Lacking confidence in God

JHN 14:1 See also MAT 6:26–6:32 parallel LUK 12:27–12:30; MAT 8:25 parallels MRK 4:38, LUK 8:24; MAT 14:31, MAT 16:8

Abandoning God

DEU 28:64–28:65 See also LAM 1:3; EZK 4:16–4:17, EZK 12:19

Worry leads people away from God

PSA 37:8 See also PRO 12:25; MAT 13:22 parallel LUK 8:14; LUK 10:40–10:42

Worry is futile

MAT 6:27 parallel LUK 12:25 See also ECC 2:22–2:23

Remedies for worry

Being God-centred

ISA 26:3; MAT 6:33 parallel LUK 12:31 See also JER 17:7–17:8; ROM 8:6

Prayer

PSA 55:22; PHP 4:6–4:7 See also PSA 94:18–94:19, PSA 139:23; 1PE 5:7